

CLAUDIO NARANJO
Eneatypes Psychology

ENVY

SELFLESS, HATERSESS
AND MELANCHOLICS



4

ENGLISH EDITION

2nd EDITION

ENNEAGRAM IV - STANDALONE

ENVY:

ORGANIZED BY:

Horus Cadent (AKA horus.who)

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PREFACE OF THE FIRST EDITION

Howdy!! Here's Horus, first of all, my greetings to my little random work I've decided to do, and that's why I'm here, explain this document, to begin I think should say that this all was only a simple work of mine to the typography community, I've found a strange media of the E4 Book, the *Envidia*, but its texts was a real mess, since then my organization sense has awaken and I've decided to put my hands on that little messy information source, was because of this that you, reader, has the chance to enjoy the E4 book in a more polite way, I believe that's all, thanks again for sharing or reading this file, see ya!

PREFACE OF THE SECOND EDITION

Hello there! Horus here, so, today I'm presenting y'all with a new edition of the *Envidia* or Envy book or Standalone, this book refers to all the three subtypes of this Naranjo's Enneagram Theory, I hope it helps you read a little better than before, said that, see ya!

PRESENTATION

By Claudio Naranjo

I don't remember when exactly, but surely more than twenty years ago I conceived the book that with this seventh volume (of nine) continues to grow slowly.

It would not be a book written by me, but one that would embody and develop my understanding of the twenty-seven characters recognized by the application of the Enneagram to personality that I originally learned during the years 1969-1970 (more implicitly than explicitly) by Oscar Ichazo and that I have been developing ever since.

The conception of the book has been to present each of the characters through:

1. An autobiography written by another of my disciples, who could be said to have travelled a rich path of transformation, and who was willing to produce a document that implied a public confession (given the sincerity that a biographical account would implicate before his family and his acquaintances). The usefulness of such an exercise in "transparency" through the Publishing one's own autobiography is something I had come to believe in the light of previous experiences, so I proposed it in that spirit, and indeed it has been a rich experience for the participants.
2. A theoretical chapter (whose set could well be considered a treatise on the psychology of enneatypes) with a structure that I formulated a long time ago and proposed to develop a series of disciples, in collaboration with other volunteers.

Naturally, the presentation of the various characters through these two complementary modalities - that of the psychological essay and that of the narrative - would speak to the two cerebral hemispheres ("scientific" and "humanistic") of the readers.

Surely, the twenty-seven chapters that would make up the "treatise on the psychology of enneatypes" would be of particular interest to academic psychologists, and it is to be hoped that the set of twenty-seven exemplary biographies will interest all readers who want to find among them your psychospiritual brother or sister; Well, it helps a lot to become aware of ourselves when we encounter the process of self-knowledge of someone who looks like us and has known how to have the courage and humility to discover their shadow in order to put their "descent into hell" in words.

Slowly the project for this work matured in nine volumes (each dedicated to the three enneatypes corresponding to one of the nine passions recognized by Ichazo's protoanalysis) until David Barba suggested that we set the publication dates for the books in question. This step would imply a more active editing work than the one I would have been offering to my collaborators or the one that the co-authors themselves had taken until then, which is why I invited Grazia Cecchini to participate in this task, who since then he has maintained a close correspondence with them in view of the improvement of the texts. Having passed eighty-five years of age myself, I cannot help but feel that the completion of this work is coinciding with that of my life, and this gives this task a certain sense of "mission accomplished."

Interestingly, I never felt, during my early years of teaching this subject, as one with a duty to develop it or even any particular merit, and only in the face of the commercialization of the Enneagram and the quackery of imitators of my early work at Berkeley (originators of the community or international movement of the enneagram) I began to become aware of my own merit in having offered a more serious work and more transformative power. Only recently, however, with the hindsight of decades, have I come to feel that, just as Ichazo predicted, the task of being a mediator of this knowledge for the Western world of our time would fall into my hands. I hope that having put all these understandings in writing is more of a help than an impediment to your deep understanding, for I have often thought that the Egyptian god Thoth was right in imagining that the gift of writing would transform humans into mere repeaters of words, leading them away from wisdom. I imagine that in this case my future readers will be divided between those who take advantage of our efforts for their own transformation and those who prefer to dedicate themselves to their academic, cultural, and material enrichment.

It only remains for me to thank all those who have contributed to this seventh volume for both their efforts and their tolerance of my criticisms, and to wish that the success of what they have produced brings them the satisfaction of serving the massive process of self-knowledge that is characterizing our generation. I am especially grateful to Grazia for taking over as editor at a time in my life when my teaching activity and my other unfinished books require me, and also to David Barba, from Ediciones La Llave, without whose encouragement I would surely would have continued to postpone the completion of these nine volumes until it was too late to tell with my supervision.

FOREWORD TO THE SEVENTH VOLUME

By Cristina Nadal

As I write these lines, feeling honored and grateful for the assignment, I once again experience the enthusiastic energy with which I set to work on the tasks that Claudio Naranjo entrusted to me years ago: that impetus that led me to revise my conviction that I did not have sufficient capacity to carry out the orders. I am preparing, then, to preface this seventh volume of this immense work on the psychology of enneatypes feeling, with the same energy, that Claudio is still alive among us, not only because we continue to nourish ourselves with his deep, extensive and precise teachings, but also because he put us to work, to investigate, igniting and feeding our seeking spirit as reflected in the acronym SAT: Seekers After Truth, in such a way that the flame continues to burn among his students and disciples.

I began my work with Claudio in the first promotion of the SAT Program in Spain, and, together with Albert Rams -then my husband-, he entrusted me to Guillermo Borja, "Memo". Memo's excellent clinical eye and confrontational style were decisive in my maturation as a psychotherapist: I was able to support myself on the ground firmer, and I was also able to start embracing my madness. That year, at 27, and with the cognitive fixation of feeling lacking and incapable, as well as uneducated, I didn't get close to Claudio: I felt extremely small in front of him. Yes, I was greatly nourished by his brilliant synthesis of gestalt therapy, since his teachings meant for me a very important structuring and expansion of the cognitive base of this approach. His transmission of the Enneagram gave me an understanding of the psychic machinery of people, which I lacked as a Gestaltist and even as a psychologist.

At that time, the stays in the SAT were twenty-eight days. The fuse was quickly lit among all the participating people: we questioned each other, we competed to see who said something more intelligent than the others or who knew how to confront better, and at the same time we also nourished ourselves from the brotherhood that was being created in the group., just as I've felt it in every SAT course I've taken. The SAT has been my third family, and many people belonging to the Spanish Association of Gestalt Therapy also agreed on it.

Upon returning home from that first course, I identified that I had gained a specific visual perspective: by looking at a certain area, I could more accurately determine the distance at which objects were located. I took that as a reflection of the depth acquired in seeing myself and in looking at the world. Claudio's ability to relate knowledge from different fields such as psychological, spiritual, educational, and musical, based on specific and extensive knowledge of philosophy, literature, history and other disciplines, in addition to his spirit always open to new contributions, radiated a knowledge that had kaleidoscopic characteristics.

When he proposed to me to be a collaborator of the SAT, in the following promotion, it was difficult for me to imagine that he could be interested in something in my way of doing things, and I thought that perhaps he was including me in a pack with my ex-husband, well, for me, the capable and brilliant was him, not me. So, it was difficult for me to accept his recognition, and it was also very difficult for me to recognize Claudio

as a teacher: one way of maintaining my closure to the world has been not allowing myself to enjoy the forms of admiring love. Precisely, writing some texts that he asked me to, and reviewing some chapters of the book for a gestalt viva, helped me get closer to him and enjoy feeling like my teacher.

Later, I disassociated myself from the SAT due to complex personal and family situations, and because, when Claudio set out to change the world through changing education, I did not like what I perceived as a devaluation of approaches existing educational programs that did take into account the value of personal growth as opposed to indoctrination.' When I went to see him, before he travelled to Berkeley, California for the last time, he received me very well and made me feel openly heard in all my criticisms.

I feel satisfied to belong to this great family that has gone through the death of our teacher three years ago, in addition to the complications caused by the pandemic, which entailed great internal work between the different departments of the organization founded by Claudio, with very difficult moments and with outstanding journeys and fruits. For this reason, I want to express my gratitude to the Fundación Claudio Naranjo team, the SAT Program, and the Education Area of the foundation, and I also want to highlight the effort to continue collaborating with the managers and coordinators of SAT programs around the world.

One of the fruits of this effort to coordinate and continue working is the appearance of new volumes of the "Psicología de los enneatipos collection". In this book on type 4, from what I have seen and experienced in collaboration with many volunteers in this work, I want to emphasize that the execution of most of this volume has been the result of choral work, as has been the case in the different volumes of this collection. Those of us who coordinated the theoretical chapters, guided and supervised by Claudio, and later by Grazia Cecchini, made it easier for several people of each subtype to write in various chapters, guided the work and also collaborated in its writing.

I began my involvement with this volume coordinating the people of E4 sexual in January 2006, and I was lucky to have the close and highly valued collaboration of Cristina Dicuzzo, may she rest in peace. While coordinating said subgroup, I realized that I was an E4 conservation, since I saw that the sexual ones worked in a very different way from mine. From that moment on, I put my tenacity at the service of finishing the theoretical part of the sexual subtype. Later, Claudio asked me for my autobiography to be included in the conservation subtype. And, sometime later, Rossana Pavoni resumed work with the sexual subtype to update it and finish the book (together with Águeda Segado and Antonella Sabia, coordinators of the book on the conservation subtype, and Chiara Fustini, coordinator of the book on the social subtype).

Regarding the work with character, we see that the function of each enneatype, in addition to the construction of the personality in the face of emptiness and uncertainty, is one of survival and defence against traumatic experiences, pain, loneliness and childish despair. Paradoxically, each gear of character perpetuates self-estrangement and, therefore, suffering, even when what we do is force the machine to try to succeed or distract ourselves or have a good time.

Envy, a type 4 passion, has, from the outset, a very bad press, and it is also an emotion that is difficult for other people to recognize. It is the enneatype that has the worst self-image. In his early childhood, he introjects (incorporates within himself) a mother -or the main attachment figure- who has been abandoning, as a way to keep in touch with her. "By introjecting that mother who has not emotionally welcomed the baby (who for various circumstances has rejected or separated from him), the bad look on herself is also incorporated. In this way, the constant devaluation is served", I wrote years ago as a testimony about the Four conservation in Claudio's book, 27 characters in search of being. The automatic mechanism by which envy is maintained is comparison, in which the person always loses out, given who looks at what is lacking in himself (and tends to look at what is lacking in the other person and in the situation), in addition to idealizing the life of the envied person. Thus, he feeds back the lack: that lack that was real in childhood, but now it's false.

Satisfaction is, therefore, an experience to be conquered throughout a therapeutic work path that also involves accepting and dealing with one's own wound, as well as the deidealization of what a person would have to be or do to have value and feel good; those processes are well reflected in each book in this volume.

Each subtype handles the attempt to get out of the lacking situation, the real one and the false one, in different ways: the E4 conservation person, long-suffering and self-sacrificing, has a very self-demanding superego or "top dog": he believes that the more he makes an effort, the further away you will be from that bad internal image, and, in addition, you have and maintain enough energy to work and work. The difficult thing is to be able to recognize what is valuable in himself and in the results of his effort, since his gaze continues to be devaluing. Tenacity is his passion. In his motto, "whatever it takes", we see how he puts value in effort.

The sexual E4 subtype, which is the one who makes people suffer the most while suffering, believes that they must give back what they lost; his passion is hate. He is the one who handles the most aggressive charge, being at the same time the most fun and impulsive, although his bad image and his feeling of guilt do not allow him to enjoy himself or his expressive and cognitive capacity. It is also the most histrionic subtype.

In the social E4 we find the most suffering of the Fours: his strategy is to show his lack to get what he needs. His passion is shame: he cringes and withdraws, even though the social E4 person also has a great longing to be seen. It is the most melancholic subtype. Like the rest, it is very difficult for him to recognize his right to well-being.

In each book, issues specific to each subtype are repeated, with different nuances, linked to different contents that better outline their understanding and that facilitate the possibility of identifying with an enneatype for the people who read it. In addition, the theoretical chapters contain autobiographical quotes that facilitate a live understanding of what is explained (in the case of the sexual subtype, I must clarify that, due to the time that has elapsed since it was written, the names of some of the authors of the quotes have been lost).

The autobiographies allow a more experiential approach to each of the subtypes and keep alive the orientation of "putting the meat on the grill", continuing to work with one's own personal affairs and showing evolution paths, something that Claudio encouraged us to do. to promote the path of transformation.

The works on the lives of relevant people, film and book characters where characters of each subtype are identified, allow us to continue deepening and outlining the differences between them.

Reading Claudio's books on the Enneagram, and specifically these volumes, makes it easier for the person to see themselves reflected in a multitude of aspects and, therefore, they are invitations to activate self-knowledge and internal work. Naturally, if we previously identify ourselves in a type and subtype, the way of working will be more direct, but all people are made of the same paste, it's just that we come together in different structures. Given that nothing that another person experiences is really foreign to us, opening ourselves to the reflections of ourselves that the different enneatypes reveal to us and subtypes, allows us a broader trajectory of transformation and with multiple nuances. As human beings, we are very complex; Embracing this complexity allows us to feel more at ease in our own skin.

I hope that reading this and the other volumes broadens your horizons and allows you to continue the journey of transformation with greater experiential understanding and more accurate maps, even if they are not simple. Have a good trip!

Valldoreix, July 12, 2022

BY WAY OF INTRODUCTION
MAIN CONTRASTS BETWEEN THE E4 SUBTYPES:
CONSERVATION, SEXUAL AND SOCIAL

**With contributions from Eva Morote,
Chiara Fustini and Rossana Pavoni Gallo**

Once the Christian idea of envy is transcended as a grudge against the good fortune of our neighbor, we see that it goes beyond that insatiable desire that, as Dante describes, implies a "love for one's own goods perverted to the desire to deprive others." others of their own." These "assets" are tangible or intangible, that is, they also include talents or privileges. The desire for what the other possesses (or is supposed to possess) is accompanied by the painful feeling that it is lacking, which the person reads as an injustice, to which must be added a desire for the other to do well wrong or get punished, which, if it happens, is satisfying. This tells us, from the beginning, of a double nature of this passion that is evident in its characteristic subtypes, since in some cases envy is felt above all as lack and sadness for one's own condition, whether real or imagined, and in others it becomes above all voracity and the desire to harm others or to take revenge on them.

One of the most obvious differences between the E4 conservation and the other subtypes of envy is the lack of expression of this passion: conservation is the subtype where envy appears most denied, and it is difficult to recognize it because the person does not stay in the lack and in envy towards what it does not have, but through effort it transforms in a compensatory way what it lacks, thus defending itself from the envious feeling. "I visit a friend's house and I look at her, what a beautiful house... The next thing is that I put new curtains in mine, I make changes, I compensate for the idea and the feeling that my house is worse", says a testimony of this subtype.

In the sexual and social E4, no action appears to compensate for what one does not have. The social E4, where a clear awareness of the feeling of envy does appear, remains lamenting and complaining about what it does not have, and in the sexual E4, where envy is felt as something very instinctive, difficult to contain, you destroy what you want so as not to feel envy.

The compensated lack of conservation E4 is accompanied by an intolerance towards the feeling of weakness and a great personal effort not to feel need, which contrasts with the lack of modesty of the social E4 in showing itself weak and needy.

This tenacity in the effort constitutes a certain narcissistic attitude in the conservation subtype, which tends to think that it can handle everything and that it does not allow itself to show its lack, which would be interpreted in a certain way as humiliating, or in any case, with an unbearable feeling of vulnerability. We are talking about a type of person who, in childhood, had to take care of others: instead of being cared for, they had to care. They are, therefore, hard-working, independent, serious, sure of themselves, endowed with integrity, honesty and sobriety. Not feeling the care, they do not ask for it, and they project that need onto the other, caring for them from an attitude of self-sacrifice. In contrast, a sexual E4 expresses his need unceremoniously, turning it into a demand towards the other, while the E4 Social is an eminently begging character from its expression of lack.

In type 4 there is a deficient self: the person feels that they are worthless, that they do not have, there is an impoverished image of themselves, and there is also a strong idealization of what they would like to be. This idealized image becomes tremendous in the conservation subtype: there is a strong superego that constantly demands the person to reach that ideal of perfection, of omnipotence, and which the person never reaches because it is really a crazy idea. The effort is put at the service, then, of reaching this ideal, as the following testimonial points out: "In my work, if I feel that I am making a mistake, I sign up for a course to remedy it, but I am not satisfied with what I have done. I learn, but then I see that I have another mistake and I am already thinking about doing a new course".

Self-boycott, relentless action, the feeling of not deserving, dryness of character, are mixed with a certain tendency to self-idealization, as well as an idealization of others, to whom he grants authority. The bar of self-demand is so high that there is no permission for legitimate anger, and there is also fear of direct conflict with others, since they are above it, which causes belittlement and submission to others. At the same time, they "cut heads" (they are sharp critics, with a lot of judgment against others), express their opinions and do not need the constant approval that social E4s seek.

In the sexual and social E4, the image of the other is also highly idealized, and the bar for one's own ideal is also set very high. The big difference with conservation is that the sexual seeks to achieve the ideal without making great efforts, and in the social there is a "I want, and I can't": they feel that they are not up to the task and that they cannot reach it.

In conservation, effort becomes a tool to achieve the love and recognition of the other, a fundamental yearning of Enneatype 4, but in conservation it becomes a very large internal demand, accompanied by a high degree of self-control, as expressed by the following testimony: "My mother was a persecutor, I tried hard so she wouldn't catch me in a mistake, and there came a point where she saw that I had tried so hard and worked so hard, that she told me: "Okay, now it's okay, rest", and thus I would get a warm look from my mother".

In this, the conservation subtype clearly differs from the sexual one, for whom their need for love becomes an aggressive claim towards the other, and from the social one, who tries to get affection by pitying, moving, seducing with their suffering.

The E4 conservation, through effort, wants to give more than anyone else, they want to be the best mother, the best sister... "At school, they told us that we had to sacrifice ourselves for a Christian ideal of holiness, I put pebbles in my shoes, I sacrificed myself". In this testimony it is understood that suffering, hostility towards oneself, is not a direct search for such suffering, but a condition to reach something else, to be able to reach the ideal. Regarding social relationships, E4 conservation is a character blocked in the relationship. The degree of vigilance in front of the gaze of the other and one in front of one's own performance is so high, enormous inhibition, which creates a blockage, being in a relationship becomes unbearable and the person feels better in solitude, because it is not put at stake. All this internal dynamic.

Regarding relationships, some E4 conservation can endure difficult situations, with the idea that if they insist, the relationship can go better; On the other hand, others think that they are better off alone, they do not put as much effort into achieving a relationship, because there is a great difficulty, they believe that it is easier to be and for this reason they do not prioritize this aspect in their life.

Deep down, they avoid having a bad time, because they do not handle the issue of dependency and loving dedication badly. The entire internal structure has been created based on becoming self-sufficient, meeting their own needs, and the person feels that, if it breaks down, they would be left with nothing.

They also prioritize other aspects in their lives, and they put their effort into them, fundamentally at work, because there is an aspiration to achieve perfection in it, and because there are many familiar introjects in this sense (generally, we talk about families where sacrificial work has been highly valued, and in which the monster of precariousness or survival hovers).

On a global level, the main difference between sexual E4 and the other subtype of envy is the open expression of passion and its investment of energy in the romantic relationship. In the sexual E4 there is not always awareness of envy, but of something instinctive experienced as a prick that the person feels when comparing and perceiving himself below the other and because of the desire to occupy a significant place in the relationship with the other. Although the comparison is common to all E4 subtypes, in the sexual it is expressed in a very different and visceral way, like a drive that one cannot contain. This expression can have different nuances such as revenge and clear confrontation or blatant denial, disqualification and blaming of the other through words, contemptuous gestures, hateful looks, etc. The idealization of the other as a source of satisfaction becomes contempt for its limits, the love relationship becomes a battlefield where the sexual E4 competes until the destruction of the other and what it loves most. In any case, people of this character are not always fully aware of the scope of their staging, since the starting point is an absolute reaction to what has hurt or bothered them in the other.

In the other subtypes, this management of envy is diametrically opposite. In E4 conservation (tenacious) this reactive expression is completely contained, even exaggerating the position of control against instinct and viscerally. In the social E4 (shame) there is no daring to express anger and hatred, not because they do not feel it, but because the person believes that one is not going to be able to express those emotions and retroflects them, hating himself and looking for other channels of expression, from the secret and hidden.

In all E4 subtypes there is a mystification or idealization of the other, but in sexual E4 this idealization is exaggerated and passionate, wanting to get closer to what is idealized without great effort, unlike E4 conservation, willing to make an effort. The sexual E4 tends to display a filmier attitude, playing more dramatic and theatrical roles: they need to be the diva and have all the attention paid to them, something that the other subtypes are not as interested in or dare not do.

The sexual E4 does not easily show his weaknesses or his need, but the conservation or tenacious subtype does not want to know anything about his envy or his weakness either. Hate protects them from fragility, and they try to make it disappear. The difference is the clarity with which the sexual damages what he envies compared to the contention of the tenacious. The sexual E4 does not ask, it demands, more or less veiled or seductively, something that is almost unthinkable for the other subtypes. The tenacious, on the other hand, demands himself, and the social or "shame" hides.

The movie *What Ever Happened to Baby Jane?* tells of the relationship between two sisters, both E4, one of them paralyzed and the other who acts as their caretaker. One is constantly in the histrionic complaint (sexual subtype) and the other in her role as a resigned victim who puts up with everything (tenacious). The spectators of the drama take sides with the victim throughout the film, until at the end, the latter rebels showing all her contained hatred, and the hateful expression of the other is understood due to an unresolved childish issue. In the sexual subtype, the role of “bad” is chosen because it is more glamorous than the hidden role of E4 social-shame or the contained role of conservation-tough.

The feeling that one claims something that one deserves in its own right and that one has to be heard for it, that is, the feeling of injustice that must be fought against, is a basic feeling in the sexual E4. In the other subtypes this feeling also exists, but the feeling of invalidity is surely stronger in the social subtype, or the experience of having to put up with the feeling of helplessness in the conservation subtype.

The sexual subtype is more irresponsible, they feel special and expect the other to solve things for them; in this it is opposed to the tenacious E4, which uses as a neurotic value not asking anyone for anything, the “I don't need”. The social E4 also expects things to be solved but it does so from a more devious, hidden and manipulative perspective.

The social type 4 is the one that tends to behave, metaphorically speaking, in a childish way; It could also be said that the sexual E4 has a certain tendency to behave like an adolescent, making transgression his flag, and that the conservation E4 behaves like an old man.

The extroversion and exaggerated joy, the eloquence and ability to stand out of the sexual subtype is perhaps the point in which the difference is most noticeable in its difference with the shy social subtype and with the self-sacrificing conservational subtype, which can be ironic but does not usually behave in such a charismatic way or take so much prominence. In addition, the conservation subtype is emotionally more stable than the rest, given its characteristic containment: it does not immediately clarify what worries or bothers it, such as sexuality, and it shows much more tolerance than the other subtypes, being able, in any case, to reserving to say, without drama, the last word in a conversation.

However, neither the conservation nor the social E4 usually defend their position tooth and nail in an argument, nor do they feel the great need of the sexual Four to be right at all costs, come out on top or enter a fierce competition.

In terms of sensitivity, it is similar in all E4 subtypes: it is always present, with more entrenchment, resistance to pain and reserve in conservation, which is not as expressive and more enduring; In the sexual, on the other hand, there is not as much victimization as in the social, but there is also no endurance or containment as in conservation: he prefers stellar and often aggressive dramatic performances, waiting for everyone to notice his acting out.

The social E4 shows his emotional insecurity more, and with that childish role he tries to get what he wants. The sexual E4 tries not to show his insecurity, as well as the conservation E4, but in a polar way: while the conservative appears as a moderate, the position adopted by the sexual is usually proud and arrogant, with a tendency to break quickly and go from hate to crying and vice versa, in a process of being filled with hate and devaluing others.

The impudence and aggressive claim is frequent in the sexual, and makes their relationships often become unsustainable. In the other subtypes, there is usually a veiled discomfort, something that is chewed in the air but is more difficult to identify, and where direct confrontation is usually avoided. Instead, the sexual adopts hurtful and guilty forms when reality is not as idealized. Contempt, rage, anger is something that the sexual E4 usually indulges in with those close to them, and they usually have a real problem with limits, always tending to go too far and trying to impose themselves on others.

The social E4, on the contrary, is very dependent on relationships, and the one who endures the most in them; he is shy and shameful. The sexual one is very polar, but not phobic: it makes the relationship unsustainable, and he has a real problem with limits, because he tends to impose himself on the other with his aggressiveness.

The E4 conservation plays his aggression using irony, and his problem with limits consists of not knowing how to establish healthy limits with himself in relation to his effort or with the other. There is no limit to the care and help when they need it from an E4 conservation, and yet, there is a lack of people who are closest to them, care for friends in terms of enjoying and sharing good things, since pleasure is not registered in your life code. The lack of experiences of enjoyment in childhood explains this reluctance: "I don't remember going with my parents to the park or on vacation, I do remember that they talked a lot about illnesses and sorrows".

In another order of things, a particular characteristic of the social enneatype 4 is their way of breathing with their chests down, shrugging their shoulders protectively and with their belly projected forward and down, like a dead weight. In this breathing pattern there is very little tone in the lower body, muscles, and abdominal organs. The sound of the exhalation is usually like a held sigh. Those who do this expired breathing sigh and gasp frequently to get more air. Unlike the other breathing patterns, to dismantle that of the social E4 an increase in body tone is needed. Finding the strength to hold on, by rooting the feet well into the ground, and letting the body stretch out in the center channel, is a challenge for this character. The lack of this strength condemns this subtype to suffer from a chronic feeling of low energy availability, accompanied by constant self-harm and self-judgment that further consumes their weakened energy.

The social is an introverted subtype—unlike the E4 sexual extrovert and the E4 conservation, which alternates introversion and extroversion, and is apparently sweeter than the other subtypes of envy. The word that defines it, "shame", refers not only to a difficulty in accepting oneself as one is or in showing oneself spontaneously due to an internal feeling of ridicule or self-disqualification, because one thinks one is defective and unlovable, but also it points to an intrinsic feeling of inadequacy and loss of dignity, which does not allow him to express his hidden desire to show himself to the world, to be visible on a social level. Perhaps for this reason, when he has a need, he does not ask, since he does not believe he deserves it, but rather manipulates with hints, tears and drama to attract attention and "give pity". When you admire and/or envy, it is located immediately below the other. Faced with this situation, his attitude towards others is to

try to hide his sadness and his feeling of inadequacy behind a smile that is often not very credible. He has secrets, he does not dare to open his truth, which he considers despicable.

With such feelings, a person like this will avoid getting angry so that they do not reject them and also feel that they do not have the right to do so, they will enter into dependency relationships easily, and in general they will show themselves to be insecure, to the point that they usually go out losing in his usual comparisons with others and usually needs approval for everything. Inwardly, the feeling of depression is common, compared to the integrity that often shows the E4 conservation and the impulsiveness of the sexual E4. The social person blames himself for everything, for what he did and for what he did not, while the conservation and sexual person have, in addition to internalized guilt, a lot of judgment towards other people.

FIRST BOOK
ENVY IN THE CONSERVATION INSTINCT

CORDENATION:

Antonella Sabia y Águeda Segado

EDITION:

Cristina Busi y Erika Marchetti

TEAM & WITNESS:

Amos Vázquez, Jainin Carmenchu, Catalina Lladó,
Elena Sansonetti, Emilia Córcoles, Ester Ochoa, Estrella Revenga,
Eva Morote, Francesca Belforte, Francesca Sarnataro,
Giulia Depero, Juliana Prudencio, Lupe Ortega, Mara Festa,
Noelia Millán, Roberta Ranalli, Simona Mazziotti,
Stefania Giannini, Susi Andreu, Teresita Rivera Loza

TRANSLATION:

Facundo Piperno y Sandra Martín

1. PASSION IN THE SPHERE OF INSTINCT: HOW ENVY WORKS IN THE CONSERVATIONAL

By Juliana Prudencio

The E4 conservation represses envy and is not aware of the impulse that leads him to compare himself with others or of the feeling of lack. Not even the feeling of sadness is allowed, so present in this enneatype as an existential climax. He locks his emotions in an inner world that has no expression, to the point that it can be difficult to recognize him as an emotional character. We could say that the feelings connected to the experience of being lacking have reactively become the ability to be people who know how to contain and sustain the sacrifice, suffering and effort that life entails. The capacities to know how to suffer and strive are constituted as traits of an identity necessary to live. To understand how effort has been constituted and the role it plays in the intrapsychic and intersubjective structure of subjects, it is necessary to consider in the first place the biographical conditions of people with these characteristic traits and also consider the way to interact with other elements.

Different authors confirm, in the clinic, a deficit in the adequate development of the subject corresponding to this subtype in an unpleasant atmosphere, and the existence of one or both parents with the same type of character, a condition that cannot be generalized but that calls attention for your presence in the working group.

Bribring speaks of a depressive feeling in childhood as the basis for later depressions, related to a childhood traumatic feeling of helplessness, which is the result of the frustration that the child gets from the signals that he emits, with the consequent loss of vitality and self-esteem and inability to provide himself with what he called "narcissistic substitutes." As one E4 conservation patient puts it: "Whatever I did, nothing was ever right. My mother criticized me a lot, she told me that I was very selfish..."

Markson considers that moral masochism and depression are inseparable and that in the case of E4 we can speak of a masochistic-depressive syndrome. In this syndrome, three vital capacities are compromised: the feeling of entitlement, operational personal efficacy (success) and initiative, the primary condition being having felt like an unhappy child or a source of sorrow and disappointment for the parents and having failed in attempts to repair the parents for the damages for which they may feel responsible. Hostility and guilt are consequences of these conditions. "My parents wanted a boy, and I came, a girl. I did things so that my mother would be fine, but things went the other way."

The feeling of E4 conservation is that of not feeling entitled and not being able to act in the world and with other people in an effective way to achieve a successful response that is pleasurable. However, the E4 does not stop doing and doing, and is the most active of all the E4 characters. Action is its most developed psychic function, consistent with the experience that it is worth neither feeling nor asking many questions about what is happening: it is time to solve, help and collaborate to keep themselves and others alive. We could say that among the most active subtypes in the entire Enneagram, the E4 Conservation is indeed the one who dedicates himself devotedly and efficiently to work, at home and away from home. It is his mission and, at the same time, his identity as a "survivor".

As support for understanding depressive-masochistic characters, it is interesting to mention Bleichmar's writings regarding narcissistic disorders, the basis of the low self-esteem found in the E4 conservation character. As far as this subtype is concerned, these narcissistic disorders are caused by a primary uncompensated narcissizing deficit. Thus, in the E4 conservation biographies, children are not "admired" in their need for recognition and support by their parents. On the contrary, they are frustrated and devalued.

"What an ugly girl, you have a face that is not even worn on the handle of an umbrella", "Shut up, what do you know about life". "My mother always compared me to my sister, she was the good one, the beautiful one". When I asked for a skirt because I was tired of inheriting my brother's pants, my mother told me that it looked like a friar had made my mouth, that she kept asking, who did I think I was".

Subjects with this character often ask themselves: "Why ask if they're not going to give it to me?" The other is not going to respond to his need: therefore, he gets what is his, which makes him the most contradictory of the envious. Sometimes, faced with the previous idea that they are not going to give it and the frustration that this entails, they deny the need, interiorizing themselves in not having a right. Nor do the parents provide a valued image of themselves, with which they can identify; in a large majority of cases, at least one of the parental figures has a masochistic character. The masochism of the parents is transmitted not only through identification, with the self-deprivation that they impose, but through a feeling of guilt that they engender in the children when they enjoy what the parents lack.

My father worked in the fields in the morning and at night at a gas station, and I always remember my mother working at home, or taking care of her relatives, the first to get up and the last to go to bed. When my father was working a party, I couldn't leave until he arrived. I didn't go out with my friends because I saw my mother having a bad time and I couldn't afford to have a good time. I suck up the effort.

The E4 conservation has not been able to build a valued image of itself and has been unable to compensate for the deficit. To what has been said above, in the E4 conservation, there are high goals and ideals and a great severity of critical awareness in its two variants (Bleichmar):

a. Regarding the non-acceptance of extenuating circumstances so as not to achieve ideals, or deviations from the norms or values under which conduct is judged, he is a severe judge: "whatever they cost.

b. In a high degree of hostility towards himself, he elevates the ideals and lowers the representations of himself to reach the most negative conclusion possible. A crazy idea in many E4 conservation is "<try hard and not succeed".

It is necessary to mention the contributions of H. Bleichmar about masochism, to better understand the E4 conservation. This author says that in the strictest sense, masochism is the conscious or unconscious search for physical or mental suffering, self-harm, self-punishment, or self-deprivation, because these conditions are codified in such a way that they generate pleasure on another level. Displeasure is therefore the condition to obtain pleasure, which is what is finally achieved, albeit through a complicated circuit.

In understanding this character, it is necessary to consider the value that certain traumatic interpersonal situations have on the subject, who needs to transform what is painful into pleasant to adapt to them or to counteract them as a defense, or actively seek displeasure because he fears that it will happen unexpectedly.

When nothing can be done to prevent something from happening, or when there is a fear of being surprised by what is outside the will of the individual, one of the ways to deal with suffering is to give a positive character to what is an undesirable presence, the narcissization of frustration.

At first, we are not facing a true masochism, since displeasure is not sought, but in its presence a share of narcissistic pleasure is maintained, rationalizing the inevitable as if it were unavoidable.

What it was initially was a defensive act, once it is fixed to this form of narcissistic satisfaction in two stages: one of defensive narcissization and another of addiction to deprivation or suffering, which do become sought after, because they grant a sense that one is the one who directs one's own destiny.

In this framework, the effort in the E4 conservation is configured as a motor of life, motivation that is understood in turn as a form of control and defensive transformation of the traumatic situation.

To observe how the conservation instinct is energized in people with this character, we will refer to the biographies of E4 conservation people where we find, along with parental figures and family conditions, as the first obstacle to the development of the individual, other very early experiences of danger to the life and physical integrity of the person, which initially entail a struggle and an effort for survival: "I was born with very little weight, one kilo. So, I started fighting for survival. Two months later I suffered poisoning and had to fight for survival."

In other cases, the experiences refer to destructuring childhood anguish in which the physical, psychic, or emotional integrity of the subject feels threatened and/or persecutory anxieties arise, in which once again survival feels threatened. In the family, the need to put all the strength into physical survival has been overvalued, a feeling of precariousness has been transmitted, which is why it is necessary to ensure primary and concrete goods, at any price and above all despite the needs more emotional or social.

In any case, in all situations there is an effort associated with how to face and/or overcome them:

"I had to get out of town, whatever the cost, I couldn't stand it; the feeling that staying here gave me was one of death, of suffocation in every way. It was vital for my survival to get out."

For me, the effort is linked to endurance. If it is a work or training context, a context of material survival, I can bear the unspeakable, I drink. I can't play the beans. If survival is not at stake, I can't stand it.

This effort is made autonomously: E4 conservation is the most counter dependent and is neither melodramatic nor blatantly competitive.

Through the effort, the subject achieves a narcissistic gratification, although through this action the well-being or the proposed goals are not so much pursued as providing the person with an idealized identity. In this narcissistic aspect, the E4 conservation needs to see himself and be seen as a good father, friend, committed person.

My friend was sick for a long time, and I would rather go see her and be with her than leave her. I felt comfortable, recognized by my family.

Care and dedication to others compensates for low self-esteem. Through effort he tries to placate the superego and alleviate the guilt of the hostile desire to harm the original caretakers. This hostile desire has its roots in the continuous frustrations on the part of the parents to the initiatives of the subject, the continuous demand for loyalty and devotion through suffering on the part of the parents, the continuous failure to produce a pleasant correspondence with caregivers.

That it doesn't stay for me, as I'm already making enough of an effort. I discover myself in the chorus of a song: "That the parched death does not find me empty and alone without having done enough".

On the other hand, that hostile desire that is part of the severe critical conscience of E4 conservation translates this subtype into demand; however, through this requirement the E4 conservation, instead of demanding the other, demands itself:

For me, the effort sometimes is to feel like I solve things that otherwise would not be done well; for example, in the; I take care of my son, if I'm not careful I do everything.

In addition, there are behaviors in which the effort is understood as intrapsychic motivation, in which the other acts as a mere instrument.

There are conditions in which the conduct is aimed at the other establishing a certain type of relationship with the subject in such a way that, based on the anxieties and desires that he has in front of the other, certain conducts destined to provoke a certain effect are set in motion, in a way that don't attack us, don't abandon us and give us your love.

Berliner points out in a study on the genesis of masochism in intersubjective terms how hostility and parental abuse determine that the subject, frightened by aggressiveness, seeks suffering as a way of inducing guilt and love for the parents he fears.

Menaker emphasizes that the hostile parental attitude is internalized and that the subject who mistreats himself by submitting and lowering himself before the other is acting defensively in the face of persecution, that the frightened subject seeks to placate his opponent through the unconscious technique of showing him that he is not someone you can rival. Thus, the E4 conservation becomes smaller, criticizes himself, places himself in a subordinate position, gives up his rights to the other, shows himself incapable, ignorant, adopts attitudes and identities that harm him and make him suffer, which entails a double gain. First, because this suffering is less than the persecutory anguish. Thus, at work and sometimes in relationships, the E4 conservation makes excessive efforts, reaching the limits of exhaustion, due to the terror inspired by the authority it attributes to its superiors:

I have been working on many occasions with a fever, or after a kidney colic, or weekends without being paid despite working in a public institution. In the same way, I

have taken care of him during my father's illness, going many days from the hospital to work.

Second, it aims to obtain a feeling of security, which counteracts phobic or paranoid anxieties. By lowering himself, the subject keeps the objects idealized, thus creating gods before whom he humiliates himself. With this, in addition, he manages to keep his own aggressiveness against the object repressed due to hostile behavior.

The effort is also focused as an instrument to achieve the love and recognition of the other, here the behavior does not try to avoid the attack, but is a form of self-aggression, a form of bribery so that they do not abandon us: "I am good, I work hard, I deserve to be loved. I'm going to get 9 and 10 so they can look at me".

Other times, through suffering and effort, a link is maintained with the mother or father, who made the child or adolescent the confidant of their suffering, in such a way that the child experiences an infinite pleasure of meeting in intimacy, being someone privileged who receives confidences.

As I was growing up, my mother was getting me more involved in her relationship issues. I felt obliged to accompany my mother so that she could cry and unburden herself to me. That way, in addition, I felt with a space within the family, that's how she saw me.

Through effort, the E4 conservation also covers up his sadism, he sacrifices himself to make the other feel faulty, to make him feel guilty.

I take care of everything at home too, if I don't do it myself, things aren't done well. If I come to work sick, you have no excuse not to come.

This condition has characteristics in love relationships. Finally, considering the above and without the intention of simplifying, we would like to mention Tarachow's review of the E4 conservation: "Masochism is the technique of someone who cannot be direct".

2. THE CHARACTERISTIC NEUROTIC NEED. TENACITY

By Estrella Revenga

The neurotic need of the E4 conservation subtype is tenacity, through which it seeks recognition, affection, being unique, and being indispensable and special to the other. This need has its origin, on the one hand, in the early lack of one of the attachment figures, generally the mother, who did not give sufficient support to the child, in a failure in the mother's attitude to constitute herself as a figure of attachment, due to circumstances such as illness, depression, parental conflicts, own neurotic needs, pathogenic character traits, situations of anguish, superego demands, and on the other hand, due to a failure in primary narcissization that was not compensated. In most of the E4 conservation enneatypes consulted, the father's recognition gaze also failed.

Consequently, he neurotically seeks the gaze, the recognition, the support, the satisfaction, the closeness, and his well-being and uses effort and tenacity for this, as the illusion of being the person who knows how to make an effort, who knows how to sustain, even the suffering itself. Our effort helps us stand out, go out, and be seen as unique. The effort will always mediate when it comes to repeatedly showing and demonstrating our validity to other's eyes. We will try as a duty, obligation, and/or gift, to avoid discomfort, to please the desire and the super-ego mandates with which we identify or internalize, thus creating a vicious and flawed circle.

My mother was a very religious person, she told us the lives of saints, of martyrs. At that time, I longed to be a saint and, if a martyr, even better, my mother would be very proud of me. The concept of holiness that came to me had a lot to do with pain, with suffering in silence for love of God. And that's where I put myself. When I was seven years old, I would put pebbles in my shoes and run miles. The more pain, the more points for sainthood. Later, at boarding school, more of the same with the nuns (and my field was already cultivated), the use of hair shirt, at night in my clique, praying on your knees with your arms outstretched. Without anyone knowing. Effort, sacrifice, recognition of God; a lowercase god who took note of my offerings (the more expensive the better). A god with which my mother told us about and threatened us with.

This dynamic is generalized and exported to the construction and maintenance of other links, always with effort to become worthy of the recognition of others. Basically, obviously, the E4 conservation starts from a poor self-concept or self-esteem that has the belief that the binomial effort gaze gives it meaning, validity, the right to belong and, in the extreme, deserves its own existence.

The E4 conservation configures tenacity as *a modus vi vendi*, a useful form of resistance to achieve what he considers important for his survival, but also to pursue an ideal image and to obtain that recognition he longs for.

Tenacity is nourished by the strength of a person, a quality that in turn is based on the ability to resist, to endure, to silence emotions in the name of the need not to give up. This aspect is activated in any situation in life, whether it is directed towards oneself (achieving professional goals, work, study) or directed towards the outside for the support of loved ones.

E4 conservation can assume the economic responsibility of ensuring that his children and his family do not lack anything, of depriving himself of what he needs to make room for the needs of others, neither materially nor emotionally nor in the inside.

If we add to this that he is an oral character of great voracity, we will see that the recognition of one person will not be enough for him, that he will go looking for the recognition of all, the affection of all, that all see him as someone special. Since this is impossible, the person becomes frustrated and dissatisfied.

We must consider that, although the E4 conservation obtains the recognition of some people - that sometimes it obtains it -, it does not let it enter; this does not serve him due to the role played by his superego, hypercritical and disqualifying the praise and recognition he receives from others. Because of the above, nothing is of any use and leaves the person frustrated, without the longed-for recognition.

This means for the person the impossibility of consolidating an internal view of their own in which they can recognize their own achievements. Because of this, the vicious circle of his longed-for recognition that he pursues throughout his life is repeated over and over again. The result of everything is frustration. The desire is not satisfied, it does not get the fantasized recognition, because it could not be obtained in any case: to achieve something like love contact, it then offers a completed task to someone who, due to his own difficulties, has not been able or has not wanted to bond lovingly at the beginning of existence.

The effort itself and the resulting frustration push the E4 conservation to keep trying again and again, in a neurotic spiral that is only broken when it can be made conscious and put into doubt its necessity, effectiveness or reason for being. An attitude that can have not only affective but physical consequences.

On the other hand, envy generates susceptibility, so the E4 conservation frequently feels discriminated against when the authority or the valuable external object recognizes other people and is permanently controlling the authority to see what it gives to others and what it does not. gives to him/her. Because of this, the person is not relaxed and calm, his gaze is always attentive to who he looks at, to whom he gives affection: he would like it to be only for him/her. All this is going to cause problems in relationships, since he remains angry, almost always unconsciously, with the person who has power, and later this denied hostility is going to be projected on the figure of authority, or on the equal, or You can displace it on other people, so you will think that the others "want me badly", or "are against me", triggering a feeling of persecution by the external figure.

There is a common denominator in all the E4 conservation consulted, and that is that where they make the most effort is in the study and at work. To achieve the long-awaited recognition they can make unsuspected sacrifices that later cost them dearly, that may endanger their health, or physically damage them irreversibly. There is no measure in the effort to gain the recognition and affection of the other. Of course, as we saw in the previous chapter, the avoidance of the feeling of envy is implicit in the effort. For example, a person who, when he had to give a workshop on a certain topic, previously studied all the literature on that topic, specifically avoided the "feeling of lack of not knowing" and envy in relation to other professionals. That is to say, he compensated, on the one hand, for the subjective feeling of lack in front of himself and, on the other hand, he maintained a subjective idea about whether with this effort he knew more than the others.

The crazy idea persists: “if I make an effort, I will achieve the affection and recognition of the other being as unique”.

In some of our autobiographies we observe how conservation is linked to early near-death experiences, when basic needs, both physical and positive emotional contact, have been at stake and unsatisfied.

The neurotic need is impregnated with effort, and the effort is the self-preservation instinct. Because also in love, a tremendous effort is being made to survive.

The early crazy ideas that are brought out because of the above are: “there is not for me”, “I can do it alone, I have to do it alone”, imbued with anguish. Effort for survival, need not to feel. The engine is the effort, not stopping not to feel. “Whatever it takes I go out, without needing to”. This neurotic need is constituted in different ways, and under different circumstances:

- The disappointment of maternal desire. We frequently see cases of the birth of a daughter instead of a son, or the other way around. Unwanted daughters who were later compared to sisters or brothers born in much more positive situations for the mother.
- Inexperienced mothers, young people, and fathers who have to make a lot of effort to get ahead. Mothers in constant task, always working. Our crazy thought by comparison was, “I don't measure up for my mother.”
- Anorexia in adolescence. In self-effort there is a part of identification with the attitude of maternal effort: “With my effort I feel that I belong, without effort, no.”
- First daughter, granddaughter, niece, who has had recognition and then go has lost it. The desire to return to have what was had.
- Mediate between parents to care for and/or achieve the wishes of the mother. Something is always missing, always some reproach, good grades, sacrifices, resignations, acts of kindness are not sufficiently recognized.
- Path that occurs to us to look for the look or the recognition, that they come closer, that they look at me, feel me inside, but they are never enough. We look for love and we give results of notes; the path through which we seek is wrong, and the recognition, at best, punctual.
- Inadequate opinions or beliefs regarding education or mother-child relationship. “I don't pick him up because he gets used to it”; “I do not praise her notes so that she is not a believer.”

We see many cases of very weepy girls who are raised away by relatives other than their parents, placed in schools at an early age, compared to siblings and denigrated with respect to them, even occupying opposite mother-daughter positions. Along with all this, we see many fears related to the psychobiological, something similar to the memory of the trauma, fear of sleeping alone, fear of the dark, etc.

Regarding the relationship with the equals, the brothers, we see in our respective autobiographies envy in many cases of the favorite brothers, cared for, considered valid or good. Latent anger and resentment against them that is made more or less explicit, directly or indirectly. Aggressiveness expressed or contained, present in the relationship with them.

On many occasions, later guilt and frustration, more rejection, more distance from the parents' punishment. Sensation of being bad and starting over in the vicious circle of effort-recognition.

The film, *Butterfly Wings*, by Juanma Bajo Ulloa, is a good example of the aforementioned.

3. INTERPERSONAL STRATEGY AND ASSOCIATED IRRATIONAL IDEAS

By Estrella Revenga and Águeda Segado

Within the interpersonal strategies, there are those that are closer to consciousness and others that are totally unconscious, such as the defence mechanisms that we are going to mention in this chapter, since they have an incidence, not only in the structuring of the psyche and in the internal dynamics of the person, but also in relation to the other.

The interpersonal strategies of this subtype are going to be highly influenced by traits such as victimhood, sadomasochism, persecution and submission. When we speak of submission here, we are not referring to the absolute submission of one person to the desire of another, but rather to a wide range of phenomena that we experience in front of another, to the inhibition when expressing ourselves, to the attentive gaze of the person in front of another, where he scrutinizes her in order to please her and not anger her. We are talking about submission to the other for fear of their emotional response, that they punish us with the loss of their love. (Bleichmar).¹ 1. Bleichmar, H., *Revista Aperturas Psicoanalíticas*, nº 28

Victimhood, sadism, masochism, persecution, and submission must be seen in the double aspect. On the one hand, relationally, which was how it was structured. On the other hand, as a consequence of this structuring in the internal dynamics of the person. These attitudes and dynamics are supported by an interpretation of internal and external reality that in this model is defined as a false lack, the fixation of E4. In the E4 conservation, the false lack is expressed through the devaluation of what he does, his actions and his behaviour. He always looks at what is missing in order to commit himself more, to see how he could do it better, and at the same time he feels a kind of satisfaction for the effort he puts into what he does, for the ability to know how to sustain sacrifices. The focus is on the fixed observation of what is missing, what is not enough. mind done well, the little value that what you think, feel and do has. Behind it is an idealization of himself as a person who knows how to support this deficiency, who assumes it as a condition of his life. He is "satisfied" with being a martyr who suffers in silence, with the conviction that his pain is the greatest and that he knows how to suffer without falling into complaints, regrets, or tears, which are expressions of little value for this person. In addition, if he expressed his pain, the "proud" image would be dismantled, of deserving of admiration for his being so lacking and dedicated to relieving the pain of others, which at the same time he despises when he is carried away by the complaint.

Seeing what is missing and seeing what is always missing helps her put more energy into the passion of having a perfect stamina, a person tireless in her idea of doing what must be done. In this way she also manages to hide and repress envy. The E4 conservation is the countertype, that is, the subtype that tries to quell the passion of envy.

We are now going to detail the interpersonal strategies, also focusing on the irrational ideas that derive from the distorted cognitive core of false lack.

There is strong competition, which is often not complete. Lowering your own value is a way to prevent criticism and gain some praise without exposing yourself to direct competition.

As we have seen previously, the tenacious E4 learned to relate from submission as a strategy, in a way of shrinking in front of the other for fear of persecution. This way of bonding was structured in childhood, where the child learned to submit to one of his parents due to persecution; later he will permanently repeat this type of link with other people.

Consider the following example: A person feels the competitiveness and rivalry of a colleague and what he does strategically is to appear smaller to calm and placate the person who competes with him because he lives in fear. The person shrinks, withdraws, leaves his place to the other before competing. Of course, we are talking about an unconscious strategy. We see that in relation to competitiveness, E4 conservation has a phobia of competition, since it fears the rupture and withdrawal of affection. Conservative E4s are people so afraid of and so dependent on withdrawing affection that they prefer to withdraw rather than compete and take second place. The associated irrational ideas are: "If I compete, I'm sure I'm going to lose, if I make myself visible, I create a problem for others".

In the previous example, the area of competitiveness of the person was in the labour field; One wonders what the person does in these circumstances within his company. What this enneatype does is strive for good returns. In this way they have a feeling of satisfaction and imaginary superiority over the other, but also a feeling of real satisfaction, since they concentrate and try in what they have, which makes it well done; in this way, the feeling of envy is covered. "If there is no effort, there is no value." "If it is not forcing me, it means that I have not done everything possible". "If I sacrifice myself, they will see me and value me."

Another way of not competing is by never showing their successes, thus avoiding the feeling of envy that they could arouse in the other.

This form of strategy, as we saw earlier, was learned in childhood in order to placate the external persecutor, one of his parents, and today, the person of this subtype continues to use the same defence mechanism, either against others or himself.

Regarding the recognition of his limits, it is very difficult for him to recognize them and also express them in front of other people. It cannot be shown with illnesses or limitations, it is a lot of suffering for his narcissism. "If I suffer, I am weak, I am contemptible". Recognizing a limit can be experienced as a situation of humiliation. This enneatype can show neurotic suffering, but pain and real limits put him in a situation of great danger and vulnerability in front of others. They are showing that they need and that they are dependent.

Dependency puts you at great risk, the person you depend on may fail you, may have other needs, other interests, and before this happens you create all kinds of strategies to manage alone and not show that you need. Dependence on the other exposes the point of maximum vulnerability of E4 conservation. "If I do it alone and I don't ask, I'm not going to run the risk that the other won't help me, won't be there for me."

On the one hand, the effort not to ask for help clearly compensates for the sense of shame and unworthiness that arises from feeling deprived and needed and, on the other hand, relationally generates the image of arrogant superiority, implicitly blaming, that is usually attributed to E4 conservation and that discourages the spontaneous offer of help.

“Nobody can help me”, nobody can understand me”, if I ask for help, they will see me as inferior”.

The risk inherent in showing one's physical weakness is always that of losing the relationship, or rather of any possibility of relationship. Striving to do one's own often becomes the implicit mode of asking for help, since the explicit request for help is experienced as dangerous. This tendency to protect his good image by fear and submission to the other can lead him to behave falsely, as is the case of not expressing what he really thinks in matters in which he should position himself in front of others, in order not to disagree, and out of fear of what others may think of him/her.

Another of their manipulations is to anticipate their own criticism to calm the person they fear will criticize them. It is very common to find patients of this subtype in consultation who come with the tasks done in order to prevent the therapist from giving them some feedback that they would not like to hear, since the image they have to give in front of the other would be damaged. and this they cannot bear. They can be very critical of the other, very bold and, on the other hand, very little tolerant of the criticism received. His favorite defense is justification and prior criticism.

There is another type of relational manipulation: putting yourself below the other. In this way, he delegates his own internal evaluation criterion to the other, about the recognition of something they have done, if that something is right or wrong. Let's look at an example:

I had just done a job and was satisfied, but when I meet my co-worker, I tell him: “I don't know if what I've done is right, maybe I should have done something else, etc.”. All this with the intention that the other person values me and tells me: “But if what you have done is good, you also know a lot about this subject.”

Through this example, we see that the conservation enneatype needs praise from the other, but it does so by putting itself below and giving the other authority over him/her so that the other person tells him or her what is right or wrong, either in your work in your life or in your decisions. In this case, he usually shows that he does not know about certain matters when he does know. This staying below then generates some discomfort in front of the other. That is, they are victims of their own manipulation. We clearly see the false lack that Dr. Naranjo speaks of when referring to the fixation of this character.

In the relational, this enneatype usually endures everything that comes his way, due to the dependence they have on the affection of the other. Thus, one of his favorite mechanisms is the rationalization of the damage he feels he receives from other people. He cannot run the risk of showing that he felt damaged by affective dependency and for fear of not being seen as good. That would show his angry face and... What will the others think? What if the other gets angry and withdraws the affection? Let's say this subtype “sold his soul to the devil” in exchange for maintaining an idealized self-image of being a good person.

This subtype is afraid of two things: that they do not see him as good and that the other gets angry with him/her and can withdraw affection. So that this does not happen, he is capable of faking, disguising, and hiding his true thoughts and feelings. Affective dependence is, at the same time, what can most lead to imbalance.

A patient told me that, at a conference, he had met someone who had been very significant to him. This person did not approach him, they did not speak as had been usual before. The experience was that the much-desired meeting could not take place. This event provoked a feeling of abandonment and heartbreak.

When these situations occur, the person cannot reason, the emotion can, the repetition of previous experiences drags him without being able to do much. The experience is that life is gone. As this patient said, "I feel like life is going down the drain."

The E4 conservation depends affectively on the look and recognition of the other, in this case of the person of a significant authority whom he idealizes, does not question, and submits to obtain the long-awaited recognition, which in its day was frustrated. Said longing is evidently unattainable; what will happen once again is the repetition of a link where sooner or later he will disappoint the authority figure, just as it happened with one of his parents in his day.

The person will say to himself: "I am not what the other expects of me", the crazy idea that arises is: "As I am, I do not deserve the affection of the other, if I make an effort, I will obtain recognition and merit". All this, as a substitute for love.

It is evident that we are conditioned to believe that what the other feels in front of us - his enthusiasm, or his rejection, his desire to caress us or the reluctance to caresses - testifies about what we are, if we are worthy of being loved or not, without realizing that, in truth, the only thing it indicates is what happens to the other. (Bleichmar)

This paragraph is significant as a healthy way out for the attachment and affective dependence of the E4 conservation on the other and shows the reading that it makes of the lack of love of the other towards itself when the encounter does not take place.

As a result of all the above, the most common thing we find in our subtype is that, to get out of the anguish of submitting to the gaze, recognition and affection of the other, they prefer to break off their relationships, almost as a form of mental health and to maintain psychophysical stability.

The sadistic aspect, not as strong as in sexual E4, is present, especially in relationships with parents and partner. There are people who have had contemptuous behavior and bad treatment towards their mother, with the consequent feeling of guilt for the aggressive discharge, and, because of this, reparative action towards the damaged person is frequent. Thus, the person who was subdued ends up subduing his subjugator.

In relation to the partner, they feel so dependent on the other that, at times, the subjugated person can manifest sadism towards their partner, especially if they have some masochistic trait, and most importantly because it falls into their area of disqualification: "If this person loves me, he must not have much value." We can say that so much in the couple's relationship is their need to feel loved, but there comes a time when the E4 conservation person is distressed by dependency and by the pain of not having the other as needed, and in many cases, they prefer to give up the love.

Many people of this subtype chose to give up what they wanted most. Another crazy idea that stems from this situation: "On my own, I manage better".

The sadism he feels towards others is nothing compared to the one he feels towards himself.

One day I watched a discharge from an E4 conservation patient where the sadistic part of her personality attacked her for having traits and characteristics that were not valued, but just the opposite, despised. This sadistic aspect attacked the person with true joy, insulting them, with anger and with pleasure for not being perfect, for having mistaken, for seeing them with limits.

The crazy idea is: "I have to be perfect." He has such a great self-ideal that he cannot tolerate being flawed. To finish, we are going to focus on three of the most significant defense mechanisms of this enneatype (introjection, retroflection, and projection), not so much in terms of the structuring or modification that it supposes for the psyche, but in terms of its incidence in the aspect that link the person with the other.

The introjection mechanism is a type of internalization where object relations that are good for the person are replaced by an internal modification of the ego; introjection also leads to the formation of the superego through the incorporation of certain selective aspects of the parents. Therefore, we see that, like identification, it is a way of structuring the personality. We are going to see introjection as a defense mechanism in the link. Freud discussed the mechanism of introjection in *Mourning and Melancholy*, a 1915 work in which he described the ego's reaction to the loss of an object (of a loved person), whether real or imagined, and also to the loss of something that for the subject has the character of an ideal -for example, being disappointed in oneself and becoming depressed-, or also of ideals in which links with people are involved.

Faced with the loss of the object, the person feels lost and has a series of reactions. One of them is to introject the loved one. In this way, object relations (with persons or with ideals) are replaced by an internal modification of the ego in the form of introjection. Being loved or hated, now inside the person, becomes part of their identity, of how the person sees himself; he thinks that the introjected person has the same attributes.

Let us see an example of a patient who suffered successive experiences of abandonment by her mother. When she was born, the mother had to rest for forty days and was cared for by the grandmother. Later, at three months of age, the mother underwent surgery and, again, was removed. Later, on successive occasions, her parents went to work and left her alone, intensifying the feeling of abandonment. This person, on a session day, comments: "I'm just as manipulative and aggressive as my mother." And she begins to describe traits that she perceived as her own and that were also her mother's. Driven to discriminate if she had other traits or attitudes different from those of her mother, she did not find them. The person discovered that there was a great emptiness inside.

From this moment on, she began to be aware of the relationship of hate she maintained with her for having a person she hated introjected within his ego. Thus, the relationship established she was hateful towards herself for seeing herself in the image and likeness of her mother.

"During my therapy, I realized that every time I visualized my image, the face I imagined overlapped or contained my mother's, and it was impossible for me to separate the two images. Each attempt to separate them, in addition to being unsuccessful, produced a strong feeling of anguish and guilt. Only after allowing myself to acknowledge my hurts and resulting anger, and embarking on a path of true reconciliation, was it possible for me to begin to separate my own image from that of my mother."

Francesca S

Naranjo, like Freud, maintains that the character with this mechanism "...internalizes parental rejection or introjects a non-loving father or mother, so that it introduces into their psyche a constellation of traits that vary from a bad concept of himself in search of a special distinction, constructing a chronic suffering and a (compensatory) dependence on external recognition.

Let's see an example of how a person builds a chronic suffering:

A patient has the experience of being unable to carry out the task of providing training in a group where her boss and several people who are also very representative for her are present. Finally, she does it successfully, and when the favorable external opinion about her work arrives, she rejects that it is so, and disqualifies this external recognition.

One must ask for what or why this person rejects what he longs for so much and for which he had worked so hard. It is a way, as Naranjo said, of maintaining chronic suffering, a lack feeling in human relations and, consequently, a way of perpetuating envy. In this way, the person avoids recriminations, competitions and responsibilities.

Claudio Naranjo comments that in envy and the depressive masochistic character there is another mechanism that is also fundamental: retroflection.

Retroflection or turning against oneself is a mechanism through which the person does to himself that he would like others to do. It literally means "turning back intensely against." That is, the subject turns against himself that he would like to do to others.

Claudio Naranjo continues commenting: "Self-hatred or self-rejection is implicit in the notion of having introjected a "bad object", the idea of retroflection suggests that the anger generated because of frustration is directed not only at the external source of frustration (and the original frustrater of one's life), but because of introjection into oneself. In this phrase from Naranjo, we see what we said before; that is, that within the person an intrapsychic dynamic is established in which the ego is split: thus, one part looks at the subject with contempt and hatred, and the other part suffers this mistreatment in a masochistic way. Also hate, as Naranjo said, is directed towards the external source; the aggressiveness. The problem is to know where it is directed: if it is directed towards the outside or towards the inside.

When the aggression is directed inward, the person does not ask; few times the E4 conservation complains, cries. It is easier for him to cultivate an internal resentment and to demand of himself not to have desires, to stay in the desert with little, nourishing himself on the passion of stoically sustaining the poor material and affective life. He is a person who turns on himself the anger he feels towards others. First of all, by carrying a

bad object introjected within him, the person hates himself. That is to say, they look at each other with hatred, they don't like it and they despise each other.

On the other hand, when you have to direct your anger at other people who have been external sources of frustration, you can't; he directs it at himself out of fear of the other person's response, or out of guilt; so this aggressiveness takes the subject himself as an object, resulting in different types of somatization for the person and a state of permanent deenergizing and depression. "Everything depends on me, there is none for me."

The social E4 is the one that turns the rage against itself the most. The sexual E4 is the subtype that most openly expresses anger towards others. The E4 conservation transforms anger into self-demand. In all three cases, what is revealed is the aggressiveness of this character.

There is an example of a person who, out of envy and rivalry towards her husband - who was a famous person in the show - attacked him permanently. In this case, the object, that is, the loved person, does not die, is not lost in reality, but is lost as an ideal within the person, and it is then that the loss within the ego can occur. This mechanism is very important to explain certain cases of self-destructive tendencies, and is linked to secondary masochism, understood by Freud as a return of sadism on the subject itself.

Our equal conservation enneatype is not as scandalous in its criticism and competition as the sexual one, as we have just seen, but the mechanism of introjection is the same for all subtypes. Whenever a significant relationship is lost, be it a partner, a friendship, etc., the person, in order not to feel the loss of the loved one, will introject a partial aspect of it with which he will identify. In order not to feel the emptiness for said loss.

The projection. Through the projection mechanism, the person rejects qualities, feelings and desires that he cannot recognize as his own because he considers them negative and projects them onto the other. Then, thanks to the fact that a certain representation of the other person is constructed as bad, aggressive, thief, etc., that is, qualities projected on the other, he can see himself as a person who does not have those defects, that is, the identity of good, non-aggressive, etc. can be constructed. In this way, projection is a process of distributing identities between the subject and the other.

Someone may not only let go of negative aspects, but they may also let go of or fail to acknowledge positive aspects because of guilt. This is common in type 4. The projection of the positive aspects of one's own person is a consequence of the need to preserve a poor self-image.

The conservation E4 is identified with one of the parents, who persecuted him. This means that in moments of great demand and anguish, he projects that persecution onto others. Let's look at this example:

I worked in a computer company and for health reasons I did not feel the same strength and I began to feel insecure, and to think about whether I could carry out my task as I did before. All this is leaving me powerless, insecure; I am becoming more and more anxious and withdrawing from my companions; To counteract the fear and anguish I felt in the face of my physical limitation, what I do is project my internal persecutor and I begin to think that it is the others who want to kick me out of work.

We can recognize some irrational ideas that sustain this dynamic: "If I don't do it perfectly, they will reject me, if I don't comply with everything, they will fire me."

Here we see how the internalized persecutor aspect is projected and becomes an external persecutor, with the consequent anguish for the person in their relationships with others. It could be said that the E4 conservation identified with the persecutor as the paranoid character did with the aggressor.

Next, we are going to give another example of a quite normal situation for any person, but it helps us to see how our E4 conservation reacts. We will be able to see that in the same situation several mechanisms of defense of persecution, blame, demand, transformed rage, projection, submission:

I had invited some cousins to dinner at my house. When I called them to see what time they would come, I found out that they had gone to another place. I was surprised, because the day before, during the family meal, we had arranged the appointment; Instead of reasoning and thinking that something had happened to them, I started a kind of fabulation thinking that my cousins would have something against me.

(Fabulation for noid). Then I started telling myself that if they didn't come it was because I had done something wrong and made them angry. As the day before they had been together with other relatives, I began to obsessively review my behavior at that meal under the persecution of my superego: "here you were not careful, you were talking more with other cousins and perhaps they have felt annoyed, look what! you are careless! ". The crazy conclusion I came to is: "Because I wasn't careful enough with them, they got mad at me and that's why they don't come to dinner."

I decided, finally, to call on the phone in order to get out of the hell I had gotten myself into, but my cousins did not answer the call. Instead of thinking that they would be busy, I thought: "Before, my cousin called me immediately." In other words, he attributed the delay to his paranoid storytelling process. I decided, finally, to call on the phone to get out of the hell I had gotten myself into, but my cousins did not answer the call. Instead of thinking that they would be busy, I thought: "Before, my cousin called me immediately". That is, the delay was attributed to his process of paranoid storytelling.

In this example we see how E4 transforms anger into self-demand and reproaches from internal persecution. And part of the anger that the person feels is projected onto others-the others have been angry with me when I had reason to be angry because they had stood him up. He does not express his anger because of the anguish he feels at the possibility that others will be angry. Here we see the submission and dependence of the affection of this person, in this case, towards some cousins. If I express what I feel, I will only be a weight for others. If I express my needs, they will not be understood, they are less important than those of others.

4. OTHER CHARACTERISTIC FEATURES AND PSYCHODYNAMIC CONSIDERATIONS

By Águeda Segado and Antonella Sabia

In this chapter, the main and secondary specific traits of the E4 conservation character will be reviewed.

Self-demand and Perfectionism:

Closely related to tenacity lives self-demand, a self-revolutionary orality that pours on itself the tacit demand, originally directed elsewhere. It feeds on the tenacity, since they demand more and more, raise the bar and what is at stake requires, on the other hand, having the resources to sustain this task. But self-demand also must be accompanied of dissatisfaction and self-hatred; only in this way is the inner emptiness maintained and leaves the door open to self-evaluating confrontation, useful to feel like it's never enough.

“ Nothing is enough for me. A task that I tackle and that I finish, always pre leaves me a point of dissatisfaction, like what do I have to put conscience and say, "Okay, that's fine, that's enough.”

Although it is not difficult to confuse the search for perfection of an E4 conservation with that of an E1, the E4 conservation accompanies this attitude with effort and dissatisfaction: the search to be perfect or to do things perfectly is the consequence of a feeling of inferiority and an attempt to compensate for the experience of being insufficient.

Empathy:

Great sensitivity and observation capacity that allows them to capture and understand the characteristics of those who are in front of them. Good listeners, they easily empathize with the suffering of others and are able to contain and accompany, either because they see parts of themselves in the other or because, knowing internal states of deep suffering, they have developed self-support resources. It is a character capable of silence, of enduring the emptiness of the other, of transmitting a deep understanding devoid of judgment. In suffering he feels a bond, as he usually does with his original affections.

Difficulty accepting limits:

Another aspect related to the above is the difficulty accepting internal and external limits. Greed, which knows no impediments, does not even take into account the limited individual resources and demands more and more effort and work. Ignorance of one's own limits, especially in terms of real possibilities, is accompanied by an idea of omnipotence. The deep capacity to endure, to tolerate, sustains the equally profound inability to ask for help, an action that, in order to be practiced, requires above all the awareness of not being able to do it alone, but also the humility to feel the need. He is unable to recognize real needs, even if they are physical (sleep, rest, eat), either because he experiences a certain level of disconnection with his own body or because internally, he avoids perceiving the needs that imply the inclusion of the other.

Masochistic attitude:

The bad image of oneself, the lack of esteem with which one is in contact and the idea of not deserving lead him to even tolerate humiliating conditions, especially in the relational sphere. The thirst for belonging, the need for love and recognition are such that they lead the subject to tolerate without limits, with the expectation that this tolerance will be interpreted by the other as a sign of love and appreciation.

Refinement:

Good taste, love for the beautiful and for everything refined, a characteristic shared with the other subtypes and revealing a deep sensitivity. In the conservative subtype, this sensitivity is hidden and masked by bodily rigidity and emotional freezing.

Caregiver of others; helpful and welcoming:

The E4 conservation lives the relationship with others, friends, and family with a great spirit of service and care. In this approach he finds fulfilment, a sense of worth, and a practical way to express love. He cares for others both materially and emotionally, though often risking taking on more than is necessary.

In service he finds an identity, a place that makes him worthwhile and allows belonging.

Stoic, little hedonistic:

The attitude of earning merit through work leaves little room for fun and pleasure, dimensions with which this character is unfamiliar. Pleasure is felt by always finding satisfaction in doing but directed towards something (a goal) or someone. It is difficult to be aware of what increases the happiness of one without including the other, in fact this character is not clear about what makes him feel good. Contact with nature, silence, being with oneself, listening to music, dedicating time to oneself, are the possibilities that one sometimes allows oneself and that are closest to an idea of pleasure, as well as, on the other hand, the pleasure of endless movement, of spontaneity and freedom of action and speech is hindered.

Resource Finder. decisive creativity:

It is the ability to find solutions creatively, especially when they are needed for issues that concern others and not oneself. Specifically, creativity is expressed in the will to find possibilities through the omnipotent attitude of overcoming obstacles, of seeing alternative paths, of not giving up despite the difficulties.

Compelling enthusiasm:

This is even more evident when it comes to supporting the other person to regain their energy and will to live, to transform and believe more in themselves. With a visceral desire for harmony and beauty, he manages to communicate that achieving a state of integration is possible. This stems from her own need, but also from a deep insight that healing (not perfection!) is a possible reality. Finally, he knows how to convey the idea that everyone has value, precisely because it is a need that he has always felt. These attitudes make you a good therapist, should you enter this profession.

Dry in tenderness with their own. Difficulty expressing tenderness:

Affectionate, benevolent, helpful character, with great drive-in friendships and relationships but with deep shame of his own loving gestures. There is an impulse to retain tenderness and related actions, perhaps because in childhood they are related to total dependence, to showing the fragility of feelings. So much dedication towards the outside world finds no correspondence towards the self.

Difficulty confronting; unclear on divergent expression:

Difficulty clearly expressing a divergent and contrary position, especially if the majority thinks differently. Internally, it remains in a different position that hardly has the courage to declare, such is the fear of marginalization or confrontation.

Rigidity:

It is a mental rigidity that finds its correspondence in both a physical and postural rigidity that has to do with a unilateral way of seeing things, self-destructive in favour of the other, but also with a physical and muscular rigidity, as if to simulate a condition of alert and fear always present, being attentive to what is happening around, capturing every signal from a control perspective, to know how to react and prevent

Save (just in case):

Ability to save and accumulate both objects that can be useful and experiences. To keep to oneself, a kind of greed, to have more to feel that one can always count on additional inner resources to draw on.

Worth:

With a brave character, he does not shy away from challenges, he knows how to endure with patience and willpower even the toughest tests, whether they affect him or those close to him.

If the stake is high, there is no room for reflection on whether to undertake difficult paths.

Constant alertness, control:

Tends to live in a state of alert with a control attitude and with straight antennas to perceive the signals in time and know how to act preventively.

Ironic:

Capable of being funny, ironic, even sarcastic at times, to sublimate anger. He has humor in a subtle and intelligent way, the irony about his own characteristics, about the heavy events of life, as an attempt to cushion the pain and access a certain lightness.

Sense of justice:

He lives a deep desire for justice that arises from his own experience of having suffered injustice. He strives and fights for equality and believes in the value of solidarity. You can be very disciplined in following your ideals.

Spiritual:

Thanks to his contact with lack, he seeks the transcendent to free himself from his painful experience and the feeling of incompleteness that accompanies it, but also as a vehicle to make sense of himself, of life and to seek the Beyond. This aspiration to transcendence, if not freed from the ego, runs the risk of being a stoic search for sacrifice, a narcissistic ideal of holiness to redeem oneself from deprivation.

5. EMOTIONALITY AND FANTASY

By Catalina Llado

We publish the testimony of a colleague who recognizes herself in the E4 conservation subtype and who, with great conscience, describes from her character how she experiences fantasy and its relationship with emotions.

If I start from the description given in the dictionary, fantasy comes from the Greek term *phantazo*, which means to appear, and this from *phaino*, to shine. Fantasy is said to be the "faculty of the mind to represent things that do not exist." Particularly, to "invent beings and events and create literary and artistic works, creating things that have no real basis."

From my character, I start from an idea of myself that is also a fantasy. This fantasy comes from a feeling, from an internal sensation of displeasure, of not worth. The character or idea of me is that of not deserving.

On a day-to-day basis, the fantasy awakens due to some emotion or state of being that I do not give effect to, and I create a restorative, compensatory situation that at the same time numbs that feeling. In it, I double myself into characters that I can see as if on a screen (my mind), experiencing events that describe a behavior different from what is happening to me.

I think the best way to make myself understood is by exemplifying what was said above while going to the origins of fantasy.

I'll start with the family. I am the second of six siblings, and I inherited the name of my paternal grandmother, the mother-in-law and the scapegoat of the family both for her son, my father, and for my mother. This got to me from the beginning, since I was the representative of the bad one in the family, an aspect that made me never feel loved or desired. In my games I was often a child who died. From the paper, I saw my sister crying for my death. When my mother scolded or punished me, I left home crying and full of rage and frustration-I said goodbye to my brothers, whom I saw behind the window suffering from my departure.

What did I get with all this? Experiencing intensely that pain, that unpleasantness, that discomfort, that feeling of inferiority, of hindrance of being bad of creating problems of being misunderstood, of not being loved, and began articulating thoughts such as "I'm going here I'm not loved and if I I am going to put an end to these situations my departure will serve for them to see that I am good and to repent of treating me like that". When the hours passed and I was tired of crying and hiding, I would come home like a beaten dog. The return was silent and tried to go unnoticed. From this I learned to suffer in solitude and to develop fantastic stories of the warrior who returns and returns to start once again with heroic purposes of being able to change and continue history fighting like Genoveva de Brabant or Joan of Arc. With sacrifice, I would get love.

Nowadays, in borderline situations where I feel very worried, disappointed, or lost, I fantasize about leaving the situation and, at times, being that character in a movie, novel or sad play of a desperate woman who looks out the window. In search of a better world that is usually far away, in a place retired, or break with everything and start from scratch and carve out a new path on my own, or the one leaning on the balcony while looking at the moon in search of some answer-sees in the void a possible space of welcome. In all of them, the common denominator is to sacrifice what I have. Even my life.

Another of my favorite games that has the engine in the competition- I played it with my cousin, who enjoyed being the prettiest in the family. In our games, she played the African princess, and I was the missionary who gave my life to save her. My kindness filled the sad heart of a kidnapped princess or representative of a very poor people. To give myself or live for the other, to have a place in the relationship in which I took it for granted that she was happy because she was pretty, and I could only give myself to her care.

Today, those I admire personally or professionally, I can emotionally dedicate all my feelings to them. By doing so, I am entering a fantasy in which I am part of a crusade in which I help the discovery of this wonderful being who has the mission of awakening or changing the world.

I cannot leave this account of my link with fantasy without commenting that there were also moments in that relationship with my cousin in which the kind one became a monster and could be the evilest witch or the murderer who ran to the kitchen in looking for the biggest knife to be able to kill her.

Even today, before those who I believe enjoy a benefit -such as the beauty of my cousin- fantasy places me in submission, or in a battle for what belongs to others, which I do not have and will never obtain. I resign myself and stop doing my thing because the other gets whatever, in advance, has made me, on occasion of being fed up, pull out the knives and fight to the death with the other. In doing so, the attitude is so intense it reminds me of an act of vandalism that leaves in me the impression that I am bad, and in the other the idea that what he has he has not earned.

Dreams of martyr and heroine. As a heroine, I clearly remember that before falling asleep and for a long time, I dreamed of getting good grades to please my father, who promised me to enrol in a swimming club where a coach would discover me as an excellent swimmer, and I would make it to the Olympics and be the great champion. And so, my effort would serve to make my father proud of me, and I would be valid and loved, finally. After that fantasy that gave me the drive to continue day to day with enthusiasm, it became clear that I neither got good grades permanently nor did my father enrol me in a swimming club, and I began to fantasize that when I grew up I would be elected governor of my city and I would take care of fixing the problems of the poor neighborhoods. This fantasy replaced the previous one; Since I would not be discovered, I would take care of those who have less possibilities. Discovering them in their poverty would save them from the situation.

That fantasy feeling - that makes me think and believe that I have no value - awakens in me the need to fight to improve, and while I fight and work, I am valuable.

How is fantasy present in my partner?

The first fantasy is to position myself in front of him with the feeling of being in debt, that he is not happy with me or that I am not the one he needs. This fantasy leads me to be suffering from not being valid enough and for that I am going to receive a punishment and I look for it like a drug, and the punishment is rejection. In times of fatigue or disturbance, I often find myself in that trap.

Admitting my masochistic tendency, I am developing a stamina made of hearing unpleasant things or seeing unpleasant faces and emotions of the other and understanding and accepting them.

Days go by and this endurance leads to a behavior in which I start by asking questions that I know will lead me to a place of disagreement, anger, disgust, pain and even situations of breach. Even knowing that by asking him, for example, how he is with me, what is wrong with him, what he wants or if he loves me, in those moments of disagreement due to diverse and adverse circumstances, I provoke a confrontation, even knowing that this is going to happen, well I am possessed by the desire to suffer and I persevere in my attitude. If I put that attitude into images, it would be as if, while I was asking, I was making my way to the scaffold and serving my head to the other so that he gradually cuts it off, creating in the other the executioner who is going to decapitate me.

I make it easier for the other to tell me what I know is going to hurt me and I allow that to become a crisis in which, once again, I feel hurt and destroyed. From there, the fantasy is that if I don't suffer, I don't feel, if I don't feel I don't vibrate, if I don't vibrate I

don't live. So, I suffer for having created the situation, and suffering I feel the love, I feel that there is a link, broken but a link, and little by little I am repairing the damaged link with my good work, my sympathy and dedication. And from this attitude the days go by, and I realize he hasn't changed at all, and that's where my disgust is unleashed. This time the disgust transforms the fantasy into a longing. The longing to find a better partner; that couple is a respectable, important, wise, famous man, who discovers me and finds in me the love he never had. I am the Cinderella with whom the prince falls in love.

This could be the balancing or compensatory fantasy that nurtures the longing and leaves me hopeful that one day this sacrifice I am making now, in these difficult times, will be rewarded.

To love you must endure and suffer. I suffer for not being what he deserves, and suffering I feel love, which is born in gushes. My feelings of love speak to me of being spontaneous and loving and that desire to get out of the role of the sufferer and enjoy love blinds me. And then, in the name of freedom, I pounce on the other in those moments when he is talking to me about retreat... And start again.

How is my fantasy in the professional field?

The first step has to do with living the competition. In this competition, the fantasy is to create in the other someone for whom things turn out well, who is more cunning and more gifted but not qualified. It is simply that life favors him or her and they know how to get a better slice of it, that they relate better. Simply put, he's doing better than me.

Those I admire are not doing better than me. To them I give all the best that I have, that is, the qualities that I possess and many that I do not have but that if I give myself to them, I will acquire (and my day will come).

In practice, I live the fantasy that I am the best worker, the one who best accomplishes, understands, and does the job. It is true that being the best worker does not include being the nicest or the most social or the one that creates the best relationships between colleagues. What stands out is the feeling of being misunderstood: I am the best, but the others do not know or do not want to see or recognize it. But the bosses do see in me the best representative of their ideology, or the one that achieves the best results, although they never tell me. Before authority, my fantasy is to see myself small and defenseless; the other is someone great and knows more than me. My attitude is servile, but I let it be known that I understand. Since he sees potential in me, I dare to put limits on him or comment on his work without his having asked me for an opinion, but in the workplace that is necessary to improve. I oscillate between the little one and the one who, in the name of work, takes licenses with the authority so that everything goes for the better.

To maintain this fantasy, I think about work in my head all day, and that leads me to study, think, work. The desire to be the best is so great that the idea that governs me is that everything at work is serious and profound. This means staying too many hours, because it is never enough and there is always a lot to do, understand, read. This way, everyone will see how committed and sacrificed I am. This fantasy makes me behave in a way isolated from others or, better yet always making my territory clear.

This need to make a difference with my colleagues unleashes a thought of "I work and work and others work half", and in my desire to stand out I have a solution for everything and I am always ready to give it to them even if they don't ask me, or reserve me and not give it to them, hoping that the time will come when they will need my opinion, which will be the good one and they will then act as if that solution were theirs. This makes me fantasize that they are my enemies, my rivals, and I am the bearer of truth.

In situations of workers facing authority, I adopt the role of the one who defends just causes, the one who puts limits on authority or tells it the truth, and then I get angry for having played the role of the heroine who shows her face and the one who gets disappointed, but this gives me a different place where I fantasize about being the brave, sincere and honest one, the others, my colleagues, are comfortable and accommodating.

All this comes from not being satisfied with what I have or what I do, and my fantasy creates a two-headed being: on the one hand I am indispensable and I sacrifice myself for the good of the company and I am the best, and on the other I am the one who does the dirty work and gets angry about doing it, which makes me the dumbest of them all. These two attitudes come together and make me so overwhelmed that the idea of work often makes me more tired than work. The burden that I produce is more overwhelming than the work itself.

In common with the other sections is the one that inhabits in me the feeling of not being happy with who I am, and this dissatisfaction unleashes my fantasy in which I am different, I fight through the effort at work to be the best position that I feel the worst, and in my effort the sense of duty leads me to never have enough information or the homework done and I need to go on and on working. In doing so, I isolate myself, and in isolation the other becomes at times this being that I have not cared for, and then the heart is filled with guilt and regret. That is when the desire to help you arises and I solve the problem you are having or suggest how to solve something that I know is not being easy for you. Or, just the opposite, the other is not working the same as me, and then he becomes the enemy to betray and to defeat.

The heroine is the one who can be alone and of course, she never needs the help of the other nor does she want favours. I see favours as a sign of dependency. I neither ask for favours nor need the help of others, and so I fantasize that I am independent. In my fantasy it is not possible to think that what I do I do because of what I feel when comparing myself with others and because of how much I depend on them. In my dependency I have no affective bond within the labour field, and I suffer seeing how others have it. I depend on the grandeur of what I admire, for that figure if I am moved by affection. My fantasy leads me to rely on what I think that authority wants and needs. I demand that they recognize my great effort. Both my colleagues and the authority. When I receive it, it seems to me that they give me a tip and I cannot hear it.

Conclusion:

I can talk about my fantasy since in the work of the SAT Program I have learned to be aware of how it is present in my character and, from there, in my daily chores and relationships.

Now, when this one appears, I am not only the actress of my fantasies or the director who plans the future movie of my life, but the critic. And from criticism begins the process of becoming objective and this helps me to be able to detach myself from fiction and look at reality again from a more present place.

Fantasy is, as far as I have understood, a fiction in which I am someone who has created a fantastic identity with which I live as if it were reality.

I am a being that has an identity. who knows somewhere that this identity is false, and I am the one who still doesn't know who I am.

The heart gives meaning to my life, to my partner, to wanting to give the best of myself in all areas and to contribute what I must give at work.

Being this being that knows that it is unknown, I recognize that the dreams that I pursue and mark my path are dictated by my heart.

The emotion is not my identity, the emotion opens me to the experience from the heart, it opens the way for me, but it is not the way nor is it the me. It helps me open up, to be who I am from the heart.

Note:

It has been fifteen years since I wrote this chapter. Rereading it has been to remember the period lived with that neurotic frame and structure. My words reveal thoughts, emotions, situations, joys and fears, well spelled from that time. I am pleased with the sincerity of the story. The desire to search for the truth continues to be a torch that guides me just as it continues to illuminate a neurotic aspect of exhausting demand. My flame is made of a feeling of commitment, pain, delivery, pleasure, fear, rage, reality and fantasy with a desire for recognition drowned in modesty. Some of the neurotic traits that I describe in the chapter have become a good work tool. Learn to study for pleasure and not just out of obligation, sustain the chaos of the search in the proposals and stop tormenting yourself so much for not knowing the end. Go as deep as you can go, combining hardness and rigor without fear of accompanying it with sweetness. Others, like the competition, continue to make me believe that “there is no one like me”, because it is authentic, although I am already beginning to hear the internal buffoon laughing that I am still around, confusing singularity with uniqueness. Today, knowing and feeling loved, the games of “You still don't love me all that I need” that entails the feeling of frustration and inferiority are less present in the love of a couple. They do take on more relevance in the labor and social sphere, where I still have a job. I am not looking to be Genoveva de Brabant, but I am a fighter for the revolution that we expect in the workplace and a rebel with a social cause. I have not become governor of the city to help the poor, but I do live surround by seventy different cultures, and I work so that the theatre is entertainment for all. I am increasingly happy and grateful to have had the privilege of being part of Claudio's team and to recognize in him a wise man of his time and a prophet for humanity.

6. CHILDHOOD

By Emilia Córcoles

In this section we will describe the infancy of E4 conservation. We will cite different authors and analyze the way in which their contributions help us to understand both the internal and relational dynamics of E4 conservation.

Allen Schore¹ states: “As the experience of good atonement in infancy establishes in the nervous system the connections of basic bodily trust, building neurobiological patterns of stress management, the baby introjects attuned care as an ability to regulate and calm down. For example, your cortisol levels and the balance between the sympathetic and parasympathetic nervous systems reflect your ability to modulate their energy and to recover from adversity.

For J. Bowlby: “The Internal Operative Model is a mental representation of oneself and of the relationships with others that serves the child to organize and guarantee the controlled permanence of attachment and interaction behaviors”.

G. Tonella³ says: “The development of oneself will originate through the bond of attachment and early interaction with the mother, an adequate interaction will allow the continuity between the energetic experiences, sensory, motor, emotional and representative. The interaction with the mother will soothe and give meaning to the baby's experiences. If in this first interaction the baby does not feel recognized in his existence, he will not be able to recognize himself and will seek this recognition in others. When these attachment ties do not exercise their organizing and regulating function, the child experiences anguish”.

In the same article, Tonella quotes Wolf, Emde, Anders, Sanders, and Stern: “The self is not built without ties and these ties are the work of each one of the parents, of their mutual attachment and their interactivity”.

Also in that article, Tonella mentions Ainsworth (1978), Main and Salomón (1988), who show that the child protects himself, adapting other types of attachment strategies.

These forms of insecure attachment establish different relational patterns: anxious avoidant and anxious-ambivalent, which are the most frequent in children and adolescents of E4 conservation.

Anxious avoidant: Children with this attachment style show an apparent lack of interest and detachment from their caregivers during periods of distress. They have little confidence that they will be helped, have insecurity towards others, fear of intimacy and prefer to keep their distance from others.

Anxious-ambivalent: ambivalent children are those who seek the proximity of the primary figure and at the same time resist being reassured by her, showing aggression towards the attachment figure. They respond to separation with intense anxiety and mix attachment behavior with expressions of protest, anger, and resistance. These children feel insecurity in their relationships, fear of abandonment and rejection of significant objects, as well as hostility. These types of experiences create vulnerability to depression.

For Anzieu, the contact with the mother, her support, her gestures, and her sounds will allow the creation of a sound and gestural envelope that contains and calms the sensations, emotions, and impulses of the baby until the self in its growth can assume that wrapper function. He will call this I the I-skin. If the mother's contact has been experienced as adequate, the child will develop his own capacity for containment and regulation. If this is not the case, the baby will suffer anguish from not being able to calm down.

In E4 conservation, it is frequent that the mother has not established an affective bond, nor has she been in tune with the rhythms, intentions, desires and physical, sensory and emotional needs of the child.

One patient said:

“Images come to me of being in the crib alone, with the presence and care of my older sister. For me, my oldest sister has been a sister who has acted as a mother, I have memories of a lot of presence and a lot of love on her part, compensating for my mother's absence. I always remember my mother's presence agitated and anguished. She is a woman who has a lot of energy and a high load of anxiety and tension.

One of my earliest memories is being cradled in my mother's arms, but how can I possibly have this memory? I am so small, but I know that my little head is resting on her right arm and my feet on her left arm, she is standing next to the curtain that closes a very small closet, my feeling is not comfort, but that I feel fear, anguish, she is nervous, and, in a hurry, I feel her impatience.”

“Over time I could have built that the song she sang to me was to surrender to the coconut that she felt as a presence inside the closet, it does not seem possible to me that this feeling goes back to a child of about three months. But that is the memory and I have never sung that song to my son.”

Stefania Giannini

The three subtypes of the E4 trait gestate in the oral stage of life, which spans from the end of the third to approximately the eighteenth month of age.

According to Juan José Albert: “During this stage the area that becomes most noticeable to the child's perception is the mouth together with all the functions related to sucking, jaw movement and swallowing.

“The child gains a sense of himself through oral motor and sensory perceptions, in such a way that his living and social experiences during this phase remain somatically anchored in the muscles of the body segments: ocular, oral and cervical.

“If the baby finds a void at birth because the different interactions (contacts, care, games) are without affection and pleasure, the oral wound will form in it, which is a deprivation wound, which will reduce in the baby the intensity of the life drive, the impulse to suck, suck, bite. What the baby does is “swallow”.”.

Some subjects E4 conservation will reveal negative experiences and intoxication in lactation. We have observed that in childhood of E4 conservation people there are common etiological factors:

- Physiological and emotional deprivation at an early age, which may be due to the loss of the mother due to death, illness, depression, abandonment or temporary absence, for example, if she is busy taking care of a sick family member, or has many children or because she is a single mother, or she has to help her husband or as in a minority of cases, in which the child is abandoned in institutions.
- Disturbed maternal affective communication. There is no response, or it is inappropriate to what the baby needs, either because physical distance is created in physical or verbal contact, or because they are verbally and sometimes physically recriminated.

In the development of the character of E4 conservation in childhood there are two wounds: one, in the representational nucleus that would touch the narcissistic wound in the “idea of self” (“I am little thing”, “I do not deserve it”, “I’m not like the others”), there is a devalued representation of himself at the conscious level, although, after years of therapy, we observe that at a more unconscious level another valued representation of himself is built and activated that it makes him give himself an image of grandiosity (“I am the best, I deserve it all), and also in the “Idea of the Others” (who remain as grandiose or persecutors). Thus, the persecutory idea that they are going to give you bad food is gestated, the distrust towards the food offered by the other being fixed (whether it refers to food or affection) and the anger towards the external source of nutrition.

In the most general case, when the mother remains by the child's side but stops attending to him, taking care of him and giving him a safe environment, the child introjects the hostile figure, giving rise to his bad internal image and the experience of lack and longing for the good mother. The mother is left as great and idealized and the child feels very small and helpless. This way of seeing others as superior is going to be repeated in their relationships throughout their lives.

The other wound, in the emotional core, provokes anger towards himself and towards the world for not feeling recognized in his basic needs. They are children who do nothing pleasant for themselves; On the outside they are pleased, and, on the inside, they are sabotaged by the rage they feel from experiencing that they are not given food.

We have verified with some people E4 conservation in consultation, that they are linked with the mother in childhood and adult life in a fusional (dependent) way, experiencing physical and emotional separation with great anguish, even though the interaction is cold, lacking in contact physical and affection.

“Suzy Stroke came to my SAT 2 and asked me why I didn't work pestering my mom; I told her I wasn't sorry, because my mom was the three B's: (Bella, Buena y Buena) Beautiful, Good, and Good, and Susy then asked me: "What did your mom do when you were sick as a child?" I lit up and said, "My mom, when she was sick, she would give me her picture, it was beautiful, and I would look at it and hold it with me." Susy insisted: "Why, your mother was not there? Works?". At that moment a world opened to me; no, my mom didn't work, I don't know where she was, or

rather she was at home, but she was never with me, I didn't feel her presence, but I needed to keep that photo, I looked at it and idealized it. I also felt a feeling of melancholy or nostalgia, like when you love someone who is not there. Then I dreamed of her looking at the photo."

Stefania Giannini

Others were unwanted, either because the mother was expecting a child of the other sex or because there were many children she had to attend to. At this stage, their relationships with their parents were marked by unexpressed anger (endured), struggle, effort, demand, and the desire to be seen, recognized, and loved.

In most cases, the child is raised in a family where there is a family environment of suffering, pain, lack and anguish because at least one of the parents is depressed or ill. The child is fixed to painful experiences and above all to suffering in the way of bonding with their parents. As we already saw in the third chapter, the child tries to compensate and please his parents, who are overloaded or ill, cancelling his own needs to counteract the anguish and suffering, the effort being idealized as a virtue and as a wrong way to get their gaze, recognition, and affection.

In filial relationships, it is common for the father of the E4 conservation to bond emotionally with the son and to have a close, warm presence and sometimes powerlessness to resolve the issues of life. These physical and moral limitations sometimes allow their children and their children to develop and legitimize their sexual desires and needs.

Some women from E4 conservation remember how their father came by every night to kiss them before going to sleep.

E4 conservation woman recounts:

"I went to my father with great admiration. When he treated my wounds, he felt like a person who knew a lot; in fact, he healed my appendix stitches with great pamper and care every day. The only pleasant and comforting physical contact I remember was from my father. Sometimes I would get close to him when I was little, to watch some TV together, it was a comforting moment for me. I left it when I was about twelve years old, because I experienced it as weak. His health was compromised, he didn't count for much at home. He was a worker, but he was smart, and he was highly regarded. Many of his friends asked him to prepare their tax returns, he did it for free and at those moments I felt that he felt satisfaction and I felt pleased and a little admired."

Stefania Giannini

In very few cases, the presence of the father is repressive, rigid and of tyrannical authority with the children.

One patient said: "My memories of my father in my childhood are always of absence or brutality, of punishments and of the fear that my mother put us with him."

A woman recounted in her autobiography: "The total absence of my father touches me a lot, I don't remember images of playing with him, of lying on the ground, in my space were my sisters and sometimes my mother. I remember him busy and with his things. My mother took care of the things of the house".

An E4 conservation recounted: "My father is the one in charge at home, you couldn't go against him, and he always told us that what he ordered was done without replying. All the food had to be eaten before he got up from the table."

He is a type of father who for different reasons does not give the child structuring or orientation, either by having a lot of work or being sick, lively, sadistic or for being absent.

Another E4 conservation reported: "My father never hit me physically, but I do feel a type of mistreatment in the relationship with his indifference and inability to show his affections and physically express his affection. From his obligation and his "shoulds", I feel that he did not know how to respect my essence and did not accompany me in my process of construction and discovery, since he already gave me the ready answers".

The father often has economic power and delegates responsibility to the mother in the area of education and basic care. The mother submits to do what he expects, and even abandons her children to attend to him. In most cases there is a lack of communication between the couple and a disqualifying look from the mother towards the father, who uses and makes the children part of it. In a minority, the respect between the members of the couple is frequent, being the motto of the family "never fight in front of the children".

An E4 conservation recounted: "My mediation between the two of them lasted almost all my life: when my mother wanted, thought or wanted something, she did not raise it directly with my father but indirectly and as a reproach; my father refused, my mother complained and I was going to convince my father of the appropriateness of my mother's desire, but in a subtle, seductive way, flattering him first, I even succeeded. Then I would go to my mother to tell her that I had achieved it and she, instead of thanking me or being happy, would get "pissed off" for having achieved what she could not".

We have observed that when the child E4 conservation is the youngest of the siblings, it is common for them to feel jealous or envy towards a sibling because the other was the desired one, intelligent, handsome, studious, or nice and therefore the experience is very frustrating. and restlessness; he believes that he will never reach that place of recognition.

"My mother always had on her dresser a large photo of my handsome and cheerful brother, at birth he weighed almost four kilos, and in the photo he is at his best, plump with big bright blue eyes and blond; the one in the other photo, smaller, is me, already looking dull and with my beautiful bricchielle in evidence: at birth I weighed 2.7 kilos and I was not good at sucking milk, so my mother breastfed me for a very short time."

Stefania Giannini

An E4 conservation woman said: "In my life this has been a constant, the eternal comparison with my sisters. Their behavior and their hobbies have always been part of my life as a way of being just like them".

Another E4 conservation woman said: "It's funny, but there are hardly any photos from my childhood. This lack of images has always bothered me a lot, since my three sisters do have photos".

The situation may also occur that the chosen child is the one who compares himself with his brothers, even though he has not been compared by parents.

In some cases, when the second subtype is sexual, the child's longing to be loved and recognized leads him to a rivalry and competitive struggle with his siblings in order to find his space among them and to be seen.

On the other hand, when the second subtype is the social one, it is very common in children that there is no rivalry and open fight between them.

We have observed by listening to the stories of some people E4 conservation, who have experienced traumatic experiences in an early stage of development, either due to non-empathic maternal functioning or prolonged psychological or physical and emotional abuse.

The experience of children is waiting for someone to be there for them, take care of them and protect them. They constantly need to convince themselves that they can be loved and liked as they are. In the case of a patient who had suffered abuse at an early age and who grew up without knowing it, this was encoded in the memory and stored in the body and in her therapeutic process she was able to establish a secure therapeutic attachment relationship and overcome primitive anxieties. to be free of trauma.

It is common for E4 conservation people to have an early development, which can be explained as an effort to compensate for the wounds of loss, lack and abandonment. From their earliest years they manifest that they are independent, although they have an attitude towards life and in their way of relating as if "something was owed to them". They are children who show expressive repression, both bodily and verbally. They look worried, feel ashamed and have a distorted and insecure image of their bodies. A conservation E4 woman said that she did not take anything if the older people did not give her permission beforehand. Another E4 conservation said: "I grew older, and an important shyness began to settle in me; I became quiet and reserved. I see myself at four or five years old with the face of a good girl, installed in the family pattern of being very good and studious.

Energetic and emotional depressive episodes in late childhood and early adolescence are typical. In this case, the parents support the depressive attitudes of inhibition, with the intention that the child entertains himself, and they frustrate in him the aggressive attitudes of expressing his needs with the threat of withdrawal of affection.

Bribring speaks of a depressive feeling in childhood as the basis of later depressions. This is related to a childhood traumatic feeling of helplessness caused by the frustration that the child suffers before the signals that he emits and the consequent loss of vitality, self-esteem, and inability to provide himself with what the author called "narcissistic substitutes".

These children can be said to be "their own mother".

"This is a memory from when I was not yet three years old. The room is large and bright, I am standing in an armchair near the front door, my mother leaves me here. I feel cold despite the light. Maybe it's spring but I feel cold, I'm afraid that an ogre or a bear is coming from the long corridor that leads to this room, and I stay still because the slightest movement or breath could make the ogre discover my presence and come to eat me, I am alone, there is no one to help me."

Stefania Giannini

7. PERSON AND SHADOW: THE DESTRUCTIVE FOR SELF AND FOR OTHERS

Personal Contribution of Teresita Rivera Loza, Roberta Ranalli

And Antonella Sabia

In the E4 conservation character it is possible to identify dark aspects and hidden parts that, however, play an important role in the relationship with oneself and with others.

The awareness of these hidden internal characters is often the result of therapeutic work, since they are difficult to recognize, but equally fundamental to integrate in the process of self-knowledge and harmonization of the being.

Specifically, the shadow of the E4 conservation character can be identified in these roles: the envious, the inner guide, the hard-working and the submissive.

The Envious:

As the E4 conservation is a countertype of the enneatype 4 whose passion is envy, it is manifested as an effect of the shadow, and not of a frank way. Since the self-image is experienced as deficient and devalued compared to an idealized internal image, it is pursued through constant effort and tension, with a perception that this perfection is far away, that it has not been achieved or done as well. enough. She is sustained by the crazy idea that when she reaches it, she will be so special, she will conquer and maintain the longed-for love (love that is a strong fusion longing) or she will achieve the admiration that compensates for the feeling of internal deficiency. The inner perception of being special would be manifested through the perfection achieved, a compensatory admiring love would be achieved, and, with this, a deep fear of abandonment would be conjured.

He relates to others with an envy that fuels competition, which is where the relationship with the outside world manifests itself. Competition in turn feeds the effort, resistance and perseverance that accompany it and that are related to the fear of being insufficient of making mistakes (I cannot fail) and of being singled out (this sensitivity connects with a deep fear of experiencing shame), reactions to the constant feeling of lack.

There is a subtle aspect that I have identified in me regarding envy: not having allowed my inner child to complain during childhood, nor after, I do not tolerate and get annoyed by people prone to complaining, unless they are found in situations that, in my opinion, are particularly serious. After all, there is envy for the inner child of the other who feels free and entitled to complain while I have excluded this possibility in exchange for recognition of my ability to endure. When this does not happen, the frustration is great.

Roberta Ranalli

What E4 deprives herself of in the name of resistance becomes an object of envy, but also of contempt when it is recognized in the other. Often, it is about spontaneity, lightness, the right to complain and to get what you want. Desire, like eros, understood as pleasure at all levels, is what is more prohibited for this type of character, so that its denial becomes a kind of flag that characterizes acting, feeling and thinking.

Envy, unspoken and not expressed, becomes arrogant and all-consuming as one witnesses the other getting what he craves without effort or strain, but simply at a simple request, an almost unthinkable sequence for a counter dependent and defiant character as the E4 conservation.

The Inner Judge:

The psychodynamic relationship between E1 and E4, in this case to the conservation subtype, gives the latter an internal voice that projects the outside world as a source of demands and mandates. There is a strong superego manifest clearly in the cognitive substrate of the character; a judge who questions each step, each behavior, each idea.

“The discovery of the inner judge came quite late in my life and came about through psychotherapy. It seemed perfectly normal to me to feel an inner voice hounding me with relentless demands and subsequent disapproval for not doing enough or well enough. I was caught in an automatism of continuous search for perfection that exhausted and demoralized me, obviously corroding my self-esteem. I felt that only by achieving things worthy of admiration would I gain acceptance and consideration, the love of the outside world, and a place of my own in the universe.”

Roberta Ranalli

The internal judge hovers as a constant demand to do and be better than one is, also fulfilling the function of sabotage and devaluation.

I could clearly see, during a therapeutic activity, how the inner judge perpetuated a real abuse against me, through a voice imperious and sadistic that mercilessly condemned my spontaneity. It was a kind of rape of the soul. It was not difficult to recognize how in that part of me I had kept my father's voice and action, and that, terrifying as it was, it served me to maintain my relationship with him internally.

Antonella Wise

The dynamics of the internal judge is not exhausted in the relationship with oneself but is also expressed externally in the judgment directed towards the other, towards situations, taking the form of feelings of contempt, of non-explicit confrontation, of hostile indifference, of affective withdrawal, particularly towards those who in our eyes manage to exempt themselves from self-judgment, live lightly accepting themselves as they are. An internal position difficult to reach for an E4 conservation.

Similarly, anger is expressed towards those who achieve goals in a way that is less traumatic and exhausting than one perceives in one's own way. Differences are experienced as an injustice, inseparably judging the lives of others as easier than their own. Rather, it is expressed through a cooling of the relationship, an emotional distancing in which not only envy is enclosed, but also, on a certain level, contempt, which is nothing more than envy adopting an arrogant posture.

For those who experience this aspect of E4 conservation, it is not always easy to understand what is really going on, often there is only a distance, a tension, which is also denied. Thus, the inner judge continues his tormenting action with subtle gestures, acting first on the subject and then, indirectly, on others. This dynamic is also expressed in the insecurity that it instils in the subject: one always feels like a loser in the confrontation with the other, fostering relational withdrawal that leads E4 conservation to be perceived as distant, sometimes snobbish, contemptuous, superior, when in reality, he neurotically lives a judgment about himself so implacable that it prevents him from any relational spontaneity.

The tenacious and tireless worker:

The E4 conservation, in his personal history, often took on great family problems from an early age, learning to bear burdens (especially emotional ones) and to endure difficulties with tenacity and great resistance, with the expectation of receiving admiration and love from change.

Enduring living away from family for many years, although it caused me great suffering, made me feel like a hero who understood and helped the family, without making demands of any kind so as not to increase their problems, the greater my ability to bear without complaining, the greater the recognition of my sacrifice.

These abilities had thus become my greatest strength and merits, the more burdens I carried, the more problems I could solve, the more effort I could endure without complaining, and the more medals of value I accumulated in my own eyes and in those of the world.

This mode created in me a neurotic compulsion to help and support others. In this way, I could achieve a double objective: feel good and obtain the recognition of a worthy person, Roberta Ranalli

In the history of E4 conservation, the repression and devaluation of childhood often go hand in hand with the appreciation of adulthood, where the individual is experienced as useful, productive, and able to contribute to the needs of the family. This character represses his childhood needs (play, fun, spontaneity) to adhere to the model that allows belonging to the family.

Working, acting correctly, doing things well, being useful, are the traits that are most valued, so this character does not doubt the need to leave childhood early to enter later stages of life without being prepared for it.

The picture is further aggravated by precarious economic and/or social conditions, particularly painful family experiences, depressive states of the parents or even the condition of being the last in the order of paternity. This last situation exacerbates the need to emulate older siblings to be loved by their parents if the criterion of contributing to family support is applied in the family.

However, it should also be noted how loading oneself with work, with incessant and strenuous activity, can be considered a useful way of life to anesthetize feelings, fill existential gaps, give oneself a physiognomy, and avoid anxiety. The ability to maintain large work rhythms aims to achieve recognition from authority, which can appreciate commitment, dedication, and results.

For this reason, it is not difficult to find in this orientation both aspects of competitiveness (feeling that one is doing well and better than others) and rigidity (things must be done in a certain way), which can inevitably sour and make relationships with those who share the work environment unpleasant.

Despite being an emotional character, E4 conservation has a strong drive for action that, if used in the right direction, would serve up a visceral emotional feeling that is very often intuitive and spontaneous.

The Melancholic:

It is that character that carries the emotional self-control of his repressed anger (resentments), his sadness for the unattainable and the pain of distrust that place him in a grey, unpleasant, or overwhelming perception of life, which he lives in constant tension. In my case there has also been a deep sadness contained by the introjection of being strong.

I have denied and avoided internal suffering for many years. Above all, the suffering of childhood was minimized or ignored, and I was pleased with this ability of mine to not give them space because it gave me a feeling of strength.

Roberta Ranalli

Melancholy is a feature that arises from looking at the past, at what could have been and was not, at what has not been done. It has several functions: avoidance of the present, contact with painful emotions, and the refusal to take responsibility for the course of one's life.

At the same time, it can be seen as an access to a childish position, the child's lamentation for something that he does not have or has not had.

Once again, melancholy has an outward implication, not only burdening personal relationships but also recreating relational dynamics like those of the family to preserve the original bond.

The Submissive:

Being a person who sees himself from efficiency and control, the E4 does not see his submissive part, which arises from obedience to mom under pain of losing her approval and with it his love and belonging to the bond (for fear of rejection and fear of abandonment). By not consolidating the basic trust in a "good enough mother", the child's rebellion is not consolidated either. A large part of the fear of aggression remains in a dark place, transformed into self-aggression. Another part is transformed into fear of conflict and when it occurs and if the accumulation of resentment is a lot, in paralysis and explosion.

This imbalance in the regulation of aggression generates difficulties to be assertive, indecisiveness, hypersensitivity to criticism, difficulty in assessing the version of the opponent or magnitude of the conflict, which ends up generating a lot of resentment towards the opponent(s) inside, since a large part of the aggression that is presumed outside is a projection of the self-aggression itself. The other is also perceived as a hypersensitive being, a projection of one's own hypersensitivity. That does not favour assertiveness either.

8. LOVE

By Noelia Milán

In the E4 the search for love is essential, the longing for love as salvation. It is not so much an active search as in the sexual Four, since the tenacious Four represses his desires more, he does not show them, he does it indirectly so that the other desiccates him, which gives him more security. His effort is really directed more at work than at love as a way of obtaining recognition. The tenacious Four can spend a long-time yearning, fantasizing, dreaming of the partner who will arrive and give him what they did not give him.

According to Karen Horney, the neurotic feels and behaves as if his entire existence, his happiness, and his security depended on being appreciated and loved. It raises whether the desire for love is for the pleasure that arises from the relationship with the other or to obtain security and avoid anguish. In the tenacious Four both things exist, although first he pursues feeling safe, more affectively (that the other listens to him, understands him, does not judge him) than materially (since with his effort he knows how to provide himself well in life). Later he discovers the importance of pleasure in the relationship.

He pursues a compulsive search for love to feel complete, believing that by finding someone who will make amends for his feelings of being unseen and misunderstood, he will resolve his dissatisfaction in life.

I remember that, as a child, my favorite story was that of Cinderella. This fantasy about Prince Charming continued into my adolescence, I spent hours fantasizing, imagining how my life would change when he found me, how he would save me from all the suffering, I would see how special he was, what no one had ever seen. He would transform me into a new woman, I would always be happy, I would finally have all the love that I had not been given.

In this sense, Hugo Bleichmar explains that the object of attachment can be the one that contributes to the psychic regulation of the subject, to diminish his anguish, to organize his mind, to counteract the anguish of fragmentation, to provide a feeling of vitality. of enthusiasm. The feeling of devitalization, of emptiness, of boredom in the absence of the object of attachment makes one look for it compulsively.

The tenacious E4 cares more about what he is going to get from the other, what he will get, and at that level, his is not a reciprocal relationship; it is not so available to the other, unconsciously. From their experience of lack there is a use and manipulation of the other to satisfy their needs. This search becomes eternal and frustrating because it is a longing, it is in the ideal, and then it can never be realized.

The tenacious E4 wants the other to fill his feeling of internal scarcity, his lack, he asks for recognition, a support that he is not capable of granting himself. Hence, he desires the absolute loving presence of the partner, to be the emotional center of his life to be sure that he is loved. But the other is never going to fill him completely, he cannot give him that recognition, because the conflict is internal, he cannot give him permanent support, a total loving presence. It is unreal, because the other is an adult with his own needs that the tenacious E4 does not consider. You believe that the other person is there to make amends and, inevitably, what ensues is frustration.

H. Bleichmar affirms that privacy is sought because our mental state is validated. One confirms that it exists through feeling, in the validity of our perceptions and thoughts, to the extent that for another what we are, feel, and think does exist. The feeling of being subjects bears the mark of our constitution from the other. As adults, we continue to require for our confirmation as subjects, for the validation of feelings, thoughts, and actions, that another validates them. Once it is painfully discovered that the other's emotional state and that their interests and desires may be very different from ours, the desire for a mental reunion will become the engine of the psyche.

I always expect more from my partner, I have doubts, as if one day he was going to discover my most intimate defect and he would stop loving me. There are days when I live in fear that another more intelligent or beautiful woman will appear, and he will leave me. For this reason, I constantly harbour doubts as to whether he loves me, even if he gives me proof of it. Other times, I tell him that I don't understand why he is with me, why he has chosen me when there are better women in the world. For this reason, any forgetfulness, or small details of carelessness, I interpret as if he did not care about me at all, as if he has forgotten that I exist, a proof of profound lack of love. For example, if I agree to call you at an hour and you don't pick up the phone because you're out of coverage or you don't realize the time, I experience that situation as a great abandonment, I don't understand how that could happen to you; I would be pending, something is wrong in the relationship for this to be happening.

This disregard of the other in the face of the slightest failure arises from the fact that in the face of an experience of reality, such as the absence of a phone call at the expected moment, which lives with an immense anguish that touches with some experience of abandonment, gives it a catastrophic hue and the inability to relativize the specific situation over time arises. This lack of empathy is not only the consequence of a demanding attitude, but rather an original anguish that he does not know how to handle from his psyche because it disorganizes him on an emotional level.

Hyper susceptibility appears, and any lack of satisfaction of their desires or expectations is felt as a rejection, with which they can quickly go from a feeling of love to another of anger. Since he does not know how to relativize the situation from the rational point of view, the narcissistic wound arises, because the other does not love him as he expects and withdraws, closes himself off to protect himself from the pain, with a more primary defence: "I don't need you". It is also a proud retreat. Faced with pain or the experience that the other can abandon or disorganize them, they say that they can do it alone, that they don't need them.

Another aspect of the affective demand is that the other covers his emptiness. Since this is not the case, he blames him for his unhappiness, he thinks that what they give him is not enough. The tenacious E4 does not directly require the other to give him, but rather makes an effort and demands himself to deserve. He may blame himself for not being loved and strive to do better, and he is complacent and sacrifices excessively to get what he expects and resentful when he is not given what he expects. They must guess their needs without asking for them directly, since their taboo is to ask and the most denied thing is to show what they need, because they usually go with the mask that they don't need anything. Showing otherwise exposes their dependency and need. In addition, pleasing serves to ensure that the other is happy and is not going to abandon him.

Another trait is envy in the relationship with respect to how much he gives to others and how much he receives. It is compared because the couple enjoys it more and makes less effort, which is followed by reproach and anger because the other enjoys being with other people and he is not the only one for the other. The tenacious E4 can awaken the feeling of guilt in the couple, tyrannizes them and insists on getting what they want, sometimes presenting themselves as the one who suffers the most, other times as someone omnipotent, again without regard to the other. He strives to hide his deep weakness (showing his affective dependence) as well as the feeling of feeling little, and he does this through a facade of apparent energy.

Added to this is the difficulty of living what is pleasurable, which is only allowed occasionally. He keeps making the effort, because if he doesn't think something bad is going to happen, or if he's going to lose it, he must be attentive to anything and to the other, so he can't relax. On the one hand, they tend to be negative, they are concerned about what is missing or what is not right, which leads to the impossibility of relaxing, letting go, trusting. It goes to intensity, and some code things with a lot of loads (for example, at the end of the holidays or when physical pain is exaggerated, as if it were something tremendous, because a person lives with little flexibility in changes). The tenacious E4 lives under the threat of how the other is going to see him, whether he likes or dislikes him, whether he does things well or badly, so that their relationship can turn into hell. It is not that he consciously seeks suffering, but rather that he lives in fear that the other will discover his faults and leave. Consequently, he lives this relationship with fear, submission, and persecution, which makes it difficult for him to enjoy what is pleasurable.

It is characteristic of the trait that love, once achieved, is devalued. He questions if that love is true, if he is the right person, if he could achieve something better, and he continues dreaming of the ideal. The moment someone wants the tenacious E4 is invalidated, because they love him, which is worthless. He has an ideal of how the other has to be and in everyday reality he disqualifies him and highlights what he lacks. From here arises the internal conflict of how to continue the relationship with that person who no longer serves him because he has disqualified him. This may be another way to cover up the anguish of committing and assuming that this is how people and life are.

I remember, as a young girl, asking my friends how they could be sure they were with the right person, I wanted to know how to have that confirmation, how were they sure that there would be no person who could give them more. If you chose, then you gave up other possibilities. It is what Claudio names about chronic dissatisfaction: if I limit my aspirations I am going to be left with very little, I always fantasize about greater satisfaction.

On other occasions, tendentious criticism of the external object deprives the subject of all private pleasure since it makes the one from whom something is expected and for whom one disappears. This is the contribution of M. Klein, who highlights the internal conditions of the subject that conspire against being able to use the external object for their own development, in this case for the confirmation of their being and their experiences.

If we have accumulated anger and guilt, this will influence our future relationships. It is as if one learned that love has two faces, love-rejection, and then it is what is repeated. In my case, I am not one to express anger, except in couple relationships, when repeating the maternal pattern, there is a disqualification of the other, to which is added the aspect of counter dependence; I need to feel that I am self-sufficient, that I can manage by myself, I do not allow myself to be dependent due to the distrust that what the other is going to give me is good or that this love harms me.

Another difficulty for the tenacious E4 is receiving and accepting the affection sought, since he is convinced that no one will ever be able to love him. He maintains a certain internal resentment, because they did not love him as he needed and he projects his distrust in the other, he suspects that they will not give him, that the other does not value him, does not take him into account, does not do it. Distrust of receiving and accepting, resounding refusal to receive something from someone for not being dependent on the other.

Sometimes I feel like I'm eagerly chasing affection and when I get it it's like I can't stomach it, and again more anguish. One way to get out of this anguish when receiving it is to provoke some discussion where I reduce the entrance of love with the fight and then I can relax because I distance myself emotionally. That is the comfortable situation for me, because it is what is known through the relationship that my parents had.

This is what H. Bleichmar says about masochism and the modalities of establishing the feeling of intimacy: he observes that pleasure is felt when suffering "together with", which generates in some people one of the forms of masochism: The pleasure of suffering derives from the fact that it allows one to achieve the feeling of intimacy with another who suffers. If this has been the basic modality of intimacy that was experienced in the relationship with parents or siblings, then, in order to reacquire the experience of the encounter, the suffering that was the air that was breathed in common will be recreated. The proposal to suffer together, which is unconsciously proposed to the other, has the bittersweet character derived from being the condition that enables a feeling of intimate encounter. Repeating the mood of the mother, a feeling of unity and harmony with her is achieved. The addiction to shared suffering, which constitutes a whole form of character, places us squarely in the role of intersubjectivity in the genesis of the psychopathology of masochism. Pleasure in suffering can have its roots and its actualization in the present, in bonds in which suffering is the privileged means to feel in communion with the other.

In this way, I understand suffering more as pleasurable, in my case it is the way I found to be in intimacy with my mother, there was only that space. The rest, joy, and one's own needs were not allowed. One learns that this is good, it is the way to be with the other, and I recognize that this is what I transferred to other relationships from then on.

The tenacious Four can experience great anguish when someone offers sincere love, as it awakens the fear of dependence, denial, and submission. What happens if I give myself up and the other leaves me? You feel unworthy of love due to your low self-esteem and cannot be trusted; He projects his distrust on the other. On the other hand, if they give him a lot, he feels trapped like in a spider web and that worries him. Many overflows and do not know how to receive pleasant things, they do not know how to handle it. The fear of commitment arises, of losing individuality. They do not want to be

linked because that generates dependency, they fear being subjected, losing their freedom.

According to K. Horney, it can also happen that the internal representation of the encounter with the other is loaded with fear: being invaded, overwhelmed, blamed, persecuted, punished, saddened, overexcited, infected with anxiety, forced to do what they don't want etc. Whether through direct experiences of exchanges with significant figures, whether through identification with those figures that transmitted to him how they live intimacy or through the product of their phantasmatic productions.

There is some tension in intimacy; one way to protect we from it is through presence and distance. We appreciate the other more when they are distant, and we despise them when they get too close. The best thing is a sufficient distance so as not to lose the other, but not to get too close so as not to be seen. Some time ago I went to some therapeutic massage sessions, the therapist was a very loving, tender woman, "like a mom, so much that I couldn't stand it, my crazy fantasy was that when I was receiving the back massage, she was going to nail me." a knife. I was suspicious, that loving and intimate space produced tension in me.

As in other issues, what is lacking is desired and what is available is devalued. It is the core of dissatisfaction, the attraction is in the distance and impossible to achieve, the motor is in the longing, not in achieving it, this is where true enjoyment is found. It is a neurotic need for insatiable, voracious affection, hence its demand for unconditional love. Since you can never get to that, a state of melancholy is fostered, where moods are intensified.

The wallowing in a sweet sadness arises, it is a pleasant and evocative state of something that was had and is not. Intensity is longed for, the everyday looks boring, that's why it is exaggerated. There is a tendency to go to the past, evoking what could have been had and was not had is better.

When my relationships as a couple were stormy, I felt all the intensity of heartbreak and helplessness, it gave me a lot of room to complain and feel unhappy in private and in meetings with friends. It's hard to explain, but there was something comforting in those dramatic situations, in telling and ranting about it, in feeling like the saddest person in the world and having all other aspects of life with this feeling of melancholy. When I began to have a stable relationship, it seemed even boring to me: I could only say that it was fine, I longed for the intensity of the complaint, I even doubted, if the above was missing, this might not be love. My parents' relationship was always one of disputes, of comings and goings. One learns that satisfaction in the relationship comes hand in hand with suffering.

The tenacious Four, by participating in the idealization of suffering in the encounter with the other, sometimes maintains stormy relationships not because of the desire to suffer, but because of the fear of rupture, of loss, or because they believe that if they endure and make an effort everything can go well: then you feel worthy and the other will notice.

9. HISTORICAL PERSONS: VINCENT VAN GOGH AND GIROLAMO SAVONAROLA

❖ VINCENT VAN GOGH:

By Giulia Depero And Elena Sansonetti

"Everything we do faces infinity".

Vincent Van Gogh

Vincent Van Gogh was born on March 30, 1853, the same day that, a year earlier, his mother saw her first and most desired newborn son, named Vincent, die.

The mother, inconsolable for such a hard bereavement, gave the same name, Vincent, to her second son. It was not a mother of explicit rejection and did not fail in the function of caring, but in recognizing the need to particularize the existence of Vincent. Therefore, this existence did not evolve as a value in itself but was perceived as the replacement of the lost son.

The granting of the name registers the person in the register, including it in the series of generations, but above all it manifests the power of the desire of the other, who in this way can have the right to exist in the particularity of his own existence as a human being. Vincent, who bears the name of his dead brother as his own, seems to come into the world in the shadow of an impoverished sense of life and of being desired.

Vincent's life is called to replace the life of another, who, as a lost person, fatally tends to assume an idealized character. Parents, failing to process the loss of their first child as soon as possible, find a real surrogate. This implies that the little second Vincent, like any substitute, is doomed to show all his insufficiency: he bears the name of another, he can only appear as an unworthy substitute, therefore never up to the task. Vincent will always be a second-rate surrogate, a reject, a narcissistic wound that has never healed. The fundamental feeling of unworthiness and melancholy that will accompany you throughout your life is the underlying reason for your deep unhappiness and difficulty in living.

Vincent died in July 1890, at the age of thirty-seven, after a day of agony, in the arms of his beloved brother Theo, after having attempted suicide by shooting himself in a dung-filled pit. He said shortly before he died: "I wish I could go like this." A few months earlier, the son of Theo's beloved brother, who had the same name as his painter uncle, had been born. His brother's marriage had taken place earlier, seriously compromising the partnership between them. Perhaps all these facts contributed to the irreversible deterioration of the disease, which had already manifested itself on Christmas Eve of 1888, after Gauguin's abandonment of the project of Vincent to create a community of painters. Again, the drama of a substitution, an expulsion, an uprooting, a rejection: there is no place for him in the world. His existence is like one more, meaningless, like a waste of the world.

His father was a Protestant pastor. Vincent describes him as a nurturing father who embodied uncompromising moral rigor. The mother is tenderly evoked. Her maternal desire seems to occupy only the living shadow of her dead son. Vincent's so-called originality, which manifests itself in extravagance, eccentricity, resistance to family principles, destined to amplify itself more and more negatively over the years, thus appears as a premonitory sign of their inevitable diversity from their ideal child.

Vincent, during his short and intense life, was very interested in literature, spoke four languages, and wrote extraordinary letters, true works of art, which were a testimony of his artistic evolution and his transformation in his spiritual path.

Emile Bernard left us a written testimony:

"Red hair, goatee, scruffy Mustache, shaven nape, eagle gaze and sharp lips almost speaking. Lively gesture, animated in speech, attentive to explain and develop ideas, little inclined to controversy. And how many dreams!"

His sister describes him like this: "Has a complexion rather robust than long, with a slightly curved back due to his habit of always looking at the ground." She says that she kept quietly away from the other children and isolated himself from the garden in nature: he knew all the places where the strangest flowers grew. He collected nests of different birds. One of these nests he gave to his nephew, who was brought to Auvers by his brother Theo and his wife Johanna one Sunday, where Vincent was cared for. His introverted and melancholic character can already be glimpsed, of which the nest represents his desire for privacy and belonging.

His entire existence is marked by a very strict and austere discipline; he eats, simply and sparingly, bread soaked in beer.

His luxury is his pipe, alcohol, and a fortnightly visit to a brothel. The pleasure is denied. Pleasure and fun seem not to be written in the code of life. It becomes a point of pride not to have this addiction.

In March 1886, the mother left the town of Nuenen. At home she has an enormous quantity of paints, brushes, objects and, above all, Vincent's canvases, which, instead of sending to Theo, she closes in boxes and entrusts to a carpenter from Breda, disinterested in her son's work. Much of that material will be lost.

There is a family figure who gives him support and support: his essential brother Theo, who loved him deeply throughout his short life and shared his passion for art. It was a support for him, a kind of alien mirror that reinforces and sustains a narcissistically precarious identity. According to psychoanalysts, this relationship with a highly dependent character appears as an imaginary reciprocal compensation relationship.

It is no coincidence that the dramatic epilogue of Vincent's life coincides with Theo's marriage and then the birth of his nephew Vincent. The same happens with Theo: the death of his brother opens the abyss of his own madness against the backdrop of a very fragile psychic situation. A few months later, he dies of an illness of uncertain origin, having first tried to kill his wife and young son; there are accounts of dramatic episodes of madness and violence.

The relationships:

According to Lacan, the Vincent-Theo relationship represents a typical model of an "imaginary crutch" that compensates for an absent Oedipus. The relationship with his brother becomes the only family relationship that makes him exist as a subject, although this relationship, formed by a narcissistic-specular identification, is incapable of supporting the meaning of his own existence. For this reason, Vincent will insistently try to convince Theo to follow him in his vocation for painting, always being distressed. Later, when Theo takes a wife and has a child, thus taking his place in the world, Vincent's psychic stability will be irretrievably shattered.

Even significant affective relationships are characterized by a need for presence and fusion that excludes alterity. It will be a series of painful failures. In all the strong ties, be it with Theo, with Gauguin or with all sentimental relationships, we find the pattern of identification that animated the relationship with Theo: the same absolute passion, the same absence of limits, the same intimacy. mirror, the same imperative need for presence.

Each failure is a weapon to demand ever greater proof of sacrifice from himself. Forge a stoic character that endures any physical test, seeking a non-human perfection, a divine aspiration free of material and emotional dependencies.

The link with Gauguin played a crucial role in unleashing Van Gogh's psychosis, who had recognized in him the ideal figure who adhered well to his demand to absolutely share his passion for art. A passion she had already tried unsuccessfully to share with Theo. Vincent's dream was to create a community of artists united by a common passion for painting and ultimately materially and financially independent. The first great psychotic crisis occurred on Christmas Eve 1888. Gauguin was his medicine, therefore a true ideal support for Vincent, but, at the same time, Vincent demanded absolute and unreserved spiritual and material communion, which Gauguin was not at all willing to tolerate. Thus, it became his poison when he decided to leave the house on Christmas Eve. After an argument, he amputates his ear, gives it to a prostitute in the brothel, and is later overwhelmed by delusions and hallucinations. After this crisis, he is admitted to the hospital in Arles.

Do not underestimate the circumstance of Christmas Eve, the nativity; his own birth occurred without being in the desire of the other. His relationships with women (Eugenie, Kee Sien) are dominated by the same need for presence, for fusion. All the breaks in these relationships, even if they are only platonic, will lead to violent depressive falls, the release of which will coincide with radical changes in Vincent's life.

From all this it follows that Vincent lives the love relationship with an idealistic fury, as if it were the only and irreplaceable one. What's more, he is unable to tolerate not being reciprocated. More exactly, he cannot tolerate the non-correspondence between the ideal representation of the relationship and its reality in fact, with the consequent frustration.

Vincent shows that he is absolutely incapable of bearing the discrepancy between his need for fusion and the real otherness of the other. Therefore, there is never a real mourning work after each separation, but rather sudden changes of course in life, as if acting took the place of psychic work. This E4 conservation temperament, which we can describe as thirsty for love, can end up giving up love so as not to feel hurt and dependent. Give up desire, with a belief: only I get it better.

Loneliness And Melancholy:

The experience that seems to emerge from the biography is that of implacable loneliness, of feeling different, persecuted by a cruel destiny, with a deep feeling of melancholy. A deep and nameless restlessness has always followed him and he cannot find a way out. Feeling different is her strength, and her ability to renounce is the food of her pride, her shame.

Between 1873 and 1876 he worked as an art dealer in his paternal uncle's gallery, first in Paris and then in London. The job's precarious conditions reveal in him a feeling of inadequacy with respect to everything related to practical life and social ties. Bourgeois conformism is unbearable for him, making a professional commitment impossible.

He has a strong feeling that he lacks roots, of being destined for a life without meaning, in disorder. This and the constant feeling of misunderstanding led him to reinforce his connection with Christianity. From 1876 to 1878, he dedicated himself body and soul to the evangelical experience. Christianity seemed to him a solution to the disaster of a meaningless existence, and he devoted himself fervently to transmitting the mystical experience of Christ. Unfortunately, this mission also failed, when in 1878 he did not obtain the preaching appointment, he had long hoped for. Faced with this rejection, he travelled to Belgium, to the mining area, to live his Christian experience together with the poorest and most dispossessed. He became a defender of the rights of others.

Later, the dramatic story of his unrequited love for Kee pushed him with increasing conviction to devote his life to painting. And that he did until the end of his short life.

In 1885, his father died. Death was followed by a period of serious disorders, fevers, weakness, and apathy that marked a state of depression that was now continuous. In 1886 he settled in Paris with Theo, who is a gallery owner who works mainly with the impressionists to whom Vincent first devoted his attention to. Shortly after, he aligned himself with the most recent experiments in color with the most significant protagonists of post-impressionism.

Vincent left Paris in 1888 in a precarious condition due to an irregular life and the abuse of alcohol and tobacco. He himself writes: "My brain was almost ruined". In the spring he moved to Arles, where he planned to create a community of artists who would meet at his home. He prepares the humble home with great passion and care, despite his limited financial resources, its construction you can recognize the strong need for a nest with a strong aesthetic sense. In Gauguin's room, he furnished a series of works that would become his greatest masterpieces: sunflowers. Gauguin, whom Vincent admired as an artist and for his strong personality, was the first of the invited artists. Unfortunately, the problematic coexistence between the two artists lasted only a few months, from autumn until Christmas Eve. The dream of the community is broken with the march and the abandonment of Gauguin.

Perhaps Vincent is attracted to the same egoism that allows Gauguin to devour life. And then you know that your friend is having financial difficulties. He is a Van Gogh who pretends to be a mother hen and who at the same time needs a mother hen, willing to sacrifice more than he already has, in order to have his friend by his side. An empathic and nurturing disposition, capable of making great sacrifices for the other, of pleasing him so that he does not abandon him and of giving him recognition.

The definitive break in their relationship caused the outbreak of the first serious psychotic crisis on Christmas Eve 1888, with the manifestation of aggressive and self-destructive behavior. Admission to the Arles hospital is necessary. After the hospital, the whole town watched him.

Any gesture, even the most trivial, seemed to confirm its danger. They describe it with a crazy look; he always looked like he wanted to run away and didn't dare look at anyone. Here we can see how a phobic trait in the report already turns into a social phobia and how persecutory anxiety manifests itself. The inhabitants of Arles persecute him to the point of requesting his internment in an asylum. Between his relapses due to insomnia and hallucinations, he is afraid of the Arlesians, he says: "In any case, I have not harmed anyone".

In 1889, he accepted hospitalization in Saint Rémy after being denounced by his neighbors for nuisance, with the hope of finding a containment of their crises, as had occurred in part in Wincent Arles hospital. He becomes engaged, among other things, because his brother Theo is engaged: a woman takes his brother's place of honour and fears that he will not receive more financial help; the asylum solves their daily problems.

So great is his desire to work that he even declares to Theo: first "If I were left without your support, they would let me commit suicide without remorse. "and, although I am, vile I would end up leaving."

It is after this intimidating letter that Theo decides to pay his way into the asylum. However, he continues to paint with frenzy and despair. This character is capable of arousing guilt and can use the weapon to present himself as a victim. It is interesting how he pours out his frustrations on the only affectionate figure he has but is now afraid of losing.

In Saint Rémy he has a new experience of loneliness and lack of understanding; He only goes through his crises without letting himself be crushed by them and he will come out of them through painting, which will be his true support.

Later, also in Auvers, in the last months of his life, the boys make fun of him for his weirdness in clothing.

In the last year of his life, Vincent alternated moments of relative tranquility with moments of crisis. His artistic production of those years is extraordinary.

Image and existential sense:

As Winnicott pointed out, the response of the mother's face allows the child to have a positive image of himself. Only the mother's face and gaze allow the child to have a sense of himself and to recognize himself and feel loved enough by another.

According to Lacan, the experience of the body is never a naturally harmonious experience for the human being; rather, it originally occurs as an experience of nonunion, of discordance. When the child is not sufficiently cared for by the parents, as in the case of Vincent, the experience of real existence can be difficult, ugly, and exhausting. This defines the heart of the melancholic experience.

The story of the other is necessary to build a complete meaning to an integrated self. Therefore, we can say that the bad image of himself, cultivated by the E4, is the direct expression of the introjection of a denying parental figure.

Existential Guilt:

In melancholy, guilt is deliriously fed, not in relation to desire and its vicissitudes, but in relation to existence itself. The guilt of the subject -irremediable- is the guilt of existing.

The experience of his existence as naked life will be like a pure discard, superfluous, inferior, which will lead Vincent to a continuous struggle to achieve the impossible. His was an existence without a home, without the possibility of being desired, wandering, adrift, uprooted.

Freud points out that this delusion of guilt is a true moral delusion: the subject feels subjugated by an infinite feeling of unworthiness, he feels that he has no right to exist. His fundamental fault is that of not having inscribed in the desire of the other. The subject, reduced to a discarded object, a rejected object, separates himself from this identification, impossible to bear, by moving to the resolving act. He literally leaves the scene of the world. Lacan speaks of melancholic suicide as a suicide of the object.

The feeling of unworthiness that accompanies his life is always intertwined with a kind of affirmative impulse, a will to be, a desperate will. In Van Gogh, this supposes the lucid distinction of two types of melancholy: in one melancholy, abandonment, death, absence, hope, stagnation, inertia would prevail, while in the other, what Vincent himself calls active melancholy, a vital energy that waits, aspires to, and seeks. This melancholy is by no means a manic denial of the melancholic wound, which he carries with him, but indicates the singular effort not to succumb to the call of melancholy. He himself talks about it: "The desolation of what is called the feeling of emptiness is the first thing to combat so that it does not become a chronic disease."

It was precisely the work of art that acquired the characteristics of an authentic active melancholy in Van Gogh. Vincent came to art through a long internal research work on himself after acquiring the extraordinary ability to directly transform reality on canvas, to go from gaze to gesture without mediation. His work, in its conquered autonomy of color/sign, therefore, became one of the great references of modern art. The work of art will be the pain of life, it will be the possibility of life in the face of the tendency to death precisely in response to the identification of the lost object. The practice of art is then how to transform the urge to die, how to turn the negative into a positive.

Compensation For Psychosis:

We know that in Van Gogh psychosis manifests itself most clearly in the first crisis of the winter of 1888. Exactly at Christmas, when Gauguin leaves. Until then no hallucinations or delusions had appeared. This means that until then he had found remedies to prevent them from occurring. Remedies in which Van Gogh searches intensely, even though extraordinary events, intense experiences, where the voracity of envy, of Pretending, clinging, emerges in an excessive attachment: his relationship with his brother Theo, the amorous passions that drive Vincent towards great sentimental disappointments, the compensatory relationship with Sien, the prostitute mother of a child

with whom Vincent lived after his heartbreak with Kee, the utopian desire to create a community of painters in Arles and the intense but disastrous bond with Gauguin, the painter's care in cultivating pictorial technique by copying great works of the past. These compensations oriented Van Gogh's life, gave meaning to his presence in the world and strengthened his most singular vocations, those of

Christianity and the practice of art. He went as far as self-sacrifice and inflicting pain on himself (masochistic aspect).

The mystical impulse, becoming a Christian:

The encounter with the evangelical message was for Vincent an encounter with a possible sense of his presence in the world. The love of God, unlike that of his parents, does not exclude him, nor does it set him up as a substitute son of another ideal; Becoming a good Christian means trying to rescue life from the insignificance to which it was destined. It is the need to admire love. He writes to his brother: "The Lord has taken me as I am, with my defects." Without this closeness to God's love, his life would be meaningless.

Vincent's father lived his mission as a Protestant pastor, according to his son, as a victim of conformism to the canon. He had lacked that absolute and unreserved dedication that the evangelical word demands, while the painter lives his religious option as a radical option that breaks with any aestheticizing conception of life, with all those ritual customs that end up neutralizing the authentic message of Christ. Choosing Christ is a leap into the void, a commitment to love without conditions. The most important thing in the Christian experience is the symbol of the cross, which represents a capacity of surrender to the Other who knows how to go beyond the sterile confines of the self until it provokes its own dissolution, it is a surrender of oneself, annulling all attachment to oneself.

In Van Gogh's eyes, the figure of Christ is not that of the Lord, but that of the poor, the beggar, the one who agrees to lose everything. The Christ to whom the painter prays is not the Christ of the Resurrection, of Glory, but rather the son of man, he is the Christ of the Passion and of the cross. For him, God is not the God of philosophers or theologians, but is the one who is realized only in his human incarnation. The center of the Christian experience is not the manifestation of the power of God that defeats death, but the mystery of the incarnation, the kenosis, the lowering, the humanization of God.

The Christian experience is an experience of renouncing earthly goods, of asceticism, of practicing poverty: becoming an abandoned among the abandoned, being a castaway. Christianity is in this sense an active melancholy. Evangelical life and preaching are presented to him as an active way of caring for the misfits, the poor and the homeless; the experience of Christ speaks to him of his most intimate truth.

He writes to Theo: "The race of miners is the race of the last, the most despised," to whom Vincent feels he belongs, as strangers on the face of the earth, as excluded from the world. world scene. God's infinite love compensates for what he has never received, and his presence restores meaning to a world that seemed devoid of it. The mystical impulse, the tension towards the infinite, the absolute, does not end with the fall of religious aspirations. On the contrary, the transition from Christian preacher to painter is the fruit of Christian love for the mystery of nature, God's love for his creatures, which is amplified in art. For Van Gogh, painting will always be sacred. It will be painting of the absolute.

Becoming a painter as a path of transformation. Pain can become an element of beauty, Vincent very lucidly defines the practice of art as "the only remedy for your melancholy, without which" one collapses. Thus, he finds in psychosis not only what it must contain, but also a creative possibility, a force in search of form.

Van Gogh affirms that the most sensitive task of painting would be to capture the mystery of nature, which is equivalent to the mystery of life's pain. Every painter knows, as Merleau-Ponty reminds us, that things are not simply represented by paint, but are touched, affected, observed from the painter's own side of the world. Painting, for Van Gogh, arises precisely from this look that is produced in the Other. Nature is not what is in front of him but emerges as something that looks at him. The painter feels affected and says: "Really for me, the drama of the storm in nature and the pain of life is what affects me the most."

The strength of his work belongs above all to the strength of color, for which he feels a strong appeal to the south of France and its timbre of light, different from the light of the north and of his early days. The period in Arles and Saint Rémy allowed him to conquer new expressive horizons, which would be the basis of modern art, both from the point of view of the color plan, and of the autonomous maturation of sign language, whose rapidity would become legendary, "full of errors and gaps".

The heart of nature remains "that pain of life." Getting caught in it carries great danger. In fact, in his last letter to Theo he says: "In my work I always risk my life." In the epistolary he describes himself as suspended in a zone of oscillation between creation and destruction. That is why painting is a limit state for him.

Van Gogh always has doubts about his own talent. Look at Gauguin with admiration, his search is obstinate and tenacious. It is not only his skills that lead him to art, but it is art that calls him, forces him to expose himself. We are not far from the other call, that of the crucified Christ, to which the young painter had ardently approached. The commitment and constant rigor of their investigations do not contrast with the nature of this call that comes from elsewhere. By becoming a painter, Van Gogh gave an account of a life devoid of defenses, exposed to the unknown, devoid of refuge, which brought him closer to the "pain of existing".

Feeling called by destiny. Art as an eclipse of the name:

In Van Gogh, the painting is dedicated to the search for the absolute, seeks to identify with the power of nature.

Van Gogh's work of art can be compared to an invocation of the absolute, to a prayer. For this reason, too, it can only be sacred. In art there is no ego, only God.

Identification with the Christ of the Passion will continue to be crucial throughout his career, and we will find it again in one of his last works: the Pietà, painted in September 1889, where he attributes his face to Christ deposed from the cross.

Vincent demands self-sacrifice like the Christian religion, his own psychological erasure, his own annihilation. In this sense, it is an eclipse of the proper name. That is why Jaspers, regarding Vincent van Gogh's painting, can say that in it the creator ends up consuming himself in the work.

When the young art critic Albert Aurier wrote an article in January 1890 entitled: The Isolated: Vincent Van Gogh, in which he sensed the greatness of genius, Vincent felt ashamed and, writing to his brother, felt taken as a model in modern painting and did not believe he deserved it and shied away from the compliments he received.

His feeling of unworthiness was such that it was impossible for him to receive recognition; nowhere was there a place for him.

The need to eclipse himself prevails over the need to make his own egoic affirmation, to make his melancholic identification. This realization takes place through art, becoming an active melancholy capable of giving shape to force the strength of the painting to transcend its own name, because it is only interested in the absolute, only God, the God of the cross and of art, the God of nature.

In this gesture Vincent transcends his E4 conservation character, which instead of living in self-hatred and passive melancholy, through the experience of art prolongs the Christian experience of love as an experience of surrender.

The sacredness and absoluteness of art wears Vincent down and exhausts him. If, on the one hand, art works as a counterpoison to his psychosis, to his melancholic tendency, on the other, having unreservedly assimilated or distant from the power of nature, it ends up burning the artist, "burning his brain".

Abandonment:

The passion for art sustains Van Gogh in the separation of all social ties to the point of realizing his existence as an abandoned being.

In it he expresses a deep force, an energy that turns against the institutions of power, his patriarchal family, the Church, theology, the Academy, and also against the success that the impressionist movement was having at that time. In his letters a critical tone towards him can be perceived and, from Vincent's words, a feeling of redemption can be sensed when he reiterates several times that his work will be a contribution to future painters, that his dedication will not be in vain.

There are many issues related to the feeling of abandonment, of being the last, of discarding. The theme of shoes in Van Gogh is an insistent theme in his production; in all his works they appear unadorned, worn, abandoned.

With those shoes, Vincent set out and made the trip his destination. By getting going you have shown a way, you have made your individual experience the experience of many who recognize themselves on the hero's journey. They are not fetishistic objects, for consumption, or clothing, they are lived-in shoes, used daily, therefore, old. The title is exemplary: A Pair of Shoes, 1886. Van Gogh's abandoned shoes do not propose any ideal version of beauty, but rather indicate that moment of transition from life to death.

Japanese art was for him the most accomplished art of light that exists. He is not so much interested in great concepts and universal speculations as in the study of a single blade of grass, the most modest and smallest form of life, because the infinite is also contained in this form and is expressed in it. To study the blade of grass is to study the whole world. This leads the painter to identify with all the plants, the seasons, the animals, and the human figure. The great Japanese innovation is to reduce the practice of painting

to the practice of drawing, therefore essential, without mediation, directly from the tube. To achieve the simplicity of the line, of the breath, of the act without thought, requires a strict discipline, almost a new asceticism; the monastic order of Japanese life must inspire his life as a painter.

Artaud defines Van Gogh's work as the unleashing and enchantment of the primary elements, therefore as an ambivalent hand in hand with nature, as an unleashing of its power and as a feeling of being drawn towards it without be able to escape The power of the sun in his works appears inhuman and indifferent; It is not the sun that warms the earth and life, it is not the sun that illuminates the scene of the world, but the real as impossible that emerges traumatically from the bottom of the canvas.

It is no coincidence that after the onset of psychosis, Van Gogh's "tremendous desire to see his friends and the countryside again" appears from the north, experienced as a real need to overcome the disease. He writes to his brother in the last year of his life that his illness is "typical of the South", that returning home to the familiar, can put an end to the hallucinations. Returning to the North is presented as the only strategy therapy to push back the disease that consumes him. Always present in Van Gogh's painting, in an always unstable balance, is the force that tends to break limits.

The chromatic force that Van Gogh extracts from his vision of nature never devastates the painting, but nourishes it, makes it alive, throbbing; it is the manifestation not of a meaning but of an untranslatable realization, the elevation of the object to a sacred dimension. The painting is subjected to strong seismic waves, but these never compromise the work. It is Vincent who ceases to govern what governs the painting and who is inexorably consumed by it.

❖ GIROLAMO SAVONAROLA

By Francesca Belforte

Family, childhood, and youth (1452-1475):

Girolamo Savonarola was born in Ferrara on September 21, 1452, the son of Nicholas and Elena Bonaccorsi, from Mantua.

As the third son, all the hopes of his family were pinned on him: still a child, he had been chosen to carry on the traditions and add luster to a name made famous by his grandfather, Miguel Savonarola.

His grandfather, in fact, had obtained a professorship at the University of Ferrara for his notoriety as a doctor and man of letters, in addition to being appointed private physician to Niccolò d'Este; when he dropped out, he secured a pension, a noble title, and many honors. His son, Niccolò, a simple and pious man, suffered from his father's fame and was eclipsed by it. Of his grandchildren, only in Girolamo did his grandfather discover an intelligence to which he attached himself with the tenacity of someone who sees his life's work jeopardized by the mediocrity of his descendants.

For this reason, Girolamo left his parents' home at an early age and grew up in his grandfather's house, under his protection, until he was sixteen.

Girolamo, shy, melancholic, studious, self-sufficient, grew up among books, showing a lively sense of responsibility.

The disposition for philosophy and dialectic was marked in him, and encouraged by his success, his grandfather wanted to perfect him by instilling in him his own cult of religion, based on contempt for the world.

At the age when children play at imitating life, the diversions Jerome's objects were the altars; later, the favorite book was the Bible, and at sixteen the model boy, whose rectitude was exemplary, was already scandalized by the frivolity of his generation and joined his laments to those of his grandfather. Serious and fond of solitude, he avoided hobbies and company typical of his age. The promiscuity of youth and the manly code of the street or frivolous pastimes repulsed him. He was more likely to be found in church, in the solitude of a dark nave, or taking long, solitary walks along the embankment of the Po.

On the death of his grandfather, he continued his studies with his father for two years, and then he was sent to the university. He was eighteen years old and that was his first contact with the world. His impression was one of revolt, shame, and dismay. The professors seemed to him concerned only with "putting on a show of virtuosity", great ideals destroyed, authority discredited, and youth corrupted. During academic disputes at the university, he defended himself with a skill that impressed his opponents and a manner that disarmed them, even though inwardly he was torn between protesting and disgust.

The effort to impose himself and resist the university environment ruined his health and he had to interrupt his studies. He returned home convinced that the world and its wisdom had little to teach him. His family tried to convince him to go to the Estensi court, but he felt lost in that splendid atmosphere of play and sensuality, he did not know the game, he could not compete with the young, strong and virile men, he felt clumsy, ridiculous, inferior, inadequate, even for his social position.

He came back from court, like from the university, disgusted by the world. However, at that moment he did not think of abandoning it; Instead, he began to believe that he could have been a doctor and, like his grandfather, care for the poor with selfless generosity.

It was also at this time that he fell in love with a young woman who came to live near his home, the natural daughter of a Florentine exile from the illustrious Strozzi family. But his disappointment at the girl's rejection—she dismissed him with a shrug, telling him that "blood and the illustrious Strozzi family could not admit such a union"—blocked his emotional development, froze him. A bitter struggle arose within him, and bitterness and melancholy slowly found their way into his heart. He saw everywhere in the world the faults of the girl: vanity, cruelty, pride, and frivolity. He began to write a treatise entitled *Contempt for the World*, he resumed reading the classics and the Bible (Sodom and Gomorrah fed his imagination). His virtues were his only superiority and the world mocked and trampled on them. He wrote then: "To be considered a man, one must dirty one's tongue with the dirtiest and most savage blasphemies and incite others to murder and provoke discord and contention. If you live chaste and modest, they say you are a fool, if you are pious, they say you are dishonest, if you believe in God they say you are stupid, if you are pious they say you are effeminate..."

Days, months, and years passed, and this friction turned into exasperation, and a normal adolescent crisis became a deepening conviction within him.

He writes: "I began to reflect to myself on what it is to strive for useless ends and how we neglect what is useful and necessary. And considering how fast death is moving, I decided to abandon everything else, to keep in mind only the end of man and to prepare for it with all my might. By the grace of God, I began to despise all earthly things. An irresistible longing for the heavenly homeland burned in my heart and I decided to serve only Jesus Christ, my Lord.

The only thing holding him back from his decision was the knowledge of the pain he was going to cause his parents. In addition, the economic conditions afflicting the family were far from prosperous. His father was in financial difficulties and his sisters had no dowry. His mother leaves upon learning of his decision. One day, while he was playing the lute, his mother sensed that the decision had been made and said to him: "Son, I feel that you are leaving." He didn't dare look into her eyes and they said goodbye in silence.

The next day, while the family was out with the crowds gathered for the Jubilee feast, he disappeared. And the next day he sent them a letter from Bologna. It was in April 1475.

Entry into the Dominican Order and conquest of eloquence (1475-1489)

On April 26, 1475, Girolamo entered the convent of San Domenico in Bologna. His novitiate year was continuous and bitter: a struggle to control himself. He was tormented by the complaints of his inconsolable parents, whom he was forced to scold harshly. To tame his tenacious affections, he mortified himself with such excessive zeal that his superiors were forced to calm him down. With the same zeal he worked as a novice. Nothing scared him, neither the humblest jobs nor intellectual fatigue. Serving at the table, washing feet, cleaning comfortable places were considered privileges; Not being able to read more than the rules of the Order and the lives of the saints was a special favor; and when, at the end of the year, he returned to school, he regretted having returned to his family studies. "I have not come to the convent," he wrote to exchange the mundane Aristotle for a cloistered Aristotle. But he submitted for discipline. Student life entailed privileges, but Jeronimo allowed himself no rest; his mortifications were continuous, and his superiors tried in vain to moderate him. He practiced the slightest privations in secret; only slept four hours a night, saved paper for writing, he even deprived himself of a crucifix. His superiors made him see that the duty of a Dominican was only eloquence and study, and he wondered if he had chosen the Order wrong. He observed that the dominant concern of the superiors was to increase the influence, wealth, and culture of the convent, and its "lukewarmness," compared to the lives of the saints, dismayed him. His confessor found no stain on him, not even a venial sin. It was perfect, and in that human satisfaction he found his peace, which lasted six years.

Jerome knew that the mission of the Order was to preach, and he felt called to do so. For this he had been born and had suffered: to transform himself from victim to scourge (to rebuke, subdue, exhort, and reform the world that had outraged him).

He prepared ardently for the mission, but his first efforts were unsuccessful. He had a weak voice, a clumsy way of speaking, and was overly severe. He was missing something, and he strove to overcome those difficulties. He received oratory and rhetoric lessons, of course, but he was getting worse and less capable of persuading others with

studied and hypocritical gestures. He reread the most iridescent passages of the Old Testament and that awakened in him an eloquence that he expressed in writing; the revelations he caught in the wake of the horrors taking place in Rome made his blood boil; but the pulpit was stifling to him, and his sermons left the public as indifferent as before. Then the mission of his life seemed to him the conquest of eloquence.

In 1481 he was sent to Florence, to the convent of San Marco, and it was a great relief for him to leave Ferrara, because of his many failed oratorical cases. In Florence, Girolamo was highly indignant at the luxurious and licentious life there, but when he was sent to preach at San Lorenzo it was a disaster, and the audience was reduced to twenty-five people. He had "no voice, no movement," no grace, no goodness in a city steeped in art everywhere, and he was advised to stop preaching, which he did desperately, deepening his inner self. I hate the spectacularization of masses of the sermons, which corresponded to a soft and corrupt age, for which it was necessary to wait for a divine scourge to punish the Church. He began preaching in the provinces, nomadic from city to city, for seven years, and here his candor and spontaneity produced a great effect. He increased austerities, fasting and bloodletting. In 1489 he was called to Florence by Lorenzo de Medici following the instructions of Pico della Mirandola, who was then going through a personal spiritual crisis. He resumed preaching with a new inner emotion, he succeeded for the first time in touching the hearts of the crowd, and his sermons became a triumph.

Relationship with Lorenzo de Medici (1489-1492):

Savonarola, from San Marco, began to preach in the Duomo before ten thousand people. He became dramatic and theatrical, bursting into sobs and sighs, and to mock him, his followers were called Piagnoni. Preaching against the sins that disturbed the family—drunkenness, impiety, gambling, debauchery—he became an ally of women against the free and irresponsible man, drawing accusations of madness and charlatanism for his own sake. the continuous visions it revealed. In reaction, Savonarola turned from oracles to reality and began addressing political abuses in his sermons. Here the ground became more treacherous: the spoke of the exploitation of workers and unfair taxes, paid by the poor and not by the rich; Imperceptibly, a current of political opinion formed around him that saw in him a connection to discontent with the Medici regime, someone close to the plebs. They advised him to renounce both politics and prophecies, but he could no longer back down because his power and popularity derived from this impulse. Savonarola recounted an inner conflict between two parts of himself, but he felt that he could no longer stop, at the cost of self-destruction.

He did not stop denouncing the corruption of the clergy, the oppression of the poor, the tyranny, the greed of the rich and the debauchery of his generation.

He was invited to preach at the palace and his sermon was an indirect and somewhat gratuitous attack on Lorenzo de Medici; Lorenzo initially ignored him, magnanimous and magnificent.

In July 1491 he was elected prior of San Marcos; it was customary for the new prior to pay a tribute visit to the head of the Medici family. But Girolamo refused and was categorical: "Only to God do I owe my choice, and only to him do I incline." Lorenzo saw it as a question of forms, not principles; he saw the prior's obstinacy as a challenge to his charm, tolerance, and generosity, cherishing the sympathy and respect of the people. Lorenzo tried to create casual encounters, he even tried to buy the convent with

money, with the threat through some of the convent's protectors. Afterwards, he returned to proudly not worrying about the prior and their dispute returned to being latent. They were two incompatible personalities: Savonarola was all principles; Lorenzo was all expediency and worldly wisdom.

Lorenzo's lack of principles was a constant provocation for the morale of the friar, who attributed all the ills of Florence to him. Completely lacking in political realism, Savonarola reduced Florence's political problem to a moral problem and saw Lorenzo's ambition as the only explanation for the bad system.

Their last meeting took place on Lorenzo's deathbed. Shortly before dying, he was not satisfied with just any priest at his side but wanted Savonarola to be called. At first, he refused, but the dying man rebelled against the refusal and sent for him again because he was "the only honest friar he knew", and this time Savonarola went. Nobody knows what followed. Poliziano says that Lorenzo flew to confession and Savonarola urged him to pray with him. Another version says that Savonarola imposed three conditions on Lorenzo before he accepted the confession: faith in God's mercy, the return of the assets that his family had embezzled and the return of freedom to Florence. Apparently, Lorenzo turned to face the wall and died that same night.

The monastic reforms (1492-1494):

Savonarola's prestige grew enormously after Lorenzo's death. Almost at the same time Pope Innocent VIII died and Borgia Pope Alexander VI was elected: it was rumored that his election had been bought and that simony, immorality, corruption, nepotism, and immorality wreaked havoc in the Church.

Savonarola's sermons were acclaimed but completely ignored, his prophecies sounding completely vain. Savonarola began to think that it was time to move from proud and desperate protests "to deeds and examples, which speak louder than words." He decided to reform the small community of the Convent of San Marcos. His first step was to propose the abandonment of the convent of San Marcos itself, with its precious library, its cells frescoed by Beato Angélico, its cloisters adorned with coats of arms and its gardens full of naked pagan statues, too mundane to his eyes.

He decided to retire to a hermitage with his favourite disciples. A new convent of primitive simplicity was planned, but the project was boycotted by the older friars when they realized the severity imposed on them. Savonarola then realized that the simplicity to which he aspired had to be achieved through new monastic rules, conquering the human nature of the monks with sweetness and joy (a very great sacrifice for him, but when the demon of melancholy assaulted him, tamed him in the pulpit, where he unleashed him), creating a community where serenity, simplicity and happiness reigned.

Indulgent with others, he was very strict with himself. No one surpassed his austerities. He only slept four hours a night. He ate the oldest bread, leaving the freshest for the sick and the elderly, and he did not touch meat. Over time, he completely lost his sense of taste. He preached austerity by practicing it. He insisted on cleanliness, himself performing the more menial tasks expected of novices. And he was never irritable, except in the pulpit.

In private life, Savonarola revealed a kind and submissive, courteous character; he would take his monks for walks in the hills, to dance the ronda, or to discuss theological questions among the butterflies. But it was not enough to win over the monks; a political decision was necessary to apply his monastic reform, which depended on his Lombard superiors. Finally, he became head of an autonomous congregation and was able to apply his reform. The rule of poverty was strictly practiced. Food and clothing were restricted. The reformed Dominicans could be recognized by their shorter, looser cassocks that barely covered their knees and by their patched sandals; the cloths they carried were not to be considered their property, books and cells were changed periodically, all necessary things turned into so many loans, the continuous circulation of which was a reminder of the transience of life. Savonarola wanted to combat all forms of property, breaking, and annulling the individual in favour of the community. The monks had to work for a living, the convent's possessions were sold. Those who knew a trade contributed their earnings to the support of the community, leaving the rest free to spiritual things.

The reform was carried out with many internal conflicts. The health of the friars suffered due to excessive fasting and fatigue, it is said that several fell ill and could barely stand. During the first efforts to achieve perfection, the temptations of the devil were frequent and, according to him, the convent was invaded by a cloud of demons that left the polluted air. Every night Girolamo chased them away, sprinkling the cells with holy water and singing hymns. The new rule appealed to refined minds, so noble and daring, connected with the ideal of simple living and high thinking. You could perceive in Savonarola at that moment a battling joy, a tone of satisfaction. Discouragement had finally turned into action. Let us remember, however, that the moralist's ambition, no matter how holy and disinterested he may be, is still an affirmation of himself; It is the most powerful elixir, which does not operate so much on material things as on man himself to impose his ideals, his passion, on himself, to print his own image a hundred times on his fellow men. For Savonarola, this meant the reaction of his entire life: ultimate revenge against a world that had rejected him. Savonarola realized that the uncertain political situation in Florence and Italy was a good time for a religious revival. The growing public alarm gave new Vigor to Savonarola's sermons, and on all sides, reality responded to the friar's visions. It was 1494, the French under Charles VIII were at the gates of Florence, and on March 17 Savonarola was preaching in the cathedral before a large crowd: "Behold, I will cause the waters to come upon the earth. Repent!"

Political reforms (1494-1495):

For his efforts as a moral peacemaker against the French invasion, Savonarola was considered by the people as a patriot. As a sign of recognition, he was invited to collaborate in the reorganization of the new city government. Savonarola sensed the dangers of embarking on a political career, abandoning his freedom and facing life and death (from the beginning he had had the premonition of imminent martyrdom). But it also meant a brilliant opportunity to finish all his work and put to the test the reforms started in the convent at a higher level. Political reform, however, was for him only a means to a higher end: moral reform: the power to punish vice by law, to sanction morality by regulation, was the realization of all your dreams, the reward of all your efforts. Prepared for the test.

Once the French had left, a provisional government was elected in Florence and it had to be decided which political form to choose. Savonarola was a supporter of democracy, for political reasons. His proposal was approved; In the following three months, although Savonarola did not hold any official position, he was in fact the inspirer or, at least, he was seen as the instigator of some important reforms: fiscal, the institution of the Monte de Piedad (against "the false Jewish sect enemy of God", the usurers), legal. Of course, all this greatly increased his enemies and adversaries: the Angry, the oligarchs and the Bigi (supporters of the Medici), the Whites (the skeptics within his party), his brothers from other religious orders, envious of his can. The attacks against him and his followers, called the Piagnoni (but also the choked ones, the giraffes, the paternostri chewers and other vulgar nicknames full of mockery), combined with the fatigue of those months and his tireless activity in all the fields, undermined the health of the friar, who ended up falling ill. At night he was tormented by demons and taunts, and it could be seen from the pulpit that he was sick, as well as anguished and depressed.

His precarious state of health had soured him, as in his younger days, and at the threat of seeing his reforms compromised he became very verbally violent, recommending severe punishments for every offense (cutting off heads, confiscating property, inciting violent revolt, "Whoever cuts them into pieces does not sin"). The government also provided severe punishments for the unnatural vice, homosexuality, but the edict remained a dead letter. And the invectives became more and more violent: "Take him out and say: 'He deserves death'. Otherwise, the city will be ruined. Leave the dances and the games and close the taverns... it is time to cry, not to party"). He then retired to his cell and the peace of his sickbed.

Moral reforms (1495-1496):

By temporarily interrupting his political activity, Savonarola was able to devote himself to moral reforms. Fueled by the prestige of his political work, his exhortations took on greater value: when trade stopped, merchants read the Bible, merchants returned dishonest gains, women gave up their whims to give alms. But the obstinacy of the inert masses could only be attacked, according to Savonarola, with legislative power and coercion: terrible sentences for sodomy and blasphemy. This served to stifle the wickedness of human nature, to subdue the anarchy of unbridled life, and to call the Universe back to goodness, reshaping it in the image of the Creator, or even in his own, since now he was convinced that he was a representative of God on earth. During this period, many of his external enemies tried to convince the Pope and block the friar, who accused him of "taking advantage of the changes in Italy to make believe that he was inspired by God, without proving it with miracles or special revelations". of Scripture, as required by canon law.

The Pope delayed, did not intervene with any excommunication and, in any case, ordered him to refrain from preaching not only in public but also in private. Savonarola accepted the silence mandate as a truce. But this was short-lived.

At the Carnival of 1496, Savonarola, with impressive ardor, adapted all the licentious habits of the Florentine youth during Carnival to his moral purpose, substituting Christian for pagan pastimes. Religious processions were organized.

They composed sacred hymns: about twenty days before Carnival, the friar instructed all the young men from good families and distributed them into district teams with their own captains, organized in ranks like so many soldiers. Little beggars armed with sticks stopped passers-by to ask for money for alms. Each team carried a banner of Christ and the Virgin. In the Piazza Duomo, groups of men and women added jewelry and personal adornments to the money already raised for the poor. In short, the boys became a moral police force. Each had his own task, they had to wear simple clothes, avoid lascivious poets and immoral readings, dances, fencing and music schools, and cut their hair down to the ears.

There were the Pacieri, the Correttori (they established punishments), the Inquisitori (they discovered abuses), the Spazzini (they provided hygiene and civic cleanliness). They had to goad the other boys into making the same resignations, and so they became a worse scourge than before. With the authorization of the government and the friar, they enjoyed severely reforming everyone else. The "boys of the friars" attacked the confectioneries during Lent, broke into the taverns to scare the players. Savonarola had found jealous allies in the boys.

Meanwhile, the government had asked Rome for permission for the friar to preach during Lent and the Pope agreed, but he imposed a trusted Dominican to observe him. And the friar preached a terrible sermon on the vices and venalities committed in the Vatican. Everything made him bold, not only the success of his political and moral reforms, but also the strength of his incorruptibility. At a time when strategic restraint might have been called for, the friar's sermons became increasingly incendiary, and the whole of Lent was occupied with more and more sermons and increasingly violent invectives against Rome, through visions, desolation and universal depravity.

The excommunication (1496-1497):

The summer of 1496 marked a time of severe economic crisis and desolation in Florence. The government ordered public prayers and processions. Savonarola resumed preaching and realized that this moment was a propitious opportunity after a few months to carry out his reform. "My brothers", the friar exhorted them, "we are only in this world to learn how to die" and he used all his eloquence to convince them of the vanity of fleeting life.

He urged the government to enforce edicts against vice, taverns were closed, races suspended, gamblers threatened with torture; prostitutes were expelled from the city. Dances were prohibited, even in the countryside, since "it was not a time to dance and sing, but to weep and do penance." Fasts were strictly observed and luxury goods sellers went out of business. The State, inspired by Savonarola, became increasingly theocratic.

Meanwhile, Pope Alexander VI was trying to find a painless way to rein in the friar, and he placed the convent of San Marcos under the jurisdiction of a vicar. Savonarola opposed it and the Pope reacted shortly after with excommunication, although he was not very convinced.

The Great Council became more numerous and began to be made up of young people, mostly arrabbiati, that is, enemies of Savonarola. The arrabbiati decided to restore the Carnival of 1497 with the old games to raise the morale of the people. Savonarola reacted with the famous burning of the "vanities": his friars had collected masks, paintings, statues of nudes, mirrors, copies of the works of Boccaccio and Pulci's Morgante from house to house in the city, and from these trophies they made a heap in the square, poured flammable liquids over it and topped it with the devilish image of the King of Carnival. On the appointed day, when the arrabbiati tried to prevent the act, the Piazza della Signoria was invaded by choirs of children and at an agreed signal the trumpets sounded and the bells rang, accompanying the burning of the Vanities.

This burning led to accusations of fanaticism, even among the friar's supporters, who would have preferred the objects to be sold and the proceeds to go to charity. Savonarola grew gloomy, he felt powerless. And the more powerless he felt, the more he redoubled his exhortations and increased his indignation and melancholy.

When the excommunication came (1497), the angry masses took control of the city and annulled all the measures of the friar. The taverns and gambling houses are reopened, the post office and the confessionals are working again. Savonarola could not continue preaching, but he meditated a reaction, appealing to the general council.

Breakup (1497-March 1498):

His political supporters resumed the fight for his acquittal, but Savonarola was intransigent in the face of any possibility of a venal exchange, or in any case, of reaching an agreement. The Vatican did not demand a sacrifice of its principles, it only demanded a formal act of submission: go to Rome or accept the Tuscan-Roman congregation as the control body of San Marcos. Savonarola was completely obstinate. His supporters did not know if it was a matter of unlimited pride or fear. But it was clear that his way of acting could only lead to destruction. Was this perhaps the solution? Is this the charm of the abyss? The intoxication of suicide? The morbid satisfaction of martyrdom? The unconscious feeling that his destiny was failure and reconciliation a shameful temptation. There are many aspects of inconsistency in.

Savonarola's attitude at this moment: an irrational hope in a successful outcome of his uncompromising cause, accompanied, however, by a great emotional exaltation in which he felt like a martyr, a lonely knight fighting alone against the Power of Darkness. He believed that God would defend his cause. "We will see who will be more powerful, if God or men".

In a troubled political climate, Savonarola made one last attempt at the Pope by writing a letter of submission. Failing to achieve the desired effect, the friar decided to defy censorship on Christmas night and celebrated mass in San Marcos, distributing communion to 300 of his followers. His followers became more and more fanatical and extremist, the timid disappeared.

On the last day of Carnival, he promised to bless the people in the Plaza de San Marcos, and tried to pass off the holy host of the Lord as a miracle. In the afternoon he repeated the "burning of the vanities," but there was less enthusiasm.

Savonarola's sermons were published and began to circulate throughout Europe; The friar received letters from Germany from enthusiastic supporters of his doctrine. The risk for the Church was that Savonarola would become the expression of a generalized movement against the Church of Rome, which could afford to circumvent the excommunication of Rome. However, the Pope hesitated, since he was well aware of the inconsistencies and corruption of the Church, and before launching the question, he looked for a mediator, the Bishop of Parma, who proposed the solution that Savonarola ask for absolution, even pretending, do an act of submission. In summary, the Pope tried to keep up appearances, since he did not want violent actions. In the end, the Pope's ultimatum to the government in Florence came to light. His political supporters strove for a political compromise, which in any case included that Savonarola suspend the need for his sermons.

The Trial by Fire (March 1498):

The next morning, March 18, 1498, Savonarola preached his last sermon. It was inevitable that he would submit, and he surrendered, but defiantly. It was impossible for him to openly admit his defeat, and in a desperate attempt to hide it, he opened his heart to the audience, communicating his deep meditations of the night before, and the direct dialogue between himself and God; he said that he would suspend his sermons, but that this would not save Rome from imminent ruin: "O Rome, it will not be easy for you to break this sting! But that will sting you even harder, trust me! Italy, Italy, the Lord is with me, you can't do anything. I warn you, therefore, that those who persecute me will fall by the sword and by pestilence and will be thrown and crushed like so many ants, and their confusion will be great. And as he makes this prophecy, he realizes how useless he is at the moment and admits that he had become a "laughingstock," and that he had been tempted several times to stop preaching, but a force had held him back, a force against which his will was powerless. "I couldn't contain myself anymore, I couldn't do anything else. The Word of God became, up there, a fire that consumed my entrails, and I could not suppress it, and I had to speak because I felt on fire, inflamed by the Spirit of the Lord. O Spirit, you provoke persecutions and tribulations against me, you raise the waves of the sea like the wind and unleash the storms. "Stop!" I say, but the Spirit answers: "It can't be otherwise"".

The suspension of the sermons had not satisfied the Pope, who realized that he had conceded too much by accepting a truce instead of submission. At that moment, a terrible letter from Savonarola reached him, which exhausted his patience. In the letter, the friar presents himself as a victim treated unfairly by everyone, an offended martyr. Calmly steadfast in the rectitude, even in the sanctity of his reasons, he maintains that God "will inflict the deserved punishment on those who persecute me," that he seeks not earthly glory but who eagerly awaits death and concludes by admonishing the pontiff to "take care of his health".

The Pope sensed an imminent attack; and indeed, Savonarola secretly began his final attack. He wrote a letter addressed to the rulers of France, England, Spain, Austria, and Hungary urging them to convene a general council. In fact, a council could have been called even without the pope's consent, but conclusive reasons had to be found to accuse the pope. The simony and the scandals of his private life were not sufficient reasons, and Savonarola thought that the only possible accusation was that of atheism: "I affirm that he is not a Christian and that he does not believe in God, which exceeds the limits of all

infidelity. “. But the letter that he tried to send to Carlos VIII never reached its destination because it was intercepted at the border of the State of Milan.

Trial and death (April–May 1498):

On Palm Sunday in April 1498, the arrabbiati stormed the convent of San Marcos, setting fire to the doors and the roof. The siege lasted seven hours. Savonarola spoke to his friars, reiterated the truth of his ideas, and was later arrested. The people tried to lynch him, with hatred and cruelty. He was then taken to the Palace to be tried.

The trial was vile and petty, vindictive, and inhumane. A rude justice acted whose precise spirit of revenge owed more to mob fury, partisan zeal, and ecclesiastical politics. The deeper reason, however, was enormous resentment of the moralist: years of aversion to his claims had accumulated, and now fury was erupting. The fact that he had also tried to translate his visions into an experiment that Savonarola Theocratic made the situation even worse.

Indeed, at the time of the Renaissance, Savonarola personified the ancient and dogmatic code of medieval Christianity, representing an obstacle to the development of the most typical dimension of the Renaissance: the clear intuition of life, the spontaneity of instinct, the free search for experience. By martyring the friar, it was as if one generation martyred the other.

The need to give a legal aspect to the friar's murder delayed the trial for forty days. The friar resisted and only the torture made him delirious and confess what the judges were looking for, that is, that he had been an impostor and that he had only acted out of personal ambition. Physically, Savonarola, worn out by long years of abstinence and fatigue, was annihilated. In the end he was so mentally exhausted and fragile that they had to help him eat. During those nights, he wrote a great deal of commentary on Psalm XXX, imagining a dialogue with a Tempter and accusing himself of being a coward and a child and of not having known how to fight.

He went to his death calmly and coldly, disappointing the expectations of the public that surrounded the stage in the middle of the square full of wood. They hanged him and then roasted him, along with the friars Domenico and Silvestro.

That happened on May 23, 1498.

10. LITERARY AND FILM EXAMPLES

❖ A LITERARY EXAMPLE:

By Simona Mazziotti

Jane Eyre, by Charlotte Brontë, 1847.

Charlotte Brontë's novel describes the life of Jane Eyre told in the first person, thus resulting in an autobiography written by an E4 conservation. The thoughts, emotions and impulses that govern and structure the personality of Jane's character emerge clearly, who since birth is entrusted to her uncles, having been orphaned by both parents.

The next ten years spent in the boarding school are described below, where she is subjected to a strict discipline impregnated with Catholicism from which she will absorb a certain numinousness. Later, she will live as a governess in Mr. Rochester's house, with whom she will fall in love.

The story begins with a description of the life of Jane Eyre at the age of eight in a family situation impregnated with emotional coldness, humiliation, mistreatment and injustice (typical colors of the deprived environment in which E4 conservation lives). orphan of birth, lives in the residence of his aunt (widow wife of his mother's brother, who has three children slightly older than Jane).

The protagonist does not receive the same treatment as her isolated and mistreated at the behest of her aunt-in-law, marginalized, and treated severely and cruelly, not included in family life, because [...] she was not considered a little open girl and not very sociable. The aunt's sadistic attitude towards her emerges between the lines when she says: "I was sorry to have to keep myself at a distance, but her own eyes that I was making serious efforts to assume a sociable attitude typical of a boy my age, with more amiable manners and spirited, [...] she was forced to exclude me from the privileges intended only for happy and contented children".

Jane perceives and describes herself as resigned and used to feeling unworthy, with a search for peace in reading books, contemplating nature, and drawing when she had the opportunity to be alone: "I I felt happy, happy in my own way". She also describes herself as being in the grip of fury in the name of a claimed and unrecognized justice.

Her cousin John harasses her. She is frightened by his constant abuses which she endures in silence, until "terror has taken hold of measure and feelings of a different kind have taken over". She rebels by furiously lashing out at him: naturally, the adults around her only see her fury and punish her, locking her in the room where her uncle and benefactor had died. In desperation she appeals to her deceased uncle to protect her in the name of divine justice (another typical character theme).

This is how he describes his experience of that event, which he continued to remember as traumatic for all the following years: "I had no doubt, I never had any doubt, if Mr. Reed was still alive he would treat me well... I felt that this idea that consoling would be terrifying if it came true [...] I thought that if that rapid and flickering glow heralded a vision of the other world “.

It is intuited-and this is later explored later in the book-that Jane's uncle really took his niece seriously and that his care for her had been more sincere and affectionate than he had been for his children. own children (Jane's cousins). Such attention and care had kindled the jealousy of the aunt, who had promised her husband that she would look after Jane as her own daughter: a promise which had predisposed her aunt to a deep and natural dislike of her.

In that house, Jane was only fond of one of the governesses, Bessie, who was occasionally kind: "When she had those kind ways, Bessie, she was the loveliest, goodest creature in the world: I wish she would always be so kind, and stop subduing me, as he used to do, to impositions, reproaches and absurd demands".

Jane is sent to a boarding school. This exit turns out to be his salvation. When Jane hears the news, she says, "This situation for me, accustomed as I was to a life of constant blame and misunderstood commitment, should have been a haven of peace."

In fact, her ability to endure, her physical resistance to cold and malnutrition (many girls at the Lowood boarding school would die of tuberculosis, a scandal that would improve the conditions of the boarding school), her commitment to study, would earn her recognition. She spent a lot of time alone, enjoying walks in nature: "<I often enjoyed this sight, at the top of my lungs, free and unobserved, and almost always alone." At boarding school she befriends Helen Burns, who is kind to her and whom she loyally accompanied until her death (Helen died of tuberculosis). He says of Helen, "She knew how to kindle a desire for higher and nobler things in those privileged to hear her, and I knew it and I felt it." She feels seen by Helena, who tells her: "In your passionate eyes and your pure gaze I see a sincere nature".

Thus, Jane will gradually be appreciated for her commitment, perseverance and discipline. From a boarding school student she will become a teacher, but when the teacher, Miss Temple-who had remained the emotional link of reference for her after Helen's death-marries and leaves the boarding school, she herself feels that there is no point in being there anymore and that she wants to leave : "From the day he left me, I was never the same.

It wasn't so much the support that had taken away my motivation, it wasn't the ability to be serene that I had lost, but the *raison d'être*. This is how she describes her desire to leave boarding school: "May I be granted at least one new servitude: freedom, exaltation, pleasure, really delicious sounds, but nothing but sounds to me, but servitude, that's something concrete."

Thus, a new phase of life begins for Jane (barely eighteen years old) when she finds a job as a governess to a girl through an ad in the newspaper. You will immediately receive care, kindness, and consideration from the housekeeper-Miss Fairfax. It's interesting how she experiences all this (typical of an E4 conservation): "I felt a bit confused having all this attention that no one had given me before, especially since it was my new employer and therefore my superior who gave it to me." offered". "A feeling of gratitude flooded my heart, so I knelt down. I asked for strength to conquer that benevolence that had been so kindly granted me before I deserved it.

It is at this stage that she meets Mr. Rochester, the master of the estate, much older than her (she is eighteen years old, he is forty), who will turn out to be the love of her life, through whom the masochistic trait will clearly emerge. characteristic of his character. Jane is initially involved with Mr. Rochester because he orders her to. On the one hand she obeys, on the other she is also sincere and not at all accommodating, an aspect that pleases Mr. Rochester, a rude and brusque man in his ways, restless and tormented. Mr. Rochester finds in Jane a special soul who can save him from despair with her freshness and nobility of spirit. "I did what I was commanded, though I would have preferred to remain in the shadows, but Mr. Rochester had such a peremptory way of giving orders that it seemed quite natural to obey him instantly."

Mr. Rochester says of Jane: "You, with your earnestness, your delicacy, and your prudence, seem made to receive secrets. The more we talk, you and I, the better, because I cannot contaminate you, while you can purify me".

For her part, Jane was attracted to this uneasiness and would have done anything to calm it: "I cannot deny that her pain was also mine, whatever it was, and that I would have done anything to ease it."

This is how she describes her relational strategy: "With him I had developed the delicious art of alternating prompting with flattery. It was one of my greatest pleasures, and an instinct of self-preservation every time prevented me from going too far; I never ventured beyond the limit of provocation and, when it was about to arrive, I knew how to use all my skills.

Rochester makes Jane believe that he wants to marry Blanche, "a refined lady of quality", by forcing her to attend a reception where he will enjoy courting Blanche: before his eyes, Jane, a governess sitting in a corner He also endures Blanche's poisonous speeches about the uselessness and acidity of governesses, submitting to humiliation, part of the masochistic erotic game with Mr. Rochester, to whom he secretly feels an irresistible attraction. It is evident how his envy of Blanche's sunny and extravagant beauty takes the path of self-destructive attack, in the form of ruthless self-criticism: "There was never, on the face of the earth, a dumber person than Jane Eyre. A poor delusional, who more than she has stuffed herself with sweet lies, swallowing poison as if it were nectar...". "Now, Jane Eyre, hear your sentence: stand before the looking-glass to-morrow and make a pastel portrait of yourself, faithfully, smoothing over no flaw, omitting no detail, however harsh, and smoothing out unsightly irregularities then below write portrait of a governess without family, poor and insignificant."

Jane will show all the tenacity of her character when, grateful for the trust placed in her only by Mr. Rochester, after an accident in which Mr. Mason (a house guest who later turns out to be the brother of Mr. Rochester's hidden crazy wife) is badly injured, he is entrusted to her care. She will spend the whole night cleaning the blood, stoic, inflexible and tireless, ready to do anything to feel herself a loyal friend of Mr. Rochester (and I would say to satisfy the demands of her lover, whose affection she feared to lose if she did not show up to the task assigned to it).

When Mr. Rochester asks her to marry her, Jane is delighted, but is once again stubborn and in need of remaining anchored in her autonomy: "The more things he bought me, the more I felt my stomach burn." cheeks with a feeling of annoyance and humiliation . . . I just want to feel at ease, sir, and not burdened by a great obligation to you.

Jane, right at the wedding altar, discovers that Rochester was already married and feels hopelessly betrayed. He will flee aimlessly and without resources and with the conviction that he must rely solely on his own strength. "The more alone I am, the more without friends and without support, the more I have to respect myself." After a long journey and a long wandering, she arrives exhausted and almost dying in front of the house of San Juan; here he finds the welcome and warmth of the young Diana and María (sisters of Saint John). San Juan, the village priest, who will turn out to be a very strict man, will help her by giving her a job as a teacher in a small school in the village, with a small and modest house attached to the school. All this will allow Jane to live with dignity from her work and with total autonomy. San Juan will be especially impressed by the perseverance, constancy and strength with which Jane will carry out her teaching task. Jane seems content in the stability of her autonomy, except that she is tormented by the thought of Mr. Rochester, whom she would like to hear from.

The balance in Jane's life will change when she finds out the news that she has received a large inheritance from an uncle, who also happens to be the uncle of Diana, María and San Juan, therefore her cousins. The uncle, however, left everything to Jane.

Here's how she describes her reaction to the news: "It was certainly a great gift and independence was a wonderful thing, yes, I felt that thought swell in my heart." However, in the name of an ideal of justice, Jane will decide to divide the inheritance into four equal parts, happy to consider the cousins as her brothers, finally feeling that they are part of a family. Finally, it happens that the young San Juan, who will soon leave as a missionary to the Indies, also wants to involve Jane as a missionary; He tells her that he sees in her the same religious ardor that he does and asks her to become his wife. Jane, driven by a spirit of sacrifice, is willing to accompany him, but as a sister. That is unacceptable to him.

Jane, adamant about the marriage, decides to look for Mr. Rochester again. He finds him blind and crippled from the fire started by his crazy wife, who had taken her own life by jumping from a burning roof. Now she is willing to marry him, to take care of him forever. This is how she describes their love: "Being together means, for us, feeling both as free as when we are alone and as happy when we are in company".

❖ SOME FILM EXAMPLES

Two films were chosen to exemplify the character form of the E4 enneatype: Roman Polanski's *Tess* (1979) and David Lean's *Lawrence of Arabia* (1962).

For both, there is an initial summary, where the plot and its main points are reported, followed by an analysis of the character of the protagonists, of the ways in which they face, react and move in the face of the vicissitudes they experience, with the intention of highlight the dynamics of character, bringing out the essential traits of E4 especially referring to envy transformed into effort and tenacity.

Despite the diversity of contexts and stories of the protagonists, the supremacy of the superego, judgmental and punitive aspect emerges strongly, to the detriment of the underdeveloped maternal aspects and a playful sense or enthusiasm for life. almost non-existent.

Tess, by Roman Polanski (1979):

By Antonella Sabia

Summary:

Set against the backdrop of 19th century England, the story of the poor D'Urbeyfield family, of which Tess is the eldest daughter, unfolds in a story loosely based on the novel by Thomas Hardy.

After the news, received from his father, about the nobility of his family origins (the name D'Urbeyfield, in fact, according to some research known to him through a prelate, derives from the ancient and noble D'Urberville lineage), the young woman is sent to meet with presumed relatives to strengthen relations and obtain some economic advantage. Although she does not approve of the choice, Tess obeys and goes to the relatives who, in fact, have acquired the title of nobility (as was the custom at the time) to attribute prestige to her social position. Tess, who attracts the interest of the false cousin because of her beauty, is hired by the family as an employee of the chicken coop.

Soon the cousin's goals become apparent, and Tess suffers violence and becomes pregnant. She briefly agrees to become his lover, but upon discovering her pregnancy, she decides to return to her father's house. There she resumes her work in the fields while taking care of her son, who, due to difficulties and poverty, dies of malnutrition. The dishonour of the return of his daughter does not allow the father to accept neither the care of the doctor nor the religious assistance of the parish priest for baptism. For this reason, Tess cannot give her son a Christian burial, denied by the prelate, and takes care of both the burial and the baptism itself, during which she gives her deceased son the name of Pain.

So she goes to a new job, at a dairy, where the surroundings are more hospitable, the climate more serene, and where she falls in love with a young farmer who is doing an apprenticeship to start his own business. The two express their feelings for each other, and Tess receives a marriage proposal from the man. Although he wants to, he cannot calmly accept it because he feels the weight of guilt and the past. She wants to confess to the man what has happened to her, but she can't until the night after the wedding. Her husband reacts very differently to what Tess expected, and when confronted with the account of what happened to him, he disowns her. The two separate and the husband goes to Brazil to set up his own business. Tess, humiliated and rejected, seeks solace in a friend who worked with her at the dairy and begins to work hard in the fields. Here she is joined by her cousin, who offers her help, which Tess initially rejects, only to accept after the death of her husband's father and the miserable conditions in which his mother and brothers find themselves.

Tess's adventures come to an end when her husband returns to look for her, repentant of his actions. Now she has become her cousin's wife, but she is not indifferent to the man's proposal and in an act of madness, to follow her only one and kills her cousin and joins her husband. However, her love is true, her flight will not last long, since she will be captured by the gendarmes and later executed, but she will manage to live the night of love that they prevented her from at her wedding. Tess is stopped when, during her escape, she steps on the Stone Age rocks, an ancient pagan temple used for sacrifices.

Analysis of the film according to the aspects of the protagonist:

The film can be divided into three main parts: a first part that opens with the spring dance and ends with the loss of the son; a second part that describes the love of the protagonist, the marriage, and the subsequent separation and a third part that concludes the narrative. The division into three phases only intends to show the personal journey of the protagonist from the temporal point of view of maiden to woman, and the way in which, through the intertwining of events, certain mechanisms arise cyclically that draw more and more force. of opposite events.

The first phase begins with a green landscape, the backdrop of the Spring Festival in which Tess, together with other girls, dances to prepare for the village festival that celebrates the arrival of the beautiful season and the blooming of flowers. incipient of the girl's adventures, but also indicative of her personal blossoming in life. In this first phase, her parents ask Tess to visit some false relatives, holders of the title of Uberville, a link with the aim of obtaining economic advantages. Tess to create a position of marginality, as shown by the scene of a nocturnal dance of the workers, inside a stable/barn, to which he does not join. On this occasion, as in other moments when service personnel meet, the shame of showing oneself, of remaining in the background, of not mixing, is made explicit, however, with a proud attitude and opinion ("If I had known what you were like, I never would have enlisted").

Tess maintains an ideal of herself that she clings to feel different from the other workers, with whom, in fact, she shares the daily tasks, shying away from the possibility of being part, of integrating into a small community that could function as support and support. food. Her reluctance, her inability to give herself up and trust anyone, is thrown into her face when, in one scene, Tess is verbally assaulted after laughing at a girl who accidentally spills molasses. In fact, everyone who witnesses the hilarious incident laughs, but the girl just lashes out at Tess.

The scene, concatenated with the previous one in which Tess stays away from the rest of the group, suggests that the distance she puts between herself, and the others does not allow her to participate even in moments of hilarity and joyful sharing. In fact, if everyone present is and feels on an equal footing with the others, Tess, by positioning herself differently, in terms of originality, in terms of suffering, in terms of beauty, attracts the antipathy and anger of others. the girl, without it being possible for her to bring out the deep fear, the insufficiency, the inability to ask, to show her own feelings, which are hidden behind this very haughty attitude. But in addition to the more manifest behaviors, Tess's behavior can also be read as an adherence to her deepest vocation, that of following a path of purity, of atonement for the faults she considers innate in her, which makes her it leads to ridicule, to minimize the simple and daily needs such as fun, lightness, unable to value the most pleasant side of life.

It is no coincidence that when he spontaneously indulges in laughter, it immediately withdraws, as if indicating the existence of a prohibition that is the result of his own way of acting.

The chain of events clearly shows how her defense of the group -and her delivery into the hands of her cousin- will lead her to much worse conditions, as a peasant paraphrases (from the frying pan to the fire), presaging the act of violence that Tess will suffer shortly after.

Then she becomes, for a short period of time, her cousin's lover, who frees her from the obligations of hard work and offers her a comfortable life, to which Tess, however, does not give in, making her even more unhappy. The transition from working woman to lady of the house, above all, sanctions a change that Tess does not feel capable of acceding to, due to the absence of sincere feelings towards this man but also due to the impossibility of abandoning the state of continuous work. , hardship and hardship, which is the way of life he knows best. For this reason, he decides to leave and break his love relationship with his cousin, taking the fruit of their union with him.

Returning home, she dedicates herself to laborious tasks in the fields and to raising a small child whom she tries to feed with great difficulty, to the point that the child, lacking sufficient food, dies without being baptized. The father, in fact, does not allow the parish priest access to the house, denying the presence of a child, also an illegitimate child, a source of shame for him, yet another shame to his already painful condition of marginalization and poverty.

In this passage, Tess's father addresses the parson bitterly ("tell your God I work like a dog"), reiterating his aversion to a paternal principle experienced as hostile and punitive.

Tess baptizes her son with the name of Pain (pain, in Spanish). In this passage, she expresses her own experience, the fruit that she bears in the world and that guides her, her disease of life, her pain. When She goes directly to the priest to ask for a Christian burial for her son and he denies it, Tess reacts fiercely, experiencing the refusal yet another rejection of her desire - but at the same time also her reluctance - to belong. The underlying request, in fact, seems to point to the hope that their pain can be accepted by the community (local and religious), the Christian burial as an opportunity to be part of the community of God's children, an attempt to tear from within a deep feeling of condemnation and resignation. Rejection once again sanctions the impossibility of feeling part of the world of men and the Kingdom of God.

Tess buries her son in a dark and gloomy setting, where the landscape emphasizes the hardness of the moment in which only the arid and dark earth can guard his suffering, passing everything in silence and without sharing it, keeping his suffering only for her.

Thus ends the first phase of the film, which we can consider as the transition from Tess's naive childhood to the brutality of life, which sees her at the mercy of the deceit and abuse of others, to which she responds closing in on herself and closing off contact with the world.

Hard work is her only chance of survival, but also a form of self-frustration, a punishment for her guilt, which seems to be linked not only to her illegitimate relationship with her cousin, but also to the original sin of having been born, of existing, that condemned to a life of atonement.

The second phase opens with the start of a new work by Tess, an element that underscores and sanctions her painful emotional transitions. Whereas before the work was done in the field, in this specific phase the setting is a dairy.

After a first phase in which she related to the masculine-paternal principle

(Father/Cousin/Parrotín) accepting a primary aspect of herself (aggressiveness, sexual drives, anger), now she seems to open instead to the Maternal relationship: the awakening of femininity.

In fact, it is here that Tess falls in love for the first time with a man, Ángel, also a guest at the farm as a farmer's apprentice, imbued with progressive ideas (Marx's Capital is included) and with a proud, narcissistic, and ambitious character.

The moment in which Ángel seems to notice Tess for the first time is during a meal, when during a conversation about the soul, the girl intervenes by contributing her experience and version of the contact with hers, expressing how it can be perceived through the connection and identification with the firmament.

The expression of a spirituality that is distinguished by simplicity and intuition, manifests an aspect that Tess possesses both as a personal inclination, as an ideal, as a refuge to get out of an exhausting and painful humanity, and finally, as a path of choice for his own life.

Her intervention makes her visible to the eyes of Ángel, who falls in love with her, not only because of her beauty, but also because of the image of an immaculate and ethereal creature that she conveys. Their love story unfolds quickly and soon leads to a marriage proposal.

In this phase, which, as has been indicated, leads back to the feminine principle, the mother figure reappears through a letter in which the mother invites the girl to accept the wedding without mentioning her past. In this invitation emerges the impulse to undertake a new possibility in life, without being anchored to the events that have occurred, to which, however, Tess, unable to shake off the weight of what she feels as her guilt, does not know how to abandon herself.

In fact, the girl, although she loves the young man and wants marriage, continues to keep alive the torment dictated by guilt, fear and, at the same time, the need to tell the truth about her past, the violence she suffered, the relationship with his cousin and its fruits. Deep down, she wants to make herself known, to show her suffering in an act that would also be purifying, a search for forgiveness that she does not know how to grant herself. Therefore, decide to write him a letter in which he strips naked and, in a metaphorical sense, gives him his life, making him judge and architect of his future. In this passage, another aspect of the character of the protagonist becomes evident: the dedication of her life to the other, then owner of her happiness and unhappiness, and the renunciation of responsibility for herself, at her own judgement. and to be the guide of his own life.

Tess loves Ángel in a totalizing way, devoid of nuances, as is typical of this specific character, inclined to idealize the other to the point of ceasing to feel himself, in an act of total self-sacrifice. "Which are my hands, and which are yours?" they ask. Tess replies: "They are all yours."

The letter, however, gets stuck under the rug in the man's room, a coincidence that seems to complicate the situation, but also offers the possibility of simplifying it by leaving the past behind. Tess arrives at the wedding day still keeping this secret. Only after the wedding, when her husband has also confessed to a previous affair, does Tess find the courage to tell of her past. Her husband's reaction is very different from what Tess would have expected; she finds herself disowned and abandoned before they can consummate their love. Even this moment of happiness, just touched, is taken from him. It is the second time that Tess ascends to a state of greater well-being (interior and exterior), but even in this situation she cannot maintain it.

After being abandoned, she sheds her lady's clothes and puts on a peasant's, to return to a primal and earthly condition of deprivation and loneliness.

He spends the night outdoors, in an improvised bed, in a bare autumnal forest with fallen leaves. He wakes up as a result of a noise made by a deer and, as if waking up from a lethargy, not only physical, but he also expresses a simple concept, dictated, once again, by a spiritually denoted perspective: "Everything is vanity! ". The pain she feels due to the early and unexpected separation from her husband appears sublimated by an attitude that tries to resize the feeling, but at the same time makes contact with a deeper truth where pain, suffering and the fatigue of living are nothing more than a narcissistic form of self-recognition, a way of attributing a form, a visibility, precisely the reflection of a specific form of vanity.

Fatigue and the recovery of the humble condition of working the land invariably follow the moments of greatest suffering, as if wanting to find a possible contact with the origin in the land, but also to distance oneself from the state of internal discomfort due to the exhaustion of the body. This also concludes the second phase of the film, which shows Tess's relationship with love, with her feminine side, with the land that always serves as a backdrop to her story, at the same time as a container for her pain and as a source of survival.

In the third and final part, Tess, alone again, turns to her only friend, whom she met while working at the dairy, who warmly welcomes her even though she too is in a very uncomfortable state. The young woman leads Tess to a new crop field with wet and muddy soil. Here she is joined by her cousin, Alec, who tries to coax her out of her penurious state and offers to look after her.

Tess, obstinate and proud, refuses the help and is harshly taunted by the cousin, who shows her that her obtuse and haughty tenacity is an instrument of resistance at the service of her continuous and unfailing process of atonement - "pride has become in your hair shirt" and that by sustaining such a condition, he is exceeding the limits of all reasonableness.

Once again, Tess's character emerges in the deepest sense of intense effort, encompassing self-mortification, her counter-dependence, her inability to accept outside help, which, in the thought form of the character under scrutiny, it implies the fear of losing the strength to face life independently, experienced as constant danger and suffering.

The only motivation that drives her to accept her cousin's offer is the need to assume the fate of her mother and her brothers after the death of her father. One can indirectly intuit in this decision the role of Tess's mother, who wanders the streets with her children with a cart full of her belongings, a place to stay.

Turned back into her cousin's lover and having found a new home for the family, Tess maintains a state of melancholy and dissatisfaction that becomes unbearable when Ángel returns to her, repentant of his actions, and asks for her forgiveness. If at first, he shows coldness, judging an irremediable distance, soon after he sinks into a state of despair that his cousin/lover mocks, treating his grief as something unbearable, boring, repetitive. Tess, perhaps to get closer to her lawful husband whom she still loves, perhaps because of the accumulated rage towards her cousin from the past and this new derision, mortally wounds him. He then leaves the house, reaches Ángel, confesses his feat, and

joins him. There is little time left for the reunited couple, however, as it doesn't take long for the guards to arrive at Tess to arrest (and execute) her. But they have one night, in which they will be able to live that moment of love, romance and union that Tess had pursued and strongly desired. Tess, in the violent gesture by which she frees herself from the chains of mistreatment she has suffered throughout her existence, performs an act of self-affirmation, perhaps the only one in which she decides her own path while paying, once again, to a great price, your choice of love. Although the fate that awaits her is not made explicit, the director shows Tess dozing on the ruins of the Stone Age, an ancient temple where sacrifices to the gods were consumed, in a last gesture of self-sacrifice.

Tess's typical character traits can be traced in the E4 conservation character structure, as we find there a constant effort, materially applied in undergoing hard work, functional in silencing the preponderance of her own world, interior, an exhaustion to stay isolated. Self-isolation, in turn, allows Tess to maintain her position, painful as it may be, but still with diversity and originality. But diversity arises from guilt, with which he identifies (I must be guilty) to justify the events that happen to him.

In conclusion, it can be said that Tess experiences two central relationships with men: initially with her cousin, Alec, and later with Ángel, her husband. If with the first she experiences a not very loving and very carnal relationship, with the second the relationship becomes ethereal and spiritual, as if in these two sentimental stories Tess manifested two aspects of herself, the most instinctive passion and devout spirituality, aspects, however, that fail to integrate. She loses her son due to malnutrition and the lack of food and matter that she herself lacks, that she has not received or been able to give herself.

In her soul, the identification with an indifferent and exploitative maternal part is exacerbated. The masculine principle, the father himself and the priest, the other two central figures that mark Tess's story, stand as punishing, insensitive and distant profiles in Tess's internal structure, as the punitive superego.

Tess represents the difficulty of E4 conservation to harmonize the three parts of the mother, the father, and the son, showing how these crystallize in neurotic forms, typical of the analysed character, lack of self-healing and self-love, judge ruthless and punishing and, finally, of repression of vitality and eros, understood in all its broadest facets.

Lawrence of Arabia, by David Lean (1962):

By Antonella Sabia

Summary:

The second film chosen is Lawrence of Arabia, based on the life of the British soldier T.E. Lawrence, whose plot narrates the military exploits of the protagonist against the historical backdrop of the First World War and the political background of the conquest of the Arab territories of the Middle East by the British army.

The evolution of the film and the trial of the protagonist has as a backdrop the military battles fought in the desert, an arid nature that becomes a co-star, becoming.

Lawrence's alter ego or even the external expression of his interiority. In this complex web of events, Lawrence emerges as an outstanding figure for his ability to take on the task, as courageous as it is ambitious, of leading the divided Arab factions in unity to reconquer the territories occupied by the Turkish army.

Thanks to his strategic and military intuition, Lawrence led the Arab factions to success, cultivating within him the ambition to unite them in a unified government, overcoming the divisions that had always characterized the tribes. The passion, the totality with which he gives himself to the cause will make him a truly charismatic leader for the Arab army, which will acclaim him and give him the nickname Lawrence of Arabia.

Only in the second phase of the narrative, after having had access to the cries of recognition from both the British and Arab armies, does Lawrence become aware that he was only a means to expansionist goals and political accommodations between the two governments, sees his ideals of uniting the Arab League and is disappointed in the political truth behind his country's military actions. Lawrence thus concludes his story, which itself seems to be the reflection of an existential journey in which the numerous character traits that undoubtedly make him fall into the E4 conservation subtype emerge.

Analysis of the film according to aspects of the protagonist:

The film traces the epic, psychological and military exploits, and journey of the protagonist. The beginning of the film portrays his funeral, crowded, where several characters of the time spend words about the man who was a poet, a humanist, a brave man, but also a shameless exhibitionist without being able to really define his deepest personal traits or express diametrically opposed opinions.

In the first part of the film, which obviously goes back through his life, Lawrence shows some of his strong character traits in his relationship with his comrades-in-arms and in his relationship with authority. He smugly manifests his resistance to pain as a game of wills, putting out a match with his fingers "The trick is not to worry that it hurts" and expresses superiority and aggressiveness in the always ostentatious dialectic (and polemical) with exhibitionist ways, camouflaging the aggression with the joke; he confronts the military hierarchies, trying to impress them with a manner suspended between obsequiousness and impertinence, finally declaring openly and with some arrogance: "I'll have fun!", when ordered to go to the desert to help the army established in Arabia, an onerous task due to the adverse conditions that the territory entails.

At first an unpleasant image emerges of an arrogant and haughty man, seemingly unable to relate. Thus begins the journey through the grandiose image of the desert, the rising sun, the blue night dotted with stars. It is a kind of call à la Lawrence responds ("I come from England, a fat land", "But you're not fat", "I'm different").

This passage is sanctioned in an exchange between Lawrence and Prince Faisal in which the latter declares his desire to recover the ancient splendor of the Arab people, vindicating the war started by his own father. Lawrence's freeze frame seems to capture the inner movement of the man, as if he wanted to convey the burning feeling of someone who intensely wants to embody that miracle. It seems that this is the only way he can start his journey, the crossing of the desert, accepting the hard and dangerous challenges, since he is moved by the ideal and the possibility of embarking on a heroic path. The spark that allows you to translate thought and emotion into action tenacity section is the challenge

of reaching where it seems impossible, pursuing a result considered unattainable. The effort and become effective tools to achieve the feat.

At this point, it is more credible that the underlying driving force is his dire need to demonstrate value, the only viable way to be accepted and become part of a larger reality (the army and the Arab people) and, at the same time, give yourself the courage you crave. His personal translation of frustration and need into intensity, of passion for the cause, help convey his tragic conception of life: only through extreme effort will he be well loved and accepted.

Subsequent junctures further affirm this first passage, as Lawrence goes on to lead the Arab people as a leader who goes out of his way, caring for his men more than himself, while displaying sensitivity and humanity.

The extreme effort is well symbolized in the desert pass of Nefud—which, contrary to the commonly sandy image, is dark and rocky—the traversing of which puts Lawrence and the rest of the army to the test. But Lawrence doesn't stop (nor does he want to!) The goal he has set for himself is far more important and what he's at game, however unconscious it may be, has a magnitude *cho major*.

It is during this first part of the journey that Lawrence, after an extreme effort, realizes that a man from his company has been lost behind. As absurd as it may seem, Lawrence has no doubt that the only action to take is to get back on his horse and go back in search of the missing man. The teammates' attempt to dissuade him from a venture that is at least risky takes the form of the words pronounced by his friend: "It is written".

These words indicate the inevitability of fate but insinuate the doubt that the dangerousness of the gesture will not lead him to complete the undertaking. But Lawrence points to his head and replies, "I'll see Aqaba! It's written here!" "Nothing is written". Thus, he indicates his willpower and returns to himself the paternity of everything. This allows him to return to the rocky desert, recover the lost man and, with a triumphant return to the camp, where after declaring again that nothing is written, he drops to the ground knocked out by exhaustion after devouring himself in the effort and the stubbornness of his gesture.

This framework would almost seem to justify Lawrence's conduct, were it not for the fact that, later, the same man he saved will perish by his own hand, guilty of an illegal act under the rules between the Arab tribes. The presumption of being able to guide and control events finds its most manifest expression here. But the action, without ceasing to be heroic, leads him to the acclaim of the army and the recognition of his leadership, confirmed by the new clothes he receives, a shiny white dress, a symbol of his rebirth. It is what he wants, what he aspires to: to be recognized publicly, externally, for his interior qualities. Soon after, the very origin of this need is revealed in confidence: Lawrence confesses its illegitimate origin; He is the son of a nobleman and a woman who was not his wife, a condition that he never allowed the right to a position or recognition, as if he had no right to be, or felt guilty for having been born.

Lawrence stands out, always in search of his own originality, for the strategies he proposes for the war against a den, suggesting the creation of mobile units for the conquest of Damascus that can attack quickly in the desert.

After a brief solitary retreat in the desert, Lawrence has a flash of genius: Aqaba must be taken. It is the throwing of a stone by a child that hits him from behind that triggers his intuition. But the only way to implement such a brilliant and dangerous strategy is to reach the objective by surprising him from behind, crossing the desert of Nefud. It is a feat at the limit of what is possible with the few men at his disposal and, at the same time, a practical example of extreme tenacity, of effort that he does not spare. However, this does not discourage Lawrence. On the contrary, always with a visionary and idealistic look, he hopes to expand his army, joining the mercenary warriors and bandits that assault that region.

Once again it appears, although as a background theme but at the same time central, how Lawrence's action is often oriented to reunite disconnected parts. The ideal, which he endorses, is to unite the Arab tribes under a single kingdom, including the most barbaric but equally brave elements. It seems that this tension is an implication of an internal action directed at the same goal: bringing together disconnected parts of himself to find a new harmony, without excluding any part of himself, even the most untamed, rebellious, warlike, and destructive aspect. This is perhaps his true heroic journey, to claim the right to find himself. In this internal journey of his, the external counterpart is total adherence to the Arab cause, loyalty to the British army. The desire to be the one to succeed in the reunifying enterprise.

The crossing of the Nefud, despite the enormous difficulties, turns out to be a success and helps to give Lawrence a place of honor among his comrades. However, to bring the news of the conquest of Aqaba to the British command in Cairo, Lawrence must once again cross a new desert, the Sinai. But it is precisely during the trip that an important event occurs that will leave an indelible mark on him: one of the young servants, who had immediately given him confidence and admiration, loses his life when he sinks into the quicksand. It seems that this new desert is again the background, the evidence, and the interiority of the protagonist. He loses his young friend, or perhaps a part of himself: the illusion typical of youth, the totalizing and uncritical, self-referential, and egotistical adherence, which or the difficulty of seeing what is really there. It is no coincidence that the following passage reveals the underlying plots of the British command and the decision for Arabia to become a British protectorate. But Lawrence remains driven by his heroic mission, and such is the fascination he exerts that he attracts the attention of the press, which once again, like others, uses the idea of the romantic man who leads the Arab revolution to create a character. On the other hand, Lawrence can no longer resist the charm of being the man who firmly united the Arab tribes around him in the ideal of reunification. But once again he encounters a very different reality: abandoned by the retreating tribes, and with only a few men, he has no choice but to call the inhabitants of the new city he intends to conquer to insurrection. But here he is detained, captured and subjected to interrogation during which the commander makes an approach that, although not made explicit, appears to be a sexual advance.

Although Lawrence tries to rebel, he is tortured and becomes the target of sexual violence. Released overnight and taken in by his lifelong friend, he is a broken and humiliated man. It is difficult to underline this passage: the commander's attraction seems to arise from the vaguely feminine features of a moon-white body and smooth features, contours that make him an object of attention for the manic propensities of the military man. the most part Lawrence's feminine, that delicate, vulnerable, and sweet nature of hers, the most slender and hidden part, the same that she has always tried to hide behind glorious and dangerous military feats, is the same that is somehow unmasked, used, violated, and humiliated. Perhaps one could deduce how man's entire life has been

characterized by an attempt to cover his deepest nature, a vulnerability that places him at the mercy of the other, as occurs in this same passage, as if to confirm the danger of showing himself such and as it is.

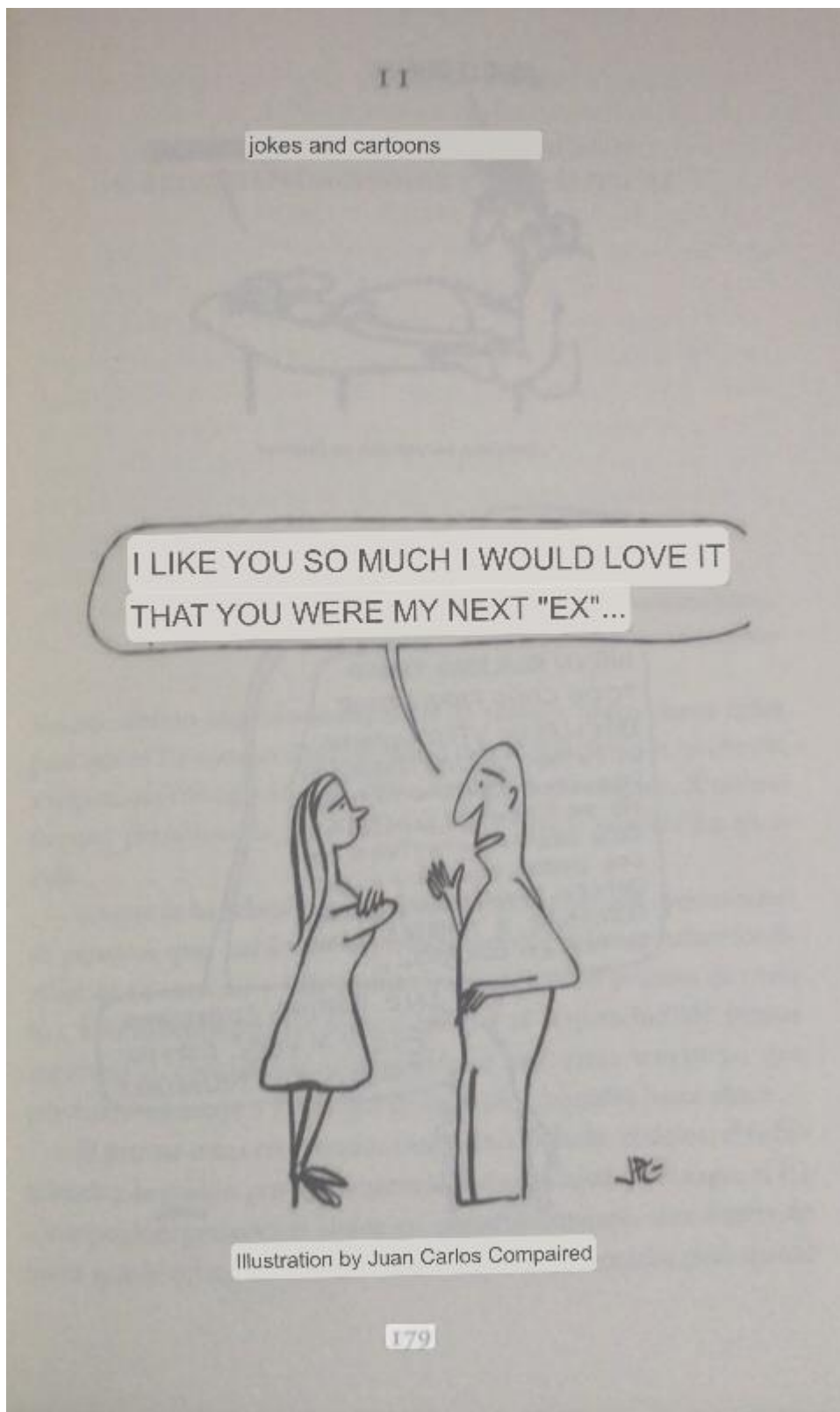
It is here where we witness a change of direction in Lawrence and in his behavior. The violence he has endured transforms him. His new mission, upon arriving in Damascus with a new cohort of men who are mostly predators and murderers-becomes a carnage that brings out a destructive rage, the sadistic pleasure of attacking the other. It is during this phase that Lawrence becomes aware of that part of him that he has never known and that scares him; he confesses that he has felt pleasure in killing.

It is internal sadism, self-destruction, that changes direction and is now directed at the enemies of war in a kind of self-vindication, revenge, an explosion of rage hidden for so long behind doubt and the tenacious obstinacy.

But the descent of man has not yet found an end: it will be the participation in the Arab Council, created for the establishment of united peoples under the leadership of Faisal, which will once again plunge Lawrence into discouragement. He soon realizes that, despite everything, the different tribes continue to cultivate hatred underground and among themselves, which prevents any possibility of agreement. All this effort, so harshly driven, sees its confirmation in the military hospital that houses war veterans, without water or assistance. The sad epilogue of the story sees in the political strategy of the United Kingdom and the Emir the definitive act that dismisses Lawrence, now considered an uncomfortable man, the unravelling of the political plots that have always been covertly directed by the events and, unknowingly, also the action of man, de facto puppet of a much broader network of agreements. Lawrence, who has already walked away by now, goes back along the path that had seen him victorious on the back of a camel and looks out over the desert for the last time, his eyes lost; It is the same desert that for so long has tried to fight, to defeat, pursuing the madness of a celebratory self-transformation. But the rocky and sandy desert and the many distinct parts it has tried to give voice to and reunite are finally giving way to an acceptance of reality as it is and a deeper awareness.

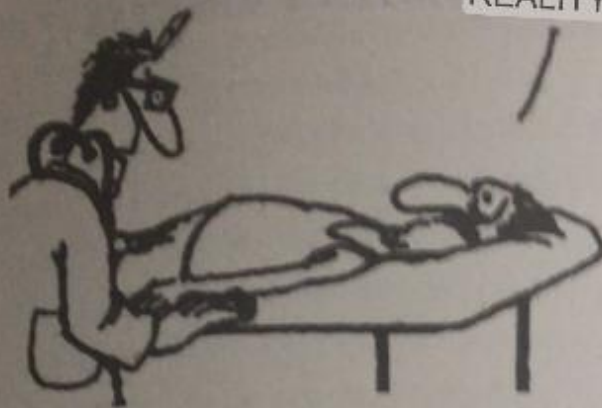
But Lawrence's journey, as an emblematic symbol of a counter dependent character, cannot be read only as the unequivocal expression of a self-devouring and masochistic character, but rather as an interior journey, a journey towards the desertification of the soul, a confrontation with each side of the world. me, a fight that finally becomes the awareness of the futility of the fight itself.

11. COMICS AND JOKES:



WHAT HURTS YOU?

REALITY



Anonymous, found on the Internet

HELLO!

ALL GOOD?

NO, IN REALITY I HAVE
EVERYTHING TO BE
WELL BUT I LIVE IN A
STATE OF PERMANENT
DISSATISFACTION. I AM TIRED
OF TRYING TO MEET THE
EXPECTATIONS THAT OTHERS
PLACE IN ME, I WANT
TO ALLOW MYSELF TO DOUBT,
FAIL, AND ALSO CRY FROM
TIME TO TIME...

YOU COULD NOT ANSWER
"FINE AND YOU"
LIKE EVERYONE?)



SHORT

Illustration by Corta (Christian Orta)

12. TRANSFORMATION PROCESS AND THERAPEUTIC RECOMMENDATIONS

By Antonella Sabia, With Contributions from The Group

In this last chapter, the tasks and useful indications are exposed so that the E4 conservation opens to a deep and respectful transformation with itself, capable of lightening the loads and, at the same time, allowing itself the possibility of greater satisfaction in life.

What has been reported is the result of numerous contributions from people who, having experienced first-hand the processes of their character and having become involved in bio, have identified the areas to which it is essential to pay attention. We then proceed by topic areas, which can be traced back to the character traits outlined so far.

The first theme on which he focuses is, without a doubt, pain, suffering and the passion for resistance. The tenacity with which E4 conservation fights that preserves pain is, paradoxically, a way of offering you the advantage of not being overwhelmed.

At the same time, it inevitably castrates him, hardens his emotionality, in addition to supporting the idea of being able to control it. Added to this is the tendency to intellectualize emotion: as soon as it sees the emotional wave, E4 conservation tries to explain it and give it a definition, with the aim of managing it. However, in this way, feelings are not experienced in depth, and one lives in an emotional chaos that is difficult to untangle.

Now when the E4 abandons the resistance to feel deeply and lets the feeling emerge, it has the possibility of contacting its most vulnerable, sensitive and weak part, the part, in short, that it tries so hard to cover. It is also necessary for them to be able to distinguish avoidable pain from unavoidable so as not to become entrenched in suffering and break the cycle of frustration. In fact, the impossibility of being vulnerable comes from the idea that abandoning the force of tenacity is equivalent to being at the mercy of events without a parachute or safety, without realizing the insanity of control that tenacity infuses this character.

Always trying to be better than I am. And what is to be better? There I went straight to hate myself for being the way I was: “You're not good like that, Lola”, said a voice. I came across a black stain called intimate guilt, a friend of not having the right and of not deserving. And I got into the stain of guilt for being born on the wrong foot; Mom almost died giving birth, she got sick, and her beautiful body was marked forever. Suffering accompanied my birth and my name, Dolores, who made others suffer so much...

And there are phrases that help: “Suffering does not exist to be explained but to find meaning”. And the meaning was that innocence appeared, yes, I am innocent, and we are all born innocent, I felt that pure and clean girl without stains inside me and I understood that there is no blame, but things happen in life that we must live.

As the main therapeutic recommendation, it is good to insist on the need to free oneself from a state of immobility, of resistance that buries feelings and leads to resignation and being open to anger and tears, which help break the prohibition and untie the knots that time has created. Once the self-repression of the deepest emotions is

removed, a satisfaction arises that makes evident the futility of the repression itself. Providing this character with support, food, means guaranteeing the conditions for it to free itself, to confess, to disarm itself, making itself vulnerable and acknowledging its hardened state.

It is important to investigate and recognize envy and its denial, as well as its self-directed rather than outward-directed counterclaim, to see clearly how the resistance mechanism works.

To this must be added the importance of recognizing one's own pain and suffering by giving it a status, so as not to have to delegate it to others in a constant expectation of empathy from others.

Separating one's own suffering from that of the mother/father, setting the limit, recognizing the burden of external pain that has been endured to raise the object of love, breaking the umbilical cord of suffering experienced as an indissoluble and unique bond that unites us to the family and/or loved ones and, finally, to get in touch with the suffering of the wounded child, to experience compassion, to start caring for him and to take responsibility for feeling the wound in order to heal it. Self-compassion leads to the recognition that the intense desire to be valued is more selfish than real and leaves no room for the true self.

We must recognize the trap of false lack and open up to the awareness that perfection is not achievable, but above all that lack in some area of oneself does not imply lack of everything, an equivalence that E4 conservation usually does. Reversing the perspective, beginning to internalize that if something is missing, it is also true that there is something else, striving virtuously to see both sides of the scale, being surprised at how extraordinarily balanced and deeply human it is to live with lack and fullness. Accepting this reality opens us to greater compassion towards ourselves and towards others, in addition to granting ourselves the mission of living daily with what life presents us, renouncing any sense of originality and recognizing ourselves as equal to everyone else.

"There is always something missing." Something for what? To live? What a harmful madness that won't let you live. See that eternal dissatisfaction as a hell that I believe. "If it was missing once, that is over." And what is missing? When will I be ready? When will I learn (I still don't know) that I will be perfect? When will I have everything? Feeling that it was me who caused me dissatisfaction broke me into pieces. Now I realize that I can live with what I have and from where today, tomorrow I don't know...

Self-love: getting to understand and feel the madness of the idea that not giving everything is the same as giving nothing, and that so much will imply useless exhaustion. In fact, working so hard to show oneself good, to be valuable, to obtain the love and recognition of the other has nothing to do with love, if it requires so much effort then it is not love, because love is easier. You must start cultivating self-love to facilitate the change from self-hatred to a more loving perspective, facilitating the transformation from a state of suffering to a state of fulfilment.

We can turn suffering into human fulfilment. It doesn't just happen to me, I'm not poor or unlucky, it's just things in life. My bad luck is when I recreate myself, I hit myself, I deny it, I use it and I don't let it go. Yes, there has been real pain in my life and now I can feel it as a life lesson of strength to move forward and above all feel very human and open my heart. And as a human I just want to be a good person that anything human can

happen to. Understood suffering has bathed me in humanity on all sides. "Nothing human should be strange or alien to me".

It is also very helpful to work on the awareness of the impossible value that the pro-so desired and sought-is internal and that, therefore, it is to contact it if only one proceeds by comparison, being at the mercy of it. It is necessary to observe how devaluation is a form of defense against frustration and lack and learn to live with it, feeling that it is nothing dramatic. Resorting to humor and irony helps lighten the burdens of such a self-demanding character, who takes life so seriously.

"You're afraid of being well," Claudio told me, and it touched me deeply. And it was true, another neurosis to believe that if I'm fine I won't have attention. The fact of daring to be well confirmed to me that the other was a very crazy idea. Out of habit, I had to try and experiment. It turned out that I don't need as much attention as I thought and received attention from another place. In being well everything is easier, but then emotion is lacking, everything becomes duller, there is no fight, there are not so many things to tell. What am I going to do? I will no longer be interesting. Well, I'll be dull and boring, even with the fear that they won't love me like that anymore. Living through this dispelled my fear: whoever loves me loves me the same and I feel calmer and more rested.

Recognize your own masochism.

It has been most embarrassing and surprising. See how I endure so that the other loves me or considers me. It has been one of the biggest scares. It is not that this trend has disappeared, but I have learned to set limits and express my feelings. I am more attentive.

Recognizing how self-inflicted harshness, self-punishment, cruelty, is a way of keeping self-hatred alive and of feeling that one is a "special sufferer" and that "the last shall be first," That amounts to an act of arrogance. There is not first or last, we are all equal and equally valuable!

Another useful task is to realize how difficult it is to get to know and understand oneself in an authentic way, having entered, for example, in contact with one's own voracity of love that presses so much and then does not accept love, when this one arrives. It is a continuous "I want, but I don't want" that feeds a verse game of denying what is so longed for.

Pay attention to the meaning and role of work and commitment.

There is no need to exhaust yourself at work, thinking that you can never do enough, because this leads to a great waste of energy and consequent difficulty in regaining it. It is important to get in touch with the value of fulfillment and self-punishment of excessive work and effort, which also does not allow other parts of oneself to emerge, which E4 conservation fears or ignores. Rather, it is worth optimizing one's own resources, resorting to an organization of activities, allowing greater management/flexibility of commitments, with less waste of time, energy and avoiding transferring the compulsive commitment to fill all the empty spaces of life.

Addiction and Contradiction:

The feeling of counter dependence is equivalent to a difficulty in being in an affective relationship with the other, to the need to maintain control, to preserve oneself, especially in love and feelings.

The fear is of feeling suffocated, but at the same time also of losing their vital space, because recognizing the dependency of the other makes them feel too vulnerable and fragile. Surrender to tenderness, to the expression of feelings, of one's own sweetness, as an antidote against the fear of love.

Letting them take care of me and help me has done me good. I need like everyone else, and nothing happens. Accepting help without debts for me is believing in love. Love me and let me love. When I felt loved, I was afraid, and now what do I have to do? Yet another madness. When he didn't love me, he invalidated the other. And when you start to love me, a fear arises of depending on that love and losing my freedom... Realizing that I depend like everyone else because I am human. Accept it. The truth is that I like to be alone and in company. Alone I am very calm (with moments of clarity). Since this tranquillity is quite new to me, I guess I want to savor it without so many ups and downs. I go out into the world considering my withdrawals and withdrawals, to find out and not always be out as I did before.

Antonella S.

Forgive yourself: the mistakes you have made, accept your limitations, see them with compassion, feel that you have the right to live to a place in the world, in your human imperfection. Get familiar with the idea that it is not necessary to waste so much energy on self-correction, abandon the stubbornness of punishing yourself for mistakes and stop imagining a possible improvement, always located in the future, seeing the deception of not living in the here and now. Accepting the limits also means recognizing that the critical judgment towards the other is proportional to the self-criticism.

Accept what is. Appreciate reality as it is (including what you don't like, what is boring, normal, and ordinary), abandoning various preferences, practicing “<what I get is worth it, it's enough for me”. This attitude contains the miracle of the transformation from scarcity to abundance.

I remember how after my communion I fell in love with a phrase that used to be an image of the sea that said: “Love is something more than an affection, it encompasses everything. No more is needed, because everything is already there, and it depends on whether it is enough. Living with what is there can be fine, savouring a state is letting go of the struggle of wanting something different and being with reality as it is. Accept the frustration of what I would like and not without drama and without telling myself that it is not a big deal and that it is something else that happens in life. Being real, without fighting with what happens to me and what comes to me, without doing anything with it. Laughter, tears, the pleasant, the unpleasant, the sweet, the bitter... and I try to live it as it is, and nothing happens. As an agreement with what is coming now, it touches this, well it touches (there is everything for everyone), without inventing anything about it so as not to deceive myself or deceive myself. Not wanting to change reality has meant accepting things that have not been easy, a trip to my deepest hells (my traps), a trip inside

Recognize your own need.

It is not necessary to give many explanations, justify or defend it, but simply to recognize one's own need, to get out of the feeling of lack and to identify with it.

The lack is something that remains uncovered, and nothing else, the negative is to remain fixed on being that. The need is something of mine in this vital process that I am living now I need rest, now of affection, now of whatever. And when I come to live that as something real, to try to satisfy myself without guilt or undervaluation, there is no longer a problem. I satisfy what I can, bear the fraction of what I can't, and that's a part of the game of life, and that's okay. I am not lacking; I need...

Spot the difference.

Recognize difference and individuality as a step up from the compulsion to compare. Not to imitate, but validate what belongs, in terms of emotions, ideas, feelings to intuitions. Avoid settling for being a bad copy of another, but rather retain the courage to experience your own originality, facing the fear of not being special.

I am what I am, and that has nothing to do with how the other is. Life has my share for me, and that share is neither diminished nor increased depending on what is awarded to others. Each one manages his own life, his own being. How my father loved me, the relationship he had with me, is unique between him and me, independent of the one he had with his other children. How I love each of my children is something unique between them and me. That's how it is.

Resize the ideal of oneself.

What you aspire to, recognize your trap, be clear that the impossibility of reaching the ideal is nothing more than a way of always feeling dissatisfied and small. In the same way, maturing and nurturing the feeling of self-love leads to compassion and to admitting that there is, as in everyone, a healthy part from which to draw strength and feed. Therefore, work on oneself must be lived as a process of awareness, and not as a martyrdom towards holiness. Recognize pride, as a defensive move, the other side of the envy coin. The E4 conservation is not always aware of his own envy, since recognizing it causes him pain and leads to a greater rejection of himself. But, even when he admits it, he often tries to hide the evidence, because he is afraid that the other person will associate the squalor of that feeling with the whole person, making a kind of equivalence between envy and the one who feels it, which is exactly the identification that the E4 conservation makes about itself: when feeling something reprehensible, it feels reprehensible. It is equally basic to cultivate a healthy humility, dissociating it from a feeling of lack and uselessness.

Taking responsibility for true autonomy is not a counter dependence but assuming responsibility for one's own desire, thought, decision and action. The E4 conservation acts as if it were self-sufficient, showing that it does not need the other, but that it is self-sufficient. He incurs in a self-sabotage of his own need to avoid the deep need of the other, the closeness that cannot be dispensed with.

Feeling the right to life and one's own space.

One is already a dignified person; one does not have to work so much to earn a living. Attribute value to the feeling of gratitude. Gratitude is an early way of learning to love, a kind of prelude to love. In his compulsive hunger for affection and recognition, this character is often unable to stop long enough to appreciate what he is receiving, but when one can make this transition then one feels a strong feeling of gratitude that it makes him loyal, faithful, and strongly feel the nourishment that comes with it. Savouring what is received reduces the feeling of frustration, the feeling of negative specialization, and encourages living on an equal footing with other people. Give thanks for what you have, thank others, yourself mine, to Life.

Thank you, value what I do have, that is real. What I don't have or lack doesn't exist, it's crazy. Put an end to treating me badly and taking care of myself. I don't need as much as I think and when I need, I try to give it to me if I can and if I can't legitimize my need without censorship, everyone has needs. I do not demand to be what I am not; I am not perfect, I am human with virtues and defects and everything happens to me in this life.

Experience new forms of love, detached from pain Love through small, non-heroic gestures that do not imply great trials. Rejoice in the successes and abilities of the other. Desiring the good of the other, loving the other even in the silence of one's own heart, without necessarily resorting to verbal expressions or overt behavior.

Strive for spontaneity, for naturalness. Without making the goal a fight, try to be in the here and now, abandoning certain rigidity (physical and mental). One way to start might be to pay attention to the relaxation of the body, allow yourself to say simple things, risk being banal, simply say what you think, without passing every word through the scrutiny of the inner judge.

Trust in the goodness of my nature and take care that it is part of me, observing myself in my actions-intentions and being able to see the other kind. I am not just neurotic nor is the other just neurotic. There is goodness in you and me and I am learning to see it. Kindness of heart that does not include forms or ways of doing or being, moves us. but for me it is what

Cultivate presence.

When I can feel present, I believe that this is the joy of abundance, nothing is missing, there is what there is, and you can be fine with that. There is everything all yes and for the moment. To say that I am focused on what is coming when "something is missing" is to deny reality. When I feel real everything has a meaning, that of the present moment, and I can savor everything. The differences disappear for me, and everything mixes. I am the one who establishes differences (neither heaven nor hell, both), and that is why I always lack something with my ups and downs. If I stop doing it, there are no preferences and I savor what arrives, whether it is sweet or bitter, and that is fine because it is real and true. And everything happens if I let it go, it's in my hands.

It helps me to pay attention to the effort. What am I striving for? And stop it when it is compulsive and meaningless. Do not push the river and believe in that phrase: "Don't try so hard, the best ones come when you least expect them." And the truth is that life has shown me that way.

Differences, comparison, different, special. Once I had a beautiful vision: a valley full of poppies, all different (color, size, shape) and at the same time the same. They were neither better nor worse, they were beautiful and necessary. Each one its beauty and at the same time the beauty of the whole.

Experience boredom.

Boredom was my biggest phobia, get bored myself! Impossible. Trying it out has been great for me because it's not bad to get bored, it's relaxed, really. I don't know to what point it is to be bored or to be calm, without doing anything extraordinary. And I get bored, but I don't get bored. Some friends have told me that lately I have become dull, I have fewer battles to explain, I go out less, I am calmer. It seems to me that they like me less, but the important thing is that I am better.

Trust what happens.

Things just happen, I'm not the one who must compromise or strive to contribute. Cultivate confidence in oneself, in what one feels, experiences, without judging, giving oneself credit, as a step to begin to love oneself, to value oneself. Developing confidence towards oneself and towards the outside world is a step of paramount importance in the path of growth of E4 conservation since the core of this character consists of maternal abandonment due to her alleged lack of love.

To survive this excruciating pain, what appears to be necessary is to "close the heart, freeze it" so that the affective channel is blocked.

It is necessary to reverse the direction, open to trust in spontaneity, naturalness, and love, let things flow, witness that everything just happens.

Transform intensity into nourishing heat.

Feeling the absence of overwhelming emotion, as interesting as it may be to walk, often leads to feeling arid, as emotion (whether positive or negative) makes you feel alive. Instead, leaving intensity in the background could be an opportunity to bring out something new, creative and, above all, unknown, although this, again on a mental level, is scary because it undermines control. Transform the inner volcanic energy into an inner home that can be accessed to maintain contact with oneself and used to feed and nourish oneself.

I think that the thing is, at least for me, in being alive without the "very". Without having to intensify my movements or exaggerate them to feel them, because with softness I can also enjoy it and it is more real. Be attentive to the limit where I go too far, without going further and further. That is the product of repression, censorship and guilt. "A volcano repressed for so many years." Sweetening my movements has helped me, and not blaming myself for my need. If I deny being who I am, it's worse, then the volcano explodes, so it's better to dose that energy. Dancing is a great help to me, and I really need it. For me it's a good therapy to dance my emotions (which catch me so much), that's how I live them, they pass, and I don't get hooked. If I deny, my volcano gets angry and goes wrong.

If I deny my fire, it burns me. Better will be the warmth that opens my heart like this, and I feel it sweet inside and that's how it comes out delicate and soft and not suddenly and rough. Sometimes I have felt like a distributor of warmth, and I liked to give it away. I feel that I like to take care of giving warmth to the people I love and better from the soft and light, so I don't invade.

Attitude in the face of difficulty:

Break down the problem as if it were a mathematical expression- minimize it, simplify, take one part at a time, start small.

The temptation not to face the difficulties - and therefore to remain in the state of discomfort - is equivalent to "feeling the difficulties as a punishment." Dismantling this "crazy idea" means giving up a state of victimhood and infantilism. The abandonment of these states is related to the confidence in the possibility of repair, which resides, both inside and outside oneself, in friendships, in close people, in a higher order, from which it is good to know how to ask for help, recognizing oneself as part of the universe and son of God.

Another important element is to recognize the impossibility of facing it all, all together and all alone. Feeling the discomfort (fear - pain - anguish) without being overwhelmed, contacting that there is, on another level, a coexistent sensation of peace, which contains me and makes me a container for the feelings that go through me, experiencing a feeling of serenity even in difficult times.

Pleasure:

This character finds it especially difficult to indulge in pleasure, whatever it may be. It often happens that we seek pleasure through addictions, which take the form of new attempts to fill the void and emasculate the feeling. Surrender to pleasure, instead it has to do with something delicate, loving, subtle, feeling the little things, every day in the here and now, but also appreciating the game, the laughter, the physical eros and the joy of being alive. Appreciating the sensation of pleasure ignites vitality and at the same time dampens the ego. Pleasure also for one's own body, respecting it and avoiding subjecting it to unnecessary fatigue. Let yourself be carried away by the movement, by the dance, by the sensations that physicality provokes as a channel of lightening, opening and self-exploration.

Take care of myself, feeling comfortable with my body, with food, my image, giving myself tastes and time for myself. To be beautiful and to like me. Live the pleasure of being myself with myself felt in my body and in my cells. Feeling that made me see the absurdity of the fact that everyone loves me and see that if they don't love me, nothing happens either, feeling like a lovable being like everyone gave me the love inside. And thus, go out into the world, attentive to the fact that the reference is inside and not outside. Believing myself was not easy, due to lack of habit. As I learned with our dear Claudio: "Freedom is exercised and you don't have to ask for permission."

Rediscovering myself was good. And realize that they are already valuable to me and my blessed nature. that I don't like it, I needed it for me who loved and valued me, no matter how simple they are: my dance, my poetry.

Body work is going very well for that enneatype, he also likes it and it's easy for him to express with his body.

Your energy, imagination and intensity need to flow somewhere. It is important that you discover that anything can be your creative expression: dancing, painting, cooking, etc.

Let him look at how good he has it because the bad is easy in his game. He runs into the difficulty of finding the good and guilt and shame appear. At this point an important click can be produced, like me. for him to say to himself: "I am the one who does not believe in me."

To meditate:

Stop thinking, dedicate yourself, observe yourself and cultivate a neutral space, also useful for practicing equanimity.

When I meditate, and that helps me to open the circuits, I can better perceive the existing beauty. If I don't meditate, there is an automatic that puts the world's pain in the foreground too insistently. With meditation I calm the intensity and compulsive action, due to a certain perception that there are not so many things to fix. Something like what is essential is done, inside and outside of me.

From compulsion to creativity:

Practice not exaggeration, appreciate simplicity, give up too much, intensify to make way for sweetness. The inner fire that usually accompanies it can be transformed into creative, light, and nourishing energy.

I have no choice but to take the butterfly as a model, as a reference for what is useful in change, for me. I, who have such a capacity for movement and action, and who also needs it to be well, to take my load off, so that the intensity does not turn against me like a volcano that does not erupt, that does not explode. Now I believe that the way out is to take away the blame for that, allow it to me in its measure. The gale is what it is until it is consumed and passes, so is my activity and my movement. What's wrong with letting go? The only bad thing for me is to feed it back artificially in the tenacious attempt to achieve something other than the intrinsic purpose of that movement, which is none other than letting myself be. That is the creativity in which I believe. The butterfly flies just to fly (at least mine), and in that it creates the beauty we see. When I release my movement or my intensity from guilt, I make them light, by which I mean free of heaviness, first for me and at the same time for others. I wonder as I write it if the intensity can be light. I don't know about other character traits, for me, of course, removing guilt is lightening it, allowing it, letting it pass, breathing it, getting to know it, observing it without censorship, to be able to also ask him to pass and calm down.

I believe that in terms of energy, everything was disrupted with the containment of the first, innocent spontaneity. I don't remember that my desire was hyper desire, that my feelings were exaggerated, that I was excessively excited. What I do remember is that my vision of the world or what I imagined had colors, much more color the considerations about reality that the elders returned to me. There was also an element of laughter and enjoyment that came from my vitality, it was joyful.

Practice equanimity:

Cultivate equanimity, be content with what you are and what you have, give up the effort, surrender and give yourself honestly and confidently to life.

SECOND BOOK
ENVY IN THE SEXUAL INSTINCT

CORDENATION:

Rossana Pavoni Gallo

TEAM & WITNESS:

Rossana Pavoni Gallo y Facundo Piperno

We want to offer this chapter specially to a dear teammate.

(Cristina Dicuzzo, that overcome her pain and found out a way to deep connection.)

TRANSLATION:

Facundo Piperno and Sandra Martín

1. PASSION IN THE SPHERE OF INSTINCT: HOW ENVY WORKS IN THE SEXUAL

By Cristina Nadal, Juan León and Collaborators

Envious passion, in the sexual subtype, takes on the character of a passion to reclaim what is felt to be lost; a claim that is a furious cry against those who have talents, qualities, objects and recognitions, that people who recognize themselves in this character feel that it is their right to have. The existence of sexual E4 is characterized by constant drama, like a lover who despairs of having lost his love and can only hate the one who hurt him so much.

This passionate suffering for having been abandoned is what the baby experienced with his mother: the “witch who left him alone and with nothing. All energies are invested in the search for that lost love.

The sexual E4 baby is very likely to be a carrier of a high energy level. They are babies who cry more, are more noticeable, are livelier and more annoying than the other envious subtypes.

“I am the seventh of seven brothers along with a twin sister (E4 social), in family stories they always tell how much of a cry-baby I was. I was a restless baby, I woke up at night complaining, as opposed to my sister who was barely noticeable.”

Juan Leon

Instead of becoming depressed soon, faced with the frustration of not having his needs met by the mother, the sexual E4 invests more energy in claiming the emotional nourishment he needs. In this trance, it is quite possible that this baby will bite the mother's nipple (figuratively or actually) and be reprimanded for it. Faced with a disinterested and affectively absent mother, she manages to attract some attention, albeit in the form of recrimination

On the one hand, like all babies who, as such, remain undifferentiated from the world, he identifies the source of the displeasure (in this case, the mother's affective lack) as coming from himself. On the other hand, the sexual E4 arouses the mother's hatred, and he swallows it, hating himself. Identified with the mother and so in need of her, the baby incorporates her by gobbling her up and begins to identify with an internal appraisal of seeing himself as a monster, bad, or inadequate. Normally, sexual E4 mothers are very emotional and at the same time unstable people, often suddenly distant or humiliating. This ambivalence makes the girl or boy unable to foresee their reactions and live in a constant feeling of abandonment, without being able to give it meaning; they have an experience of injustice for feeling mistreated, without being able to associate this behaviour with some objective event in reality. Sometimes, this feeling of injustice is based on the difference in the treatment of the mother with respect to other children. There are many reports about having experienced a difference in the attitude of the mother with the brothers and sisters or feeling disregarded with respect to another sick or problematic

brother/sister. We can say that the sexual E4 feels known a paradise that has been cruelly taken away.

All this occurs while the baby configures, little by little, integration of the maternal function in itself, which is distorted. The sexual E4 passes to the following stages of growth and maturation already damaged or and fixed in his neurosis. As in all subtypes, this fixed pattern is reproduced in all phases of development and gets in the way of their dialogue with the world. What is specific about the sexual subtype is that it does not turn all the hostility against itself, but also projects it outwards, towards others.

Let us see the following testimony that exemplifies several of the aspects that are developed below and in other points of the chapter:

I am ashamed of being so despotic and inquisitive with myself, loving myself so little, despising me, denying myself love (what I can give myself and what I can receive from outside), and then drag myself and beg for it right and left in a covert way, nothing clear. I do not ask for it or make it explicit, because that commits me. So, I demand that love and attention (I'm dying to get it) and, if I don't get it (which is likely by not exposing it openly), I unleash my hatred and my revenge (all before feeling pain, emptiness, loneliness).), I aim, I shoot and, if I can, I kill. I refine my style. You can go to kill in many ways and I have style, I don't kill in any way, what merit does that have? I can be a bitch with a simple eyebrow raise, I can unload all my rage and hatred with the slightest of gestures. And here yes, I feel powerful, indestructible, absolutely.

sexual, because I will be bad, but how good I am being bad! In another thing no, but in contempt (both outwardly and inwardly), I'm good. And that turns me on, warms me up, makes me work, lets my hair down. Here I do believe in myself.

The strategy to get some love, even if it was a substitute, has been through the early and unconscious decision to openly claim it in an intense and angry way. Statements such as:

"I was very nervous and attracted attention by doing shit, capricious and obsessive, I used to put on big numbers if I didn't get what I wanted. Little by little I specialized in provocation and faced everyone at home. My reason was clouded, and I went on the attack with my crazy energy, and then I regretted it."

Juan Leon

This passion for intensity is going to mark the voltage with which the sexual E4 is going to be handled in his life -below which everything will seem decaffeinated and too opaque and will keep him far from his balance hypertrophying his emotions, which, in turn, time, they will enlarge their deficiency fund.

Regret in this subtype also fuels the passion for intensity and stems from how bad he feels when the monster he can't contain comes along, in the form of rage, hate, or viperine tongue, and is directly proportional to the pleasure it gives him. display it cyclically. In fact, it is one of your best manipulation tools.

Competitiveness:

The dominant passion is competitiveness, in an odious way, as a desire for superiority linked to an instinctive level. It is likely that, as they develop by learning to frustrate their needs and fix frustration, they compensate by managing hostile components of the aggressive drive, such as rage. It may also be that this is the origin of his thirst for revenge, justified by a feeling of justice. All this has to do with the experience of an original lack of love, which comes from the childhood wound of maternal love. A woman of this subtype declares:

With competitiveness I learned to measure affection in a family environment that was not lukewarm, and outside the home it was the best weapon to combat shame. I competed with my mother, believing that I was the only one who understood dad, and thus I covered the envy that she gave me, that, despite many defects that she had, I always found her very sensual and the good sexual vibes she had with her was noticeable with my father.

Envy pushes the competition "me or the other." They value their personal value in the attainment of what is lost, or supposedly lost; however, given the high level of devaluation they use as a defence mechanism, they do not believe they can achieve it on their own merits. They must get it from some good source.

Eroticism And Sexuality:

Seducing and trapping through sex will be a good weapon to win over others, to defeat them. The following statements may be an example:

To the men, until I was thirty years old, I took them to bed to take away their power. In adolescence I dedicated myself to flirting with the fashionable boys, to Show them that they really are shit.

And, at the same time, with eroticism and seduction they buy love: "With me you are going to enjoy a lot in bed".

They maintain the crazy idea that if they give themselves sexually, they will love them. And it is a good way to appease the experience of lack and mask the self-crushing and internal devaluation. The following statement reflects the original motivation for the sexual predominance in the desire for fusion with the mother:

Through the sexual, I recognize a search for fusion, in which, in that being clothed, there is the element of searching for a mother, even if it is through a man.

Eroticism and sexuality also serve to achieve other valued aspects, such as recognition:

"Back then my body served me to show off, not gain weight and dress in the latest fashion. In sex I was looking for something aesthetic, ethereal, that prevented me from enjoying myself. When she grew up, she fucked to be the most modern girl in college. The act itself, I think deep down, seemed vulgar to me."

Annie Chevreux

Sexual energy is powerful, captivating, filling and, like rage, ensures the desired intensity. Along with resentment, they are the great drivers of this subtype. They handle envy through anger, and hide it through anger. Instead of admitting envy, they react by disqualifying and attacking what they envy as a way of making it disappear. In addition to envy, lack, need, emptiness, and shame are hidden.

I have had a mixture of anger and shame ever since I was little, although I always angrily demanded that they give me what I considered to be my own.

Cristina Dicuzzo

To the extent that he is unable to make the envy he feels disappear, he maintains an enormous tension between the painful feeling of not having or being what he envies and the fantasy of a lost paradise. Along with this tension, he holds the hope of becoming the envied object. You can indulge in this quest in a very voracious way. On the few occasions that he achieves what he envies, he later transforms it into contempt. Like the rest of the envious subtypes, they cannot value what they get since nothing from outside can satisfy the original lack of maternal love.

"I tried to be the person I envied to be with all my strength, very image-oriented, frivolous, contempt for everyday life, feeling special, skilled at hurting others with words, especially my partner at the time."

Juan Leon

In many cases, a castrating mother is present, through hyper protection and the transmission of her frustration:

When my mother appeared, what she conveyed to me in a glance was her bitterness as a woman, the deep hatred she felt for men. "Don't be like them, men are only good for hurting women." That look was also full of tenderness and was accompanied by "I will always love you like this, being a little boy".

"And contaminating the sexual encounter, whether hetero or homosexual: I think I felt like a bit of a man and couldn't compete with them, so an unconscious solution was to seduce them. It was my way of competing and of continuing to have my mother inside."

Juan Leon

2. THE CHARACTERISTIC NEUROTIC NEED: HATRED

By Cristina Nadal And Collaborators

The subjects belonging to the sexual E4 flee from the void by increasing the desire to cover it, exaggerating the experience of lack that is characteristic of the envious character. The anchoring in the oral stage and, therefore, voracious- typical of the sexual subtype, is more hostile in this one than in the other subtypes. Envy in this subtype is a passionate resentment. Since the neurotic instinct is sexual, resentment focuses on the desired and loved other, who is denied. Love turns to hate. She is passionate about hate, or rather, passionate about turning love into hate, as the only way to stay in the relationship, denying her need to be loved and denying the love she receives. Their love relationship becomes a battlefield, competition and conflict are the conditions that characterize the relationship, that sustain it. Passionate and competitive intensity is nourishment for his ego, for his ideal self, which is strong, right, and everything is owed to it.

Injustice and claim:

Sometimes the sexual E4 can be confused with an E2 subject, a self-proud person who presents herself as a queen with a throne, she enjoys her position, feels lucky and apparently has a lot to give. A sexual E4 person feels like a queen but who has been robbed of the throne early, either because she has done something wrong or because they have realized that she does not deserve it and she spends her life claiming it. "Give me back my throne! Don't you realize that it's mine? This is unfair!". In other cases, the individual E4 hatred is not aware of the loss of the throne but feels that it is unfair to lack what he lacks. Loen spoke of this characteristic referring to one of his cases:

I have discovered that this attitude is typical of the oral character. I asked him if he thought the world owed him a livelihood. He did not hesitate to answer "yes." It is impossible to argue against such an idea since it conveys an internal feeling of approval. The individual who adopts this attitude acts as if he believes that his birthright has been taken from him and spends his life trying to recover his inheritance.'

What is neurotic is pretending to recover what is real or supposedly lost and demanding from the other what they lack, supposing (more or less consciously) that they will not achieve it. One of the distorted ideas, rooted in the lack of emotional relationship with the mother in the oral stage, is "I have come with fewer possibilities to this world". The sexual seek to return what they lost or give them what they lack by complaining and claiming. This cannot happen because the other cannot give it to them because they are not capable of satisfying each other. Satisfaction will never be achieved since the sense of existing and the possibility of being recognized is in the identification with hatred towards others; vital energy is nourished by competition with an "other" that is always experienced as the cause of one's own lack. They cannot receive, doing so is experienced as being in debt or putting themselves below, which they hate. Receiving what is concrete and limited that the other gives them means saying goodbye to the fantasy of what was or what they suppose could have been. As we will see later, feeling gratitude is a powerful antidote to envy.

What we do is try to appropriate what we lack, we have to take it because the world owes it to you, and if you don't take it, you're stupid. If we can't get it, we either compete or chop everyone's heads off and it won't be anyone's.

In the previous paragraph, at least three distorted beliefs are captured (which we will talk about in detail later): the first is that the world owes me what I lack. The “sexual” subtype identifies with lack but gets angry about having it and denies it through pride and arrogance. They owe him what he lacks and he gets angry because they don't give it to him. The next crazy idea is that he has to take what the world owes him "and if you don't take it you're a fool." In addition to providing the feeling of being ready, it feeds back the bad image, the experience of being a monster. There is a certain bad conscience about theft, which hides behind anger and resentment.

For me, the neurotic need that has predominated is to be the preferred one, the first in the life of the object of desire, generally my partner and before, obviously, my father. The need for them to defend me, and for that preference to be demonstrated with acts that were obvious to everyone. Need to feel seen as good, pretty, adequate, etc. Like a princess, and not like the monster she used to live with.

Getting rid of that feeling of monstrosity actually feeds back into the sexual Four's hateful reaction if they don't achieve their goal.

“In my last marriage this was my battle horse, I couldn't accept not feeling preferred, I constantly wanted public evidence that didn't come as I needed it. My resentment and my frustration prevented me from seeing the other as he was, I could only focus on my fight and on the useless wear and tear that this was causing me. The way I found to get out of this crazy game was to once again walk out of the relationship.”

Cristina Dicuzzo

Irresponsibility:

Many sexual E4 recount in their autobiographies times where they have deposited themselves in the other, generally in the couple. There they seek to complete themselves through fusional and dependent attitudes. Referring to the beginning of their relationship, a sexual E4 recounts:

Shortly after we met, we moved in together and I delegated to him the responsibility of making and deciding. He only woke me up in difficult times, financial or otherwise, if not, he let me live and I let him take care of the everyday. The essential thing for me, the engine that had started me, was to find my partner. Now that I had it I could rest on my laurels (that of my mother that I had always rejected).

In the neurotic need to demand that they be returned what they lost or what they lack, we verified that it is common in this subtype to flee from difficulties. Even if they live alone and are successful in their work, their intimate attitude is to keep running away. Several could affirm and confirm this testimony:

“My life was traced fleeing from difficulties, that was my driving force, I couldn't bear the responsibility of life and I went looking for people and places that reproduced the maternal”.

Juan Leon

O well:

“I took advantage of any excuse to throw myself out on the street, I needed people a lot, there was a lot of superficial noise in my mind, I constantly changed jobs, I dedicated myself to jobs that I did not like, I changed cities easily, I tried to get away from my family. I was very afraid of my body, of the sensation of my own body; a feeling of permanent restlessness, of always looking the other way”.

Juan Leon

The search for maternal refuge is due to the need to find calm and the desire to be saved from hell itself. In fact, he intends to save himself the real work of growing up that takes charge of his own life. Another sexual E4 man, referring to his misunderstanding of responsibility, states:

I have never known what this means, by not trusting myself or anyone else, the blame for what happens to me lies with others. If you don't hold me accountable, I'm still a child. Then I project all my discomfort, my bitterness, my envy and my scarcity on others, especially on the people closest to me, and I blame the world, turning all this into hatred. They owe me, I've had such a bad time that they have to give, but it is never enough, there is always someone who has more than me. And if they don't give it to me, I demand it. And if not, I steal it because it belongs to me. It's my part, they have a lot. And if I don't get it, I'm dumb.

Underneath is the self-devaluation, the distrust of being able to achieve a proposed goal and the fear of failing. They believe themselves worthless to take responsibility. Actually, they don't even think about it, it's more comfortable to blame others. Setbacks are experienced as confirmation of their own uselessness. They have a very low tolerance for difficulties, they quickly become anxious and blame others for their discomfort.

Orienting themselves to get what they want by their own means and risks also means giving the arm to twist and letting go of the fantasy of getting what they suppose they are owed --- which is loaded with idealization ---- and keeping the achievements obtained, which are concrete, and which can be experienced as inferences to those fantasized.

3. INTERPERSONAL STRATEGY AND ASSOCIATED IRRATIONAL IDEAS

By Cristina Nadal And Collaborators

As we have seen, subjects of this subtype demand compensation from the world and those around them for being or feeling deprived, which they experience as a grievance and use it as a weapon to manipulate. The false lack is the distorted vision (fixation) of oneself, projected on the other and on the world (nobody and nothing can fill me). For the E4, being deprived is not a specific affective experience associated with a specific event of abandonment or deprivation, but rather it is an existential condition of being the abandoned, the deprived, the unjustly discriminated; in the sexual subtype, this cognitive distortion assumes the meaning of having every right to accuse the other for this lack and pretending that the other is as he wants. The fact that someone did not give you what you needed in your childhood is not false, but the problem is interpreting any event as an abandonment or an unjust act, feeling the right to destroy the guilty party and accusing the world of not being understanding. The impulse to destroy what is envied is typical of envy, and the sexual E4 is the one that most clearly executes it. His destructive impulse is based on the crazy idea that if the other did not have what he envied, the envy would disappear. Obviously, it is not like that, because envy is an attitude based on the also crazy assumption that what is good is outside of one. Destroying what you envy does not prevent you from continuing to envy and contributes to increasing the experience of being a monster.

As we know, fixation is based on distorted beliefs about oneself, the other and life, "crazy ideas" that are out of touch with either the context or reality. We will describe here some of these, in the different psychic and relational fields.

Competitiveness, insecurity, and aggression:

They share with the other E4 the crazy idea "Either I am the best or I am shit", and since many other people are better at different things, they often feel "shit". As in all competitive relationships, they are convinced that the good is small, limited, and that there is not something for everyone. Therefore, they experience the idea that "if someone else has it, I can't have it." The "cake" is only for a few, if there are others they cannot be there and they believe that due to their qualities or abilities they cannot be among "the chosen ones". Thus, adhesion and alliance with the other serve to get a piece of cake. However, this is not even declared to himself, or only very secretly. It is very difficult to recognize the desire for privilege (fame, wealth, or power) that is supposedly for the few. In general, they take care that it is not noticed, they can even despise those who do not hide that desire and are proud of not having or displaying those needs that can be considered vulgar. They derive from the competitive energy in being the center of attention and in monopolizing the attention of others with histrionic, funny, and dramatic expressions.

A participant of a therapeutic group where everyone but her were psychotherapists comments:

For some special reason I had to be noticed. Since I couldn't compete in their field, I played at being the sickest, the craziest in the place. And beware if someone, in good faith, approached and gave me encouragement! His advice and help could be saved!

In another group, with the same conditions, reveal:

I felt embarrassed with them. I never told him. Instead of sharing the insecurity that gripped me, I attacked them with bad faces, rudeness, silence. He decreed that everyone falsified their own process, that they did not really get involved in it, that they protected themselves intellectually from what happened to them. I was the real one, the one who got dirty, the one who didn't compromise.

This subtype also has the crazy idea that showing insecurity makes you unworthy. And insecurity is hidden by aggression. The perception of being the only authentic person in the room is typical of all haters, and the sexual E4 uses it to despise others more explicitly. Recognizing yourself as intrinsically equal to the rest and having the same rights as others is a profoundly healing experience.

Fears and projection Many express fear of competing. Just as envy is hidden under contemptuous and proud attitudes, attacking the other will be the best way to not recognize competitiveness. When winning is not easy, retreating with a contemptuous or angry attitude is the best option, even if it increases the feeling of bitterness. Added to this fear is that of one's own hatred, of one's own fury that blinds and that brings power but also implies psychic destabilization and inner discomfort. One way to handle this fear is to isolate yourself with the experience of being totally misunderstood and establish alliances that support them. From the non-recognition of competitiveness in an open way, an E4 hatred affirms:

"I have always experienced the need to point out the other's flaws more as a way of equalizing myself than as a need to be above."

Juan Leon

The sexual E4 finds it difficult to maintain a desired place of superiority and commit to the task that such authority entails. The desire for leadership is present, it is almost always lived in fantasy and many times it is discarded in reality as impossible. When the sexual E4 gets the power, it can be very authoritarian. We see Hitler as a monstrous representative of this subtype.

Given the internal level of devaluation and their compensation for competitiveness, peer-to-peer interaction may be difficult for them. As in other traits and subtypes, the other is placed below or above. In its most neurotic functioning, the one below is despised and the one above, who can be a source of enrichment, is envied. From this perspective, the experience of hostility is assured. Given the intensive use of projection as a defensive mechanism from the awareness of their own hostile impulses, they easily hurt the other. The idealized other, as someone who can contribute to them, over time shows his limits or stops contributing and suddenly falls into the circle of the despised. Thus, the neurotic balance is reestablished where the sexual E4 does not feel

any more inferior, to then restart the circuit: idealization, disappointment, contempt, lack, envy, idealization.

The other, more or less close, easily becomes the enemy. Much of how insufferable they are to themselves and to others is increased because they confuse rivalry with living the other as an enemy. The rival is hated because he offends and activates the rage. If they assumed the rivalry, the sexual E4 would give way to the work that requires preparing to win something. But the sexual E4 handles the rivalry with hate, not work. The crazy idea associated with this is: "If others are nothing, then I am necessarily better than them".

Revenge And Fight:

With the crazy idea "either I get revenge or I'm stupid", they feed a revenge fuelled by fantasies and resentments that they carry out consciously and with impunity, convinced that they are responding to an affront. "If you do it to me, I'll make it fatter for you and that way I put myself above you". "If I'm not above you, I'm shit." Revenge can also come automatically. "When I do shit to someone, tracking, I almost always find an affront to which I am responding". As we have seen, it seems that all individuals of this subtype already coincide with feeling jealousy with great intensity. Several of them come to mount histrionic scenes and others try to hide them. Statements like this are not strange:

I have always been very jealous, first of all, of my younger brother. I remember that when my father hit him I felt as if he was hitting me. It's like I wanted to be in his place, for my father to beat me up; if he did, at least he saw me.

"Fighting is always much better than indifference." The latter is experienced as the worst of punishments. The fight is a form of relationship, it is a way of being taken into account even if it is being hated. In the relationship with the other, self-hatred and the rejection of one's own helplessness are also played out.

Relationship with authority:

This subtype has the facility to despise the other and the ability to see what is lacking in authority, which they easily discredit. When this happens, they fight or move away, usually in an open and contemptuous way. They are arrogant and confront each other ironically, shooting where it hurts the most. It is very difficult for them to recognize the authority of the other and to take away their power they act as if they were on the same level, they treat them as equals and they try to seduce them. This type of recognition is common:

I need to know that I am on equal terms with the authority, I put humanity to the test and if she does not respond as I think she should, I cut her head off, especially with contempt, speaking ill of her, putting myself above her and, above all, not needing her. Not at all.

Juan Leon

Some do not openly state that they recognize another's authority: "It bothers me that he might think I want to benefit from his contact." In general, before the few authorities figures they recognize, they become submissive and helpful and move with a high degree of fidelity and loyalty. In these situations, they can display a great capacity for genuine delivery and collaboration.

It may be the case that, if they manage to be treated in a special way by a recognized authority, they feel preferred and compete with the rest, they swell narcissistically to feel superior, projecting their own hostility on others. They accuse others of going against them even though they use the preference of authority to feel like winners.

The idealization of the figure of authority is frequent. When it falls from the pedestal, it is possible that this subtype becomes depressed and then strongly discredits and despises it; he won't forgive you. This can also happen with a partner or an idealized friend.

They idealize who they suppose can save them from how monstrous they feel and who will give them the intensity they seek. As in other subtypes, they also idealize those who they believe can provide them with values that they feel they need to incorporate, in a parasitic way. "If you have something, you have to give it to me."

Manipulation Tools:

They have a lot of capacity for verbal fight. They are very eloquent and sharp, when they are interested, they know where to hurt the other. By exercising this ability, they intend to obtain what they want from the other. If this does not produce the desired effect, they can move on to physical aggression or break objects in the presence of the other. The objective is to subdue him by frightening him: having the other frightened by my raging and histrionic crises is a way of subduing him.

Many report that they lose sight of the world when they get angry, see blurry or everything turns red, although they know perfectly well the value of what they will break and can be selective: they will not break the five-hundred-year-old Chinese vase, unless be that with it they can hurt the other more.

If all the above doesn't work, or isn't scary enough, they may move on to self-harm threats such as "I'll kill myself," "I'll throw myself out the window," or "I'll starve myself to death." Sometimes they even commit suicide attempts and self-harm.

One of the manipulations is to show pity, for example, recounting and exaggerating episodes of your life that will impress the speaker. In fact, they are the ones who usually have the most dramatic and violent episodes in their lives. Although they do not recognize it, they are aware that they do it to get attention and protection.

The star manipulation is blaming the other for their unhappiness and for being treated unfairly. They use their acute ability to catch the other in their falsehood, pettiness, arrogance or manipulation and they try to remedy it by doing what they want for their own benefit. They are great strategists. Another way is to claim more attention from the partner, from a girlfriend or friend, from the mother, or whoever, making him or her jealous.

Many times, I have been told that I am scary, that my reactions are frightening, that I have great strength and emotionally dominate any situation. And it's true, there is an infinite range of resources to get away with, but when I get it what comes next is a guilt that kills me, I don't enjoy losing, I don't enjoy winning. The battle is always lost.

This is one of their great disabilities, because being competitive they never find wellbeing. They cannot be calm neither losing nor winning. Serenity with themselves is very difficult, they try to flee from the internal experience of being monsters and cannot assume their desires since they are entangled in protesting the lack and destroying the well-being of the other. It is precisely believing that they are lacking that gives them back the energy of the struggle, the possibility of existing and feeling alive. Emotional catharsis calms down for a short period of time and is sought after because it brings intensity. As satisfaction is not possible for the envious person, since satisfaction is his way of healing, this subtype uses the outburst to discharge the bitterness and rage that said dissatisfaction produces. The false identity is based on the false lack that allows you to feel that you have all the reasons to claim and ask, to be in the center of the world. The crazy idea that if I don't claim, no one pays attention to me sustains envy and competition.

The sexual subtype neurotically seeks unconditional love. If the other loves me, he must put up with me. He entertains himself by putting this love to the test to see if it is the definitive one if it is going to save him from the internal experience of uneasiness for being so monstrous. If he manages to show that the other does not have this unconditional love, he can blame him and continue in the bond of war, typical of this subtype.

Deep down, he hopes that the other does not obey his manipulation; if he manages to manipulate it, he despises it. When he finds someone who does not give in to his neurotic demands and is in a good mood, he cannot stop attacking him/her, since he/she cannot tolerate others being well if he/she is not. "If I don't enjoy myself, no one is going to enjoy here", "if I'm not happy, let no one be", "if I suffer, we all suffer". Crazy ideas that are based on a very distorted idea of justice/injustice.

4. OTHER CHARACTERISTIC TRAITS AND PSYCHODYNAMIC CONSIDERATIONS

By Cristina Dicuzzo And Contributors

This section aims to illustrate characteristic aspects not developed in other chapters that complement the description of the subtype and help to discover if the person corresponds to the E4 sexual subtype.

Devaluer:

Devaluation is present in the repertoire of defence mechanisms of this enneatype in all subtypes. The difference in the sexual is that it tends more to projection, to devalue the other and to openly blame him for his shortcomings and defects. In the enneagram there is no one more devaluing than the sexual Four. Other enneatypes also devalue, but it is in the style that the competitive differs; It is the quintessential head trimmer to look comparatively taller. Devaluing the other by belittling and blaming him as a way of not being in permanent contact with his own sense of internal worthlessness

Guilty and blaming others:

The sexual is, of the three subtypes, the one that projects the most, and in this aspect, it can easily reach cruelty, above all displaying a great capacity for verbal aggression, as we have already pointed out. Sexual Fours have a phobia of feeling how little they value themselves, and of feeling guilty. He tends to blame the other, compulsively needing to find someone responsible for the feelings that he does not want or except for himself.

On the other hand, he has no problem admitting his guilt dramatically when he feels that all is lost. The fault can even be of life or of God himself, and it can be a form of manipulation. There is great mobility between the extremes that go from “I am not guilty of anything” to the tear of “I am guilty of everything”.

“I have always moved between a very high ideal of myself, and on the other hand a very poor self-image. With little packaging to recognize the pain and refusal to accept the responsibility of life. I have always blamed God; my craziest idea has been that God has a plot against me.”

Juan Leon

Irresponsible:

What is observed in this way of functioning is the difficulty and little capacity to assume responsibilities in the affairs of life. As we have seen, the sexual E4 tirelessly dedicates itself to making something or someone (normally the couple) take care of those aspects that they do not feel capable of sustaining or developing by themselves, with a

feeling of their own right that is difficult to reasonably question. Only with introspection work do they come into contact with what it means to take responsibility for one's own life. They usually deposit in the other the need for material sustenance or emotional support that allows them to put their energy into creativity or navel gazing as really more important matters, which help them perpetuate the sense of being special. If that sustenance does not arrive, they can develop the aspect of being misunderstood, very present in this subtype, justifying outbursts of bad humour, anger, rudeness, etc. They directly relate irresponsibility to complaint and protest, as a way of reacting to the fact that responsibility is not understood:

“The complaint and the protest work automatically in me; I live the realities of life, common to all humans, more closely, as if they only happened to me that way. Complaining is a childish mechanism that allows me to remain unaccountable and is perhaps one of my most common neurotic traits. I protest about everything and if I don't express it verbally, I protest in my internal dialogue. It's so automatic that sometimes the only thing that stops me is the idea of ending up as a bitter and curmudgeonly man.”

Juan Leon

The sexual E4 also presents obsessive tendencies, either towards a person who is the target of his love, or towards some activity in which he finds comfort, and these become the only lifeline and something essential that is out there to solve the problems. issues that he does not face on his own, and perhaps to control a depression that he could not contain.

“Here came my encounter with yoga and inner work. I went to live in a community. It was a lifeline, and I became obsessed, I've always been very obsessed with the things I like. There has always been something that I have placed my obsession on.”

Dissatisfied:

Everything previously developed is basically based on dissatisfaction and the way of relating to it. Although this topic will be illustrated in the section on love, we would like to underline in a sympathetic way the Gata Flora style ("if they put it in, she screams and if they take it out, she cries") that this subtype boasts and that shows its almost dissatisfaction. permanent in all areas. If they don't hit him, he screams, if they hit him, he doesn't know what to do with it and most likely despises it. Dissatisfaction is associated with the belief that nothing and no one is enough and the experience of a bottomless void.

Emotionally labile:

The sexual E4 swings a lot between euphoria and depression, there are no greys or nuances, they move in extremes from everything to nothing, always or never, in fact they are common terms in their vocabulary. This manic-depressive or cyclothymic tendency is found at various levels of severity depending on the subject. We can read it from the passion for extremes that leads the person to identify at different times with being the most wonderful or the shittiest. These subjects can go from one state to another in very short periods of time, either due to external stimuli, environmental circumstances, or internal ones, related to fantasy. Emotional lability is characteristic of this subtype. This network of functioning leads to the intense way of life with which these people identify so much, and which they use as another refined way of not being in touch with real lack.

Transgressive, intolerant of limits:

People of this subtype do not easily adapt to limits imposed, either by authority figures, laws, or conventions, nor do they have many references to internal limits. We could mention here a certain maladjustment (not as much as the lustful E8), restrained at times by the feeling of guilt that usually appears. The transgression of limits is developed on many occasions at the level of fantasy before an audience or an imaginary other. It is not so important to break the limit itself, but how this is seen by others; There is a pleasure in causing some kind of stir among the spectators, as if from that place one could obtain a great adhesion or a great rejection, but in short, something intense to enjoy and to talk about.

The sexual E4 is not very reserved, but he feels special pleasure for telling his experiences in a compulsive and shameless way. His position is: "If I don't tell it, it's as if it hadn't happened to me", and if he feels that this provokes his audience, all the better. His goal, more than sharing, is to impress and feel superior, even when what he says demeans him.

When they do not obtain with their manipulations (and it finally happens), they can undertake a change and a path inward, taking responsibility, recognizing the lack as such and the drama. In this way, begin to transit creative solitude, inner strength, and finally responsibility for your thoughts, feelings, and actions.

Histrionic:

This trait makes it sometimes difficult to recognize the character of this subtype as it can appear very humorous, funny, and expressive. He likes to occupy the stage also in a theatrical way and through the tragic. When he is in this polarity, he is sustained by a grandiosity that makes him feel superior and that I can do everything. Obviously, it is a temporary situation that can end quickly, because he is very susceptible and sensitive to any adversity.

Selfish:

Always finding a justification for his great suffering or difficulty or lack of possibilities, it is easy for him to be a person who is not very available to the needs of the other. He uses his suffering to not carry out tasks or to delegate things to the other that he does not like or that require effort. Egoism is also in the conviction that the suffering of the other is never as important as one's own.

Violent:

We have already talked about aggressiveness and self-injury, here we want to underline the harmful behavior that they can have towards others, reaching physical violence, which above all acts in the relationship of a couple or family. Violence occurs in a special way when you do not support frustration or fear when you feel that you are losing control over the other.

Extravagant:

Sexual Fours are not afraid of originality and often enjoy feeling different. He loves to be special, unique, and original. And he succeeds. You can speak very explicitly without conforming to good manners, as well as dress flashily and against the grain. His desire to be peculiar makes him also brave and adventurous, minimizing risks and dangers.

Inconstant:

Despite being very creative and talented people, they often fail to carry out their projects. The self-ideal is very strong and low self-esteem is often hidden. They have many dreams and aspire to occupy special places and their thirst to be admired is so great that it is difficult for them to sustain the slightest failure or any obstacle. The difficulty in maintaining discipline and tolerating the necessary path can cause disappointment and feelings of incapacity that are suddenly masked with anger or devaluation also outwardly.

Jealous:

Jealousy is lived with great intensity and is the reason for enormous scenes, especially in the couple; but also, even disguising more or less well, they feel jealous in any situation: family, work, social, friendship. The constant competition that keeps them alive makes them evaluate in each situation if they are preferring or choosing them with respect to others, and if they do not feel chosen it hurts them a lot, provoking and jealousy projecting the one who becomes their opponent. But he is also very clever, knowing the terrain, to provoke the jealousy of others.

Overpowering:

In relationships, in his impulse to be seen and by his demand and need for things to be as he intends, unable to be even-tempered or feel equal, he imposes himself many times with a modality that runs over, abuses, oppresses, humiliates and discounts. Although being polar can also be overwhelming in its generosity, care and concern for the other.

Vain:

He shares with the neighboring E3 this characteristic, and with the triad dependent on the image, in this case to hide his envy, as if he would dress up and apply makeup on himself attempting to cover the horror of his internal atmosphere that he is so ashamed of. As we have seen, the perception of oneself is in a continual series of ups and downs, and in the moments of ascent, vanity accompanies it, such as the excessive belief in one's abilities and the attraction it causes in others. If he is in a good mood, he takes great care of his appearance (according to his canons, of course) and likes to be recognized, although compliments make him a little uncomfortable because deep down, he never fully believes them. So, he can manifest himself as arrogant, conceited and arrogant, self-centered and with high points of queen/king narcissism, considering others as mediocre.

Sarcastic:

The sarcasm of sexual E4 is a mixed fruit of his bitterness and his wit and talkativeness. He does not laugh healthily at himself or at reality, but rather mocks with scathing and cruel irony, offending or teasing. And they have a lot of ability to do it, only, seeking excessive attention, they ridicule, humiliate or insult through. In effect, the etymological origin of sarcasm is linked to “biting the flesh” (of the victim). In their histrionics, they appeal to humor cleverly, but maliciously seeking to make the other look bad or if they themselves, if they themselves are also the object of their sarcasm. However, this trait sometimes serves as an escape valve for anger, to release it before it becomes uncontrollable and dangerous.

Cheerful and chatty:

They are usually very happy people, especially in moments of euphoria within their manic-depressive peaks. Just as when they are down, they are the most dramatic in the enneagram, when they are on top they become the funniest, sharpest and most capable of laughing at themselves and their misfortunes. Quaint as they come, they can be talkative and very talkative in their attempt to focus the audience's attention on them. If they find the paid field, there is no one to stop them, and they even tire the audience, of course.

Seductive:

Intense for the bad but also for the good, they are usually good lovers and are well predisposed for sex, since it is something in which they have specialized as a weapon to obtain love. They know how to enjoy sex and also seek their own pleasure, unlike the other subtypes, who may be more content with just giving pleasure to the other. But it's not just about sexual seduction; the sexual E4 seduces even without realizing it. In general, they have a strong erotic charge that permeates all their movements—walking, dancing, eating, talking — and they know how to handle it well when it is directed or focused. Seducing and rejecting often becomes in the E4 Sexuals the story of never ending an endless circle. They are attentive to what they like and detect what works and what does not. It is a peacock that only unfolds its beautiful tail when there is someone who, perhaps without knowing it, has previously seduced it. They are good observers, analyse and capture who they want to seduce.

Sensitive and Artistic:

When they take the final steps to grow internally, they can reach high degrees of understanding and empathy with the other and also be experts in the ability to confront in an open and positive way. They have a deep emotional wisdom that translates into a good understanding of the human being, his emotional range, and the availability to connect and be compassionate. They are highly sensitive and spend much of their lives immersed in internal mental landscapes, where they feel free to cultivate and analyse their feelings and out of a desire to manifest this inner world, they tend to have a great interest in the arts and many become real artists in different fields. They have the ability to be very creative, thanks to their emotional richness, and their fertile imagination is usually translated into artistic work or other fields in which they contribute the new, the original. They have an important aesthetic sense of life, they value beauty in all its forms, they are aesthetically concerned with self-expression and self-revelation in the general nature of their lifestyle. If they are given to art, they can be profound, peculiar and novel. Because of the drama of the character, they can be good actors. They seek to give everything an artistic and special touch. They are among the people who investigate and investigate the most in personal growth. They have an interest in finding ways out of the neurotic. Due to the experience of dissatisfaction and relational problems, they are usually well predisposed to therapies. When they find a bond of trust, respect, and affection, they can commit and respond positively to treatment.

Intellectual:

Among the E4 subtypes, the sexual is sometimes highly intellectualized. This is revealed in his aspirations, his inclination to knowledge, to study, to research the most varied subjects, but above all humanistic and philosophical. They love to read and be informed, and, in many cases, they are strongly involved in social or political commitment and commitment. In his stubborn non-conformism, passion for criticism, rebellion against the system, they define him as a revolutionary, although the ideals of justice for which he fights may be based on a very personalized perception of reality that refers to his need. to compensate for his feeling of injustice.

5. EMOTIONALITY AND FANTASY

By Cristina Nadal And Cristina Dicuzzo

The sexual E4 resorts to fantasy as a defense mechanism against what he usually experiences as boredom. The latter is a pervasive theme in this subtype. They have great difficulty living with the ordinary aspect of life, especially because they feel that this normality does not allow them to feel “special and different”.

What grace and intensity are there in the plain moments of everyday life? The answer is none. A simple, routine life has no meaning. There is a significant phobia regarding the routine. Faced with what is not different, the sexual E4 acts in a counterphobic way and rebels. In the story that follows we see an example:

“He worked in an office and had to come in at nine, like everyone else. Every morning, when I got to the subway entrance, I couldn't put the token in the grinder, I saw the crowd like obedient sheep, and I had to rebel every day. I waited for everyone to pass, I lost a meter or two, and when there was hardly anyone left, I put my token and passed. I was different. I don't like sheep because they have obedient faces and because they all pass by on the same side.”

Cristina Dicuzzo

Fantasy allows sexual E4 to get out of that nonsense and distances it excessively from reality and from the possibility of recognizing facts and concrete interactions, especially in conflict situations. Intense emotionality is sustained by fantasy. With the help of a fantasized thought, which often resembles a movie in which he is the protagonist, the sexual E4 can suddenly be in heaven or hell. You can cry the bitterest tears (which have a sweet, melancholy aftertaste) or visit paradise, where you reach the ultimate experience of total love (in the future, of course, always in the future).

“If I felt depressed, I would play music for the occasion, ending in drama. If, on the other hand, I felt euphoric, I put on the music that led to even more euphoria, all this alone at home and sometimes imagining that someone was looking at me, the important thing was to feel that I was alive and not feel the boredom of everyday life.”

Cristina Dicuzzo

The fantasy is related to a lacking past and present and a future in which love will finally arrive, love as a couple, erotic love that in turn will represent and fulfill the functions of a good mother and father who can provide unconditional love. They will discover that he is not bad, they will recognize him and make his life easier, they will give him everything or they will give him back what belongs to him: the lost throne that was unjustly taken from him. Let us not forget that in this subtype there appears a strong sense of kingship that was early and unjustly usurped.

In my youth I remember many times when I imagined situations and it was that imagination that gave me drive and strength to continue living. The future would be better, love would come, above all. In some secret place there was someone who would discover me, and it was by and for that someone for whom I cooked, got ready, kept the house in order, etc. When I moved away from that fantasy, I could enter periods of disorder, personal carelessness, etc. I remember once in a great sadness or melancholy and spending days going out on the street looking like a real mess praying that no person, I know would see me.

One difference between the type of intensity of the sexual E4 and the E8 is that in the E8 the search for intensity is more about the visceral and the concrete and is less related to fantasy: "This has to be mine and it will be." ". The sexual E4 is impregnated with emotions to the point of feeling possessed by an emotion, while the E8 seeks sensory intensity. The E8 takes what it wants and the sexual E4 is satisfied with imagining that it comes to it out of its own merit. If you saw it, you wouldn't know what to do with it and perhaps you could only reject it: there is no internal reference to deserving what is good, therefore it is difficult for you to recognize and value it.

For example, fantasizing about some kind of platonic love, including eroticism and romance, may be enough to feed this need for emotional intensity. If that love goes from platonic to real, there may be a loss of interest in the much-desired object.

In childhood, the fantasy of being adopted or that one is not a child of the family and that is why they do not want him, that surely there are some good parents out there who are looking for him and that when they appear, life will appear wonderful. Even without resorting to adoption as a fantasy, there is usually a desire that someone will appear who will be better than the parents who have touched him and who will rescue him from the degraded and/or shameful environment in which he finds himself immersed. Statements like the following are common: "I console myself by inventing that my true life is somewhere else."

There is much waste of fantasy, which, in general, seems preferable to reality. This can lead to withdrawal and seclusion; and it is in that state in which you can live better, since there is more hope there than in taking reality as it is presented. The latter would require taking the responsibility to change it or accept it as it is. It is from this fantasy that the sexual E4 can develop, in some cases, a passion for reading, cinema, etc. That is, through a foreign world in which you can feel like the protagonist of numerous stories. Perhaps it is this facet that very likely fuels the creativity and artistry so characteristic of this subtype. In this sense, they tend to have a predilection for certain types of movies and music that evoke melancholic states and to which they can resort exclusively to cry.

I was a teenager and I saw a movie in the cinema that moved me so much, it was tragic, she died, and he was devastated. In the cinema I couldn't cry because I was embarrassed to be seen. After a while they put it on TV, I locked myself in my room and just when the title appeared I started crying and I never stopped until it was over.

Within the fantasy aspect there is the catastrophic and dramatic tendency characteristic of this enneatype. In the case of the sexual subtype, we have verified the presence of catastrophic thoughts, of the type that some misfortune will happen to someone very dear and close, thoughts that can plunge the individual into an intense and real emotional state as if it had really happened. That is, you can reach a degree of pain and despair in which you no longer know why you are crying. However, this trend is shared by the other E4 subtypes. What characterizes the sexual is the intensely dramatic externalization of feelings.

As mentioned, the E4 has a passion for discussion and verbal confrontation. On some occasions, this happens at an imaginative level, with long internal conversations with the other (his enemy at the time), with great detail and reactions. In general, sexual Fours allow themselves to visualize defeating their adversary in the most dignified way. Only when he ponders the victim attitude does he let the opponent win in his fantasy, that's when everyone cries for him and with that he calms down. Vengeful, elaborate, sadistic, violent and all kinds of fantasies have also been observed, which in general are not carried out, or at least not in the specific way that is fantasized, but it can be specified in attacks and with explicit conflicts, or manipulation to lop off heads or to create hostile environments.

It can be deduced from what has been described that, although it belongs to the triad of emotional enneatypes, there is in this subtype a great deal of mental activity, which feeds emotionality, from which it turns out that true emotion is not really such, that it has a good invention and inflation component. For this reason, it is important to consider the management of emotions. The sexual E4 cannot bear to feel pain, because it leads him to a state of fragility and frustration that he cannot allow himself and that makes him feel tremendously vulnerable and inferior, dependent on someone he does not trust, for which he responds immediately with rage as defense, reaction and attack that, that makes him feel strong, especially in the eyes of others, who will not be able to cause him more pain. The rage that he sets in motion is a powerful motor that he has lubricated and that, if not channeled, overflows and turns into hate, a remarkably intense hate to which he in turn becomes addicted, and that returns the charge that you need to feel temporarily potent and falsely satisfied. A feedback loop that leaves no energy to go the other way. Any source of dissatisfaction in this subtype has been set as foreign to it, with the consequent outward hostility expressed in rage, which, transformed into hatred, has the purpose of destroying the object of desire or frustrating object. Through the fantasy of destruction, E4 contains part of the anguish in exchange for feelings of ambivalence and guilt.

The memory of experiences of helplessness of the E4 and the awareness of its dependence have created mechanisms to contain the anguish of frustrating experiences with unmet needs. These two unpleasant states do not allow access to loving feelings, such as tenderness towards oneself or towards the outside. And the energy used in the demand is perceived as worthless, devaluing himself, which he despises victimhood and the crying that he sees as an expression of weakness that would lead him to feel defenseless again and, in any case, without aid. This situation creates anger against himself for being perceived as the source of his tension, his frustration and his inability to satisfy himself. The source of dissatisfaction with hostility will also be directed outward, remaining trapped in the problem of feeling that he needs help from someone who wants to destroy because he does not give it to him. Thus, the sexual E4 turns hate into a centripetal and centrifugal denial of love.

Detecting needs causes displeasure. In this way, the sexual E4 is de-energized, causing a feeling of emptiness and chronic lack, unable to retain energizing stimuli from the outside, there is a constant voracious demand that is not satisfied. The difficulty in retaining what you receive is the basis of envy. With the pleasure that comes from not being able to give yourself permission to feel deprived, because if others see me as I really am, they will not love me, I will not be worthy. This conviction goes hand in hand with an aristocratic attitude, a strong ambition, and a desire to stand out, to be special and successful. All this structure does not allow neither the crying nor the victimization that he considers demeaning, it is not up to his standards.

The sexual E4 is further removed from his true emotions than he imagines; this distance is usually addressed through a process of personal introspection and is not easy to recognize.

6. CHILDHOOD

By Christina Nadal and Christina Dicuzzo

Abandonment Childhoods have been observed where the main characteristic in people who develop this subtype has been abandonment, which may be real (by one or both parents, due to premature death of one of them, due to disappearance, and also due to abandonment in orphanages or in the hands of other relatives) or it can be an emotional abandonment that includes neglect on the part of the mother. Many people with this character describe their own mothers as very labile or fickle, emotionally or psychically. In general, they have been children who have not developed trust and stability in the love relationship.

This abandonment, as almost always in childhood fantasy, has happened because the child has done "something bad" or, worse still, because simply "he is bad."

My childhood wound is the abandonment I felt when my mother died, I was three years old. They told me that she had gone to heaven, they didn't let me see her dead. I thought she's gone and left me; she doesn't love me. What had I done to her? I must have been bad.

After the death of my mother, we were already ten siblings. My father put me in an orphanage of nuns. I experienced it as another abandonment, again the feeling that I am too bad for everyone to abandon me.

In not so extreme cases, and when the family situation is more normalized, there is usually tremendous jealousy towards a sibling who has been perceived as the parents' favourite, either due to illness or for being nicer, or smarter, or more handsome, or adapted". The experience is usually that there is another who is better, who can never be surpassed in terms of affection and attention or consideration.

Words from parents such as "this child is unbearable, I don't know what we are going to do with him/her, there is no one who can stand him/her. There are also usually comparative comments with that brother or sister who is much calmer, understanding, good, etc.

Before my arrival, being the first, my father was waiting for the boy, therefore I was a disappointment for him. In my case, my brother is only thirteen months younger than me, so my mother gets pregnant when I am barely five months old. For me, this is the moment of losing the throne. To this we must also add a problem with breastfeeding, since due to the pregnancy my breast was withdrawn abruptly. I sucked "bad milk" or bad milk (apparently, my mother discovered or confirmed her pregnancy when I began to feel bad and, taking me to the doctor, told her that the problem was her milk, that she no longer fed me for the pregnancy). In other words, because of my brother I lost paradise.

Cristina Dicuzzo

There have been many cases of this subtype who have had negative experiences with breastfeeding, they have literally expressed having “drunk bad milk” from their mother, even in a literal sense.

Shortly after birth, my mother got an infection in her breast. The first three months were spent between life and death, and I was narrowly saved thanks to the recently invented penicillin. I often wondered which of the two was responsible for the poisoning: her for being careless, or I for having bitten her. I was left with the bad feeling that I had damaged it.

There is a lot of difficulty in remembering the happy part of childhood. The generalized experience is that both childhood and adolescence are stages that a sexual E4 would not want to relive. Even when in adulthood it is discovered that there have been good times, the memory does not arrive associated with emotion, but as a confirmation. These moments are known because they appear reflected in photographs, because a family member has reminded them, or because the person has recovered them in some regression work, but with great difficulty in feeling and validating them. What remains associated with the emotion are the moments of suffering, of rejection, of pain, as if there were a specialization in that.

The E4 sexual child/adolescent usually feels very ashamed of his family or one of its members, living this aspect as a disgrace and even as an injustice, envying the families of his friends, in which the parents are inevitably better than his, or simply because the others have parents and he/she does not.

“In short, I don't remember a happy childhood, I always harbored the hope that when I got older things would get better and all those people from the slum, who didn't understand me, would be gone. Adolescence was not a very satisfactory stage either, everything was complicated by the issue of sex.”

Juan Leon

I know I was ashamed of them (of my parents), of what the neighbors were going to think of us.

Father, Mother and Lies:

Another recurring aspect is that of terror and fascination towards the father figure. A figure that is generally feared and desired, that seduces and rejects. Perhaps this is the context in which the sexual E4 learns to love what he hates most, to hate what he most desires, and to fight to be accepted by the person he feels most rejects him. These statements are representative of it:

At the same time, I develop a contradictory feeling regarding the violence and my father: terror and fascination. Dad passes without transition from being the most tender to the most implacable of parents. In his presence hangs in the air the threat that he may be displeased.

My father was very tyrannical in his youth and family life revolved around him, his reality, and his needs. I have never seen a need of my mother take precedence over one of his.

During my childhood, life at home revolves around the figure of my father, his work in the theatre, and the unappealable decisions he makes regarding us. Dad oversees everything, even in the domestic sphere, and mom, who reveres him, submits.

It is also observed that in childhood there is usually a family air of lies, that somewhere there is a hidden truth that the sexual E4 child or adolescent feels called to unearth.

I grew up not knowing which was the truth and which was the lie. In my case, I am the daughter of an E7 father and an E3 mother, which created a fantasy environment that everything was perfectly fine, while I smelled like shit all the time, but the weird one was me. After time I discovered that my grandmother was not my grandmother.

I never know what is true and what is false among so much drama, because they reconcile with the same impetus with which they have begun to quarrel, between laughter and affection, as if nothing had happened when witnessing the brawls between them; I cry, and they console me by telling me it was a joke.

The sexual E4 boy or girl is usually shy and introverted when facing the outside world and with strangers, and self-exclusion or isolation is easier for him or her; He can be jealous and short-tempered with those close to him and especially with the closest ones (parents and siblings).

I was a savage who hid under the table when I didn't like the visitors, or when I didn't want them to leave. Before my attacks of hysteria, they once put my head under the cold water tap to get me out of the drowning that I caused myself.

In the more generalized case that the mother remains by the child's side, although emotionally absent, a strong feeling of abandonment is created that cannot be verified, since the mother is physically there providing care and attention. However, the falsehood is noticeable; this is experienced with great intensity and, with it, the sexual E4 learns to claim, as a desperate way of attracting the attention of the absent figure although physically present. Such a situation provides a significant dose of mistrust, bewilderment and despair that remains throughout life and is usually an aspect that, if chosen, provides intense personal work.

"I was a very dramatic girl who got my mother into difficult situations. I had many fantasies of abandonment and violence. If my mother went shopping, I would stage a scene of abandonment, go out into the street to scream, and cry and drag my brother to do the same; I have amazing dinners on this. Yelling at my mother not to hit me, me alone in the garden, and my mother inside, asking me to please stop, causing the neighbours to worry that my mother was mistreating me, until they looked out of the garden and, seeing the scene they couldn't believe it (my mother never hit me). But my fantasy was huge, I really saw the drama".

Cristina Dicuzzo

It has been observed in quite a few people of this subtype that anger appears as an element generally inherited from the mother, either because she expressed it easily, or because she swallowed it, consciously or unconsciously pouring it out on the child. The child learns, in this case, to despise that overly dramatic or overly submissive mother.

“In my personal work with therapy, I have come into contact with my mother's enormous rage, which I never saw manifest openly -I only remember that she bit her lips and clenched her mouth)-, and I have felt as if I had been the repository of that rage of hers and the one in charge of spreading it, of declaring it. It has cost me a lot to disidentify myself from that role and to be able to find within myself the right to be calm with the life that I have.”

Cristina Dicuzzo

It is probably due to the physical or emotional absence of the mother that the sexual E4 has a clear boundary problem. If the mother is neither physically nor emotionally present, what has been the child's formation in terms of loving limits? Probably, the way out he finds is to skip them, especially to attract attention, albeit negatively, to give himself the privileges that have been taken away from him, and to take power over the other and over life itself.

7. PERSON AND SHADOW: WHAT IS DESTRUCTIVE FOR THEMSELVES AND FOR OTHERS

By Juan León, Cristina Dicuzzo and Rossana Pavoni Gallo

Sexual E4s tend to establish intense links of dependency through the hostile components of the aggressive impulse, especially hate, since the unconscious experience that was processed and encoded is that any attempt at gratification provokes frustration and that it lacks essential value. Originally, the satisfaction of their needs was perceived as lacking in tender content, unsatisfying and not very nutritious: a state of emotional abandonment, mobilizing hostility. Naturally, his impulse will be distorted, oriented to the destruction of what, real or imaginary, causes him more frustration, thus preventing any possibility of gratification. Sexual Fours have more aggressive energy available to them, which is why they can be annoying and harmful, hateful. In this way, feeling that he has the right to be gratified and the fact that his sensation of lack is permanent, leads him to demand hostile and inappropriate demands, and even in the case of being satisfied, he cannot be linked with a tender identity, so it degrades their satisfaction and who provides it, perpetuating dissatisfaction. It is very difficult for you to establish and maintain tender and positive sustainable bonds, because he could not have them with himself. The dynamics of this structure predispose him to self-degradation and to relationships that degrade, with contacts in a state of handicap from which he constantly compares himself. "I was not good for myself nor for my mother, nor will I be able to be for others, nor will they have anything good from me; what I received from me, and my mom was insufficient and unpleasant, like what I will receive. Others enjoy and have, I do not". A mechanism of denial and projection of hostile aggressive impulses takes part in this dynamic.

With this childhood experience, he perpetuates an adult attitude that harms others in addition to having a negative impact on them, with different ways of manifesting himself.

Such a perception of oneself and of others crystallizes envious feelings towards the well-being of others, not of material goods, but of the capacity that they attribute to "being able to be happy and have everything. How do you handle the feeling of lack, together with a distorted and unpleasant sensitive and sensory perception of oneself, feeling bad for himself and then with the mother and the world, envy is expressed through rage, hidden through it, and reacts to persistent frustration by generating hostile impulses destructive also with the outside, because the world does not satisfy him. From the polarity "I need, or I want" and "I don't deserve or be rejected", he moves on to the degradation that arises when he tries to obtain gratifications: "I don't deserve what they give me, so what they give me and whoever gives me gives it are worth nothing. This perpetuates the inadequacy of asking. Instead of admitting the envy, he reacts by disqualifying and attacking what he envies so that the envy disappears. Envy is magnified with the sexual instinct and sometimes becomes unsustainable: any object of envy can be the focus of hatred, and the reaction to it is destruction. "If I can't have it, neither can you." In addition to envy, they hide need, emptiness, and shame.

You can feel great love and admiration for someone, but any little action can turn it into rejection minutes later.

When guilt turns into depression, the sexual E4 disconnects from their relationships, becomes highly reactive, and pushes others away, sometimes rudely, ahead of the rejection they think they will receive.

The difficulty in feeling loved brings into play the invalidity of the other and one's own; the E4 denigrates those with whom it associates. "If you love or appreciate me and I'm worthless, then what kind of person are you? If you cheat on me, it is because your need is like mine, then you are like me, or worse, you are of no use to me". For those who cannot conceive of being loved, love, appreciation and acknowledgment are never perfect, romantic, intense enough to satisfy and recognize each other. The other is constantly discouraged, he is never enough. That hurts them and exhausts those who are by their side since it greatly frustrates the impossibility of being accepted for who they are.

By hiding tenderness and shortcomings, he shows himself to be arrogant and self-sufficient by compensatory contrast, which sometimes means not respecting the other; This is evident when he becomes self-referential, he looks at his navel, he gives himself over to his ills, which are the worst in the world, and he leaves out, rejects or forgets many people around him.

Despite the sensitivity and knowledge of suffering, when he cannot avoid the endless emptiness in which he feels himself sinking, he becomes selfish, and others, who may need him at that moment, take a back seat. You can be detached, uninterested, cold, busy, unaware of the feelings and needs of those around you.

Mistrust, at times, can also show through, even when trying to maintain good manners, which can also be offensive. No one can save him from the precipice because of how special he feels, or yes: only a fantastic non-existent being that leaves the other common mortals with the feeling of being useless despite their efforts.

It is difficult for him to be sweet and loving. Tenderness not received at the right time, in its proper form, has set in, dumbing him down and convincing him that it will be very difficult to receive it, since he cannot risk feeling disappointed and rejected. Sweetness is not a spontaneous feeling in the sexual E4, since it is not easily accessed; He even feels it as a weakness that has caused him pain.

He especially hides the fear of rejection, which he cannot feel or show. He denies being dependent and becomes counter dependent, displaying an elaborate and false independence that alienates and penalizes those close to him; he feels invaded, afraid of being discovered, and rejects closeness that he later cannot bear.

He is so susceptible to being hurt or frustrated that he prefers to anticipate the situation by hurting or frustrating. He does not allow himself to ask openly and is ashamed of the desire, for what it demands pretending not to pretend. He's a good emotional blackmailer.

He does not declare his authentic pain, despite the complaint of his pains, which are an indefinite list of shortcomings, sometimes unreal or inflated and that serve to cover a single and great pain that he cannot declare: not having felt loved. nor attended. Accepting him would turn him into his fantasy, into a defenceless being that nobody wants because he is heavy, cumbersome, burdensome. That wound cannot be revived, even if it is always open.

As life is a battle, it is destructive, with a competitiveness that permeates all areas of its existence; From the position of someone who feels worth little, he focuses on losing, defeating, and humiliating the other, invalidating and despising, devaluing what he does not have to win the battle. He is unable to enjoy his successes without degrading the achievements of others, which is a non-success: "If I win over something that has no value, what is my gain worth?"

The sexual E4 have greater facility to establish sadomasochistic relationships and, more often than the rest of the envious, they may be victims of physical and psychological abuse. As adults, they repeat the affective bond characterized by the mistreatment they have experienced as children, either repeating the condition of victim or aspiring to be seen, or in the role of abuser as a form of revenge; we have hard skin in the face of abuse, we know how to do it with ourselves and with others.

A shadow of the sexual E4 perhaps little explained is depression, from which it flees like a viper before the cross, but as a shadow it always accompanies it, in a latent or present state. In this childhood, depressive attitudes were supported with the intention that the child entertain himself and appease himself, and aggressive attitudes or expressions of needs were frustrated with the threat of affective withdrawal, to contain his request for attention. The impulse to survive and avoid unpleasantness leads the creature to continue asking until exhaustion, since the satisfaction of the need has not arrived, nor has it been lasting and repeated. Their efforts are useless, and they fall into energetic depression, to which is added emotional depression, the psychopathological core of the character. Depression and its variations in your dysphoria form the basis of the attitude with which you will relate to yourself and to life. The tristizia (sadness) that Evagrius Ponticus named has been replaced and is a precursor as the basic emotion of envy. They are associated with depression as a feeling of worthlessness that cannot but be a sad feeling. And when it is not passive, it leads to self-destructive and self-defeating attitudes. Melanie Klein explains envy as a kind of original sin, an evil that comes down to us genealogically and phylogenetically, an aspect of a death instinct inseparable from our nature.

In its polarity, the sexual E4 when it is in its euphoric phase hides envy and in the depressive phase it hides itself, to lick its wounds alone and not be stigmatized. They feel like a bluff, a lie, depression chases him and does not leave him, even though he uses a lot of energy to evade it, except when it defeats him and he has to take refuge, because it is impossible for him to get out of the black hole that swallows him.

Depression is experienced as stagnant energy, especially when one does not allow oneself to set limits and remains in a drowning energy swamp. It is blocked and there is a tendency to repress and exclude, because it is not an emotion that is well seen.

In this subtype, addictive tendencies proliferate that are born from the basic addiction to hate as compensation for the lack of love, and to the feeling that nothing is enough for this perennial state of deficiency. The sexual E4 originates oral addictions, such as alcohol, psychotropic drugs, food, with the hope of quenching the disenchanted maternal thirst. Intensity, already an addictive behaviour, contributes to aggravating other dependencies.

As we have already seen, the sexual E4 has a good imaginative capacity, to which it is also addicted. Through autosuggestion, he develops elaborate revenge plans with desired events, and invests a lot of energy to replay them repeatedly in his mind to quench his thirst for justice/revenge. When he finally carries out his vindictive action, the subsequent feeling of guilt or remorse may appear in different degrees of intensity; it will depend on how offended the desire to take revenge has been. In the appearance of the feeling of guilt is where the difference with the form of revenge of the E8 is also appreciated, which does not usually feel guilty.

If we consider the person and the shadow as parts of a photographic development, we could see the person as the photo where the appearance is appreciated and the shadow as its negative, the hidden, the dark. In the photo of the sexual E4, strident colours predominate in his evident features. Soft or less vibrant tones, veiled and barely perceived, remain in the shadow. The sexual E4-in its distorted perception of tenderness, shame, fear, vulnerability, cowardice, fragility-hides traits that it considers inferior, succubus, monstrous. The separation and break within himself is created by not being able to accept and integrate these experiences, burying them, increasing the distance from his essence and from his scared and alone inner child. This little transparency and concealment are also deleterious in the interpersonal relationship due to his lack of tenderness, pleasure, love, serenity and spontaneity, elements that he avoids putting into play and exposing in his relationships. Paradoxically, what the sexual E4 considers monstrous and impossible to show is what would make him healthier if he allowed himself to take in oxygen, bring these characteristics to light, drawing a bridge with the rest of his traits that he generally exposes.

In the image that the sexual E4 projects of itself, the hostile components of its aggressive impulse are more expressed, such as rage, fits of rage, hatred, exhibitionism, counterphobia, transgression, vulgarity, drama, irreverence, contempt, complaining, promiscuity, addictions, megalomania, crazy spontaneity, just feeling. Speaking of her childhood fights between her parents and their later reconciliations, a woman of this subtype says, "That was my first bath of emotional intensity and where I accepted the message that those who really love each other fight loudly"

On the other hand, the components of the tender impulse, contributed by the integration of the maternal sphere, are barely expressed, and also devalued and repressed. We can hear: "I have been forced to be attractive and intelligent, but not good". Or: "I didn't discover the pleasure of being helpful until I was twenty-seven years old, although with that I felt super false" These components have to do with contact with sweetness, modesty, tact, the ability to respect and respect oneself, the gentleness, recognition of personal dignity, the need for love, fragility, self-confidence, acceptance of limits, dedication, moderation, calm, tenderness, generosity, listening, appreciation, prudence.

What I was most ashamed of was expressing the love and the vulnerability, the softness, the subtlety, despite being very emotional and vulnerable. JUAN LION

By gradually incorporating the capacities of the order of tenderness, by letting them express themselves, the excess of aggressive impulse turned against itself and projected on the other, dominant in the ill sexual E4, is balanced, which stops much of the tender impulse, which is released gradually, as if an alchemical process were produced by balancing these two forces.

From a proud and vain appearance, I have disguised envy; I didn't need anything from anyone, and thus I didn't show my most vulnerable and needy part. It is something that cost me a lot, it meant showing how bad and ugly it was. When I am most authentic, it is when my vulnerability becomes tenderness, without judging me, that is when I find peace.

What can really dazzle and positively engage us is to begin to recognize our ability to love, hold and confront with gentleness and humour. This subtype, like the other envious ones, have an enormous ability to empathize. It's not like wolves are going to turn into lambs. It must be considered that the sexual E4 devalues and does not admit in its expression the components of the tender impulse. This is a very deep aspect of his monster because it is seen as such when it shows its fragility, even if it is a subjective appreciation, it is when it is more balanced towards the outside, without losing its strength.

In my dream I was with my therapist, and my appearance was monstrous, nothing from the outside remembered my appearance, it was as if my interior was manifesting without being able to control or hide it. My therapist encouraged me to go out looking like this and go to my peers. I was totally terrified. I go towards them, and they greet me with all the naturalness in the world. So, I ask myself: do they not see my monster, or do they accept me as a monster too? In this dream I get to have my first complete experience of unconditional love.

Cristina Dicuzzo

8. LOVE

By Cristina Dicuzzo And Collaborators

With Testimonials from Teresa Cerullo

In love, the sexual E4 tends to display all its typical characteristics more spectacularly. The importance that he gives to the relationship and to the figure of the other is predominant in this subtype, the space where his self-esteem and his madness are at stake, in short, his passion. Many people of this subtype recognize that finding a partner has been the most important thing for them.

"In the love relationship, the egoic part emerges like never before, the one that demands, attacks, and despises. I hope the other makes me happy. The other can do anything, but for me it is never enough, something is always missing. If the other does not see me, does not pay attention to me, does not recognize me, in order not to feel small and unworthy, I despise him. Belittling, offending, denigrating, hurting is my specialty. "I attract his hands." Sometimes men have raised their hand to me and I, deep down, have understood them. I would have done it too with one like that. Even the mercantile attitude towards men and complacent sex: if I don't have sex, what can I give, what can be found in me? I give pleasure and maybe I receive love."

Teresa Cerullo

As has been repeated, the sexual E4 are very passionate and sexually active. Sexuality plays a predominant role in their relationships, since being sexually attractive to the other ensures their affection. There is a great concern and occupation in appearing appetizing, dedicating themselves to improving their appearance and the way they present themselves to the world. The sexual E4 needs to bring relationships to the field of sexuality, regardless of whether they really interest him or not.

In this sense, a person belonging to this subtype usually has many relationships throughout his life endowed with intense and magical moments in search of that love that will solve all his ills.

The sexual E4 has a great need to admire the object of desire. It seems that a stable relationship could not be established with anyone who is not admired, especially for something that the other has and that the sexual E4 feels that he lacks and believes that he cannot achieve on his own. Apparently, couples tend to be unconsciously chosen as true beacons that indicate what the person needs to develop on their own and believes that they must be provided by another. Perhaps the healing process is focused on achieving what is envied in the other and verifying that you can achieve it yourself or daring to face the frustration of not achieving it and taking responsibility for your achievements and failures.

"At a certain moment I start to see in the other only the neurotic aspects, without indulgence, or only the parts that I perceive as negative. This is because then I will be able to confirm to myself that I am unlovable except by a bad person."

Teresa Cerullo

Unfortunately, on many occasions he comes to glimpse this possibility when he has already managed to destroy the relationship, as if the strength came from the fact of feeling like a victim. There, attitudes are displayed such as: "I am going to show you, I am going to show myself, I am going to Show the world that I can." The important one is still the other.

I destroy the other because I will have a good reason to feel guilty, denigrate myself and then atone. I induce a feeling of guilt in the other as well, accusing him of exploitation: "I do all this for you, and you don't see it! You feel comfortable with me because I take care of you, I help you and I support you, but you never, not once...!". The role of the victim.

He usually finds people who he considers difficult especially attractive, because what is easy, plain, simple and above all, possible, is not interesting at all. He unconsciously searches for those who represent a challenge, who seem susceptible to being changed by the force of his love and who, especially, will change when they discover all that the sexual E4 believes he is worth, who in the end will choose him above all other things.

He needs to feel like the partner's favorite, to be the most important thing in the other's life, and at the same time, he has little awareness and ability to value what is positive that he receives. This is a very narcissistic aspect of which there is little awareness. You just take it for granted that this is how it should be in a relationship. As if in this way he sought the gaze of the physically or emotionally absent father and/or mother or could thus get out of the comparisons in which he has been disadvantaged. Then he establishes a struggle, generally not silent, to obtain the desired place in the life of the other, maintaining the eternal position of the misunderstood adolescent.

Could my stutter represent difficulty speaking for fear of saying the wrong things and being scolded? Or was it to get the attention of my parents?

In a love relationship I always feel second to someone or something (my mother and father, my mother and my brother). When I don't feel seen or considered, the pain disguises itself as anger that I throw towards the other. I demand your attention, I want to be me first and foremost, even if that's the case outside, I would not stand it because I would feel suffocated. My mother told me that when I was in the cradle she rocked me with her foot while she knitted with her hands and I rebelled yelling at her that I had to rock with both hands! I wanted all the attention and love for me.

"There is difficulty in growing. A compulsion to remain in an emotional state typical of my childhood experiences. How difficult it is to recognize the distance between the present and the past. How much my neurosis is deleterious. Wanting to stay in that painful state as if it couldn't be anything else. Wanting to seek confirmation of the refusal received as a daughter. A pain that I know and in which I wallow, as if it were difficult for me to live a state of well-being to which I am not accustomed because I do not allow it. Being in pleasure I experience as a sin. As a child, my expressions of joy have always been blocked, experienced by my mother, above all, as frivolous, and therefore worthy of contempt."

Teresa Cerullo

From the place of lack and of little internal value, it has a great orientation to always recognize what it lacks. even if this is a tiny detail during great displays of love from the other. It is as if, in front of an infinitely beautiful sample, he was specialized in detecting the only defective point, he focused on it and it seems that it is the only thing he sees, the only thing that reaches him, that small defect that prevents him from fully enjoying the beauty. that he has before him.

This is common to all E4 subtypes. What differentiates the sexual is the way he reacts to it: he reacts by being openly and shamelessly aggressive, demanding what he feels is given with a wide range of verbal aggression focused on what he does not lack, on how unhappy that makes him, probably ensuring that his happiness depends on obtaining it.

Share with the E4 conservation/tenacious subtype the following position in relation to the desired other: "You are God when I don't have you, the devil when you leave me and a nuisance when you are. Come, I'm going to crush you."

There is no awareness, as long as a process of introspection and self-knowledge is not undertaken, that even if what he claims was given to him, he would surely go on to detect some other missing detail, and so on to infinity. He does not take charge of the internal hole, the emotional bottomless sac forged in his lacking childhood, which no one can fill more than himself, accepting that a part of that emptiness will accompany him for life and that he must take care of it without projecting it towards the outside.

"When my suffering is not understood, the feeling of emptiness I feel is so deep that I have to fill it with hate, but more than hate I feel anger for the other. I suffer without thinking about the pain I cause, without thinking about the consequences it can bring, as if they really left me and I was alone. And when I am abandoned, I enter despair. It is here that I see the other as the most wonderful person in the world and whom I have lost! Like crocodiles that eat their children and then cry. So, cover my head with ashes and ask for forgiveness. And then, because I've lowered myself, I feel vulnerable and in danger again, so the merry-go-round starts all over again. It's exhausting and painful, as well as childish. I did this with my parents, I punished them by provoking and opposing them. I did everything to get them to abandon me and when this happened, I went into that feeling of cold loneliness and hot despair. But with them I never lowered myself to ask for forgiveness. At least I don't remember doing it."

Teresa Cerullo

The sexual E4 usually causes feelings of impotence in your partner that, if not detected in time, can plunge the other into a permanent feeling of guilt for not being enough. The couple may try to please their sexual E4 ad nauseam and then reject him, assuming that he has been castrated and rendered impotent. At that moment, the sexual E4 finds the portion of suffering where he knows how to handle himself from victimhood, blames himself for not being enough and asks for forgiveness, drags himself, etc. "When I am rejected, I am convinced that the other has seen how monstrous I am inside".

We could say without mistake that there is a vocation for the sadomasochistic, superior-inferior, rebellious-submissive game, which together with the desire to be an agent of change for the other with problems are ingredients that can facilitate this subtype to enter relationships of psychological and physical abuse.

The sexual E4 lends itself easily to relationships in which the struggle for power is present. Relationships that allow you to enjoy suffering, the necessary intensity that allows you to feel life with meaning, without boredom, with a challenge and that you will finally achieve it, even if you don't really know what.

“Sometime after dragging a professional and couple crisis that lasted for years, this is where I realized the masochistic and sadistic facet in which I was immersed. When things were going badly for me, I would get depressed and my masochistic self would appear, catastrophic thinking, apathy, irritability, hyper-suggestion, sadomasochistic sexuality, and when I was euphoric, I would take my sadist out for a walk, a very pronounced and automatic verbal sadism; with my partner it came to physical violence.”

Juan Leon

The sexual E4 is characterized by being in relationships of great emotional intensity, of fighting and reconciliation. In the fight he is aggressive, with a great command of verbal and stabbing aggression, as he knows how to detect the weakest area of the other and aim where it hurts the most. It is usually accurate and hurtful. Once you have made the other feel bad, you enter the spiral of guilt from where you try to solve or reverse the situation. If he succeeds, his thirst for intensity is quenched in a positive way, like a beast that calms down at the sight of its vanquished prey until the need to fight strikes again. If he does not succeed, he enters despair, guilt and victimhood typical of the abandoned and wounded, from where he can also display all his fury and resentment, feeling justified even to exercise just revenge for the insult suffered.

Infidelity is usually carried out as a vengeful act, not so much associated with one's own enjoyment but so that the couple finds out and suffers. What is pursued is that the other is punished. But there are also cases in which infidelity is not even lived with guilt, because feeling the constant lack, you need your search to not stop and if you do not feel that your partner completes you, you will search and find other people outside of the main relationship, as a right to be happy.

The Three Loves:

Among the E4 subtypes, the sexual subtype is the most erotic. That is to say, the one that has the most access to pleasure, although it can quickly disqualify or destroy it, since it does not support satisfaction and identifies with the lack. In fact, he is seductive and compared to the other E4s lives sexuality intensely and can overcome the shame and sense of inferiority he feels, even if he hides or represses it. It can be said that people with an E4 character who indulge in sexuality often seek to compensate for maternal love that has been lacking or harmful.

"With reference to playful situations, my expressions of joy have always been mortified and I experience pleasure with guilt. In a love relationship, in order to abandon myself and feel pleasure, I have to feel that I love and that I am loved. However, I must say that I have used sex to attract men. As I have always felt unworthy of love, when a man has been interested in me I have always thought: "if I don't give him sex, what am I going to give him? What can you find in me? If I give pleasure, it stays." So, my attitude was mercantile. I give pleasure and maybe I get love."

Teresa Cerullo

Compassionate love is in all the E4s: taking care of the other, suffering for the other. It is recognized in the intense sensitivity, although it is not always materialized with effective care actions, as in the case of the conservation subtype. The sexual E4 does not know how to suffer much or strive to care. But they can be "animal" protectors in case their lives are in danger. It belongs to all of E4 to charge for giving so much to the other; but in the sexual E4, as we have already seen, he charges demanding that he returns what he has given, with an aggressive claim.

"Perhaps compassionate love has it a little more developed. I am an empathetic, maternal, generally affectionate person. Also with my partner, I like being a mother, caring. But all this must be recognized, otherwise, more than a mother, I become a bad stepmother. This thought horrifies me."

Teresa Cerullo

The E4 admires in the sense that he sees the other as someone who has what he lacks. It is an envious admiration that turns into contempt; the sexual subtype finds it difficult to admire, better to say that it idealizes, especially in the couple, and very easily destroys it because it is disappointed when the other appears with its limits. This subtype is also very sensitive to social issues of injustice and can be very involved in battles for equality or the defense of the excluded and most needy. It can be a person passionately dedicated to the rescue of those who suffer; In this sense, he has a strong admiration for the values of solidarity and collaboration.

Admiring love is what I lack the most. It is not easy for me to admire someone. In order for him to do so, he must have characteristics such as honesty, a sense of justice, superior intelligence, and a big heart. A special person, like Claudio Naranjo. I can't stand bosses, who are often unworthy of their position and for whom I feel respect and contempt at the same time.

"In the couple, it is essential that you feel admiration to be able to love the other, although then I do nothing more than denigrate him. If you don't see me, you don't listen to me, you don't recognize me, I despise you. I have to feel the partner is superior to me, but at the same time this is an obstacle to me, and I have to prove that it is not, so as not to feel small and unworthy. Here begins the fight for supremacy. Belittling, offending, hurting is my specialty".

Teresa Cerullo

9. HISTORICAL PERSONS: MARQUÉS DE SADE, SAN AGUSTÍN AND FRANCISCO DE GOYA Y MARQUIS DE SADE

By Vanessa Dorotea

A writer and philosopher, influenced by La Mettrie and Rousseau, he made a private commitment to himself, fought for his right to be what he was, and tried to show in his works that even such an extremely immoral creature could become representative of a different moral system, provided it derived from the true nature of man. This is how Sade formulates the popular maxim of the return to nature, to the instincts. Natural rights correspond to the natural man, and the greatest is freedom. There is nothing more beautiful and greater than sex, and there is no healing without sex. He felt masochistic or sadistic and, with such polarity, everything led to satisfaction and liberation.

Its mythical genre points to the animal that we carry inside and to the extraordinary role of intelligence in the service of that animal. He was not crazy, as they were led to believe, but reasoned differently. His muse was hate, but he carried the inheritance of the light of love linked to Petrarch. His ancestor, the Marquis Hugo de Sade, married Laura de Noves in the fourteenth century, who achieved immortality by inspiring tormented and yearning sonnets by Petrarch. Sade took care of the memory of Laura, who raised a large family and died young. She appeared to him in dreams and consoled him, and this sounds sentimental in someone who "would have turned off the Sun so as not to give light to humanity", with a bold streak of hatred for the world.

Donatien Alphonse François de Sade was born on June 2, 1740 in Paris, and was baptized in Saint-Sulpice by two servants, the only ones present, who had forgotten his name. His genealogy dates to the 14th century. The father was a marshal, plenipotentiary minister in foreign courts and governor in four provinces; His marriage to Marie Eleonore de Maillé de Carman related him to the powerful families of Count Bourbon and Richelieu, thus he spent his childhood in the castle of Condé.

Joined by my mother to the Monarchy, I participated, through my father, in the distinguished that counted the province of Languedoc; in abundance and luxury, I imagined that nature and destiny were allied to fill me with gifts; I believed it because they were so foolish to assure me, and this ridiculous presumption made me arrogant, despotic and irascible; I thought that everything should submit to me, that everyone had whims and that I was the only one with the right to have and satisfy.

An example illustrates that dangerous thought nurtured in me: I was born and lived in the prince's palace, to whose family my mother belonged. He was my age. They brought me closer to him so that I could ask for protection at any time. One day, playing, I got angry because he wanted to take something from me and he felt entitled, for being superior. I responded with beatings; nothing stopped me and they had to separate us. (Story of Aline and Valcour).

At the age of four, without yet knowing his father, he travelled to the house of his grandmother Louise Aldonse, in Avignon. "They sent me to my grandmother's house, whose blind tenderness fed me all kinds of vices." His mother travelled with her husband on business, and he stayed for a year with his grandmother and some aunts who pampered the beautiful boy and gave him mischief. When they decided that he needed an educator, they chose a relative, the abbé and writer Jacques de Sade, a friend of Voltaire, with a

frivolous and worldly life. The forty-year-old abbe educated his nephew from the age of five to ten. It is said that the uncle's libertine personality had a negative influence on the boy. For ten years, he went to the Louise-le-Grand Jesuit College with Abbot Amblet, from six in the morning to nine at night. During the boarding school he saw little of his father and from 1760 almost not at all of his mother, who retired in a Carmelite convent, which speaks to us of a family lack. At the age of fourteen, he dropped out of school on his father's orders and went to Versailles, to the cavalry academy of the royal guard. His father wanted for his only son -two others had died after being born- to have a military career; the family patrimony diminished greatly due to bad administration. Two years later, Sade went to Germany, to the Seven Years' War, as a cavalry captain; in his military years, his wildlife of pleasure frightened his father. He lost large sums of money gambling. In his novel "History of Aline and Valcour", he writes: "War broke out. training. While others went to school, I was with my regiment. My family, attentive to my service in the Army, did not let me finish my mission. I assure you I was brave. My innate impetuousness, the soul, the fire that nature granted me was associated with an indomitable virtue, bravery, unfairly highly valued among soldiers, along with intrepidity and impetus. When my regiment was destroyed, we were sent back to the barracks." This phase, morally, had very destructive consequences.

In 1763 he returned to his parental home in Paris and led an unbridled life of pleasures, gambling debts and honours. A regular customer of the boudoirs, he did not consider it necessary to pay his respects to the king. Sade avoided his father, misanthropic and full of reproaches, and aggravated the family finances with debts. The father considers marriage the only salvation for his son. But Sade wanted to marry Laure de Lauris, with whom he was in love. The marquis loved four times in his life passionately and without sadism, one of his contradictions. His beloved had given her heart to another man, and he writes to her:

You will certainly have judged the feelings of my heart towards yours. Vain reason, dictated by falsehood, ungrateful impostor. She fears joining someone who adores her. The links of a persistent chain are only a burden to you, and your heart susceptible to inconstancy and frivolity, was not delicate enough to recognize its charm. My love was not enough for her. Huge, born to make you unhappy. May the unhappiness of the traitor who has taken my place in your heart make love appear to you one day as hateful as you have made infidelity in my eyes. But what do I say? Ah, beloved friend, divine friend! Only content of my heart, only delight of my life, where does my despair take me! Forgive the words of an unhappy man out of his mind, whose only goal is death once he has lost what he loves. Who can bind me to the life whose only happiness is you? I lose you, I lose my life, I die the cruellest death, I am dazed, dear friend, I am no longer in my right mind, tears flow, I see through a cloud. Only to you longing and desire! I only think of you!

The chosen one was Renée-Pélagie de Montreuil, daughter of the president of the court of appeals and of a resolute and intelligent woman called the President. The Sade family was completely ruined, and the father borrowed money for the suits and the carriage. Before the ceremony, rumours reached Mme. Montreuil about his future son-in-law. In 1763 it was a luxurious wedding. Since the honeymoon, Sade was spied on by Inspector Marais, who sent reports to his mother-in-law. The pimps sent girls to Sade, in addition to having meetings with dancers, actresses, and chorus girls. Sade did not let himself be seen in society nor did he associate with people of his condition. This introversion and suspicion aroused anger in Versailles society, which took it as contempt and lack of caste pride. The life he led was not well regarded on a social level and he was

imprisoned six months after his marriage. After fourteen days, his mother in-law manages to release him.

When he got out of jail, Renée was pregnant and then miscarried. She loved her husband despite his absences. He considered her cold and prudish. For two decades he gave himself totally to it and in humiliating circumstances he defended its interests unconditionally. Unlike her younger sister Julie, whom Sade would gladly have married, Renée was plain and heavy-set. She gave her husband three children.

After prison, he remains monogamous in his wife's family castle, allowing himself to be pampered and devoting himself to reading. In 1764 he travelled to Paris, where he had two passionate loves: Collete (an eighteen-year-old actress) and the beautiful Beauvoisin, who kept him in her net for two years.

In 1766 his father died. The relationship between the two had always been ceremonious and distant, as the father despised his disrespectful son, whose perverse character he considered incorrigible. In the nine years following the death of his father, and the disappointment in love with Beauvoisin, all the scandals took place that made the marquis the most soulless libertine in the kingdom. He took the liberty of exhausting his unbridled self and fulfilling his perverse desires and sadistic instincts.

In 1768, he brought a girl, Rose Keller, to his house in Arcueil, who later appeared battered saying that, threatened with death, she had fled from the house of the marquis, who had cruelly flogged her. His wife and mother-in-law get Rose Keller to drop the complaint in exchange for a sum of money. But he was arrested and went to prison, where he remained until November 1768. It was the first scandal, although it was already known that he flogged in brothels, something usual but hidden at that time.

He dedicated himself to writing theatre and in 1772, he represented his first play at the family castle. Theatrical ambition prevailed over writing. Having become a regular theatregoer, he knew the atmosphere, attended rehearsals, mastered dramatic declamation, and began directing his own plays. He would have to wait thirty years to achieve success as a theatre director. In 1769 he had his second son and in 1771 his third daughter. He lives in the family castle of La Coste, spending a lot of money on decoration, despite the financial difficulties that led him to jail for the third time, this time for his debts, showing a trace of irresponsibility. He invited the nobility every month for theatrical performances and balls.

His young sister-in-law, Ana Prospère, arrives at La Coste, who becomes the great love-passion of his life. He surrenders to it with blind sincerity, and the world defines him as a moral monster. He was capable of genuine love passion up to self-destruction (typical trait of sexual E4). He loved her more than she loved him, with great emotional intensity. There will be no scandals or other women until 1772, when he urgently leaves for Marseilles for money; There he meets with four young prostitutes to pass one of nine tails, as they did not reach the appropriate ardor (he wanted to make tomorrow happy. In addition to the whip they agreed to sodomy), he offered them cantharid chocolates, a substance to cause sexual arousal. They had to call the doctor, who submitted a report to the prosecutor. He was accused of attempted poisoning, but the girls withdrew the complaint in exchange for an indemnification. The arrest did not take place because Sade and his lackey fled. In 1772 both were sentenced to death for absenteeism. When he finds out that the police are looking for him in Marseille, he packs his bags and goes to the Italian border with his sister-in-law, who will not return to the castle for months.

By seducing Ana Prospère, single daughter of the powerful President, he turns her mother-in-law into his mortal enemy; She ordered him to be arrested in December 1772, asking that all of Sade's letters and writings be made available to her. In 1773 he fled from prison. The death of Louis XV and the change of throne benefited the marquis for a while, and no one cared about him. until a new scandal with fifteen-year-olds hired with the excuse of a job that included the sexual bacchanalia of the marquis. Added to Sade's potent sexual desire was intellectual curiosity, the urge to investigate everything. He was an intelligent and strong monster in personal analysis and in his own observation during his excesses. After giving in to the irresistible inclinations of sadism, he was capable of leading the life of a nobleman, withdrawn and devoted to family and reading. It represents very well the intellectual part of the character, the capacity for a deep analysis of himself and the double life.

In 1775, at the age of 35, he received the news that his mother-in-law had obtained a new arrest warrant. Flee again to Italy. In 1777 his mother died. Sade had felt little affection for her since his youth because she was coldly indifferent, as with her father, with few courtesy visits: a relationship devoid of love and total distance, where the traits of lack of love and tenderness are evident in the childhood.

He travelled to Paris and was arrested with a letter of cachet signed by Louis XVI. Frightened, he enters the dreaded Vincennes prison, which was a kind of security internment for an incorrigible prominent man. He enjoyed privileges in the dungeon, decorated it and supplied himself. In 1778, the king ordered the review of the case, the previous sentence was annulled and in an urgent procedure the marquis was only imposed a small fine and a reprimand by the court for excessive disorder. They arrest him again because his mother-in-law would not leave her hated son-in-law alone, he flees again and commits a new imprudence. He is arrested and imprisoned in Vincennes, in a cell worse than the previous one, with almost no light. He writes letters to his wife for twelve years until he understands that the purpose is not to allow him to be free again. At the age of forty he is consumed by sexual desires and loses his reason.

He is a very annoying, quarrelsome and rowdy prisoner, as well as capricious and surprising. One day he's sweet and polite, and the next he's insulting everyone (traits: lunatic mood swings, love/hate polarity, doesn't connect with his pain, aggressive). His wife suffers from these changes, he attacks her when she does not follow his instructions and requests, despite complying with his orders (Traits: permanent dissatisfaction, abuse). He offends her by letter and insults her when she visits him, with jealousy, suspicion, and hatred for being the daughter of the one guilty of his fatality (Traits: attacks to defend himself, hidden insecurity, projects his hatred).

In Vincennes he could not go too far, so in 1780 Sade began to write. He read and wrote a lot, away from the world and women, creating imaginary universes. His works were a confrontation between his inner world and the outer world, hated by a distorted morality, of which he felt like a victim. In the years of isolation, he wrote twelve volumes and journals. He was allowed to write with controls, confiscations, and prohibitions, so he made copies that he hid or gave to his wife on the sly when she visited him. He wrote to vent his instincts and abandon himself to his vices, without fearing persecution.

In 1781 he received the news of the death of his sister-in-law from smallpox. After four years, the marquise obtains permission to visit her in Vincennes. The scenes of jealousy were such that they denied him visits and correspondence. But she was the only one who loved him, and she had to make sure that this would continue to happen, even though he only felt a certain eroticism towards her. Sade had two sons and a daughter (of the only one known to have been an ugly and boring young woman, according to the chronicles). The children lived in their maternal grandmother's castle. At the end of 1783. Louis-Marie, the eldest son, writes to his father to inform him of his joining the Roha-Soubise regiment, at seventeen, which angers Sade, who has not been consulted. His servant Rousset dies, leading to the abandonment and ruin of the age-old castle, La Coste. In 1784 he was transferred to the Bastille. He was allowed to furnish the cell to his liking (he requested silk curtains and other furniture), and food was plentiful. There he wrote his masterpieces: *Justine*, *Aline and Valcour*, *Philosophy in the boudoir*, *Dialogue between a priest and a dying man* and the *120 days of Sodom*.

In 1786 and 1787 he was restricted from visiting because he was unpredictable and irascible. In 1787 he was given an hour's walk a day and a servant was assigned to him. Health problems begin inflammation of the cornea from working in low light and obesity due to limited movement. During his unjust captivity (by the powerful mother-in-law) he took every opportunity to protest and rebellion; he was the king's most rebellious prisoner. He threatened escape attempts. He never accepted his situation or resigned himself, he permanently claimed his right to freedom. (Traits: Fighting and Constant Fighting)

In 1789 it was fifteen years since his captivity and in Paris the turmoil began. Security measures were doubled, prohibiting all prisoners from walking. He did not accept it and threatened: he took a tube with a funnel as an amplifier and shouted that they wanted to kill him. He was transferred to Charenton (psychiatric hospital) and in ten days the popular uprising broke out, the Bastille was stormed, demolished and set on fire and the governor suffered a cruel death. On July 14, 1789, the French Revolution began. In May 1790, he wrote to his friend Gaufridy, after his transfer to Charenton: "My manuscripts! I cry tears of blood. The beds and dressers are replaceable, but not the pansies. No, my friend, I am not in a position to describe my despair at the loss that can never be recovered. Since then, the delicate Madame de Sade wants nothing to do with me, she wants to annihilate me and asks for a divorce. The marchioness could have collected her things, but she didn't. Sade was furious. Nor had he taken care of the numerous manuscripts that he had secretly given him during visits to Vincennes and the Bastille. He stated that he had given them to others, who had burned them. These statements provoked in Sade fits of rage and horrible scenes of hate, which he experienced as abuse. He threatened his wife with scandal; she replied that it would be worse if she testified. Sade agreed to a ruinous separation that caused him great financial difficulties.

When he was released, he called himself citizen Donatien Sade. He frequented theatre circles and met the actress Constance Renelle, forty years old, with a son, abandoned by her husband. She remained with the marquis until his death. She knew how to treat that insufferable, capricious, and maniacal man, and he, in turn, repaid her with affection and gratitude.

Sade wrote a lot of theatre, most of it unpublished. In 1791, at the age of fifty-one, he premiered one of his works at the Theatre Molière, but an altercation caused his suspension. Then more doors opened. He enjoyed literary esteem, performed plays, and improved under his friend's care.

Despite his physical problems, his sexual desire did not abate, as the next nine books show, especially *Justine* and *Juliet*. He took a deeper pleasure in invention and writing; he had become, thanks to his dedication, a true writer.

At the end of 1791 he wrote to his friend Gaufridy: "I do not belong to any party, and to all at the same time. I am against the Jacobins, I hate them to death, I revere the king but I deny the abuse of power. I really like the articles of the Constitution, others outrage me, I wish their meaning would return to the nobility; having removed it has not brought any improvement. I want the king to be the head of the nation and I do not want any national assembly. I prefer two cameras like in England; it contains the authority of kings and is substituted by the necessity of a nation represented in two classes; the third (the clergy) is useless, I don't want to know anything about it. My sentence: what am I then? Aristocrat or Democrat? Tell me, I beg you, because I don't even know myself". (Traits: mental elaboration but insecurity of one's own ideas, difficult positioning).

But Sade joined and actively participated in the revolutionary process. He will be at the celebration of July 14 in 1790, and in 1791 he is invited to the assembly of active citizens. He collaborates with speeches such as *Ideas on the method of enactment of laws*. He is given tasks for the organization of the improvement of hospitals and public assistance and is appointed secretary of his section. Being president, the accusation against his mother-in-law and her husband comes to him; he could have pronounced his death sentence but delays the process and succeeds. for those who kept him in prison for more than ten years, money to flee France. We see his generosity and the fact that he was not excited about the new situation; he abhorred the daily bloodshed with the guillotine, his sadism was of another kind. Because of his stance in favour of innocent defendants, he must give up his presidency. In 1793 he is arrested without knowing why. Constance remains by her side. In 1794 he was released, after the fall of Robespierre and with Napoleon on the throne. From now on. Sade and Constance (nicknamed the Sensitive) live in misery and in 1799 come to beg. He continues with enemies who accuse him of *Justine* or the misfortunes of virtue that Sade denies (his masterpiece), feeling the danger of power. "I am a debauchery of fantasy and unheard-of behaviour, an atheist to the point of fanaticism; kill me or take me as I am, I can no longer change myself", he writes. (Traits: sincerity or sincericide, provocation, transgression, risk, carelessness, self-destruction).

In 1801 he was arrested at his publisher's house and numerous manuscripts were seized from him. He will not be free for the next thirteen years, until his death. The family agrees: their two military sons were ashamed of the father. Declared a public enemy and mentally ill, he is admitted without trial. He spends a year in a civilian prison, engaging in scandalous conduct, and then is transferred to the Charenton Asylum at sixty-one. The director Coulmier welcomes the elderly Sade courteously and grants relief to the unjustly interned. You will have furniture, carpets and curtains, a library with 300 books and permission to walk through its gardens. Constance lives several months of the year by his side, writing his dictations when his eyes fail. Despite police kidnappings, Sade's banned novels continue to be printed. It offers theatre performances in Charenton with the inmates as actors, attended by important personalities. There he wrote ten volumes of plays. In 1810, the divorced Marquise de Sade died, whom he never forgave for the loss of his manuscripts. In 1813 the works of the marquis in Charenton ceased to be represented by order of the minister.

On December 1, 1814, he suffered an asthma attack, one of his sons visited him, and the day after he died with his nurse Constance at his side. He will be buried in Charenton Cemetery with a religious ceremony, contrary to his will.

In short, Sade was an instinctive man with multiple contradictions. Unstable, extreme, irresponsible, scoundrel. He lies, he cheats, he lacked pride, he had little compassion. He was aggressive, fighter, libertarian, artist, creative: the opposite of a French nobleman; but at the same time he considers himself an aristocrat and disdains the lower classes. His relationship with money and practical aspects can be described as childish.

❖ SAINT AUGUSTINE OF HIPPO:

By Annie Chevreux

Agustin de Hipona (354 BC-430 AD) was born in Tagaste, a province of Roman Numidia in North Africa. From a deeply Romanized family, he does not overlook his Berber origins. His mother, a fervent Christian who will later become Santa Monica, tries with little success to instil in him the basic principles of religion. Young Agustín leads a turbulent life, stumbling around without finding his own way. A brilliant scholar of letters, a lover of poetry and highly eloquent, he devoted himself fervently to the theatre, which brought him fame and praise. His passionate, impatient, impulsive, and sensual character does not prevent him from taking an interest in philosophy. It was decisive for him to discover Cicero. As a fervent seeker of the truth, he is interested in many philosophical schools without actually adhering to any. He unsuccessfully seeks in heretical doctrines the method to guide his life and practices Manichaeism, which he ends up abandoning. He leaves for Rome, where he falls seriously ill. The ailment that is moral. Already recovered, he meets Bishop Ambrosio in Milan, who has immobilized him not only physically but will also serve as a mentor by recommending him to read Plotinus and the Epistles of Paul of Tarsus. These readings are decisive for him to convert to Christianity. He renounces worldly life and decides to live ascetically. In his desire to delve into the origin of evil, he studies the Neoplatonists. Considered the "Doctor of Grace and the greatest thinker of Christianity of the first millennium, he ended his life in Hippo (Numidian province), where he was bishop.

Among his philosophical and theological works, the Confessions represent in the Western world a spiritual autobiography in which he accuses and repents of the sin of having wasted time, which, like memory and interiority, are ideas of the greatest mental importance and in his own process of knowing himself.

Scholars of Saint Augustine see his spiritual pilgrimage as a tortuous and tormented itinerary; its existence implies "a sense of search and struggle. An agonizing, almost tragic sense, which gives all his actions the passionate emotion of the fight. All this is reflected in the Confessions, the autobiography of Saint Augustine, in the panting and yearning tone with which he addresses God, repeatedly asking forgiveness for taking too long to surrender to him, to break with the Manichaean sect, for which he continued his pilgrimage in the spiritual search.

What was found to be important about how the ego transcended is collected here.

Recognize the good and the bad within oneself. Responsibility:

Do not go outside, go inside yourself where you will find the origin of all your goods and all your evils. I am the one I want and the one I don't want, the one I seek, the one I consent to. My heart is the center of the controversy and dispute within me." "Going and arriving was nothing more than wanting to go." "Evil was the perversion of the will." "I was the origin of the habit that prevailed against me, since I had voluntarily arrived where I did not want to."

Difficulty and distraction:

"The inner self impeded and attracted by the reality that surrounds it and that it longs to possess."

Acknowledging yourself as a sinner Recognize yourself in the fight:

"I preferred to excuse myself and accuse I don't know what strange thing there was in me, and it wasn't me... My sin was the most incurable because I didn't believe myself to be a sinner. In my execrable iniquity, I would rather defeat you [speak to God] for my downfall than be defeated by you for my salvation."

To be contrary, to go against oneself:

...I did not even suspect lightly and darkly how it was a spiritual substance (teachings of the sect of the Manichaeans). So, I was ashamed, but with joy, of having been barking for so many years, not against the Catholic faith, but against the spawn of my carnal intelligence. I had been impious and reckless for having said condemning what I should have learned by asking." "And I was so afraid of seeing myself free from all those obstacles that surrounded me when it is fair to be prevented by them."

Attachment to obstinacy:

"The accustomed evil was stronger than the unexperienced good."

Do not give up the inner fight. Attachment to suffering:

"Until when, until when, tomorrow, tomorrow? And why not now? Why not put an end to my clumsiness at this very moment?"

Attachment to disease:

"... I was completely sure that it was better for me to surrender to your love than to submit to my desires. But the one pleased me and won; the other pleased me and tied me down."

Belonging. Source:

“The light did not shine on my mind, in the way that oil floats on water or the sky hangs on the earth. It was above me because it was the same light that made me, I was below because I was made by them.

Competition (in relation to Bishop Ambrosio):

I, for my part, began to love him. At first not as a doctor of the truth... but as an affable man with me. I began to listen to him carefully... but not with due attention. I wanted to judge for myself if what they said about his skills as an orator was true, if his fame as such was greater or less than what he told....

Search for recognition. competition with yourself:

.... The desire for praise leads us to beg for the approval of men, attributing it to a certain personal excellence. And even when I reproach myself for it, I am still tempted by the desire for praise. In the very act of reproaching myself there is a temptation, for frequently I even puff up even more for having despised vainglory.

❖ FRANCISCO DE GOYA:

By Aurora Spinoza

Francisco de Goya was born in 1746 in Fuendetodos, near Zaragoza, the youngest of six children of a master gilder and a woman from a fallen family of Aragonese nobility. In 1749 the family moved to Zaragoza for commercial reasons, where Francisco attended the Pious Schools of the Piarist Fathers and met Martín Zapater, who later, dedicated to commerce, would jealously watch over the interests of the painter. They remained united all their lives by a deep and sincere friendship: “I would rather fall from grace and be with you to achieve that satisfaction that we have enjoyed in the past and that neither the praise nor the gratifications of kings and princes can give me”.

His early aptitude for drawing and painting led him as a teenager to enter as an apprentice in the workshop of the local painter José Luzán y Martínez, where he met Francisco Bayeu, who would be of great help in his career as a painter. Due to his joking nature and given over to love madness, he was forced to leave Zaragoza at the age of eighteen, after a bloody fight in which three men were injured. In 1763 he arrived in Madrid following Bayeu and there, in addition to an intense study activity, he spent his time in taverns, drinking and gambling, or serenading the beautiful girls. He was also involved in several bullfights and, to demonstrate his strength and fearlessness, he did not hesitate to join a gang of bullfighters.

In Madrid, a center of renowned international culture, the Aragonese painter increasingly consolidated his belief in making art and strengthened his strong desire for affirmation and recognition, even having failed twice in the competition at the Academy of Fine Arts. Precisely this refusal, together with his anti-academic style and without scruples, was the incentive for him to come to Rome, a crossroads for the most advanced artistic experiences and a must for those who wished to gain a foothold in the world of art. Even in the Eternal City he could not contain his impetuous and threatening arrogance. It seems that he kidnapped a girl from Trastevere locked up in a convent by some relatives of the one who was hopelessly lost. For this fact he was persecuted by the police and took refuge with the Spanish ambassador, from where he was repatriated at expense, returning to Zaragoza in June 1771.

Opportunism, histrionic capacity, and theatricality:

With an emphatic egocentrism that borders on narcissism, the sexual E4 does not see the other, does not take them into consideration, sees only himself in the act of surprising, provoking to compensate for the deep feeling of inadequacy and being the absolute protagonist of the scene.

After his repatriation, Goya received numerous and important commissions from Bayeu with which he consolidated his reputation. The marriage with Josefa, Bayeu's sister, a notoriously unbeautiful woman, to whom, despite the constant betrayals, he was tenderly attached, was also advantageous, due to the deep value that Francisco placed on the family. Always due to Thanks to Bayeu, he was commissioned to make the cartoons for the tapestries to decorate the Palace of San Lorenzo in El Escorial and the Royal Palace of Gatopardo in Madrid, in which the painter carried "all the colorful joviality of the last glories of the Spanish aristocracy of the Old Regime". The success ensured him a growing prestige among the aristocratic classes. Due to his behavior, lover of hunting, good food, music, theater, loquacious, ironic, joking and seductive, he was highly sought after in the most extravagant, relevant circles of the old Spanish nobility. For the young artist, this His position of privilege and unanimous recognition had to take the form of true social redemption. Born in the provinces, Bora could finally boast of being among the most prominent in Madrid and compensate for his mediocre and lacking self-image.

Need for recognition. Artistic temperament between commitment and eccentricity:

Contacting the feeling of loneliness and uselessness of his own existence, the sexual E4 appeals to his natural artistic gifts and creates a character that stands out for being unique and exceptional, with extravagant, bizarre ways, far from the common ways of being.

In the tapestry cartoons depicting scenes from popular life, according to the testament of the future Queen Maria Luisa of Parma, Goya finally gave way to his own inventiveness. The narration is livelier, full of emotional participation often of autobiographical origin, the rapid and fluid brushstrokes and the warm and vivid colors convey the joie de vivre typical of courtly life, but also of Francisco himself. Goya's success was at its peak. In a letter to his friend Zapater he says: "If I wrote with more

time, I would tell you about the honors that, by the grace of God, the King, the Prince and the Princess have done me [...]. I kissed their hands; I've never been so lucky!" After entering the Academy in 1780 thanks to the king's support, Goya made numerous images, mostly portraits of the nobles of the Madrid court with pitiless eyes and immortalized on canvas as mannequins with a fixed and alien gaze. , impregnated with great stupidity and moral misery, despite their various honors and degan clothes, Liberal by instinct and progressive of ideas, denounced with refined and cold determination bad government, corruption, immorality and the indifference of the rulers who should be concerned about the fate of the people.

Ambition And Arrogance.

Through arrogance and the pride of being superior and more than others, the sexual E4 tries to cover up his tendency to self-destructiveness, to the denial of his own deep needs and to the will to destroy the other, everything that which would highlight its lacking aspects.

The notoriety achieved by Goya began to be accompanied by official recognition. In 1786 he was named King's Painter by the new King Charles IV. His ambition was more than satisfied: his presence, in effect, had become indispensable at receptions and various gallant gatherings. He wrote to his friend Zapater with great presumption and arrogance: "I am no longer an antechamber; The one who wants something from me comes to look for me, and I make myself wanted. If it weren't for very high-ranking people or the insistence of a friend, I wouldn't even be working. And for the mere fact of making me want so much, they don't let me free for a moment. His histrionic and falsely accommodating character allowed him to go through, without being at all involved, even the turbulent events that shook Spain in those years. While his friends and protectors were removed from power, Goya kept his position and continued, as court painter, at the service of the new king and his ministers.

Attraction and repulsion for the feminine world:

The impossible search for the ideal person, who fully understands and shares everything, leads the sexual E4 to enter a maze in which the only way out, to avoid touching the true and real feeling of lack, is deny the feeling of love and turn it into deep hate.

Undoubtedly, Goya had an irresistible attraction to women, in whose arms he sought that warmth that he had missed as a child. In the numerous portraits that he dedicated to them, beyond the social rank to which they belonged, he always tried to "incorporate the warmth of raw flesh into the texture of the painting." The famous nude Maja is clear proof of this. Goya is aware of this dependence on the feminine and responds with an attitude of determined hostility. Often, almost moved by a feeling of revenge mixed with contempt, he tries to capture in the portraits of women their character rather than their beauty, exposing their pride or vulgarity, their intrigue or stupidity, lust or vanity. Sometimes he even considers them a source of evil: in the drawing *The Viper Woman*, a young woman contemplates herself in the mirror that gives her the image of a snake coiled around the scythe of death. This ambivalence of attraction and rejection, of hate and love towards women, surely derived from his relationship with his mother, a demanding, affective, and dissatisfied woman, incapable of giving her son the unconditional maternal love that Goya desperately searched for in the many women in

his life. Although he always took care of her with care, responsibility and great sweetness, Goya always felt inadequate, rejected, and unrequited in his filial love, so much so that he wrote to his friend Zapater with great melancholy and sorrow: "I could not have treated her with more attention, but I could not satisfy her with anything!". A wound of love that undoubtedly conditioned his affective and sentimental life, unleashing in him a feeling of betrayal and resentment that he appeased, like a great balm, with his creative fury and his intense tenderness towards the children in whom he found hospitality, protection, and warmth. Your inner child is thirsty for love, joy, and lightness.

Illness and descent into the underworld:

Contact with illness and death, isolation from the real world, the obfuscation of the senses, manifestation of the deep feeling of self-destruction, inevitably leads to sexual e4. as an extreme attempt at salvation, to throw oneself into the black hole of one's own existence.

In 1792 he left Madrid for a brief trip to Andalusia, and in Seville he was surprised by a serious illness. They transport him to Cádiz as a guest of a merchant friend. The painter lay paralyzed in bed, tormented by terrible headaches and earaches, dizziness and eye disorders, to such an extent that he feared for his life. In a letter from Zapater to Bayeu we read: "As for Goya, as I have told you, it is his poor reflection that has led him to where you are. Despite managing to recover after a long convalescence, Goya lost his hearing for the rest of his life. This episode marked a remarkable change of style and subject matter in his painting. Abandoning the cheerful tones of the previous paintings, he produced numerous small-format paintings, the "little squares", which portray terrifying and brutal events such as shipwrecks, mental hospitals, fires, bandit attacks, and obscured people. In these small canvases, the tragic and painful meaning of life emerges in all its virulence and truth, the feeling of impotence before the will of fate and the awareness of a profound loneliness of man (sharpened by deafness): demons held back, until then, at bay from his unbridled ambition and his arrogant and deceitful self-assertion

However, despite the serious illness, he did not lack recognition nor did his inexhaustible vitality falter. His passionate sentimental relationship with the Duchess of Alba, one of the most fascinating, unscrupulous, and rich women in Spain, to whom he dedicated two extraordinary portraits, is well known.

The truth to the point of cruelty:

Going through the black hole of existence means for the sexual E4 to see and capture in oneself and in others the most frightful and terrifying aspects of human action. Becoming aware of their misdeeds, in an attempt to redeem himself, he becomes a relentless executioner, transforming himself from victim to executioner.

His sensitivity to major political upheavals that crossed Europe and the dramatic personal events that he lived through in those years contributed a lot to this drastic change of theme and style. He was sensual, impetuous, petulant, vain but also endowed with a keen sense of justice and humanity. He loved "the truth to the point of cruelty and had a keen critical sense". As an artist, he assumed the responsibility of highlighting the true range of evil in which the threads of actions carried out in the name of justice and divine

mercy were intertwined. He felt horror towards the Inquisition, from which he had to defend himself several times, and he deeply hated fanaticism and superstition, traditional ignorance and the blind egoism of the high clergy or idle aristocracy. In *The Burial of the Sardine* (1812-14) and in the subsequent *Pilgrimage to the San Isidro Fountain* (1821-23), man loses all his humanization to become, through a rough, violent and corpulent brushstroke, a indistinct element of a delirious, hallucinated crowd, pushed by chaotic and dark forces destined to produce uncontrollable disasters, not very different from those that the civil war was producing and would produce in those years. Goya, from being investigated, became an inquisitor at the service of humanity.

Look in the mirror of human misery:

Powerless spectator of a reality in which good and evil coexist indissolubly, winners and losers, tyrants and oppressors, love, and hate, the sexual E4 assumes a compassionate attitude towards human existence and towards itself that leads to surrender, to lose emotional intensity and to gain lucidity. In the summer of 1793 he began the series of engravings entitled *Caprichos*, in which, with caustic and sharp irony, he represents, in the perspective of ridiculing the baseness common in the Spain of the time, faces as cunning, hypocritical, sharp, and evil as the profiles of raptors [...] Witches, covens, mischief, children roasted on a spit, what do I know? All the debauchery of the dream, all the hyperbole of hallucination (Baudelaire). Among the engravings, the most famous is undoubtedly *The Dream of Reason Produces Monsters*, in which he denounces the progressive decline of Enlightenment values in favour of the violent instinctive drives of the human soul. This awareness was manifested even more explicitly in the *Disasters of War*, in which, with the lucid and chronic vision of a witness, the atrocities and brutal violence suffered by the population by Napoleonic troops are put on paper. On May 3, 1808, in Madrid: executions on the mountain of Principe Pio (1814), the execution of hundreds of patriots by French troops is represented. In extremely crude painting, the artist "wants to express more than narrate, provoke more than inform." In the canvas in which all the nuances of the tragic feeling of man before death are represented with great truth, he finds his point of support in the central figure of the condemned man who, in the name of the ideal of freedom and justice, has put his life on the line. A clear allusion by the artist to his own feelings.

"The dark night of the soul":

For the sexual E4, descending into the darkest corners of one's existence means identifying with the darkest suffering, with universal pain, with dissolution and, above all, with the ruthless and desperate struggle for survival that many times stripes in tragic and creepy tones. In 1819 Goya, having lost his privileges and having abandoned the court, retired, together with his young partner Leocadia Zorrilla, whom he met in 1805 at the wedding of his son Javier at a country house on the outskirts of Madrid. After another terrible illness, Goya began to decorate the house where he would spend his last years. The place, baptized by the locals as "Quinta del sordo", became a theatre in which the energy of evil manifested itself in the most varied forms of obsessive despair. On nights of insomnia and delirium, personal pain assumed the immensity of universal pain, which in the painter manifested itself in a feeling of deep anguish, characterized by states of hallucinations and altered perceptions of reality. The disease and degenerative state of his once powerful body confronted him with the true and cruel meaning of life. The apparent tranquility that honors and money had given him before the war crumbled into

insurmountable grief. He had seen everything given and done, all the thoughts that had agitated him, all the pains he had secretly felt, in particular the premature death of two daughters, the death of his wife and above all of the Duchess de Alba, revived again and appeared in his tortured body, in his hallucinated mind, in his wounded heart. A dark night of the soul that he painted on the walls of the house, perhaps not to go crazy and certainly to be able to express himself and give free rein to restlessness, to violent and irrepressible inventive freedom. The joyful and hopeful visions of the past were transformed into images of a deformed, grotesque, bestial humanity, represented with an expressive violence hitherto unusual, or terrible characters from mythology such as Saturn devouring his children (1821-23), a painting that has become an icon of all Goya's work. The painting captures the god voraciously devouring one of his newborn children, terrified that the prophecy would come true that one of them would steal his power. The brushstrokes-moved by an exasperated corpulent and lively expressive fury capable of expressing the aggressive orality characteristic of him-are strong, fast, and dense, with a material E4 sexual character. It should not be ruled out that in this highly intense painting Goya wanted to represent Saturn in the figure of the tyrannical and repugnant father towards whom the young Francisco could only harbour feelings of hatred and disdain for his stolen childhood, as well as the indirect request for early responsibility towards the inadequate mother. Theirs was undoubtedly a competitive relationship both in affective and professional terms. Goya never shared with his father, who also worked in the midfield artistic field, neither his successes and awards nor the luxurious worldly life he led in Madrid. He considered him credible and marginal, incapable in the role of father and husband. On his death, he wrote to his friend Zapater, with clear contempt, that he had died without a will "because he had nothing to do with it."

Exile: return to the original source:

Having acquired the awareness that everyone and everything belongs to a single great design, in which the individual parts are connected to each other, the sexual E4 reaches a state of meditative tranquillity and can abandon itself to the flow of life as a continuum of experiences and knowledge and be part of its totality and fullness.

As soon as he finished the cycle of black paintings, Goya, taking advantage of the amnesty granted by the king, decided to leave the country, and move to Bordeaux, where he arrived "deaf, old, lethargic and weak and without knowing a word of French, but eager to see the world." In the French town, far from everyone, he spent the last years of his life in serenity, dedicating himself to experimenting with new lithographic techniques and teaching the art to his little and beloved daughter María Rosario. Having given shape and voice to their own demons, recognized as manifestations of the vital forces of the universe, they had finally given themselves the possibility of being able to abandon themselves to the flow of life whose meaning is not disclosed. The artist's last years were characterized by a more compassionate and welcoming attitude. Despite the ailments and the burden of a convulsed existence, Goya never lost that extraordinary vitality that, if once it manifested itself in the obsessive search for the different and the unknown, in challenging the mystery, in overcoming the limit, now it was revealed in a savouring of everything that life offered him, capturing the most intimate, real and human aspects. A joy to live and to know that led him even in art to always experiment with new techniques and composition solutions. In *The Milkmaid of Bordeaux* (1827), which represents the young peasant woman who brought him milk every day, considered his last work, the light tones of his youthful manner reappear, revised in the light of

impressionist experiences. The painter, over 80 years old, left with this work a kind of spiritual testament that invited the new generations to look at art and life as a spectacle that is eternally renewed, in front of which we must place ourselves innocently, with the charm and wonder of a child. In one of the last drawings, as if to give us a key to understand his entire existence as a man and an artist, he represented an old man leaning on a crutch and a cane, with the legend "I still learn": the last and deep act of love towards the life that requires nothing more than to be lived fully and unconditionally.

10. LITERARY AND FILM EXAMPLES

❖ A LITERARY EXAMPLE

Wuthering Heights (Heathcliff), by Emily Brontë, 1847.

By Rossana Pavoni Gallo

Heathcliff personifies what in literary typology is known as a Byronic hero: a dark antihero, of mysterious origin, fascinating, destroyer of what he loves, marginalized and cruel. Dark-haired, reclusive, a bit demonic, and no doubt sexy too. He is a romantic, tortured, taciturn and obsessive character. Very sexual E4.

In the Wuthering Heights mansion, on top of a hill exposed to all the elements, owned by the Earnshaw couple who live with their two children: Hindley, fourteen, and Catherine, six. Their neighbours are the Lintons, who live on the Thrush Farm and have two children: Edgar and Isabella. Mr. Earnshaw picks up a boy of about seven years old on the streets of Liverpool, without knowing his origin or his identity, incorporating him into family life, treating him like one more son, will be almost the only one to treat him that way. They give him the name of a son who died as a child, Heathcliff, and they won't give him his last name.

He enters the family as a poor orphan stigmatized by his origin. Mr. Earnshaw, for all his magnanimity, introduces him by saying, "He looks more like a demon sent by his blackness," and various characters will call him a "gypsy" and treat him cruelly. He speaks unintelligible slang and is called a bad boy, a villain, and the spawn of Satan. His arrival is like a threat to almost everyone, especially Hindley. Says the maid Nelly Dean: "From the beginning, Heathcliff sowed the seeds of discord in the house." Found in Liverpool, a port city with immigrants, it is likely to be of mixed race. Heathcliff doesn't fit in with these people. That hungry and homeless child will not improve his situation and will become a product of helplessness, abuse and neglect. In this beginning we find what can generally characterize childhood or the childhood experience of a sexual E4: abandonment, not belonging, lack of origin, without allies, alone and with rejection of the environment, feeling different and inferior.

Hindley sees him as an illegitimate brother who threatens his fortune and his relationship with his father, whom he feels is a tyrant and who treats Heathcliff as his favorite, who in turn will never show gratitude for taking him in or show any signs of affection. Heathcliff is rejected by Hindley and begins to harbor resentment. On the other hand, they become inseparable with their stepsister Catherine, they will spend their childhood together as much time as they can doing mischief. As children they meet the Linton brothers, Edgar, and Isabella. And since then, Heathcliff begins to hate Edgar because he is blond and pretty and because Catherine is also his friend. Hate and competition towards who he considers better, more beautiful, and richer, and jealousy with the presence of only having his friend's attention.

Hindley goes away to study and returns married to Frances on the death of his father. He unleashes against Heathcliff, who was never kind, all the rancour of the legitimate heir, becomes his greatest enemy, venting all his frustration on him, and condemns him to the rank of servant, humiliating and enslaving him. Heathcliff made no secret of his desire to bleed him dry and paint the facade of Wuthering Heights with his blood. Hate grows as a reaction to what he considers so much injustice against him and the weight of his situation of inescapable inferiority, topics of sexual E4.

Hindley's acrid antagonism is opposed by his sister's love for Heathcliff, a primitive and fantastic infantile feeling that does not exclude, unconscious of its weight, a caste prejudice. Catherine has an accident and the Lintons take her in by hosting and caring for her at their home during her convalescence. When she returns home, she looks for Heathcliff and, happy to meet him again and tell him about her experience, she laughs a lot, to which he reacts: "I won't stay here to be laughed at," interpreting the laugh against him (sensitive and spiteful). She explains to him: "I wasn't laughing at you, but look at you", Catherine's hands were dirty from having touched him, to which he replies: "Nobody told you to touch me!" (resentful).

At the party organized to receive her, Heathcliff appears taciturn and looks at her insistently, expecting to be seen and resentful, seeing how she is having fun. Hindley finds out and throws him out, to which he responds in a rage by breaking things, so he is punished and locked up. Cathy goes to see it: "The worst thing about you is that you do not take others into consideration, and the obligations of others". The sexual E4 fails to take others and their feelings into account. He tells her that during his absence, he found a bird's nest with eggs and had put a net over it so that the parents could not feed them and they would starve, as they did. Because you did?". There was no reason they existed if I couldn't show them to you. (Rage, cruelty, obsessive, if it wasn't what he wanted, it wasn't). She promises him that she will always come back to him.

Frances dies giving birth to Hindley's son, Hareton, and he loses interest in life. He doesn't even give him a name, that's what his sister will do. Desperate, he surrenders to vice and waste, being a despot against his own son. His behaviour isolates the family and only Edgar visits them, because he loves Catherine.

One day, Heathcliff shows Catherine a piece of paper where he has marked with a cross the days that she has spent with the Lintons and with a dot the days that she spent with him, to show her the difference and make her feel guilty for not being by her side as before.

Catherine: "It's silly, what's it for?" Heathcliff: "So you know I'm on the lookout for this." Catherine: "And do I always have to be here with you?" Heathcliff: "You never complained about my company." Catherine: "You can't talk about company when you don't talk or do anything".

The sexual E4, with his guilty and manipulative behaviour and the self-conviction of being right and deserving of attention, manages to be a magnet for abuse of all kinds, as he applies, and for impossible or twisted loves.

The young woman confesses to Nelly Dean that she will marry Edgar because he is beautiful and rich, despite the fact that she feels a block in her soul and heart because she loves Heathcliff, but her brother has degraded him so much that she cannot lower herself to be with him, although her worst pain has been the pain that Heathcliff

has endured. A recollection from Catherine's diary: Hindley is such a poor substitute for Daddy and is atrocious to Heathcliff. We are going to have to rebel...". If she marries Edgar, she will also have a fortune to protect them. From her perspective, it threatens her social status by not being able to even receive a last name she doesn't have. "My love for Edgar is like the leaves in the forest that change with the seasons. My love for Heathcliff is like the eternal rocks, a source of little visible happiness, but necessary. I am Heathcliff! I have you constantly in my thoughts, although not always as a little thing I like myself. Let's not talk about parting that is unrealizable". It is one of the most famous phrases of the novel. expresses the touching nature of the love between them, beyond the physical. But Heathcliff, hidden, hears only the first part of Catherine's confession, and wounded and offended in his self-respect, he flees from his humiliation and leaves the house without saying anything. Heathcliff and Catherine considered themselves the same person, despite their differences, which their love makes insignificant. But this condition is experienced in different ways by both: Catherine considers it a part of herself and does not see her marriage to Edgar as a separation from Heathcliff. For Heathcliff, soul mates must be together.

With Heathcliff's absence, Catherine recognizes that she cannot live without him, without his life, without his soul, and finally goes with Edgar to Thrush Farm. Heathcliff will disappear for three years, without revealing where he was or what he did during that time. But we will know that he has decided to take revenge against everyone. One of the reactions of the sexual E4 is not to bear the frustration, pain and humiliation, fleeing being their best response to situations that they cannot sustain.

On his return he has become, in appearance, a rich gentleman. It has undergone an even physical transformation. He is no longer a street child, but, as Nelly Dean tells it, he has become a man, tall, athletic and well built. "My master (Edgar) seemed like a young man next to him. Seeing his upright continent, it was thought that he must have served in the army. His countenance bore a firmer and more determined expression than Mr. Linton's, betrayed intelligence, and apparently retained no trace of his former inferiority. In his knitted brows and in the black gleam of his eyes his fierce but restrained nature persisted. Dangerous can sometimes be the makeup and external changes that sexual E4s achieve in their eagerness and need to hide pain, shame and vulnerability, while they have also covered up their hatred keeping it burning like an ember finds his beloved married to Edgar Linton, who agrees to welcome him into his home out of love for Catherine, he knows that he will make her happy, and he says it clearly to Heathcliff, who brazenly replies that he can feel happy in a situation only if he does part of it (egoism). "I came back just to see your face, I have faced a lot of harshness since the last time I heard your voice" (victim and manipulator). You have to forgive my silence, I have fought only for you" (sacrificing and recriminating). And without caring, he will harass her in her own home, sometimes even in the presence of her husband. Heathcliff seems not to realize, like many sexual E4s, that his decision, in this case to return, even enriched, is not enough for things to take the course he wants.

Catherine asks him to go away and forget about the past. "You treated me without dignity and if you think I'm not going to take revenge, you're stupid," he declares shamelessly to make her suffer (spiteful and vindictive). He offends Edgar by calling him a coward and sarcastically compliments him on the good taste of his clothes.

Heathcliff also finds himself with an aged, impoverished and drunken Hindley. He takes advantage of these circumstances and the debts and buys the Wuthering Heights house and his lands, strips him of his assets, disinheriting him and his son, whom he

leaves without prospects for the future. Hareton will be raised as a savage, taking revenge and using the son as his father used him. What is barbaric here, in addition to hatred, is the ignorance produced by civilization itself. From this social structure spring the prejudices of the characters. Heathcliff returns blow for blow how many he received in his childhood. In sexual E4, the excessiveness of one's own suffering, constantly fed back, is stronger at many times than the capacity for forgiveness and compassion for others, which gives room for revenge. Envy for who does have it, low self-esteem for not having been deserved, hate for being loved, is an explosive mixture that is reversed with contempt towards the outside to compensate for the annihilation towards the inside.

At the Thrush Farm he also meets Isabella Linton, who exudes the fascination that Heathcliff has. Catherine, jealous, because she still loves him, speaks to him despite him: he is elusive, cruel, wild, aggressive, a wolf. "Heathcliff has a noble soul," Isabella replies. Heathcliff wastes no time and uses this to his advantage by upsetting Edgar and landing Bella just one good hit on Catherine. He openly seduces Isabella for revenge and they get married. "I am evil and a scoundrel, for your fortune," he tells her. From the first day he condemns her to bitter suffering. He takes her to live in Wuthering

Heights, and she forms an unlikely friendship with Hindley, bonding over both being victims of Heathcliff's brutality.

Heathcliff goes from victim to victimizer, spreading suffering wherever he goes, with premeditation and treachery, cultivating his own unhappiness with his claim to control, victim of his own wickedness, announcement of his madness. The love between Heathcliff and Catherine acts as a catalyst for evil, rather than good. His passion, apart from being frustrated by social conventions and lack of opportunity, is itself destructive. Like a constant battle between love and hate, between good and evil. In Heathcliff, the source of his hatred is identified in his helpless and lonely childhood situation, which becomes a shell of defiance to the world, to the social order, to the martyrdom of feeling intimately inferior and lonely and seeing enemies and attracting unhappiness.

Lockwood, its tenant, points out that "Heathcliff contrasted greatly with the environment. He looked like a gypsy, but with the manners and clothing of a distinguished man." It is emblematic of the contradiction in his story: his origin contrasts with his appearance as head of the house. He becomes rich and master, but he cannot change his skin or his origin, neither his light nor his shadow; the internal nonacceptance is here stronger than the efforts to change externally and socially. Who he really is has been the source of his unhappiness that endures in the impossibility of having the only thing he has wanted in life.

It can become a beast, in its threats, in its symbolic association of the names of its dogs: Iragon and Spy. His emotional complexity and the background to his motivations and reactions make him much more than a depraved gothic villain. His anger and hatred are linked to the revenge that he intensely seeks. And he commits acts of gratuitous violence, like hanging Isabel's dog.

His deep wound does not allow him to feel compassion for anyone other than Catherine. As Nelly Dean recounts: "He seized her (Isabella's) arm and flung her out of the room, coming back exclaiming, 'I can't be compassionate, I can't. trampling, the more the pain increases'". He's talking about his wife. He mistreats her physically and psychologically, destroys her and accuses her of hating herself, of not having dignity. He has no limits if he finds someone to denigrate, and he does it with bitterness and

resentment. He treats everyone with savage tyranny and remains in love with his romantic idealization.

Their love, impossible as it was, became violent and passionate in the extreme, generating a defensive attitude of counterattack. A love that was immature, blocked in childhood. The moments of happiness that will haunt Heathcliff for the rest of his life barely took place in a few pages. And many of them were a way to escape the violence. Another characteristic that we find here of this subtype where the attachment to romantic and impossible loves are frozen and maintained as a source of perennial misfortune by paradise lost.

Catherine falls seriously ill while expecting Edgar's baby and Heathcliff can't stand being away from her, but she tells him that she got sick, because of him, that he killed her. "These are words that will remain engraved on me, torturing me forever while you will rest in peace" (extreme victim, envy even death). It has become a strenuous game that the sexual E4 knows very well: he takes offense, drags himself, attacks her again: "What right did you have to leave me? I didn't break your heart, you did it yourself, and you broke mine. Catherine, dying, asks for forgiveness: "It is difficult, I forgive you: I love my murderer" (she cannot calm down even in that mortal moment, she continues to attack). "I hope she wakes up in the afterlife full of torment; I will repeat only one prayer forever: Catherine Earnshaw, may you not rest in peace while I am alive. If you say that I have killed you, then persecute me like a ghost or in any other way, it is enough that you always accompany me, make me go crazy but do not leave me" (flagellant self-torture). His counter dependency opens into a deep and sick dependency and repeats what she said when he left: "I can't live without my life, I can't live without my soul."

The sexual E4 is tied to an impossible love for life to continue feeding his suffering, which is the only insane modality he knows and to which he is addicted. Catherine passes away giving birth to her daughter Cathy. Heathcliff tells Nelly: "If I look at the floor, I think I see her features carved into the tiles. In the trees and in the clouds, in everything during the day and filling the air at night, I see her image. I think I see it in the most vulgar features of every man and every woman, and even in my own face! The world is a horrendous collection of memories telling me that she lived and that I have lost her. Catherine's death increases his obsession; he goes so far as to ask the gravedigger to dig her up so he can see her one more time.

Soon after, Hindley dies and Isabella leaves him, but he dismisses both events and remains lord and master of Wuthering Heights. Isabella can't stand the evil and violent man any longer and flees to London, where she will give birth to Linton. When Heathcliff finds out that she has had a child, he doesn't care much either, but vows that one day he will live with him. This boy will not know of his father until twelve years later, when his mother dies, and his uncle Edgar takes him to Thrush Farm. When Heathcliff finds out, he sends his servant Joseph for him at midnight. Edgar refuses to give up his nephew, but he doesn't want trouble with Heathcliff, so at dawn he sends Nelly Dean with the child to Wuthering Heights. Heathcliff will treat his son no better than his mother. He does not tolerate the constant sickness that the child suffers, he despises him for being weak. History will repeat itself, changing the characters: Linton will behave cruelly with his cousin Hareton.

Eighteen years later, Cathy meets Wuthering Heights and makes contact with Hareton, unaware that he is her cousin. At first, she is attracted to him, but the boy's rude manners and ignorance (the result of mistreatment and the subservient position to which

Heathcliff and his son have subjected him) make her despise him. Instead, Cathy decides to go to Linton secretly from her father. Heathcliff, in his constant misery, continues to feed revenge and hatred towards everything and sees the opportunity for another twisted evil: marrying his son to his cousin, daughter of the woman he continues to love, to still beat Edgar Linton and keep the Farm. of the Thrushes What happened to Heathcliff is not ambition, but revenge, cruel and explicit, which he continues to nurture for having been offended, frustrated, hurt, and this continues to be unbearable for him. Destroy those you hate, is his maxim.

Using traps, deceit and violence, he achieves his goal. Edgar Linton falls ill, and Heathcliff holds Cathy in his house under blackmail to force the marriage. She asks him to please let her see her father: "You are not a monster; you are just a cruel man. Have you never loved anyone in your life? And Heathcliff, arrogant, replies: "How dare you flatter me and want to soften me? I hate you!".

When Edgar dies, Linton inherits his estate, as Cathy's husband. But he also suffers from fragile health that leads him to an early death; Before dying, he transfers all his property to his father. Heathcliff hates and mistreats Cathy, since he considers her guilty of the death of the woman he loves and orders her to stay and live in Wuthering Heights, so that he can rent the Farm. He openly curses her because she has come into the world and openly punishes her for her pain: "You will not leave here and I will make you suffer, like my Favourite hobby". He clings to the impossible love that made him suffer to continue thinking about lost paradises, it is his way of being in the world.

He has passionately sewn hatred in his heart and around him. They hate each other, or think they hate each other, and despise each other, as well as Cathy and Hareton, who have become hateful and recalcitrant. You have to learn to keep her from losing control, otherwise one of these days Hareton gets out of his mind with her, but confesses that he is on her side in that house, although he admits that he loves Heathcliff as much as he does. a father, despite his mistreatment. Cathy discovers Hareton's noble side, apologizes for the humiliations he has inflicted on him in the past, and begins to educate him.

Even having achieved his wicked goals, Heathcliff is neither happy nor peaceful. He spends his life thinking about Catherine and being able to remember her face as it was. Not being able to find a clear image of her in his memories, he decides to commit suicide slowly, avoiding sleeping and eating, until he succeeds.

His feeling of inferiority, pain and loneliness has made him pay to those who have crossed his path, as if the whole world should recognize him and pay for his condition, with contempt, hidden victimhood and endless revenge, style and attitude of a sick sexual E4. It should be noted here that revenge is also characteristic of the E8, who also represses his tender and weak part, is aggressive, independent and dominant with the desire to control others, but differs from the sexual Four with his inner experience of darkness, sadness, self-boycott and feeling of pain and self-pity despite the appearance, moved from lack.

Towards the end, Heathcliff admits to Nelly Dean that he is no longer interested in violence, not because he has had his fill but because he is over it: "What a mean denouement! It isn't true? It is a rather absurd consequence of my violent efforts. After I provide myself with enough tools to tear down the two houses, and I give myself to some almost Herculean labours, it turns out that I lack will to consummate my work. I have defeated my ancient enemies and now I can, if I want, take my revenge on their descendants. But for what? I don't care, I don't even want to bother raising my hand

against them anymore. A big change is coming (tormented). It's been a long fight and I'd like it to end (exhausted from his own hateful entanglement). He loses interest in continuing his revenge, fascinated, and tormented at the same time by the visions of Catherine and the announcement of her death. He will not think of anything other than being able to unite with the invoked ghost and the posthumous betrothals in the afterlife of their damned spirits, which to be worthily celebrated require a vengeful apotheosis: the destruction of the houses of Earnshaw and Linton. But the storm that has swept him seems to suddenly subside: "What stops me is not the idea of striking, but only the laziness of raising my hand." Humanized description of a great gale that subsides. Heathcliff dies accepting that the widowed daughter-in-law and the son of his hated enemy start over together. He will be buried next to Catherine and Edgar Linton.

In her editor's foreword to the second posthumous edition of the book, in 1850, Emily Bronte's sister Charlotte wrote: Heathcliff is left, indeed, unredeemable; without ever turning its unalterable course to perdition.

❖ A FILM EXAMPLE:

August Osage County (John Wells, 2013)

By Rossana Pavoni Gallo

The Weston family meets at the mother's house following the disappearance and subsequent suicide of the father. The mother, Violet (Meryl Streep), sick, bitter and addicted to pills. She lives with Ivy, the only one of the three daughters who stayed in the house and who plans to become independent at the age of forty, and an indigenous girl that the husband hired, before leaving, to take care of her.

They arrive with their loads of misery: Violet's sister, Mattie, with her husband; Barbara, the eldest daughter, with her imminent ex-husband and troubled teenage daughter; Karen, the third daughter who tries for the umpteenth time to have a stable relationship with her boyfriend on duty; and finally, Violet's nephew, frail and submissive. Conflicts and feelings exacerbated by the heat of August are being put on the table. 121 minutes without compassion for each other, in a game of mirrors. A live systemic genogram of three generations that repeat, pay and make mistakes, myths, slogans and pains pay. A family tree with lymph that smells of frustration, competing for who suffers the most. They are united by the inability to be happy, as if they lived to hurt themselves, with the maxim: condemned to live surrounded by solitude. The heat will be a constant eloquence throughout the film, suffocating outside and inside the house, like the environment that the protagonist creates.

The personality of the protagonist identified as sexual E4 (Violet Weston-Meryl Streep) was shaped by her marginal origins and few resources in the harsh Osage desert, the love-hate relationship with her husband (teacher, poet and alcoholic) and his three daughters.

Violet suffers from an emblematic tongue cancer that hurts, like life, and is addicted to a long list of pills with which she alleviates her unease and frustration. The disappearance of her husband brought her fear and insecurity, covered with arrogance; nostalgia that hurts and revives masked wounds spouting evil with histrionics and

confrontation. His fragility, loneliness and victimhood bring to light questions that he poorly hides with an imposing presence and his burning tongue.

A difficult and dysfunctional mother who has sacrificed herself to offer what she did not have: better opportunities, comforts, and possible success to her daughters, who seem to have not taken advantage of it as she would like, to later despise them, criticize them, and highlight their mistakes, with love. contaminated that it fails to soften, except in a few moments of recognition and affection.

A curve is designed in the film, beginning with her despair and rage, rising to the highest point of aggression and destruction, to end with her abandoned fall to her fragility and need to be attended and loved.

Scenes, behaviours and dialogues where outstanding characteristics of sexual E4 are highlighted.

The presentation of the main character of the film is carried out through her husband, gloomy and tired, who tells us about her, her dependence on drugs (anxiolytics, antidepressants, sleeping pills), and tells us what prevents her from "until you drink in peace." Violet's arrival on the scene is, in her unnecessarily excessive and hateful way, an assault on a silent indigenous girl whom her husband has hired to look after her. It is her defence-aggression, typical of the subtype, which she reactivates when she feels jealous and betrayed, imagining plots against her. He immediately demonstrates his polarity, going from impudence to realizing his excess feeling guilty and ashamed, with a different expression and an apology: "I'll be cloyingly sweet." Now she is seductive, eager to be nice. Addiction and the experience of cancer can be seen as two of the punitive resources that are inflicted by his unsustainable feeling of worthlessness and that, at the same time, he uses to claim all the attention of his partner, something characteristic of the subtype, which it will end in the disappearance of the husband, and this will lead to the reunification of the family. Through her husband, we have an external vision of Violet: he is a man who loves her but who feels exhausted from living with someone who demands and overwhelms, and who therefore takes refuge in his books and alcohol: "Everyone here revolves around the Indian fig, and we always return to the Indian fig", an allusion to her life and to her, a thorny fruit that we cannot touch without pricking ourselves, despite how sweet and rich it is because of within.

With her daughter Ivy, Violet has sweet expressions that are suddenly accompanied by complaints: "I can't do everything by myself," and sarcasm, talking badly (and behind the back) of one daughter to the other: "I can imagine how I will be their help, just like you." It is also offensive: "You should change; with your hair like that and without makeup you look like a lesbian, you should find yourself a worthy man ". She is a slave to the image even in pain, she cannot show her deterioration and tries to mask her tragedy: "We all need makeup, even Elizabeth Taylor!". She feels less than anyone but she can't admit it. When a sensitive chord touches him, he manages to stop, acknowledge and thank. "Are you afraid?" asks her daughter. "Obviously I have... You are a great help to me. At least one of my daughters stayed with me..."

Her sister Mattie arrives with her husband, of whom she comments acidly through the window, unheard: "He puts up with her because she smokes a lot of joints." Dramatic and outgoing, Violet throws herself into a hug with her eldest daughter Barbara (Julia Roberts) when she arrives and won't leave her alone during her stay. Barbara, aggressive but restrained and dry (moralistic and hard), she returns: "Maybe dad knows a little about you, maybe you attacked him too much when he drank." Distrustful and irrational, Violet

declares that she barely knew it was to get away. Mystery, her husband had left, she checked the safe where they had money and jewellery, in case he had taken them. But he also idealizes the loved object, especially in his absence, remembering him for "his silence, his intelligence, his distinguishing himself from the rest, and... so sexy", or that he seeks a sexual E4 in the longed-for and special relationships. make it a couple.

Violet repeatedly reproaches and blames her daughter for not coming to see her, for having made her father suffer, for not having continued studying, for following her husband. Jealous, she blames him for not coming back when she got sick, but she comes back for her father. The daughter responds: "Parents are supposed to love their children the same way, but you are really mean, I always felt treated differently than my sisters". Violet cynically tells him, "If you want to believe in Santa Claus, that's the reality, I also knew that my mother preferred my sister, and here I am." He also overreacts with glamor and eloquence, hurting the daughter: "Your father was disappointed in you, he thought you had talent as a writer." Violet pretends to be a champion of justice and to always be right. He laughs like he's done or said something funny or unimportant and walks away. In her way of relating and feeling intensely alive, she cannot not hurt. But neither can he support the drama and its weight for a long time; she even gets tired of herself and forgets her arrows, even if she leaves the other prostrate. The daughter can't stand it and manages to attack with-poison-, with which she becomes the victim: "I'm sick, my mouth burns, my husband disappears, and you yell at me." Violet responds by crying in one of the few moments when we see her fragile and consoled by the daughter.

When they announce that her husband has died, she starts dancing and laughing. Even though he is under the effects of the medicines, there is a characteristic way of removing pain, which cannot be deeply hit a sexual E4 suddenly; resists, evades, does not support.

The third daughter arrives with her story of love disasters, efficient at work and with a man older than her, childish and superficial, she thinks he loves her, she thinks he loves her, childish and superficial. He does not show any sorrow for his father's death, and his mother hardly takes it into account. Competitive but with low self-esteem, Violet now feels neither beautiful nor attractive, insisting, "Aging women cannot be sensual." If she isn't, neither will the others. It is very important, as in general for the sexual E4, the physical attractiveness and the seductive capacity; it hurts her not to feel like this anymore, so she decides that they will all be old and ugly. You don't know how to conquer a man," she tells her daughter, boasting as well as belittling her.

The next scene of the family dinner after the funeral is the apex, in which Violet unfolds E4's sexual need to be the diva, when she has an audience and a stage to show off and stand out. He arrives at the table with what appears to be a tirade prepared and weapons loaded. "I see the gentlemen are in shirt sleeves, I thought this was a funeral dinner." All the men get up and, despite the heat and familiarity, put on their jackets. Violet looms large, tough, defiant, glaring. While smoking, he reminds those present that someone has to say a prayer. Her brother-in-law begins and she, who does not share the prayer with the others, demonstrates with obvious and contemptuous gestures that the man is incompetent and irritating.

She begins a string of confessions, secrets, reproaches, and harsh realities told without euphemisms about the misfortunes of her life: sacrifices, being a mother, having cancer, living in a miserable and forgotten town. He leaves no one without his dose of evil. She already wants to get rid of the furniture and renew herself, and she offers her

daughter a piece of furniture that she really wants to get rid of herself and doesn't even listen to the others. who attacks the maid, jealous of the compliments she receives for lunch, emphasizing: "They pay you for that, let it be clear they pay. She makes fun of the other daughter and her new boyfriend, scathing, and seeks the complicity of the others, with a disapproving look.

Destroy the loved and admired object with the same force that idealized it, from heaven to hell. She criticizes her beloved and barely dead husband: "He didn't write a poem until he was sixty-five, he was an alcoholic, he never liked teaching, and he was so drunk when he had to give a speech to alumni at a university, that he couldn't they invited him more ". He has the courage to tell the truth frankly, without filters, but he tinges them with resentment and envy. She is able to silence everyone every time she opens her mouth and unleashes darts, turned into a deranged matriarch who feels that she is the truest, the most long-suffering, the one who knows everything, emotionally exhausted and exhausting. As if there was no room for hope, for tenderness, for trust. Although deeply insecure, she is intelligent and her body language, tone of voice, graceful and subtle gestures, well disposed and controlled, reinforce the character's histrionic, seductive and even brave (but cruel) character. She always needs to be the center of attention, talking loudly, being nice or laughing hysterically. He criticizes and manipulates, he goes from one target to another, pointing the arrows of his acidity at each of the daughters, and then he laughs.

Talk about the will. A daughter doesn't want to talk about it now. She insists, shouting: "If I want to talk, I'll talk." Then, she says without qualms: "This furniture and all this shit, if you want you can take it, I don't want it, it doesn't work for me, I'll put it up for auction, or I'll sell it to you at a lower price than at auction. ". Only Barbara manages to answer her with the same hatred: "Or you die before the auction and we keep everything, and that's it." Violet replies, "Yes, they can do it like this," upset but oozing pride.

The ghost of old age and lack of beauty reappears: "You cannot compete against women younger than one, and it is a great injustice of life. He keeps hurting his daughter, asking his son-in-law or if he has another younger woman. He answers in the affirmative, if he could not oppose such a destructive force. "You have no hope, daughter," says a triumphant Violet, "you have no chance of winning." Another daughter says: "Mom, think that only women deteriorate over the years." "No!" she says, "I said they get hideous, and there's no arguing about it." And he attacks another daughter: "You are the living proof of this".

The brother-in-law manages to tell him: "I don't understand why you are so controversial. She replies: "I only tell the truth, does anyone feel threatened?". He adds: "We all love you." She ditch: "Fuck you. the He does not accept love, he does not know how to receive or give love. The eldest daughter says: "Why do I have to be here when you meanly hurt all the members of my family?" And she responds: "Assault the family?". And she begins to become a victim, yelling, and talking about when her mother's boyfriends followed her, about how much she suffered as a child with her father, who mistreated them, or when her teenage husband had to sleep in a car with her. the alcoholic mother. The daughter tells her that everyone has suffered in one way or another in childhood, but she doesn't listen; Violet's childhood was, in her eyes, the worst, and only she knows what it is to suffer.

"We grew up suffering and sacrificing ourselves for you," he says. Her redemption includes the husband: now she blames the daughters who have obtained a university education without taking advantage of it. "You don't know what the problems are, only me." Barbara asks him, "Why are you yelling at us? Why do you put everything against it?", to which Violet replies, "I'm the only straight man in this house, and today is a perfect day to clear things up." She seeks attention and feels that she is the champion, the justice, the only one with the truth in hand, who can attack, criticize, tease. "Everyone thinks I'm mean."

The truth is that Violet, like most sexual E4s, has several gifts such as understanding, intuition, the sagacity of connecting dots with few elements, seeing broad systemic schemes in short time. Only she herself destroys her own ability to see beyond and shrinks, closing and circling around her navel.

In an extreme and outrageous discussion about the drugs she has always used, she declares: "Yes, I am a drug addict. I love drugs- she has had gas, they are my best friends, and they never let me down! Try to take them off and I eat you alive!" The daughter recriminates what with an addicted mother. He doesn't even hear her: "I'm at home!"

In a scene when they return from the doctor, she runs out of the car in the middle of the field as if with shame and despair, in a desperate catharsis, and the only one behind her is Barbara, who recognizes when she catches up with her that she has lost control. Violet placated and honest: I was looking for reasons to fight and you gave them to me. So, what can we do now?". "<You have to detox," Barbara tells him. And Violet replies: "I need only a few days to recover". Her sorrowful daughter replies: "You are not alone, if you need help." And she, counter-dependent and shrewd, adds: "Your help is of no use to me, I can be very well alone, I know that when all the talks are over, everyone goes back to their miserable life, don't worry about me. I know how it works. I can do it". And it is not a lie, he knows how to do it from the point of view of his false image, although he pays a very high cost for it.

It is difficult to accept old age and the weariness of a hard life. And Violet is now more vulnerable, without a wig or make-up, calmer and moved to see her three daughters together, in a rare moment when she doesn't feel attacked or must defend herself. He recognizes them with the tenderness that he is capable of as they are part of him. And she tells them about an episode from her thirteen years, now without theatre, or excesses, without rage, just with sincerity and the grief caused by what marked her, no longer poverty or beatings, but an evil mother: "A boy I liked him a lot and he was wearing cowboy boots of which he was proud. I thought that with boots like this, as a woman, he would ask me to be his girlfriend. I dreamed of it. I begged my mother for those boots until Christmas came. My mother made a very beautiful package and placed it under a tree in front of the house days before, and she told me not to open it until the 25th". She gets excited... "When the mop arrived, I went and opened the gift: they were men's boots, big, used and old, broken and dirty with dog poo and mud. My mother laughed at me for days." "She was cursed, the daughter of a bitch. I must have taken from her, I imagine".

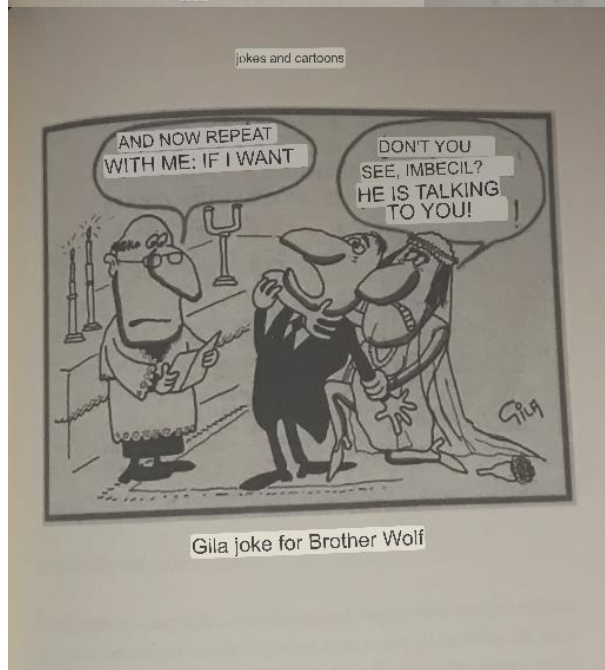
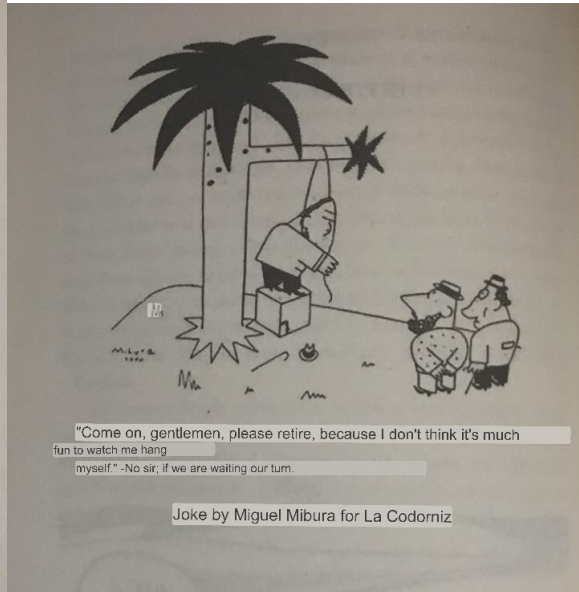
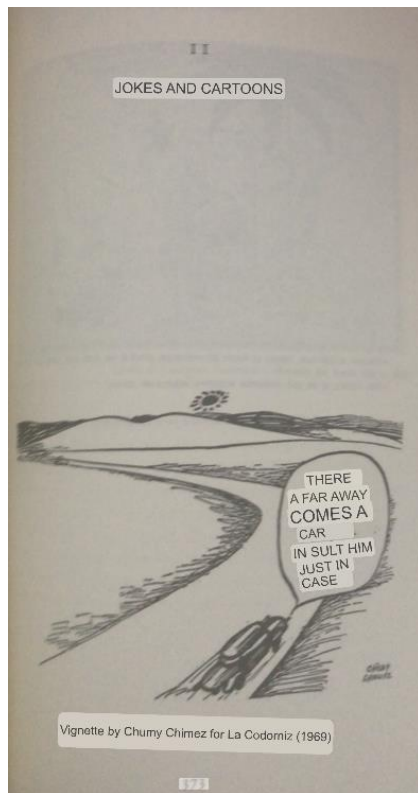
This story shows the root of so much hatred: having felt humiliated and having received destructive envy from whoever had to take care of her and recognize her; the way out she found was to spit out the poison she swallowed, return to her daughters what she had received as a daughter, burn what was around her and distrust any love. With his attitude he drives everyone away, he doesn't let himself be loved or manages to love, he

doesn't know how to do it, they didn't teach him and he didn't learn it. She, her sister and her daughter treat their children as they treated them: without love or generosity.

And, as a finishing touch, two surprising statements: "Who is the victim here?", he asks the daughter, whom he has revealed as a blow, that his cousin (whom she is in love with and with whom she plans to leave), is actually his brother, born from his father's relationship with his aunt. But our sexual E4 fails to see more victims than herself. And with magnanimity and complicity he tells his eldest daughter: "We couldn't let your sister go live with her brother, she is fragile and I love her. He is not strong like you. I never told anyone I knew this secret, only your father, although we never spoke of it. I chose to be superior", she declares with the pain and heaviness of having hidden her husband's relationship with his sister and the conceived child, lying to everyone out of shame and compassion. She believes that no one is capable of a protective scaffolding that weighs as much to bear as she, armed too much. strong and you saw the message that I had left warning you! Could you "Did you know where Daddy had gone! You took the money from the box to stop him!" says the daughter. Violet replies, "Money is important, you can't understand it. And he reverses the accusation of the father's death on his daughter: "You are the reason why he committed suicide. His blood is on your hands", and he apologizes with his illness for not having saved him. He even feels like a victim judging him. He created a cruel strategy to make me feel responsible for his death, leaving a message, testing me. But no one is stronger than me, I manage to resist, when it's all over I'll be here. Who is the strongest? The last of the daughters answers her You're right, mom, you're the strongest. And he goes. Violet is left alone. He puts on music, takes off his wig, calls the ghost of his love. He goes up the stairs and hugs the indigenous girl, seeking tenderness and rest in the person whom he has despised and mistreated. Finally, she lets herself be seen and the mask falls, exhausted, vulnerable, needy.

A wounded character can spend his entire life savagely, without finding how to clean and heal his wounds, repeating the original pattern over and over again. It can improve, perhaps, its shell, but keeping intact, hidden and uncared for, wild and rugged, the inner animal turned monster.

11. JOKES AND CARTOONS:



12. TRANSFORMATION PROCESS AND THERAPEUTIC RECOMMENDATIONS

By Cristina Nadal And Cristina Dicuzzo

Hate Consciousness:

If we focus on the specifics of sexual E4, the first consideration is that these people need to become aware of their hatred. Many times, it is difficult for them to fit the word hate to the expression of their feelings and they almost always try to justify their actions and emotions based on the previous actions of others. It is necessary, then, that this righteous rage be given its true name and see how it is hiding or denying its guilt. The hatred felt by the sexual E4 is behind the arrogance that looks at the weaknesses of others very carefully so as not to feel inferior and weak.

“When my therapist told me not to look at her with that hate, I had a tremendous insight. I would never have said that what I was feeling was hate and there I entered my own guilty underworld, where I had not wanted to enter until then. I who believed that I had every right to feel those emotions, I who was good. It was the others who did not understand me.”

Theresa Andreu

It will be necessary to realize how they have become an expert in seeking, reactively and automatically, the weaknesses and reproachable aspects of others to escape the hatred that makes them feel inferior and recognize their own weaknesses and failures.

“The great obstacle that the sexual E4 encounters in order to get in touch with his character is to admit that he is ill, to give in to the evidence, to get out of the stubbornness that most of the time what he considers sincere and authentic in his way of expressing himself. It's pure hatred and competitiveness. It is essential for the sexual Four to come to understand that hate is a hard drug, an addiction from which one cannot be cured forever. I insist on this point because it has to do with the extremist positions that we of this subtype tend to adopt and that are real obstacles to growth. The euphoria produced by seeing progress in the healing process, like despair when one stagnates, are dangerous emotions that justify getting discouraged, throwing in the towel, surrendering to chaos. They are emotions that feedback the hatred towards oneself and expand it outwards with all that it entails of their own unhappiness and that of others. I experienced all this through my therapeutic process.”

Annie Chevreux

Focusing on the passion of envy, we see that it is essential to assume the feeling of envy and the passionate nature of the emotion, and then appreciate what one has instead of looking so much at what the other has. It is good to see the price that the envied person has paid to have what he has and see if one is willing to pay it; the position is envied but not the process and the effort to achieve it. Although this can be experienced in a similar

way in the other subtypes, in the sexual E4 the difficulty in trying is typical, as if things had to be given to him, "like a queen".

Being satisfied with one's own life and evaluating one's own experiences is necessary, as is observation of all the aspects that the envied entails. Obviously, whether this change is achieved by rational conviction, a therapeutic work must at the same time value the sincere wound that the person brings, recognize what was truly lacking and learn to grieve for it, and not resort to complaints. aggressive and to the intensity of emotions, even hysterical attacks, to effectively not connect with his real lack of affection and his deep pain for what he experienced in his childhood. Like all E4 they have to learn to feel pain and not get attached to suffering.

Recognizing the need behind the search for intensity that can be disguised as originality, modernity or creativity is healing. Several members of this subtype may share the statement: "I don't ask, I wait to be guessed." The members of this subgroup will be offended if the other does not guess their need, even without having revealed it. Recognizing the need equalizes as a human being and opens the subject to the exchange necessary to mature. Recognizing one's own desire, as such, allows one to orient oneself towards achieving it. The healing thing for the sexual E4 will be to focus on getting it by your own means, asking, negotiating, not demanding or assuming that you have to receive what you want. that I have realized that with anger and rage I hide an unrecognized need ". The difficulty in identifying it lies in the refusal to feel the vulnerability associated with said experience.

One of the fruitful therapeutic tasks is to break with the desire to be special, to dare to recognize oneself and feel like one of the crowd. In other words, it is healthy for people belonging to the sexual E4 to begin to accept that they are ordinary people; this implies work on narcissism of which this character is not aware, it is difficult for him to recognize that he identifies with the unattainable ego ideal. It is both healing and liberating to accept that one is normal; abandoning the desire to be special at all times, at first it can be settling, acceptance comes later. Go on recognizing your own fragility, as well as your own mistakes helps to see the other as equal. The other also needs attention, acknowledgment, sorry, like everyone. In relationships with others it is curative to go more unnoticed, not always show off oneself, appear less and be more present. It's reassuring to go knowing that whatever you do, it's not that important."

Containment:

Another specific task for this subtype is to identify when the angry histrionic outburst is going to be triggered and learn to hold it, deepen your breath, and count to ten. This is necessary if the person wants to give himself the chance to learn to respond to the situation that has triggered the exaltation instead of just reacting. That is, approaching being able to do nothing. Being able to stop until you see more clearly what is happening and what is triggering the explosion. In therapy, this patient has to learn to take the time to mentally elaborate, give meaning to what happens and feels before letting himself be carried away by emotion.

Breathing anxiety and anguish gives anyone the possibility of deepening the knowledge that these emotions reveal when looked at in the face. This last task, for

subjects belonging to the sexual subtype, contributes to generating the necessary time to learn to stand on their own feet instead of trying to be saved by others.

Recognizing anxiety as such, differentiating it from the mental productions that feed it, will reduce the volume of intensity to which this subtype is so addicted.

It can be easy for the sexual E4 to go into therapy, as it is something they know they need. But at work all your competitiveness is very present and a lot of skill is required on the part of the therapist to break the conflict that the sexual E4 continually raises. As we said when talking about their relationship with authority, if the patient can concede authority to the therapist, the conflict gives way to dedication to therapeutic work. Said competitiveness tends to be softer when the sexual E4 is already in the adult and mature phase of his life, in which he has surely already had many disappointments and breakups. It is then when the awareness of hate can be more curative because one has already explored many paths and has seen that the problem cannot always be outside.

Another difficulty in therapy can be the lack of discipline of this nature, which does not want limits. It may be that during the process he finds himself with feelings of boredom that hide the refusal to give up the drug of intensity, as he will also try to challenge the therapist to verify the truth of his interest or love.

Listen, sensitivity and tenderness:

Listening and loving confrontation, along with non-judgment by the therapist, are essential for the sexual E4 to commit to its healing process. Much patience is required on the part of the therapist to contain invalidations and relapses.

“Both as a client and in the role of therapist, the most effective has been when I have been able to verify that, even when the therapist was pointing out something ugly in me, I continued to have his love, which did not punish me or abandon me. From this experience, greater confidence settles in me, and I no longer need to manipulate or control life, I can bear distances much better, that they don't prefer me, that they don't choose me, that they don't like me, I can orient myself within my preferences and choices taking charge of them and taking risks. Now the person in charge of my life is me.”

Cristina Dicuzzo

Reactive hatred tends to give a lot of strength and the sexual E4 needs, to change, to rely on sensitivity and tenderness. Many times, at the beginning of the healing process, the sexual E4 feels vulnerable and fragile and thinks that before it was better off with hateful energy as a shield.

I am realizing that the intensity was a form of escape, in this sense I have changed a lot the concept of love that was so transcendent and intense and my life as a couple is much more serene, it is real, I do not have to invent it.

The difficulty of expressing my feelings was shame or modesty of being sensitive or tender and loving.

Body, subtlety, and presence:

People of this subtype need to give a more subtle relevance to body awareness and intuition as guides to orient themselves against the compulsion of exaggerated thoughts and emotions. They require not letting the mind wander and become obsessed with ideas and emotions and paying more attention to small tensions in some part of the body when the mind, for example, is obsessed with wanting to be right. The distinction that what one is feeling is exaggerated or theatrical is something that can be subtly perceived if one is attentive.

For me, the bodily process has been very important, I am a person who first perceives from the body and then gradually emerges into consciousness. Many times, my processes are accompanied by the certainty that something is wrong with me but I don't really know what it is and that certainty comes from the body. I have always felt a gap between my energy and my consciousness. In my longing is the desire to relive certain situations that make my heart beat a thousand, however, I can't anymore, my body won't let me.

The abandonment of intensity, in general, brings calm once the experience of running into boredom has been gone through. Boredom, for this subtype is an excellent door to get closer to themselves. This means appreciating the ordinary and insignificant, also the range of greyish colors, as a way of working inside, as a vehicle to go down into the depths. Learn to distinguish between the emotional intensity that they think is deep and the subtle emotional movements of the inner world that constitute the experience of existing.

I experience the search for intensity as an alteration of the senses, a deformation of the perception of reality that makes me believe that this is the only way I am feeling. When I unveil this spell, I can appear dull, less vibrant, not only to others, but also to myself. But I feel it's good to stay there. The need to explode is withdrawing and gives way to sustaining. I am more interested in myself and less projected on the envied object.

The reduction of intensity in the sphere of the sexual makes them more open to the subtle and exquisite, leaving the great experiences and, often, coarse or empty of content.

I feel a regulation of sexual appetite to the benefit of the awareness of my need to give and receive affection, although I am haunted by the crazy idea of never reconnecting with sexual desire if I let myself. Instinct regulation puts me in touch with boredom, normality, lack of intensity. There is something addictive in this.

The work that is essential is to focus on the perception of the here and now, trusting in one's own intuition (differentiated from fantasy) and not giving respite to resentment and prejudices. When the sexual E4 is totally open to the present, it cannot be express hate or comparison. The sexual E4 is usually in the past, either to magnify it or to reject it and it is good to leave behind what could or could not be. It is also necessary to gradually recognize and release the ideal fantasies projected into the future.

It is highly therapeutic to land on the obvious, leaving aside all the fanciful arguments that maintain the high degree of anxiety in which sexual E4s easily settle. Some people belonging to this subtype explain it as learning to say "bread, bread and wine, wine." For example, being able to see a beautiful sunset without having to intensify this vision with some other memory, being able to enjoy it without having to find a special and esoteric meaning in order to savor it; or to be able to feel mourning or sadness without having to turn the experience into an absolutely heartbreaking hell. A woman belonging to this subgroup understands looking at the obvious as:

Using the eyes to see, not for the benefit of the imagination. You didn't have to be so nostalgic for the mountains in the distance or try to remember what mood you were in the last time you saw them. They were beautiful in themselves, period. From then on I became more active, determined and began to take the concrete into account.

Responsibility:

Another essential point is to take responsibility for your own life and stop believing that the other can save you. Loneliness is usually very productive and realizing that the same things happen to one alone as being with the other, so you cannot blame them for your dissatisfaction.

It is enriching to accept emotions as they come and not give them so much importance; For this it helps to develop the meditative attitude of recognizing them and letting them go, letting go without clinging to them.

The absolute dedication to experiences is usually a good antidote to the demand that things be as one wants. We see reflected in this sentence the fruits of this type of inner work:

A state is emerging in me where I just am and can simply withdraw when I no longer want to be.

As we have mentioned, behind the layer of hatred and arrogance there is a great compassionate heart that needs to be revealed little by little. First accepting one's own mistakes and loving oneself a little more, even if one is not as wonderful as the projected model, then embracing the dirtiest and most vile, the horrible monster that one believes one carries inside, which is not so terrible if it is given a voice and if it is listened to.

The emotional split between criticism and overvaluation (more typical of this subtype) is something known in the sexual E4 and, although it is very difficult initially, it is worth little by little working to have a more even stance; train yourself not to give more importance to one thing than the other, to keep your spirits the same no matter what. The virtue corresponding to E4 is equanimity. For the sexual subtype, the practice of this virtue is especially difficult since it is the character that most polarizes their emotions and experiences. As we have explained, it alternately identifies itself in the most deprived, depressed pole, or in the grandiose, exalted pole. For this reason, it can sometimes be confused with a sexual E7.

The difference is in the emotional intensity and in their distorted interpretation of lack of all internal and external events. Getting out of this polarization for sexual E4 can be interpreted as giving up what you need and want, giving up the dream of abundance and, consequently, of being seen and valued as a person.

Equanimity has to be well understood and practiced as the ability to see what is there and what is missing, what pleases and what hurts from a position of neutrality that does not renounce either of the two experiences but knows how to evaluate them and move according to the opportunity of the context in the here and now.

Frustration, laughter, and satisfaction

One of the hardest jobs of the sexual Four is dealing with frustration and rejection, there is no other better way to master the idealizing ego and see that the role of queen so well known in this subtype hides distrust in themselves and therefore the fear of committing to what they want. Fear is at the base of the anxiety that is so easily triggered. Also decriminalizing the queen, playing it, expressing it, getting to know it, admitting it allows one to risk saying “no” when they do not want something or to seek without disguising so much what they do want.

It is about understanding that no matter how much theatre is put on there are things that are not going to change and are as they are. And above all, that this idealized character that one would like to become is ideal, in the most literal sense of the word, an idea that will never be real.

“He must accept that neither himself nor the world are as he imagined them to be. That everything is not going to be unbearably bland and boring if he puts aside his fictional vision of life. That this unrealistic way of apprehending the world is not harmless and that hatred and contempt for the basic aspects of survival nestle in the excesses of aesthetic valuation. Healing involves mothering, realizing that one is made of flesh and blood like the others and that in order not to die one needs to eat, shelter, organize, develop a practical sense, that is, learn to be in favor of oneself as a way of leaving to hate yourself. One must tie oneself short with the tendency to self-destruction. Set tasks and schedules, be productive so as not to sink into chaos. You have to discipline yourself in anything that makes you feel good about yourself. The discomfort caused by a lack of self-esteem causes hate to grow. It is a vicious circle from which one has to force oneself to get out. It is a matter of will.”

Annie Chevreux

Laughing at oneself is a good job to lower the resentful ego against others. When the therapist can lead the client with great affection and respect to laugh at their own mechanisms, a path back to health begins. Laughing at oneself and self-irony require letting go of the ideal, which is worth differentiating from cynicism and sarcasm, which are the fruit of bitterness. It is interesting to open up to the celebration:

It is very important for me to strengthen the sense of joy, the contact with the Dionysian, sometimes I forget, and I stay dry. Cultivate an attitude of celebration, what life brings me is just what I need and want.

Differentiating pleasure from excitement allows us to get closer to the experience of satisfaction. This is an emotion that appears throughout the process of self-knowledge, gaining ground, since the person can get closer to more intrinsic aspects of himself and can take care of the issues that concern him.

The following testimony reflects very graphically the experience of getting closer to herself by a woman of this subtype when reflecting on the phase of personal work in which she finds herself:

“In this phase there is, as in the previous one, fear, anguish, anxiety, but I do not despair (at least not always, that is already an achievement). This is very important to me. I am much more capable than before of being with myself, whatever happens to me. I can stop and not believe everything I tell myself, neither the very good nor the very bad. I stop giving credibility to the automatism that either insults me or praises me to make me flee from the present moment and from the genuine emotions that are found in it. I accept more, I run less, I climb the walls, but I don't leave the room. I look at the door, but I don't pound on it, I don't scratch at it, in a desperate attempt to get out. I stay, I see myself and I try to welcome with affection what is happening.”

Elisa White

It is worth highlighting the ability to thank, to feel gratitude, which is curative for any envious subtype, providing the following statement that reflects the specific difficulty of this subtype in being able to really feel it.

It was expensive to find the inability to thank. I gave thanks for a yes, for a no, like a parrot, without conscience, to be liked or to be nice, the obedient, but real gratitude, the luminous feeling that springs from within, it took me a long time to get close to her. I experience this lack as a misfortune, as well as a lack of talent. It has been the most desperate and arduous part of the interior work. As if my life depended on me if I give my arm to twist. If I thank the other, I lose merit, I fear sinking into misery and disappearing.

Gratitude, satisfaction, and creativity:

All the therapeutic tasks that we have referred to throughout this point make it easier to expand both satisfaction and contentment as well as gratitude. Both feed back.

What is being refined, as the sexual E4 works on itself, is the ability to reveal deceit, abuse and falsehood in oneself and also in others, realizing that what was previously used in favour of the ego can now be used to stop it. When they are no longer so egoic, they have a great capacity to confront lovingly with great energy and forcefulness that opens the heart of the other.

Throughout the personal work process, the creative capacity will gradually turn in favour of work, enjoyment and satisfaction. It is stripped of the imperative need to attract attention and is freed from the compulsive competitiveness typical of this subtype. It can be a therapeutic task to turn drama into an artistic production since most have this talent. Transferring in drawings, dance or music what is being lived can facilitate equanimity and helps to detach from the false identity built on suffering. The experience of transferring an artistic product, stripped of the idealistic aspiration to be something stupendous that everyone can appreciate, becomes a practice of experiencing being.

Finally, the sexual E4 can subscribe to this type of vital perspective:

I am coming to the experience that what life brings me is just what I need and want. Cultivating this attitude does me good and makes the richness hidden in everything that happens unfold. Let go, stop grabbing.

THIRD BOOK
ENVY IN THE SOCIAL INSTINCT

CORDENATION:

Chiara Fuscini

EDITION:

Cristina Busi y Alichita Ross

TEAM & WITNESS:

Alchita Rosi, Chiara Fustini, Susana Basáñez, Elena Curiel,
Giaia Cignon, Rosi Canta, Wie Maria Weber, Elena Lunardi,
Marina Putzolu, Walter Martini.

TRANSLATION:

Facundo Piperno y María José Morales Fore.

1. THE PASSION IN THE SPHERE OF THE INSTINCT: SHAME

By Alichita Rossi, Chiara Fustini, Giulia Clignon

The social E4 has a smoother and softer attitude than the conservation E4 and the sexual E4. He usually has a slim build, his back tends to go forward and his shoulders to close, as if he wanted to make himself smaller than he is. His body expresses the desire not to be seen and to hide from others. By withdrawing anger towards himself, the 4 tends to close the chest forward. E4's face is marked - this is a characteristic of this type ---, but his gaze is languid, ostentatious, pleading and sweet. By establishing a relationship with the outside world, he shows both the sweetest part of himself and the suffering, to further stimulate the loving kindness of the other.

“When Claudio invited me to say something about myself in my first SAT, he compared me to Bambi -from the Disney cartoons- because of my languid and fearful appearance. This image was a revelation to me. I discovered that my body and my attitude went hand in hand with the desire to inspire love and sweetness so as not to be punished or beaten.”

Chiara Fustini

When the social instinct feels invaded by envy, it turns to self-hatred, to the feeling of devaluing oneself in continuous comparison with others and the subsequent feeling of inadequacy in relation to the group to which one belongs, or to which one wishes to belong.

Like all E4, the social tends to make continuous comparisons between himself and the other. He constantly worries about himself and always loses out; not infrequently he is very hard on himself and can have a punitive and contemptuous attitude towards himself. The social aspect is represented precisely by the gaze directed at what is outside him, the continuous confrontation with the outside world, which leads him to maintain a constant focus on what he lacks.

“During my first month of life my sister was conceived. I think that this circumstance prematurely changed the breastfeeding phase and the bond with my mother, since I felt that a part of her was no longer for me. His birth did not improve things. On the contrary, he created more distance, as soon as he was born, he had a severe pneumonia that completely absorbed my mother's attention and energy. I felt very alone and abandoned, I felt that there was no interest in me anymore. I remember an insistent image that accompanied me throughout time in which I am standing on the threshold of the bedroom, neither inside nor outside, motionless and leaning against the door frame. No one notices me, my mother is completely turned towards my sister, bending over her, like a single organism. All that affection - that "world" - hurt me deeply because I was not part of it. And the more I looked at them, the more I felt my body grow disproportionately like a rubber puppet, bloated and speechless, a giant that no one saw or heard. I couldn't do anything, not even make noise, for her to notice me, I just became “eyes”.”

Rose C

The passion of envy manifests itself differently from the other subtypes: at the beginning of the course it is very difficult for this character to recognize it, not only

because he considers it a deplorable and negative feeling , but because lacking the tenacity of the conservation subtype that sustains the feeling of lack-and the instinctive sexual freedom that takes what it lacks-, the social subtype transforms envy into false admiration: the other becomes the model he aspires to emulate, even with the conviction that he will not succeed, since he never feels adequate. You can have a dual attitude towards people: although it is easy for you to idealize them, you can just as easily devalue them. The devaluation arises, paradoxically, at the moment when he gets what he wants. When he achieves the goal so desired or coveted, he loses his charm, his attractiveness and his importance, despite having seemed to him the only reason for happiness. This mechanism is related to a neurotic need to maintain tension towards something that one does not possess internally, but it is also linked to the low value of the social E4 towards oneself, which it then also transmits to those who show love or devotion to it. "If he loves a nobody like me, it means that there is something wrong with him, otherwise he would aspire to something better," he thinks, although this thought is ambivalently accompanied by the expectation of being special, of being loved without half measures.

"This lack, this perpetual pursuit of goals that immediately lost their meaning and meaning the moment they were achieved, has also been the engine of my life to achieve things. I always felt that "it's never enough", I pursued and achieved (probably with the tenacity of my second subtype, conservation) many things: I graduated in Educational Sciences, then I became a teaching assistant, then I did a master's degree, then a bachelor's degree in psychology. I never felt competent enough in my profession and for years I looked outside for that security that I couldn't find inside myself. Few people know all my ways, because there is still a feeling of shame in admitting what I have achieved. Immediately that devaluing voice takes over, telling me that with all these titles any other person would have been able to build a more satisfying and better paid career."

Giulia C

"If I look at what I have done, the list is long. I also recognize that I manage to focus and be effective in my work but the feeling of "not being enough" remains, I always feel as if I know nothing, I feed this feeling by staying messy and disorganized. A little over the top, putting too much on the plate! For example: I always read two or three or more books at the same time! It almost amazes me when I receive grateful comments from my patients, who love it! I mean that the work was hers; great difficulty in taking recognition and credit; I don't know if it's envy, but when someone does it, I feel disgusted, it seems shameless to me."

Marina P

"When I finished high school I enrolled in the Faculty of Architecture, a decision that came almost by chance, since combining my aptitude for mathematics and scientific subjects and my desire for humanistic knowledge, it was an "everything" for me. I must say I had no major difficulties, I graduated within the curricula deadlines, everything was planned, easy to follow; There was also the tiredness, the moments of bewilderment when I felt my incapacity and above all the lack of an example to guide me, but there was also the success that I was able to obtain from my education. The problem, later, was the discomfort in carrying out the commissions, in complying with the requests of others, something for which they paid me, I was in crisis in the design phase, in my ideation-creation. Every time I had the feeling of putting my hands in an

empty sack and before trying it I was afraid of not finding anything, the effort became necessary and then the tiredness, I needed the confrontation and the company. I continued my training ad aeternum in several specialization schools to increase my knowledge and skills in different areas, with the experience of therapy I wanted to know more, and I graduated as a counsellor, but it was never enough, after all it was what I felt that best he knew how to do: fill the void."

Rose C

The emptiness and the feeling of uselessness are fed by the constant search and comparison with new or foreign things and situations ("I have to learn", "I am never enough") instead of looking at what they have or what is and recognizing their own worth. The external gaze replaces the internal gaze.

"I always assumed tasks of great responsibility: leading teams, bringing quality innovators to educational centers where they carried out work projects, managing conflicts, organizing, and directing training sessions for hundreds of teachers. The commitment I put in was always beyond my limits, in a challenge that never ended. All the accolades, successes, and many accolades I received did not change my internal state of lack, of not measuring up anyway, with the malaise and unacknowledgedness that had devastated me in my childhood."

Valter M

Desire and longing as well as aspiration are strong emotions that appeal to you. The passionate motivation that keeps him alive is envy and suffering for not having what he wants and sees in the other.

The social E4 is hungry to be loved, and to achieve this he invests a lot of energy in being recognized as belonging, having a place in the group, being considered, and feeling important. Paradoxically, it is usually solitary, silent, and docile. He prefers to hide, he doesn't like being the center of attention at all, which he avoids from time to time, but at the same time if he is not remembered, if he is not paid attention to, he suffers and feels non-existent. He doesn't want to be in the center because it scares him and he doesn't feel equal enough, but he has an overwhelming desire to be seen, with the illusion of being discovered in his invisibility. At the same time, when he sees himself, he feels that he has something deeply inadequate, wrong, or dirty inside him that makes him feel uncomfortable and ashamed.

"I remember during a SAT course, early in my journey, Claudio asked me to stand up and speak. For a moment I felt a great embarrassment and could not look at the group publicly. He asked me what I was ashamed of and I told him that I had the feeling that others could see inside me. "What do you see?" asked Claudio again. I was afraid that they would see that I was not a nice, meek and clean person. I felt deeply dirty."

Chiara F

The social E4 has a constant need for recognition not only from the group to which it belongs, but also from outsiders: if they recognize me, I am worth it". He sees himself and identifies himself based on how the world perceives him. In the social character subtype of envy there is a constant emotional contact with lack and a desire to fill the void. He lives in an incessant feeling that only the outside world is indispensable in order to satisfy his lack of fulfilment and recover a sense of personal worth. It is as if a part of him is still waiting for what his mother had in childhood; only the object has changed, the

same idealization of the other remains and the expectation of receiving what will make him satisfied, fill the feeling of emptiness and finally be happy.

The social E4 has little autonomy and, not feeling worthy even to ask for help, uses laments: his request for help, never explicit, is made up of tears, sweetness, irony, but also of blaming the other, above all when angry and disappointed by whatever he expected, and it hasn't happened.

He has a strong emotionality and also a pronounced capacity for empathy, but it is his emotions that arise as a reflection of the outside world; it is as if his emotions, feelings, and behavior cannot be separated from the world outside him. Empathy is the channel through which you allow yourself to experience your emotions even more fully and feed that emotional part that makes you feel alive and not alone.

In the family context, he has learned how he should be so as not to bother, not to irritate his mother, not to be punished or mistreated, but he has forgotten to listen to himself, to his needs, to express them and to trust that they can be satisfied, something that perhaps you have never learned.

"I feel my predisposition to isolate myself, not to be in a group, especially in moments of celebration, of lightness. Punctually fear prevails in me, when I should be enjoying with others, to feel invaded or forced to share banalities, to show off and be unsigned. All of this with a feeling of self-exclusion, of not measuring up, of basically giving up on meeting my true needs."

Valter M

Childhood:

Already in childhood, the social E4 feeds the illusion that he can save the people around him, even if they hurt and humiliate him. He believes that by saving them, giving them a chance at redemption, he can save himself. Thus, he identifies with the other, projecting his need to be saved, as if he wanted to "eat" his loved ones. The real need to satisfy the "hunger for mother" and the impossibility of doing so leads the E4 social child to be filled with anger towards his own mother, an anger that he cannot allow himself to express, since he needs her, depends on her. Thus, he swallows it, to feel that he has it inside. "Since I can't have you, I'll become you, so I can have you and also hate you." The social E4 has a relationship with himself that mirrors the one he experienced with his mother: if his mother speaks contemptuously to him, the child addresses himself contemptuously, if his mother is annoyed by his laughter and play, he represses himself, forbidding himself to laugh and play. If his mother repeats: "You do everything wrong, you're useless", and the person constantly says to himself: "<I do everything wrong, I'm useless", and he is convinced of it. Thus, she incorporates the "bad mother", she carries her inside, she swallows her, she cannot bear the pain of not really having an ideally good mother all to herself. The feeling of disappointment and frustration turns it on itself; even the hatred he should naturally feel towards her, he directs towards himself. It is as if, by swallowing her mother, she can hate her through the hatred she directs at herself.

"I am the first of three children, first born with a short-lived "singularity". In the same year, after ten months, my sister was born. With her birth (or perhaps already during her gestation), I lost my "paradise" and became "the eldest" from the beginning. I remember a dream I had during therapeutic work: "I was little, I think I was barely a month old, I was resting in my crib and waiting for my parents to come back from a party. They arrived after a while intoxicated with joy, happy, and as soon as they entered I was certain of my sister's conception, I felt that my mother could no longer feed me and suddenly she became a murderer of which I had to be wary. ". So vivid was this feeling that all night I slept curled up next to my roommate's bed, certain that someone behind the door was out to kill me. With the birth of my sister, the very brief privilege that I had experienced until then completely disappeared: she was demanding, centralizing and arrogant, she could monopolize all the attention on herself and I felt invisible. After a while, my brother also came. They told me that at first I was a happy and communicative girl, with a great fondness for music and dancing, but little by little I lost that joy. I remember that my brothers played a lot, there was complicity between them, their self-confidence, their desire to have fun, caught my attention, I saw them as pure and innocent; I participated little, I was excluded, and I felt different and forgotten. She was like a spectator at the window of family events, waiting for something to change."

Rose C

The social E4 has internalized the negative and devaluing look of the mother and has interpreted it as a lack of love towards him. For this reason, he has convinced himself that he is what the adult made him feel he was, and his deep wound is that of not being important. With these characteristics and an indistinct fear of the world, of life, of things, of people, it is clear that the E4 individual finds it very difficult to assert himself, to experiment, to savor what life offers him and to launch himself into experiences. What he does most spontaneously is to withdraw from the world, shut himself away and isolate himself. His is an extreme need of the other in order to live.

"As a child, I realized very early on that I had to fend for myself and that I couldn't explicitly ask for help, since there was always someone in the family who had bigger and more important problems and needs, emotional or material, than mine. Thus, I began to underestimate and hide my needs from my mother, ending up hiding them from myself and being unable to recognize them. The emptiness I felt as a child became an existential emptiness."

Giulia C

Sometimes, in childhood, he has suffered the social ascent of some member of the family and, therefore, fights a downward battle to denounce the neurotic movement and his emotional abandonment, due to the father's interest in success, perhaps trying to be as important as the outside world that so attracted his mother or father. Other times, we find ourselves with a family "shame" for failure or "guilt", and it takes charge of not feeling worthy of the social environment. It is a character that is formed from the need to be seen, a need that self-sabotages by the fear of not being successful. And it is precisely the self-sabotage that becomes the condition to continue aspiring without really facing limits or real failure. In the same way that the frustration or pain of failing becomes a weapon to express anger against those who do not take care of their hurt.

“If I fulfil myself socially, I do something that she likes and gives satisfaction to my mother (E3 social), then I don't do it. To get revenge, I am ready to destroy and self-sabotage myself.”

Giulia C

When what the experiences is very unpleasant or painful, he spends his time waiting for redemption from the "enemy" who causes him so much suffering. He doesn't leave, he doesn't run away, he doesn't save himself but waits, as he has always done since childhood, for the other person to notice him, his pain; then finally see him and love him.

The social E4 grew up with a painful ambivalence: the person who should have loved him, should have taken care of him, is the one who made him suffer the most, the one who castrated him and from whom he must defend himself. This ambivalence is perpetually present in the life of the social E4.

With these ambivalent parental figures, he experiences that his happiness is linked to others, to the feelings that he can inspire in other people, to his presence, to his closeness: essential factors to endure the painful sensation of inner loneliness.

Although the social E4 has an enormous need for attention, he does not ask for it directly. Far be it from waiting for him, although it is within her rights. He is afraid of being a burden to the other and, consequently, of losing him, he is afraid of realizing that he is a nuisance to the other and, consequently, he can become a difficult person for the other: difficult to understand, difficult to satisfy. Always wait for the times and moments of others. You think it's not important enough to spend precious time on. And so he interprets the confirmation that it is not worth enough.

Unlike the E4 conservation, which gets attention through detachment and the tenacity to do things alone, the social person tries to get what he wants through complaining, suffering, illness, all the aspects that make him uncomfortable. I manifest their lack and that they can stimulate the other to come closer and fill their emptiness with what they need; it is as if he were saying pleadingly: “Give me, please. Can't you see how I suffer? Can't you see how it hurts

Along with the feeling of inner fragility and the inability or impossibility to ask directly, a shame regarding the effect aroused in the other person may also grow in this person and he may feel ashamed when the other person feels compassion for him. She may be ashamed of her own frailty, of feeling unable to provide for and care for herself and of her dependence on the other, and feel a strong sense of shame when the other "sees" her and realizes how helpless she is.

Sometimes it can happen that an illness and its subsequent instrumentalization revive in the social E4 the perspective of finally receiving from the other that loving gaze that he has been waiting for all his life. The disease can be for E4 in general a form to get the attention of people of reference and to feel loved.

“I remember that when I found out that I had cancer, I thought that my mother would finally be aware of me, of my existence, that in addition to her youngest son, she would also be aware that she had another daughter. To wake up he had to lose that daughter he had never seen.

Nothing seemed to faze or worry her. Once, during a trip to Africa, I contracted cerebral malaria, early diagnosis was my salvation. When I got home, I just had to do a follow-up exam. I didn't know how to tell my mother, I was afraid of her reaction, since it was something very serious anyway. Instead, he not only underestimated her but even laughed at it. On that occasion, I remember that both my ex-husband and I were surprised."

Alichita R

Illness can be an opportunity to get out of impotence and the inability to act, to avoid abandonment, to keep the other tied. It can be a real loophole, a means to avoid the worst: separation, anger, estrangement from the other. Faced with the fragility of the subject, faced with his state of need, the other can only lay down his weapons or intentions and retrace his steps; other times, on the other hand, illness is a channel for the expression of anger, as a kind of mystified revenge, a punishment that can appeal to the feeling of guilt. In some contexts, illness can be a convincing excuse to say "no" to uncomfortable or overly demanding requests.

I had a very difficult few years, emotionally and practically, taking care of a father with dementia. Being the only one of the three children single and without children, there was a family mandate for me to take care of dad, who lost his autonomy every day. There was a strong ambivalence; I wanted to take care of him and at the same time I tried to follow an inner voice that told me I couldn't sacrifice my life in that way (I had already done that for my mother, who had already left about ten years before, after fighting cancer for twenty years).

"At one point, my back got stuck. For a week I was in bed unable to get up and needing injections and painkillers. I think it was my way of saying "I can't anymore"."

Giulia C.

When you are given a task, you can give yourself completely. At first, he is assailed by discouragement and panic: "Can I really do it? It's very difficult, I'm not up to it! What figure am I going to make!"

The first thing he thinks about is giving up, because he fears it will be a disaster; his exhausting internal struggle begins, he warns the other person of his lack of capacity, but then his desire to participate, to belong, to obey the demands of others prevails. After a series of reproaches to himself, he tries to shake himself off and try to comply with what is asked of him. It must be a job done to the best of its ability. However, once he's done and checked to see if he really did a good job, he downplays the praise. They embarrass him, because he feels that he "steals" the compliments; Before the praises he feels bad faith because he is never happy with the final result. 'You've only done the least part of your duty', or 'Oddly enough, this has come in handy, I've been lucky, too bad it's worthless for everything else. He constantly forgets about repeated successes and continues to demolish and injure himself. He brings back memories of "neutral situations," which he judges to be failures that he never gets rid of. It fixes in his memory with incredible ease the scenes of situations in which he has failed, while literally erasing those in which he has achieved his goals brilliantly and letting the compliments and praises he has received pass by, always finding a reason to devalue them. or downplay them.

When I was in college, I remember often getting good grades. By the time I got a 'thirty in my notebook I wasn't glowing with joy, it didn't seem possible that I was actually touched. As

soon as he turned his back on me and went downstairs, I told myself that I had done well because the teacher was in a good mood that day, or that the test was easy, or that I had asked myself the questions I was most prepared for. In short, at the bottom of the stairs there was no trace of the intense joy that he had felt.

Alichita R

From early childhood he acquires the idea that pleasure is punished or paid for later with pain. The social E4 child does not allow himself to feel pleasure because he fears the pain that will come: the pain of discovering that the pleasure is not real, or that it will not last. But he also faces a reversal of the belief that if he continues to suffer, he will be able to gain attention. Thus he enters into a vicious existential circle; it is but that by suffering I can receive what will make me happy, but if I don't suffer, I can't aspire to be given what I need.

I well remember the air in my house when I was a child. There was only room for having to do, to fight to survive. Entertainment was forbidden, work on Sundays was even more demanding, never a movie, a little trip, a vacation. If I smiled when I met my mother's eyes, she would immediately stop me: "Why are you laughing, don't you know that something terrible could happen tomorrow?"

Valter M

The angry rejection towards the mother is usually directed at food, which in a way is what the child cannot openly express as the equivalent of the tit: "eat", nourishment, becomes a real torture for him.

I ate nothing, I liked very few things, not even pizza! I couldn't even force myself to eat certain things; this was a source of conflicts; my mother was a sweet tooth; I changed my tastes when I got pregnant.

Marine P

Eating becomes an obligation, the morsels of food pile up in his mouth, forming a big "ball" that he cannot swallow. This often arouses anxiety in the mother, who tries to force him to eat, and gets angry with him and punishes him. What was pleasant at first - food is one of the greatest pleasures in life - ends up becoming a torment; in the end, it is the only weapon left to him to fight against his mother, to return the hatred he feels towards her and to make him stay with her and give her some of his time. It is possible to conceive of an eating disorder as a relentless sadistic attack on one's own body. For those who suffer from this disorder, the body represents the conflict with the mother, with femininity itself and with sexuality (Kernberg, 1994). Social E4 often has an ambivalent relationship to food, which represents the link between the self and the internalized mother figure. With the symptoms of anorexia or bulimia, people of this character manifest the difficulty and ambivalence between wanting to become an "adult", overcoming dependency, and remaining in the illusory protection of the omnipotent primary relationship. The physiological anguish triggered by growth takes refuge in the regression to orality and food -desired, rejected, vomited, idealized- becomes the sign of the conflict between the illusion of being master of oneself and pathological dependence.

Often, the problem with food tends to resurface in adulthood, when the end of a relationship is in sight. In that circumstance, it can happen that the subject loses almost

all appetite and finds it difficult to eat. It is as if through food, in a situation of especially intense emotional pain, a regression occurred in him.

In all situations, when a relationship ended, the hunger disappeared. My emotions filled everything, I always felt full. The needs of the body were crushed and forgotten by the emotionality that overwhelmed me, I felt strong with that emotion, I felt alive even though my body disappeared.

Chiara F

The food represented the true relationship that existed between my mother and all the members of the family: it was she, the cook, who dispensed pleasure and love through the careful preparation of her dishes. When I left the house, I remember my paroxysmal neurosis of running home to make myself some food so as not to panic, since I felt in a kind of mortal danger of not being fed. The fridge was full to bursting despite me being the only inhabitant of my flat.

Valter M

Masochism / Self-destruction:

Basically, there is in the social E4 a strong fear. He fears that the unstable, unreliable, and sometimes dangerous environment that surrounds him - which he still perceives as that of his childhood - may cause him new pain. He doesn't know how to move in the world, he has the feeling that everything is bigger than him and that it surpasses him and he doesn't see any way out; he feels defenceless, as if he had no skin.

And in the end, situations are created around him that are inexorably sources of pain: everything is repeated as in childhood, when his parents caused him more pain than comfort and even their absence made him suffer: he feels like a dog that bites its tail.

Social E4 is the subtype in which masochism is most manifested. The paradox is to harm oneself or cause oneself physical pain in order to relieve or feel less emotional pain, or sometimes even "seeking pleasure", or rather the feeling of existing, or a contact with oneself. Accustomed to his mother's punishments, he continues to inflict them. "I've let myself down, I'm ashamed of myself!" he says to himself, and an anguish arises in him that, until he has been punished, will not let him live.

Obviously, the ideal of himself, having never satisfied the mother, is very high and impossible to reach, so he always disappoints himself, creates psychological suffering or procures physical pain on the borderline between pain and pleasure and risks procuring true bodily injuries that cause direct or indirect illnesses up to the extreme gesture of suicide, that can be experienced as an extreme gesture of revenge on the other who has not paid us due attention, who has ignored us and underestimated our needs and suffering. In this type of character, the self-destructive gesture has the meaning of a cry against the world that did not understand him, did not look for him and did not see his talents.

There are people from the social E4 who have a tendency to consciously injure themselves. For example, to cut one's limbs and then see how the blood flows: its release, like a bloodletting, frees one from anguish, from the ugliness that one carries within and from guilt: "Here is the 'evil!' that comes out of me, now I am free!". Or there are those who greedily eat an impressive quantity and variety of foods without giving the body time to transmit the sensation of satiety, only to stop when it is already too late, when the

natural sensation of satiety is accompanied by nausea and vomiting, until lead to intoxication, loss of senses and physical collapse.

The Blame:

The guilt, which accompanies him from childhood, arises from the feeling of having made a mistake and, therefore, of having hurt someone, or of having disappointed his mother's expectations, being himself a "mistake". This feeling is related to his great empathy. In fact, he wouldn't feel so guilty if he didn't realize the emotions he arouses in others and he wouldn't dwell on them if the other didn't play such an important role in his existence.

Guilt is also associated with the concept of punishment. He expects to be punished and, above all, he is convinced that he deserves it and that he cannot do anything to avoid it. Suffer in silence, He doesn't even try to exculpate himself or explain his reasons. He is as if surrendered to the adult, completely defenseless. The feeling of guilt affects the subject's ability to judge and leads him to overestimate the consequences of his actions.

Dependence on the other:

The social subtype clings to the people he loves and lives in fear of loss, abandonment, death, since he has the feeling that without them, he himself will die, because he is convinced that he does not have the necessary resources. to get ahead alone in life. He counts on others more than on himself, he values others more than himself, although later he ends up falling into an abyss in which even the other lacks value, meaning: the abyss of impotence that surrounds him and to the rest of the world.

The real drama for him comes when life leads him for one reason or another to experience loss. That is when the pain becomes unbearable and it is like dying. You feel emotional, psychological and physical pain, as if an internal part of your body is missing; he feels devastated and has the feeling that he will not be able to live without his loved one, who accompanied him, who protected him in life (more in an idealizing fantasy than in reality). Life itself loses meaning. There is the emptiness of the loss of the loved person, there is the emptiness of the loss of the person that one yearns for and hates because it does not correspond. Very often, death confronts him not only with his love, but also with his repressed hate. However, that for the social E4 could be a great opportunity for growth, such excruciating pain could open the way to autonomy and the realization that he can get by on his own. He may discover through that shock that in addition to not dying for the first time he can really live, make decisions, live time for himself, dedicate himself to listening and caring; he may discover, when what is for him a fundamental bond is broken, what it means to be free. As long as he remains under the wing of the other for fear of life he will never know what it means to live.

Until I was six years old, of school age, I felt segregated, my world was family and home. My parents worked and when they left each day, I cried in silence between the songs of our nanny and the laughter and games of my brothers, always united and complicit. For me it was abandonment every time. But even more dramatic was the fear that they would die, he controlled them if they fought, believing they could hurt each other, he acted as a witness. I remember looking with a mixture of terror and compassion at a boy in my class who had lost his mother, obsessing about how he could survive, keeping him at a distance, distancing myself from the

discomfort his condition caused me, and imagining him in a dark and cold house, with nothing, I prayed to all the gods, praying that it would never happen to me, because the idea was unbearable.

Rose C

As a child I was very distressed by the idea that my mother might die. She, who had lost her mother at the age of two, often repeated to me: "I too, like my mother, will die when I turn thirty-two." I felt the terror inside me and prayed with all my heart to the Lord to let me die instead of her, because I could not survive the pain of her loss.

Walter M

The fear of abandonment contaminates many areas of the life of the social E4 and takes away freedom and spontaneity. Unable to express his own point of view, for fear of being punished and abandoned, when he finds himself in a situation of discrepancy of points of view, he tends to enter the role of victim to justify the acceptance of options that are not his. Avoid conflict but promulgate blaming the other: "You must act thinking for me even if I don't do it". You try to resolve your sense of inadequacy by making the other feel inadequate and guilty. What he is unable to do for himself, he projects onto the other. He knows how to assume the defense of another person, what's more, he feels a real impulse to defend those who are subjected to something that they consider unfair. On the other hand, when he experiences similar situations, he does not even think that they affect his own person, nor does his head act on his own; Deep down, he doesn't feel that he deserves it and, furthermore, he doesn't feel strong enough or with enough energy to sustain his own reasons.

The typical sensitivity of the social E4 and his empathy for the pain of others is the mechanism by which he unconsciously deals with his own wounds. He tends to withdraw. He does not feel strong enough to defend himself, nor does he trust that no one will really protect him. You cannot perceive anger as healthy vital energy and this does not allow you to live spontaneously, to follow your instincts, to literally throw yourself into the flow of life. He is rarely able to allow himself situations from which he can take advantage or pleasure. Expressing anger means becoming aware of repressed hate, it means becoming aware of "destructiveness."

The social E4 unconsciously chooses to preserve its "inner emptiness" as such. She doesn't know how to be alone with his own emptiness that stinks, that kills. "If mom didn't even love me, why should I love myself?" Cannot contact adult resources. This happens because she never gave up the attention she did not receive as a child and continued to live with the expectation that sooner or later it would be offered to her, perhaps by a prince who would rescue her. And just as she did during her childhood with her mother, when she blamed herself for not being loved, believing that she was the cause of her abandonment, as an adult she prefers to run away with the enemy, that is, she can also accept being devalued or mistreated as long as she does not lose the other. Fantasy helps her with this, because it gives her the illusion that sooner or later things will change and the other will realize her value and how much he loves her. Sustained by these thoughts, you can hold out even for years in a frustrating relationship.

2. THE CHARACTERISTIC NEUROTIC NEED: SHAME

By Susana Bayonas

Among all the social subtypes, the social E4 is undoubtedly the most difficult to recognize. Usually, a social subtype, regardless of its dominant passion, is revealed to be very eager for affirmation, for success, to be seen as a person of value so that it can feel that it belongs to its tribe. The social E4 lives all this inside with great difficulty in bringing it to consciousness, since an attitude of renunciation prevails in him, and he assumes that he has no talent or value. The very desire for confirmation becomes a strong shame, the envy towards those who allow it is experienced as a failure, a guilt.

Broucek proposes that shame is the evolution in the child's awareness, around eighteen months, of his condition as an object in the eyes of others, dealing with public consciousness, which leads to public consciousness of the self and to an awareness of oneself based on the observation of the other outside.

Shame is divided between the very feeling of shame that arises on the occasion of a specific event, and the constant feeling of shame as a background noise. Sensation refers to an anticipated shame or "existential attitude" that makes us stop before saying or doing something, that protects us from an exposure that we feel is threatening.

Shame is a feeling that has to do with dishonor, with humiliation. It is an emotion that comes from believing that something wrong has been committed, an embarrassment that is felt before others when committing a fault or when doing something that is considered ridiculous, strong or humiliating. To live the passion of shame is to live in the constant feeling of being at fault, in the constant struggle between the great desire to be visible and the fear of not being up to the task. The need of this social subtype is to belong to the group and the way to do it is to cultivate within himself this desire that makes him ashamed. Shame, passion of the social subtype, is the condition that allows him to live in the fantasy of being visible and doing nothing to achieve it.

Behind the shame hides the need to be liked by everyone, the need to be accepted, approved, that is why he presents himself as soft, affectionate, calm, good-natured. He seeks recognition outside since he does not have an internal reference of recognition of himself.

When you value what you do, you can't take it. There is a part in which he feels like an impostor, a part that the other does not know and that he wants to keep hidden.

Individuals with this character do not have an objective capacity to judge themselves; they tend to find negative aspects in themselves and also to negativize their own merits. They prefer to devalue themselves and not recognize their own value, rather than endanger the relationship or the atmosphere of peace with others.

When someone pays me a compliment because he recognizes a merit in me, I tend to feel uncomfortable, I would say embarrassed, and then the operation I carry out is to downplay it, turn it into something trivial or in aspects that many people commonly find themselves in.

One of the reasons is, without a doubt, that of not wanting the other to consider me too big, since I am afraid of disappointing him when he gets to know me more deeply, but there is also an aspect that has to do with the protection of the other: it is like if I were to defend him from a frustration that is all too familiar to me, namely, that which comes from being compared to someone who is better, something that has always happened to me.

Alichita R

The state of shame puts the person below, and keeps all his defects, with the rejection and the conviction of being a victim, so that he leaves the other before he says no. Hypersensitive in affections, with a small no that they are told they don't try anything else. And the pain of what could have been and was not lasts a long time, they revel in the lack, in the no, in the mistrust of themselves and of life.

Behind this feeling of lack there is a need to feel better than the other. He needs to be rescued, resolved, taken care of, he needs to be contained, embraced, approved, cared for and protected.

At the same time, he "needs" the rejected one in order to continue suffering and reconfirm his existential position of lack, a position without which he loses hope of rescue.

He is addicted to the chemicals of sadness and melancholy, which he needs as much as the angry man needs his shot of adrenaline. He feels it in his chest; how it rises and falls with the breath, which becomes deep and black, inward, without end, which gives a minty and warm sensation to life, which hurts.

Know love, which unites suffering; He is used to being looked down upon. "Even when you do everything you do to me, I love you because I understand you, and so, with everything, I know how to forgive and love, I am good".

María Abac Klemm, in her book the veiled personality, distinguishes physical shame and existential shame.

Shame takes over the solar plexus and the entire body. My solar plexus jumps, my chest sinks, my face turns very red, red spots appear on my neck, my whole body vibrates a lot and at the same time I feel frozen inside, as if I had ice on me. the chest radiating cold to my whole body, that weakens me, makes me very insecure physically, very vulnerable, my hands get cold. When I speak, I don't say what I wanted to have said, my ideas get tangled up, I feel like I'm wasting other people's time. A paralyzing terror compresses my body, the sides, the ribs tighten, the breathing is blocked, it is limited on a tremendously superficial level. I feel like I'm becoming very small, very ridiculous, a horrible lump appears in my throat that makes me choke and my eyes want to cry, I can't control it and the worst thing is that I feel that everyone notices, that makes me feel even more pathetic.

Susan B

E4 has the feeling that he cannot say what he wants to say, that it is very difficult for him to maintain eye contact.

I freeze, I can't speak, just the thought inhibits me even more! It also happened to me at the SAT, whereas before it seemed like such a protected place! I feel anxiety, my body stiff, tachycardia, I don't think I'll blush, if I speak my voice is calm, almost automatic, due to the control I unleash. I fear being judged stupid, inadequate, not saying the right thing, being looked down upon. There is almost no ability to think, a physical state of inhibition is triggered, I would hide. I always thought that with a (real) mask I could say anything like that without being seen! Today I realized how my mother said things to my daughter, scolded her, without asking her, without explaining to her, without teaching her, she directly scolded her! and he did not understand why he told him to stop, to say it in another way! It was as if he "already knew" what to do.

Marina P

Self-esteem is at a very low level, and he feels strong guilt for not being perfect and, therefore, lovable. He is deeply convinced that he has nothing good to give to others. He sees himself as weak, incapable, in need of help from other people, he perceives himself as wrong and is sure that he can never improve, because he has no qualities. Thus, he remains eternally a child even though he can cope well with the various vicissitudes he experiences as if he were more at home in adversity than in the daily routine. He hides behind a childish cry, painful and frightened, which expresses the desperate need for his parents or someone else to fill that role, someone to teach him the serenity with which one can live, someone to welcome him, to help him overcome the accumulation of constant dropouts that he has had to endure. Shame is, then, the barrier behind which he can hide, observing the world from the shadows, the justification for himself of the impossibility of receiving the much-desired confirmation.

In friendship, I became deeply attached to a person and it became my link with the world, I let him organize outings or what to do in my free time, through him I could live a social life without being the one who organized or decided, sometimes I decided but I waited for the friend to expose herself, call and act. This aspect of mine became more evident in the world of work, immediately showing good qualities as a sociable person, who supports and creates the best conditions so that another (boss, superior...) can work as well as possible. A prerequisite was that it be a person he admired and held in high regard. Thanks to his ability and skill, I could be too. Through the SAT path it became clear to me how this subordinate position allowed me to avoid the embarrassment of showing myself, but also to avoid competition, ultimately not conflict, and ultimately to take full responsibility for the good and the bad.

Chiara F.

If he finds himself suffering from something that has happened to him, not only does he not seek to distract himself from contact with what he is experiencing, from moments of joy with friends or from situations of lightness, but he tends to sink deeper into sadness with thoughts of moments that could have been but weren't or are far away in time and are unrepeatable. It brings up memories of experiences that can never be repeated; in short, he tends to emphasize what he is already experiencing, letting himself be carried away by boundless sadness. Pain magnetically attracts other pain, sadness is a resonance box for other sadness, life is in the past, the present has no value.

Through the pain he feels that at least he is accepted for himself; it is the only moment in which he stops, can observe himself and dares to allow moments of tenderness for himself. At that moment he heals his own wounds and feels contained, protected. But that doesn't last long, because soon the anxiety of facing the world appears again. All kinds of emotion are viewed with shame because it could be wrong, just as he thinks it is. And shameful is, of course, every manifestation of it, but hiding emotions is a fight without quarter. He can't contain them, they are like the water of a swollen river, they can be seen on his face, his voice broken, his eyes that turn bright in an instant, the red on his cheeks. At such times he wants to literally disappear from the sight of others.

I remember that when my mother said something that hurt me, I felt a lump in my throat and my eyes filled with tears. I hated that moment, because I knew that no matter how hard I tried, I wouldn't be able to hold anything back, and while I felt like a fool, my mother noticed that tears came to my eyes and added words that humiliated me because in her opinion- mine was a ridiculous reaction.

Alichita R

In meetings with more people she was a little hunched and cross-legged on the edge of a chair with her chin tucked in, a tortoise's head tucked into its shell (which is why we get a little double chin hiding the face about an inch), eyes that go in and out and move like a radar that picks up signals of disapproval to use in an unfair and painful comparison and then goes back in to mumble like cows their food, all these signs of the world that are food for us to feel so bad, inadequate, cumbersome, ugly, insane, disgraceful, disabled. Those eyes that go out to look for food are our own barrier so that the others don't get close since the fire that we put in is the same that we put out. An envious vibe. The more we mutter and compare ourselves, the more we sink into the armchair as if it could swallow us, and then comes the need for it to be the same earth that swallows us and takes us out of there, of others, that does so much damage. not belong want to disappear And if suddenly we dare to relate, shallow and short breathing protects us from not being complete in the experience of being with the other, we remain self-absorbed judging every word, every gesture of our performance, like a prison that protects us from showing ourselves, since what we are is unacceptable and shameful. And envy plays its worst game when someone in the meeting shares something of himself with others and we perceive how that person is being listened to, received, and appreciated. I don't know about all the other E4, but I think to myself that I can do more and better than what the other does and I'm dying of the pain of not being able to express it, of not being able to make myself heard and appreciated by others. Even today I don't know how to give myself importance to others and that hurts me, it's getting to me. I didn't realize before; my tools, strategies, and masks to protect myself were very well armed and protected me from myself, from my contempt for myself.

Susana B.

3. INTERPERSONAL STRATEGY AND ASSOCIATED IRRATIONAL IDEAS

By Alichita R, Chiara F, Giulia C, Marina P

"In the melancholic we observe the desire to communicate his own defects to everyone, as if he found satisfaction in this debasement."

Sigmund Freud, *Mourning and Melancholy*

The theme of abandonment, common to all the emotional characters, acquires "catastrophic" emotional and behavioral dimensions in the social E4, such as always walking on the edge between life and death. Every internal or relational experience and every external event is interpreted in terms of "not having enough, not being enough, being deprived." False deficiency, the distorted cognitive core through which all E4 types make sense of what they experience, is summed up in this subtype around a core self-loathing. If I don't have it's because I don't deserve it, if life doesn't give me what I want it's because I'm not worthy. All interpretations go in the direction of denying and mistreating oneself. He doesn't bite the world like the sexual subtype and cannot stoically hold on to the internal desert as the conservation subtype. His envy is sustained by a feeling of hopelessness.

Next, we describe the fixation of the false deficiency in the social subtype: If I give you everything, you will not leave me; If I don't get angry, if I don't tell you what I need, if I accept your mistreatment, you won't leave me.

The masochistic character feels crushed by life, by everything that happens to him, he feels that he has no energy or capacity to face the vicissitudes and problems that arise, so he tries to avoid that strong discomfort and anguish he feels. before something greater than himself, relying completely on the other, whom he loves, in whom he invests with enormous expectations. He refuses to assert himself, maintains a poor perception of himself and at the same time idealizes the other, extolling his gifts and abilities, even justifying disrespectful behavior. He lives in the shadow of the other, believing himself to be safe under his protective wing, but he avoids being in contact with reality, becoming aware of what he really is. The idea of not surviving by himself, of not succeeding if he is abandoned, induces him to do everything possible to avoid it, and if it comes to the point of actually risking being rejected or abandoned, he is inclined to abandon the other first, to avoid the anguish of waiting and also the unbearable pain, according to his feeling, of the moment of abandonment.

When I was very young and struggling with my first loves—in which I invested heavily to fill an inner void, when I felt there wasn't enough interest—I never waited for the other party to make a decision: I couldn't stay in that limbo of waiting and the frustration caused by the lack of intensity of love. I was preventing events and it was I who was leaving the other.

Alichita R

When in a relationship I get the feeling that the other person prefers something else before me, I begin to doubt the truth of the relationship, each situation begins to confirm my feeling and I tend to create situations to distance myself and detach myself with the absolute certainty that the other person will do so. I enact behaviors that anticipate detachment.

Chiara F

The social E4 enters relationships feeling indebted, as if the person who is taking them into account is doing them a favor. The favor he is doing is that he is giving him permission to exist, that he is looking at him. That favor comes at a price, and the social E4 immediately feels indebted. Perhaps that is why he sometimes prefers to be alone, so as not to owe so much. His withdrawal is much like that of the E5 character, but while the E5 is relieved and able to regain energy, the social E4 sinks into his emotions and thereby feeds his own self-devaluation. Low self-esteem and the fact of never having felt appreciated and recognized by his mother or by both parents, makes the subject develop the idea that he has no value in the eyes of the world. He feels uninteresting and, often, in his relationship with the other person, especially when the other person is interested in him, he feels very uncomfortable and often loses his lucidity because of the emotions that literally explode inside him and they invade him, which further complicates his relational and communicative capacity. That is why he is surprised when, in spite of everything, the other is really interested in him; almost hard to understand.

"If I am worth less than you, you will take care of me, you will protect me." The social E4 is like a refugee who has crossed the desert without water and will always feel thirsty and lacking. Water is love, also expressed in physical form. As an adult, he keeps alive the need for a hug that he did not have in childhood, or that was taken from him too soon. He is never the first to take the step, he is too afraid of rejection, but indirectly he does everything to receive attention and physical contact from the other. To achieve this, he tends to make himself "small" in the eyes of the other. Thus, he sells a functional image of himself that arouses tenderness to obtain protection. In these respects, you can be confused with the conservative character E6, although the difference between one and the other lies in the strong invasion of emotions and the motivation for the recognition of the group.

"What worries you is always more important." The social E4 invests his time, his energy and his care in the other in exchange for loyalty and the security that he will not abandon him; thus, the subject fulfils his desires, his needs and his interests by carving out small spaces for himself, secretly, taking care not to separate himself from the other, or he takes refuge in fantasy, in a world in which no one can enter and in which he can only devote himself. He continues to apply a modality learned in childhood, when he saw his mother so big and felt that he could not occupy space with his needs, nor bother her with his demands. He always feels less important than the other, whom he puts first in everything: in attention, in needs, in desires, in life.

Actually, the balance changes when he is surer of the other's feeling, but he is inclined not to let the other perceive it, because he is still afraid to take the space for himself, as if he feared some kind of punishment. The greatest fear remains that of being abandoned if he allows himself and his needs to come to the fore. If I'm happy, I lose hope that you'll come and rescue me.

"It's better to run away and give up than to feel in danger, or frustrated, or disappointed." Characterized by a false lack, he undervalues himself and victimizes himself. He does not confront himself because he fears defeat, nor does he trust his possibilities of expressing a position that deserves to be valued. What's more, he doesn't even feel like having the energy to do it. Thus, he anticipates frustration, taking advantage of the slightest rejection, which stimulates a silent "revenge", which consists in running away. Sometimes you can escape even by remaining present but no longer available in the relationship, as if you are there with your body but no longer with your soul. His is an absence that is felt but difficult to explain. To be there in front of the other, but not anymore. This is a way of defending oneself, but also of taking revenge. By not conceding, he punishes the other.

"You know much better how to do things." You do not have enough confidence to do what is asked of you and also feel that you do not have enough energy to carry it out. The social E4 tends to retroflection, fantasizing, elaborating projects, without reaching the realization; feels the environment hostile or frustrating and gives up the fight. One part tends to unsatisfied goals, the other is retroflexed to prevent action from going outside, which wastes energy and confirms the feeling of inadequacy. "I need someone who knows more than me, who I can lean on."

In fact, he is often inclined to abandon the result before it is achieved, even though his may have been a very interesting project. Low self-esteem makes you prefer to give support and help to another person whom you recognize and consider capable of performing a task to the best of your ability. However, in doing so, he hopes, more or less consciously, to be seen and taken into consideration. He is capable of sincere admiration for someone whom he considers superior, especially intellectually, but whom he also considers noble from a human point of view. But if he sees himself disappointed in his expectations, that is, if he recognizes errors and incapacities in the other's work, he can be very critical, although hardly directly, and also very devaluing with whom he achieves a success that seems undeserved in his opinion. This, instead of raising his level of self-esteem, generates anger towards himself, because he has made a mistake again. It is also a confirmation that he is incapable of making objective assessments. So ultimately, instead of using it to gain strength and confidence, he turns it against himself.

In reality, there are two completely conflicting instances within social E4, namely a deep sense of worthlessness and a longing to be special. The fantasy of a secret greatness collides with the threatening conviction of uselessness that leads him to self-evaluation, a heavy feeling of emptiness, feeling misunderstood and fixating on suffering. On the occasions when he successfully achieves a goal, he never brags about it, as it would embarrass him and cause him discomfort. But at the same time, he expects others to notice him, and if they don't, he feels very frustrated.

I remember when Claudio spoke of the virtues to pursue for the Four, "equanimity and contentment". I felt that one could be happy, it was even a goal! It felt like permission that I felt I never had. The crazy idea was that only suffering gave the right to be seen.

Marine P

I have always preferred to put myself in someone's shadow. I chose, of course, carefully who. He had to be a role model, a person I held in high regard. So, I would work seriously and hard at his side, apply myself and give my best. It was very important to receive his esteem, that look that told me many things. Even as an adult, I continued to seek the esteem and appreciation that I had never received from my mother. I wasn't envious even of the success I had achieved, of my work, if anything I was proud of having contributed. My prize was not to be on the podium, but to have the esteem of those who were up there.

Alichita R

If someone agrees to be with me, or work with me, then I'm worth it. But this can also have a double face: if someone works with me, then it's not worth much.

Other irrational ideas:

- I'm not worthy.
- I have no right, neither to request, nor to have, nor to occupy space and attention, I have no right to exist.
- I'm mistaken.
- There is something wrong with me that I must keep secret
- If my mother doesn't love me, no one can love me.
- If I suffer, I exist because they love me, and they see me.
- If I am successful, they hate me or envy me, they reject me. It's never enough, I never have enough.
- Life is difficult and hard.
- I only deserve love if I am good, tender, kind, of great zoning, dedicated and non-conflictive.
- If I express my anger, they won't love me anymore.
- If I have different ideas than others, I will be rejected.
- If I express my emotions, others will judge me as stupid, fragile, ridiculous, they will see me as weak, they will abuse me, they will make fun of me.
- If I show my sexual desire, others can see that I am dirty.
- I suffer and feel many emotions, that makes me special.
- As I suffer, nobody suffers.
- If they leave me, I don't know how to live.
- In the end, despite everything, I will lose the one I love

4. OTHER CHARACTERISTIC FEATURES AND PSYCHODYNAMIC CONSIDERATIONS

Imaginative/Creative:

The emotional, sensitive, and introspective aspect allows you to access your creative and imaginative side more easily. From an early age, he likes to console himself and entertain himself in fantastic and dreamlike worlds in which his imagination allows him to compensate for the great inhibition he feels in real life. This imaginary world that he has created and in which he somehow believes will be able to materialize in the future, serves him to metabolize everyday reality. Poetry, art and music become channels of expression to the outside

Sensible:

Low self-esteem and the need to defend yourself from others lead you to reject criticism or behaviors that challenge you. Their gaze perpetually directed to the outside world and the continuous comparison he makes with himself lead him to give a subjective reading and interpretation of what happens; the slightest criticism annihilates him, he feels that he has given a lot, more than the others, he finds himself again without recognition. In addition, since it is difficult for him to express his opinion directly for fear of being hurt or conflicted, he expects the same from others (understanding, empathy)

Romantic:

For this character, life is hard, difficult and sad, but it is characterized by a romantic feeling inside. Thanks to his romanticism, the world becomes lighter and more bearable, it is as if he added a note or a touch of color to so much pain. The romantic vision that he harbors within him is expressed in the world through poetry, music and the search for positive loving situations and opportunities. It is as if he did not resign himself to the harsh reality through his romantic aspect. It is as if through romance he sweetened a bitter pill.

Passive-aggressive/self-destructive:

He is not allowed to express anger; he always represses hatred. Showing hatred for his mother (or father) would be tantamount to losing her, something no child could afford. So, he learned to repress his hatred and swallow it, he began to hate himself believing himself defective, unworthy of love, guilty of not being loved, in order to save his mother. The parental anger you experienced in childhood is too destructive and distressing.

Introspective:

The closure, the isolation in which he takes refuge as a child and in which he grows up, somehow leads him to spend a lot of time in contact with himself, listening to and analyzing himself, doing with himself what no one did when he was a child. Pain and contact with suffering continually stimulate him to study himself and to investigate his inner dynamics, he longs to get out of his suffering and has to continually face it, but he does not believe that this can be done by acting or making decisions on his own. life. Instead, he prefers an interior movement of study and analysis of how he is, what he feels and why.

Reserved:

He is extremely private, and only talks about himself and his intimate experience with very few people, as he does not trust others to understand him. Since childhood he has experienced not being understood, not being seen, having the feeling that no one is aware of his needs, and therefore, as an adult, he has no faith that there is someone who can understand him deeply.

Feminine:

Delicate, sweet, and languid. It poses in a delicate and tender way, and therefore also in the masculine social E4, the characteristics of listening, welcoming, understanding, caring, as well as a friendly physiognomy in which the smile, a manifestation of benevolence towards the world, is always insinuated as a background note. There is no trace of aggressiveness or attack in him, but of sweetness and tenderness.

Gentle:

He is always kind, expresses himself in soft ways and approaches, as he wants to avoid conflicts and losses. Use kindness to please the other, try to avoid behaviours that can provoke or irritate. She has learned to stand on her toes in the world, to try to prevent or avoid the parent's mood swings or attacks, and thus has learned since childhood that this soft way is what works best for her in the relationship.

Comprehensive:

Willing to understand the motives of others, strong empathy combined with fear of abandonment and conflict makes you lenient and benevolent towards the motives and reasons of others. He tends to put himself in the place of the other, he justifies his actions even in situations in which he is humiliated or is not seen, he has difficulties with separation, as well as in primary relationships. From a young age he learns that it is better not to express his opinion or clearly what he wants because this creates a distance with his parents. Thus, he learns to understand them, to justify them.

Lazy and Procrastinator:

You are recalcitrant about committing and lazy about getting a task done. He tends to postpone his execution because he always feels that he is not up to the task and very often he believes that he is incapable or that he does not do it to the best of his ability. Fear of failure paralyzes you. Obviously, this is closely related to low self-esteem and lack of confidence in their own abilities. No one ever believed in him; as a child he was not only not encouraged, but which, on the contrary, was devalued. His procrastination is linked to the need to do things as perfectly as possible, even beyond. He does not admit mistakes to himself, and this requires him in the actions that he then undertakes enormous energy to complete the task.

Criticism and Self-disqualification:

He is critical and disqualifying both with himself and with others. He tends to be critical of himself because it is the experience he has had. It has been heavily criticized, disqualified. To the extent that he compares himself with others and in order not to be annihilated by the superiority of others, he tends to have a critical look and to express, not directly, disapproval, negative judgments about the other, his way of being. or to work. So, the criticism of the other is born of an attempt to survive, not to be completely crushed by the comparison with the outside world.

Sadness and Suffering:

He is sad and suffers from a young age, even before he is aware of it; when he becomes an adult he continues to drag this suffering, since he remains attached to that need to receive that has never been satisfied. His attention does not shift, he does not find compensation in life because it is as if he is still waiting for that love. There is a part of him that is obstinate in not wanting to give her up and that is why he does not learn to give himself the love that he did not receive in childhood. Thus, love becomes something sublime, inaccessible, almost impossible to find and experience.

Proud:

He reacts superbly to an offense and a wound, in the sense that to defend himself he creates a distance with the other, or he even leaves, separates, becomes cold and distant. He does not back down, he resists his suffering without showing it and confuses pride with strength, he has the illusion that through pride he can protect himself. it retriggers the wound in the same way that it hurts the most.

Shy:

You like to be social and need others, but you tend to hide and find it difficult to expose yourself, especially in a new and wide social context. Shyness is due to an excessive concern for the judgment of others, the perception of being inferior to others and a feeling of inadequacy. From a very young age he experiences the weight of being judged, often being asked to be different than he was or to better fit the context. You develop an excessive tendency to focus on your inner world of thoughts, emotions, and behavior.

Pessimistic / distrustful:

You perceive the world as dangerous and unpredictable, so you tend to always see the negative side of things and situations. Through his pessimism he believes he can anticipate and control the pain he will feel when something bad happens, because he is sure it will! He has no confidence in the course of events or even in himself, this becomes functional to remain passive and withdrawn and at the same time to be able to complain and suffer.

Insecure:

He has the constant doubt that his actions or words can lead to difficult or irremediable situations and that they can lead him to disappoint the other and be abandoned by him; this, of course, makes him very insecure. As a child, the father corrected his actions a lot or even criticized him often, which made him insecure and hesitant, especially when it came to taking the initiative or acting instinctively.

Complain / Claim:

He complains about small things, he is impatient. Need to continually express and externalize dissatisfaction (I'm hungry, I'm thirsty, I'm bored). Through the complaint he seeks attention and confirmation that another is available and sees him. Complaining is also their way of feeling the other person is present in the relationship, it is a bit like a thermometer to check that they are always there, that they have not gone away. However, in situations where he is really hurt or has a real deep need, he tends to withdraw and not share, because he thinks that no one will be able to help him. The emptiness and anguish he feels are indescribable; He doesn't feel like he can trust anyone, he mistrusts others and life so much that he thinks that no one can really help him in the face of so much pain (and, above all, that there is nothing he can do to stop it). It is as if he were desperate, exhausted. He also feels shame wash over him; Showing yourself in such pain in front of the other person makes you feel enormous shame and E4 feels even more miserable.

Silence:

It is silent, it tends not to make noise, not to be noticed, not to bother. To be accepted, one must not disturb the other, not disturb one's own mother, and for this reason, as an adult, one tends to be silent, not to interfere with the atmosphere of the environment, not to be seen by the other.

Altruistic/Helpful:

Being helpful and helping arises in the subject from the idea that love must be deserved, that it is not free. He has learned that to be loved, he must earn that love in some way and that is why, when something is asked of him, he spontaneously puts himself at the service of the other person. In addition, he has experienced the feeling of need and, therefore, it is as if he somehow knows from within the feeling of the one who needs help, and being clearly empathetic, it is automatic for him to go to the other. Finally, we must add to tell him that he finds it difficult not to do someone's request. Backing away makes him uncomfortable; when he does, he feels that he is in danger of losing something, perhaps of losing the other person or of being abandoned.

Hypersensitive:

It is extremely sensitive to loud noises, raised tones of voice, and sudden gestures. It is as if he had developed in his existence a sense of constant danger, as if he was constantly on the alert when exposed to the danger of being attacked and therefore reacts with jerks, sometimes even with excessive vocal emissions in reaction to environmental stimuli that may arise suddenly.

Jealous:

He is jealous of his partner, but he can also be jealous of other beings he loves, even friends. His jealousy comes from the fear that someone else will be preferred over him, since that is the experience he had as a child, when he felt ignored compared to his brothers. Furthermore, this fear is made even more vivid by the fact that he has developed a lack of self-confidence and is therefore convinced that another person can be much more interesting than he is in the eyes of his beloved.

Empathic:

He has a great ability to put himself in another's place, to live his emotional experience. This attitude is supported by his sensitivity and emotionality. In addition, empathizing with the other allows you to feel useful in the relationship. Empathy unites the other and removes the feeling of guilt for not intervening or helping.

5. EMOTIONALITY AND FANTASY

By Giulia Clignon, Chiara Fustini, Elena Curiel

Fantasy is a sleight of hand that people play without understanding how, and act so that one part of us doesn't understand what the other wants.

Ethel S. Person

Fantasy is a relevant aspect of the E4 social character. It already manifests itself in childhood as a refuge and comfort in the absence of attention or to create a positive space in which to live and move more lightly. The subject elaborates great stories in which he is ultimately the undisputed protagonist, unlike reality, in which the comparison with the outside world is ruthless and devaluing.

The resort to fantasy is normal and widespread in childhood; Through the game, fantasies are created that allow us to go beyond our own limits. Little by little, the children realize that what is pretended is not reality but that, while the game lasts, it is as if it were. However, in the case of the social E4, this attitude is maintained in adulthood because, while they fantasize, they experience a feeling of omnipotence: they break down the barriers between the present and the future and experience the illusion of manipulating reality as they please.

Since I was a little girl, I was often invited to shut up, because mom was too busy doing other chores around the house; then I started to fantasize. It was my way of not feeling the loneliness of those moments and of not getting bored.

I used to invent great stories in which he was often the protagonist. But only in the fantasy dimension, never in reality. Then I lacked the strength to make that fantasy come true.

This ability to withdraw from present situations that I did not like and to escape into imaginary worlds that I created has been with me ever since, sometimes becoming a way of salvation and other times a prison from which I cannot easily escape.

Giulia C

Around the age of six they took me to a speech therapist for my dyslexia. At one of the meetings my mother shared with the doctor in front of me her concern: I was often absent and absorbed in my own thoughts to the point of making her think I had a hearing problem, but she was especially alarmed because I made up fantastic stories or changed real situations by telling them and adding things that had never happened.

Chiara F

Imagination helped me a lot during the hard years of boarding school (from the age of five to eight) to overcome the pain of feeling abandoned by my mother, who came to visit me once a week, and by a situation of objective difficulty (the fear that the nuns inflicted on me, their negative looks towards me, the son of a girl mother, for them certainly a sinner, the nightmares I had for a religious education based on the terror of sin). I convinced myself of a rubber ball and anything that hit me bounced off, so I couldn't feel the pain.

Valter M

One of the first to discover the psychological power and mechanisms of fantasy was the founder of psychoanalysis, Sigmund Freud, who gave this great importance in mental life: fantasy was the way to express unsatisfied needs that otherwise could not arise.

Human beings tend to pleasure but reality forces them to give it up, so fantasy allows them to access worlds where all desires can be satisfied, escaping the limits of everyday life. Daydreams console us for what we are not or do not have, they mitigate our anxieties, they allow us to undo, at least in our minds, the mistakes of the past.

But imaginative activity is not just a relief. It serves the subject specifically because it is also a tool to anticipate the future:

I remember the first passions of adolescence, the great reflections on what to do in life, what direction to take. These were too important subjects to think about, often leaving me fantasizing for hours on end while high school teachers explained concepts that were too far away for me at the time. I remember the long train journeys in which my thoughts were numbed by the images that I saw through the window, and I found relief in those non-places.

Giulia C

In the affective sphere, for the social E4, fantasy becomes a predominant aspect in their way of living relationships, an escape route from reality. When he enters into a relationship with someone, he feeds more on the imaginative and loving fantasy that he nurtures on a daily basis than on the actual exchange; hyper-fantasy and the constant creation of fantastic expectations lead to idealizing the other person and the relationship. Fantasy becomes an accomplice and ally.

During a ten-day Vipassana meditation retreat I was able to see how my mind works. How, in the absence of external stimuli, I kept creating incredible fantasies about my life and future possibilities, especially with strong romantic overtones. There were days in which I expected important news in the work/professional field, but my mind always flew (with pindaric flights) on affective topics, imagining future associations, fantasies so real and concrete that they became a valid substitute for the reality. I had to make a conscious effort to return to a principle of reality, and after long moments in which I imagined a life as a couple, a vacation as a couple, a daily life shared with a man, I voluntarily and intentionally began to repeat myself mentally: “You are thirty-four, you have been single for years, you do not have a mature experience of living

together”, a mantra to return to reality and find a real path (neither hypothetical nor imaginary), made up of small steps that could later accompany me to my desired destination.

Giulia C

In the absence of couple ties or a person who acts as the engine of this fantasy world, the social E4 tends to imagine romantic and impossible love stories, so as not to feel the pain of loneliness. A fleeting glance with a man is enough to imagine distant trips, romantic passions, a life as a couple and sharing times, spaces and places.

When I was in high school, I had a great desire to have a love, but there was nothing on the horizon, or nothing that lived up to my expectations and imaginations. One Sunday when I was visiting my aunt with my family, a friend of hers showed up with his son, who immediately struck me as very handsome. But, as I was used to doing, instead of coming closer, I turned away and hid out of embarrassment. I don't remember exchanging a single word, other than name, with him, and yet, in the days and months that followed, I built up a fantasy so vivid I believed it was true. I imagined that he too had been impressed by me, that he thought of me every day, he wanted to see me again and that as soon as he had the chance, he would come to confess his feelings to me. We would finally be happy together and I would feel loved like never before.

Alichita R

At twenty-nine I was in Finland for a European project; my mother had recently passed away and I was glad I chose such an isolated land with such impressive nature and landscapes to grieve. I was often alone and immersed myself in natural or urban environments without looking for company. To internally sustain the loneliness of everyday life, I invented (and ended up believing!) fantastic stories: I was the companion of a diplomat on a business trip forced to eat alone because he was busy with important meetings and accompanied by the thought that at night someone would be waiting for me at home.

I believe that this disturbing fantasy serves as support and justification for a pathological shyness that is expressed especially in areas that are most difficult for me, such as love. I believe that, without completely discarding the trait of fantasy, which has great creative potential, it is necessary to do a lot of therapeutic work to put it at the service of concrete and real tasks, to learn to recognize the moment when fantasy becomes a substitute for reality and, as such, takes energy away from making real changes in life.

Giulia C

Fantasies are then a "private theatre" in which the author is both an actor, generally the protagonist, and a spectator: no other public is allowed. Fantasy is, in fact, closely guarded: one is willing to recount his night dreams more often than his daydreams. It can be out of modesty, out of shame, out of doubt about not being understood. But often it is also the fear of losing the power of the imagination. In other words, we fear that, once

told to others, the fantasy will fade away and stop giving us pleasure or relieving our tensions. Other times, we prefer to live them in secret to avoid confrontation with reality: a person's perplexed face lets us know that one of our dreams is unrealizable.

I immediately imagine the final destination. And in my fantasy, it is always so beautiful, so unique, so special, so romantic, so idealized... that later it is difficult to find a man or specific situations that can fulfil such lofty and perfect fantasies. And instead of crashing or settling for a reality that I don't like, or accepting my idealizations, I end up preferring to continue feeding my fantasies, much more satisfying. Without seeing the trap: the distance from reality.

Giulia C

The excess of fantasy of the social E4 character is combined and intertwined with the emotional aspect. Fantasy supports and broadens access to experience and connection to emotions. Fantasy allows access and amplification of positive emotions to often offset the negative emotions that prevail in real life. Fantasies are not always positive, because with the same ease with which positive ones are accessed, negative and harmful ones are very often accessed. In this case, they make it possible to prepare for possible negative events that may occur in real life. One negatively fantasizes to feel “prepared” for the worst.

Fantasy, imagination, and emotion have characterized my life since early childhood. My earliest memory is in kindergarten, around the age of four, a first crush... As I stood watching him play ball and was lulled to sleep by that strange feeling, the romance and fantasy of childhood I remember that it occupied all my thoughts... The memory of that experience is accompanied by shame and embarrassment because at home I was the object of ridicule and mockery for that state of mind. Therefore, my emotional world was very visible externally, as if it were impossible to control.

Chiara F

As a teenager, my father's illness and my sister's schizophrenia disproportionately increased my sense of shame for who I was and what was happening in my life. The fantasy of a better and different life came true through a constant attempt not to let others know what was happening to me. Even when things were known to friends and acquaintances, he acted as if they didn't know. Then, when my father died of cancer and I was seventeen at the time, I asked a best friend to tell other mutual friends and the class at school with orders to pretend nothing had happened. Thus he nourished in me the fantasy that my father had gone on a trip and would return. Hiding the real fantasies that I had became a matter of survival so that I would not be invaded by the painful feeling of shame, of being wrong and different from the other members of my family.

Chiara F

The social E4 is the type that is more in contact with emotions, to which they have direct access. He often finds it difficult to contain them and control his expression, especially when it comes to sadness, disappointment, etc. It is as if an unstoppable wave

washes over him, leading to tears, although this creates considerable embarrassment and discomfort.

As we have already said, anger is the emotion that is least accessible to E4. Anger and hatred towards loved ones who have betrayed or disappointed are emotions that cannot be expressed for fear of rejection or even abandonment, but such emotions cannot even lodge in consciousness for fear of feeling like a bad person, and thus feed all fantasies or self-destructive behaviors. Being aware of hate would also mean, for social workers, breaking the mask of a victim and a good person, with which one claims to be right and the right to cry and ask.

Sadness and melancholy are, without a doubt, the most accessible emotions, directly associated with the belief of being deficient. These are the emotions through which people with this character grieve and secretly hope to be seen and put to safety.

This intense emotionality has many functions for the social E4. This strong emotional experience gives color and intensity to life, makes it special, and at the same time special to the character, who tends to believe that this feeling of his is rare, that it is his and very few other creatures. Emotionality is a place where he takes refuge, where he confirms that he is in the world, that he is there, but at the same time where he feels terribly alone. He is totally incapable of managing his emotional world and, therefore, he is a slave to it, he is dominated by it.

As a teenager I became aware of the turmoil of emotions churning inside me. Often, when asked by me, the answer was "no", sometimes even expressed in a sour and guilty tone. The feeling I had immediately inside me after the rejection was an invading wave that rushed up my chest and squeezed my throat, preventing me from being able to express any words. Then my ideas disappeared, my head was completely clouded, and I was left like an idiot with tears in my eyes that I tried in vain to push away and which occasionally fell to the ground. That was the worst moment. The moment my mother realized that I was crying was the lowest point. Her words made me feel stupid, deeply alone, and without any chance of salvation. I was going to my room, alone; no one followed me to understand or clarify, and I sank into my pain, into my feeling of how insignificant I was, how non-existent.

Alicita R

Feeling empathetic and in touch with the experience of others, especially in difficult situations, allows them to justify and feed their own emotional experience. It flows totally in the emotional experience of the other: what the other experiences is what they are experiencing, there are no limits, and the emotion occupies the entire interior space.

I listened to the news on TV and found myself crying not just because of the pain of what I had heard, but rather because I had become that mother or that wife or that daughter who had lost a loved one. I was her; I was in her skin, I felt her despair exactly.

Alicita R

At the beginning of my SAT course, in the reality of the therapy group, I was often overwhelmed with emotions, a great maelstrom, most of the time painful and moving to witness the pain of others. The other became the medium through which I could amplify and unleash all my pain.

Chiara F

The sad image reflects the sense of identity that the social E4 has built, its possibility of existing lies in the suffering for something he has lost: love, the other, life itself. It is as if he constantly presented to the world the character of the abandoned, sad and lonely.

The feeling of loneliness is constant, even though the E4 does not live alone and has a good social life. A sense of being a stranger to the world, one who has been rejected, excluded, one who has a hopeless wound, deeper and more special than any other.

The feeling of loneliness has been with me since I was a child. I was a very sociable and even often cheerful child, always trying to be with others and constantly struggling not to be alone. But despite this, I always felt a kind of constant isolation from the outside world, which was mixed with the fact that I felt misunderstood and alone in the world, and how this was an unavoidable condition for which it was impossible to find a remedy.

Chiara F

As a child, when I expressed anger or agitation, my mother would make me lie down in my room with soft lighting and play classical music, which she thought should relax me. On those occasions I felt alone in the world, different and misunderstood. There I accessed and amplified painful emotions, but also romantic and melancholic.

Chiara F

Fear is undoubtedly an emotion that is familiar to us, especially when the possibility of social exposure arises. It is not an emotion with which he strongly connects, also because in his isolation he avoids it or even hides it from himself, but fear is always tinged with a lack of hope, with the feeling of not having options or possibilities.

And, of course, the most distant emotions are joy and jubilation. It is not so much about not allowing yourself moments of enjoyment-of course there are-but that this character does not allow itself the possibility of remaining in joy or contentment, of being able to feel it as a lasting state. Contentment is always chased away by the interference of the crazy idea that "it can't be for me, no it can't last". Allowing oneself joy and satisfaction would be to have left behind the mask of the sick person that allows the social E4 to tell themselves who they are and how to orient themselves in the world.

6. CHILDHOOD

Chiara Fustini, Alichita Rossi, Giulia Clignon, Valter Martini

In most cases, the social E4's mother has a strong and controlling personality. She is a tough woman, who implements hyper control over her children, which gives the child the perception of not having their own space. And it does not allow them to achieve their own autonomy, because any initiative, any spontaneous movement for independence or any divergent manifestation is forcibly castrated with a guilty intention. The mother takes up a lot of space, absorbs attention and punishes. In some cases, she even seems to take pleasure in preventing his son from carrying out his wishes or any kind of initiative outside the family. He comes to intervene in their friendships, judging their connections. She negatively evaluates the people around him and only approves of those who represent the values in which she believes and with which she identifies. Normally, the friends that the social child chooses are not appreciated and discredited for fear of losing control over him, who may find other role models outside the family. It is evident that through the devaluation of friendships, the E4 son perceives distrust in himself, because he does not feel capable of choosing for himself.

When my mother was at home it was as if she were not there, or as if she were not there for me, because she was always busy with more important things, she was always working.

ALICITA R.

My mother didn't see me as someone other than her. I was an extension of her and in this inability to see myself I just had to be perfect and meet all her expectations. I tried my best at everything, did very well in school, helped around the house as a homemaker, went shopping, paid attention to money, helped my father at work, but appreciation never came. On the contrary, a trifle was enough, a little milk put to boil on the stove, not having fulfilled one of her orders perfectly, for her anger to be unleashed and blows to fly. I felt guilty and in no way allowed anger to get through to me. I was isolated from the world, I couldn't ride a bike or play soccer for the neighborhood team: the fear that I would be hurt in some way stifled any attempt at autonomy. Often, as a child, I told myself that these couldn't be my parents: I fooled myself by telling myself that I was the son of a king who had put me in this painful situation to overcome difficult tests and that later, when I grew up, he would come and would take me back to the palace.

Valter M.

As a child I felt a deep emptiness, a lack of attention and affection mixed with the feeling of being forgotten. For a long time I waited for my mother to approach me, to give me a hug, to caress me, to tell me that she loved me, while I played alone in a corner of the garden. Over time I transformed this pain, I tried to compensate for it with fantasy. I made up that this was not my real mother, that I was the daughter of a very good fairy who could not keep me and had entrusted me to that family to raise me, but that as soon as she could, she would come to recover me, and then, at last, I would be loved and happy.

Alicita R.

The father of the social E4, in many cases, is a weak individual and little involved with the difficulty of assuming the role of father. He does not establish a relationship with his daughter, almost always mediated by the mother, who is usually the one who takes all the initiatives and decisions about everything that has to do with the lives of the children. In other cases, the father also appears as a punitive, authoritarian and scolding figure, and what worries him is always much more important than what worries his daughter or son.

In families where there are siblings, children of the social E4 subtype feel that there is no place or time for them because the needs, problems and illnesses of the siblings are a priority. The social E4 gives up asking for the attention that they should naturally receive and feels that the needs of others are more important than their own. This perception is internalized and causes in this character the conviction that will accompany him in his future life that others are more important than him in every way: those who are sick have more rights, those who suffer are more important.

The social E4 child lacked physical contact, pampering and caresses, and if he had them, it was not only for a desire to exchange love but for other purposes. For example, to put him to sleep, to feed him, to check his hygiene. This lack of warm contact leads in the child first and in the adult later to a poor development of trust and appreciation of the body. The mother of an E4 takes care of her son performing only basic functions such as food, health and the practical organization of his life. He is concerned about the physical and biological development of the child but does not pay attention to his emotional needs or his inner life. This type of affective relationship can explain how the E4 social character is formed. From a very early age, the individual chooses crying and moaning as the main expression of their emotions. These manifestations allow you to attract attention, avoiding the judgment of the mother or the adult:

"If I suffer, I will be important and she will not be able to miss me, if I cry she will be kinder to me."

Chiara F

This causes in the child a strong inhibition of his maturation desires, accompanied by a very great feeling of guilt. Often, the child takes responsibility for the actions of his parents, devaluing himself by judging his behavior as bad and thus saving adults from their own anger and possible devaluation. Thus, he loses the natural correspondence between emotion and bodily reaction and does not develop the ability to associate the appropriate behavior with what the situation demands. Crying and moaning are an unconscious manipulation tool.

I don't know how I felt, certainly alone, I remember waiting for a doctor to tell my mother that I needed special attention, to justify my great sadness with science and find a solution. I cried often; it was the attitude that gave me the most attention. It seemed to me that I felt an infinite sadness. Joy did not seem achievable to me, that's why I used to cry and lament neurotically, the victim attitude belonged to me for a long time! Also, this great suffering made me feel special.

The child develops frustration when facing external reality that is not as he would like, people are not as he expects. He suffers for it, but fears that by externalizing this feeling they will abandon him. He suffers because he doesn't have what he wants, but he sacrifices himself so as not to destroy the other. In this way, he also manages not to give up the idealization of his family. The only way the child finds to save his outside world

is to make it his own, thus putting himself in the shoes of his mother and father, introjecting them.

A process of self-accusation of the subject begins, of blaming himself. He is the problem; he is the author of the negative things. The price that the child pays for the family ideal to live up to his expectations is the impossibility of expressing anger to the outside world, which over time becomes a real incapacity.

The E4 child builds himself around social interjective parental figures, particularly the mother. It totally feels in his hands, he has no right to choose, because the mother chooses for and knows what is right and good for him. You cannot express a need or make any request; you cannot assert your autonomy or your individual taste.

More precisely, we could say that even when the mother does not choose for the child, it is the child himself who chooses the things that his mother would choose, so as not to hurt her and not risk being scolded, rejected, or abandoned. The child's underground demand is not to interfere or be a burden to the family.

E4 feels a bit like a puppet, it can only move if its mother pulls the strings.

As a child I did not take any initiative, I waited for my mother to propose something to me. When I had an idea, or felt like doing something, I hoped she would guess it by reading my mind, but I never said it because her refusals hurt too much.

Alicia R.

To avoid the frustration of not being seen or noticed in the family, I excluded myself. I took refuge in my own world (reading, drawing, best friend).

Chiara F.

The social E4 child experiences situations in which he is often left aside when it comes to expressing his feelings, in an environment in which the expression of emotions is not allowed or is judged negatively. In other cases, it is the mother or father themselves who only support negative feelings and not joy, success, and happiness. Within the family and in the world, there is no space where he can show what he feels, understands, and learns from a young age that to survive you have to avoid being seen. Their feeling becomes something to hide and protect, accompanied by the feeling of being inadequate and wrong. Shame is the protection of the inner emotional world. Turning invisible and not being seen gives him more freedom, as he can protect himself from being judged and punished. Develop a separation between the emotions and the body. The anger, the love, and pain do not correspond to an action. When, for example, he feels anger, he does not feel entitled to express it, he is afraid of being punished and for this reason he keeps all the anger inside, immobilizing the action.

In many cases, the mother has strong power to inhibit the development of femininity in her daughter. It is as if the femininity it expresses threatened the mother herself. In fact, the social daughter hardly receives recognition on an aesthetic level. She is a very emasculating mother, even in this respect. Compliments are never directed at the girl, but at something external, like a piece of clothing, but not the person wearing it. The pleasure of the body, food, vacations, luxuries, the flow of beautiful and pleasant things are inhibited in the child; sexuality, sensuality and eros will be penalized in the future.

The social E4 feels that they do not share the life project of their parents and wants to be different, longs for something different, cares for and loves the aesthetic harmony of the home, the originality of the clothes, the beauty of the costumes, the refinement, and the culture. You may even develop, over time, a feeling of shame towards the sociocultural level of your family of origin. Due to these profound differences, not infrequently he does not feel that he is the son of his own parents and sometimes even wishes he were not.

I remember when I was young, I thought I was adopted, I think it was the consequence of a frustration of love. I felt so misunderstood, so different that I thought I wasn't his son. Over time, I developed a strong sense of aesthetics in all areas and a refinement of taste that had nothing to do with those of my family, which were much coarser and almost incomprehensible to me.

Alicita R.

The search for external beauty serves to repair the feeling of scarcity, emptiness and lack and, at the same time, balances the beauty that one cannot see inside, because they do not recognize it. Therefore, the quasisocial child experiences frustration of his own emotions and often hides in a fantastic and ideal world.

Reality is never as beautiful as we have imagined it, which is why many times it is better to be in a dream than in the realization of what we had imagined, because the moment it takes shape, it loses its charm and magic.

G. Leopardi

It often happens that the child, instinctively perceiving that the only channel of communication and interaction with the mother is the linguistic one, develops language early. Not infrequently, the E4 have a feeling of scarcity in their family that refers not only to emotional deprivation but also to the economic and social sphere: they often live with little and with scarcity, but this is not always linked to a real lack of financial resources. There may be a tendency in the family to save for fear of not having enough, as if there is a feeling that tomorrow there may not be enough to live. Sometimes not wasting and saving is a point of pride for a parent.

The child is very sensitive to his mother's whining, he perceives her moods, and this makes him always anxious. It is the mother's moods that define the climate of the home, also because the father adapts completely to her to avoid conflicts. There are no moments of frivolity: there are rules never said, or always unclear, latent.

The child goes through life with a feeling of lack, and yet it is difficult for the subject to understand what he really lacks, because he does not know himself deeply, he does not know his own needs.

Seek friendships in which the relationship is intimate, intense, and special; If the relationship does not have this characteristic of depth, he prefers not to give his friendship, he flees from superficial relationships. He only has friends at heart and establishes relationships based on a deep mutual trust and intense contact. He does not get involved in superficial Relationships.

In childhood, there may also be other figures who contribute decisively to nullify the spontaneous impulse to express themselves, such as siblings. The presence of other siblings represents another determining factor for the social E4 child, who is deprived of the already scant attention that he feels he receives from the mother. In many cases, the child's siblings present particularly fragile situations. The causes can be many and varied: it may be that he has an illness or a disorder of some kind that strongly attracts the attention of the parents and absorbs their energy to the detriment of the other child, so that this one, who already feels inclined to not expressing themselves for fear of rejection or disapproval, postpone even more any spontaneous manifestation, waiting for a better moment or a space in which the mother is not so busy taking care of and attending to the brother. Over time, the impulse to say or ask is as if swallowed, it does not come out but remains imprisoned in the subject's body and mind, causing frustration at first, getting lost. That is to say, it happens that in the end the subject hardly knows what he wants or what he really wants, he disconnects from himself. It is also due to this phenomenon that he develops a facility for confluence with the other. Even as an adult, he needs to stop to get in touch with himself and feel what he really wants and needs.

Siblings, when they are present, thus fuel a castration of the subject's needs and accentuate the feeling of comparison and envy. However, the social E4 hardly allows himself to express anger, frustration and envy directly, as he wants to avoid being perceived as negative and bad; For this reason, he adopts a victim attitude, accentuating the complaint as the only way to attract the attention of his parents and take it away from his siblings, embodying the role of a good boy who meets his mother's expectations and does not bother.

When the siblings are not present, this dynamic can occur with reference persons in the nucleus to whom the parents reserve the attention or with classmates who are more "seen by the teacher".

7. PERSON AND SHADOW: THE DESTRUCTIVE FOR SELF AND FOR OTHERS

By Susana Bayonas

It is evident, according to what we have described previously, that this character hides its virtues, qualities and potential to say no, set limits, get angry, shine, indulge in pleasure or enjoy life. We have already talked about how this attitude and the vision of life as constant lack lead to self-destructive behavior.

We now want to show how all this becomes harmful for those who are in relation to people who recognize themselves in the social E4 enneatype. The intensity of melancholy and the feeling of helplessness can be frightening since these people cannot feel reciprocated in any relationship. When relationships are started from a devastating hunger, there is no human way to satisfy such an appetite. Dissatisfaction can be permanent and a cause of reproach towards the other, it becomes a form of demand that destroys any possibility of loving. Due to the humiliation experienced and the blows received, they accumulate a swallowed rage that twists inside, easily leading them to depression, absolute isolation and even the desire for death, attitudes that, in some way, the world receives, because depression, isolation and death do not stop being, in part, an attempt to covert punishment. Someone who feels punished doesn't want to be there to receive all that. Once again, this destructive mechanism acts in only one direction: "I destroy myself by not destroying you, and at the same time I want to harm you, and also you leave, with which I destroy myself doubly because I know that I am causing it in some way, and at the same time I provoke in you the sense of guilt for being the cause of my suffering".

It is difficult to believe that someone can love a miserable person, therefore this someone must not be worth much, or is someone interested, who deceives. Despite anything the other may do or say, he will find himself nailed to this inexorable trial, and the more he will feel impotence, whether to be able to question the judgment, or to be able to feel that he has a place in the heart or in the life of this person.

The empathy that the social E4 feel towards the suffering of others is extremely paradoxical, since in truth they cannot see them for what they are, but only see the other based on the satisfaction that they can provide.

My disqualifying mechanism, the one that makes me feel so "miserable">, is triggered at any moment and without warning, so that I can see myself crying without knowing why, in the face of any situation that implies something to face (in work, with your partner, with friends, with your family...).

"I would say that there is a very abused victim inside me and that my internal abuser mercilessly relents with aberrant humiliations. For that reason, he mercilessly beats that enemy that is me. Destroying myself I destroy the world, my world: my relationships, my possibilities, my illusions. "

Susan B.

It is easier for a social E4 to become aware of the damage to himself, because believing himself so inferior, he does not consider that he can cause harm to others. You may be very unaware that self-boycott is also a way of accusing others, weakening them, or annihilating them: you use them as a projectile to hit those who are close to you. A certain cruelty remains very unconscious when you do not give the other recognition.

For others it can be very destructive if you don't believe in their love, if you don't think they are important. It can be very destructive to bonds and relationships that without realizing it is bringing others down all the time; it constantly raises and lowers them, and very subtly makes them feel bad.

This also happens in social or work relationships: with such a fragile, insecure and powerless person, it is impossible to get angry or confront them regarding their responsibilities. It is difficult for him to see how this way of protecting himself can take away from a group the possibility of his help, support or collaboration. To avoid failure, avoid contributing what you can or what is up to you. The feelings around self-pity and the pain of not being able to hide that you are not assuming a responsibility, or that you unload a part of the work on others.

To the extent that he does not appropriate this passive-aggressive mechanism, in the same way that he prevents himself from standing out or shining, he will also try to prevent it from others (what is prohibited is what is prohibited for me and for everyone). It becomes imperative that he appropriate his envy, to free others from covering the responsibilities he does not take). Only having developed this sense of responsibility will he be able to live in a relationship without feeling like such a small and miserable thing, without the need to compare himself, because then he will have his own resources available to build what he wants to build and will not depend on what others achieve.

In a way, it would be an act of humility: recognizing the good things is an act of humility, a relinquishment of the special place of being the most suffering person in the world.

One day, in a SAT group, I was in the middle of everyone, vibrating, and I started to cry. Very cleverly, the therapist realized my mechanism and brought me out of tears, she confronted me with the joy that was to feel that vibrant energy and forced me to tolerate it and show it in front of the group. It was terrible, and now that I am writing it my cheeks are red again and my nose and eyes are watering. Terrible because I realized that I am very afraid of being destroyed if I am happy, enormous fear of envious women. Here are two things mixed up: one, the transfer that I make of my envious and emasculating mother to the group, and the other, my own envy projected onto others.

“Being there for those minutes was an experience full of revelations. My hysteria mechanism was also very present, where because I don't have much space in my body to tolerate a lot of energy, it overflows, and I get hysterical. The therapist helped me to tolerate and manage it, I was able to move a lot in front of the group, with my hips and with everything; there was guilt, anxiety, hysteria, shame, above all, fear, the desire to disappear, the desire to tell everyone that what was happening was not real, to apologize deeply for taking up their space and time. What a shame! You could see my whole life running through me, the whole vibration of life taking over me, and I couldn't hide it anymore in front of all of them: they discovered me. It is life itself that is in the shadow.”

Susan B.

The social E4 person puts his own in the world as if it were neither valuable nor important, and he does the same with his own, his own children and his partner. This is destructive, especially for children who look to their mother to nurture their self-esteem and self-esteem. The social E4 mother, by wanting to love the other, accommodates herself in a place of servility without having the power to set limits or assert her own needs. She gives her all and gives everything, she generates abuse from the children because she manages not to be appreciated, valued or respected. With its devaluation, the social E4 leads relationships to inequality and imbalance in giving and taking. This is not only detrimental to him or her, but also to the other person in the relationship. Subtly, there is a lack of gratitude and a chronic discontent in relationships that wears them down, because the other feels that it is never enough neither what it gives nor what it is; he leaves feeling unappreciated, undervalued, underseen; To tell the truth, the social Four does not see the other because he is focused on what is missing, and in his suffering, he only has eyes to see his suffering. That takes away the energy to see the other and love him with all that he is. If he dared to see it, he would also be envious, which is why the social E4 prefers that the other also stay small, so that he does not arouse envy. The smaller the other is, the more love he thinks he feels towards him. He feels like the saviour, and therefore worthy of receiving love. This game is quite destructive.

8. LOVE

By Alichita Rossi, Chiara Fustini, Giulia Clignon

"Sometimes love can: be magical. But magic is just an illusion."

Javan

The deep wound of the social E4 is the frustration with respect to the expectation of love from the mother, a love that was directed towards the other children and that, consequently, left a feeling of indignity or a feeling of inferiority. This phenomenon determines an affective void, a great distrust in love that tries to fill in the expectation of a saving love that transfers a lot to the couple and gives them the illusion of redeeming their feeling of inferiority. There is a constant search, even in friendships, for a love of fusion in which one can let go and trust, like a child in its mother's arms, in the desire for deep intimacy without interruptions or abandonment. And on the other hand, each small limit or distance is experienced as an abandonment. An idealization that has all the conditions to become deception.

Without being aware of it, he shifted the expectation of love from the mother to the partner. But the realization of this kind of relationship between adults is almost impossible to carry out, since it requires that the other live and manage his life looking only for his own good. Waiting for a love more like that of a "mother" than that of a mature and adult couple, not infrequently he comes across someone who manipulates him, who deceives him and who can even exploit him.

Love is the meaning of its existence; without a love relationship, life seems empty, meaningless. Life consists of waiting for this moment that heals and transforms everything as if it really began with the arrival of love. Only then can you be happy.

"As a child, I remember that I loved to see the bride and groom's car go by, all decorated with white bows. I watched him, enthralled, slide down the road and thought of the two inside, happy, safe, saved by their love."

Alicita R.

"I remember the first dedication that Claudio made to me in his book "La via del Silenzio e la via delle parole [Between meditation and psychotherapy]", at the SAT 1 in Lignano Sabbiadoro (Italy), in 2006: "May you find a man worthy of you ". I reread it countless times, amazed to see how the spiritual teacher I had been lucky enough to meet had grasped such an essential point for my life in the first meeting. And that he had used the word "dignity." I often felt unworthy, unworthy of a loving relationship, unworthy of being happy."

Giulia C.

"As a teenager, I amused myself by watching old couples, imagining that their union had been perfect and untouchable for so many years, that they had spanned their entire lives with intimacy and poetry."

There is in this character an ideal of romantic love that is built over time, in which there is a total comprehension, a deep understanding and a fusion of spirits, souls and bodies. But often this person's destiny is to remain single for a long time because no man can live up to that inner ideal. When you enter a relationship, the social E4 is loaded with anxieties, fears of rejection and abandonment. If before the central point of their existence was waiting for love or a partner, later it becomes the fear of losing it and being abandoned. As we have already said, it is not uncommon for him to stay in and endure unsatisfactory or destructive relationships precisely because he does not give up on the realization of his dream. In this he can be tenacious, and this tenacity can become a kind of challenge to himself and to the other: the need becomes a hyper desire that admits no limits.

Often, the impossibility and fear of expressing your needs and desires end up making you feel alone and misunderstood. It anguishes him not to find anyone who understands him. He is looking for a sensitive person who perceives his fragility and takes him under his wing, as if he were a child. Deep down it is his greatest desire, although he keeps it hidden because he is ashamed of it.

If you find someone who thinks of everything, who takes care of the tasks, of the problems, who knows how to give you attention and affection, who hugs you anticipating your desires, then, protected, and safe, you will be able to calm the anxiety of having to face daily to a hostile and unknown world. You can finally switch off your brain and let it rest, since it is someone else who takes care of everything.

But inside you two instances coexist: on the one hand, you strongly want to feel safe, protected and guided and at the same time you want to be independent, autonomous, free to make the decisions you deem appropriate. He does not tolerate anyone behaving towards him as his mother did, treating him like a puppet with no right to choose or do, and he is too used to having to depend only on himself and doing everything by himself.

Thus, by not really trusting others, they have a strong need for control that manifests itself by doing things with total autonomy instead of having them done by someone they do not trust or knowing that they would have people. You have to endure the judgment or confrontation of others, an evident contradiction within yourself: on the one hand the need for love and protection, on the other an absolute need to be free and autonomous. He is a bit like a small child taking his first steps, who needs to turn around and see that his back is covered because his mother is looking at him and at the same time he wants no one to hold his hand or stand in front of him.

“ I managed to survive my internal anguish, my fear of being abandoned, through total control of the needs of the people around me, my partner, my children. I avoided the needs of others so as not to give space to my own. I considered myself indispensable, in a continuous effort, until exhaustion, for everything to turn out well. Who could do it better than me, sacrifice to the maximum? It is equally true that I could not bear any criticism, any judgment, any limitation of my autonomy. So I prevented the autonomy of the people around me and I got angry that others had to understand my needs on the fly, without me having to express them directly.”

“Often it is that the couple must intuit our moods, our thoughts, our desires... before we express them. In this there is an incapacity and a lack of self-affirmation and self-exposure, making yourself seen for what you are.”

Giulia C.

But the balance of the social E4 is precarious. In fact, a difficult situation is enough for anxieties and fears to surface and a relapse into anxiety to occur. She tends to position herself before her partner as a unique woman or man, almost a fairy or a hero who cannot be compared to anyone else, neither before, nor during, nor after.

A narcissistic aspect is present, not expressed outwardly but cultivated covertly, referring to one's own value; he has a kind of illusion of leaving an indelible mark of his presence even after a possible break in the love relationship, "How is the other going to forget me?". The consequence of his feeling

Low self-esteem leads him, in order to win the love and recognition of the other, to build an image of an ideal couple in the eyes of his partner. He works so that the other recognizes in him characteristics and aspects never before found in anyone; there is a continuous investment in making himself irreplaceable, in demonstrating his own preciousness. In reality, all this arises from a strong abandonment anxiety and energy is carried out to ward off the danger of the end of the relationship. To make up for his parents' deficient, ambivalent, or sadistic love, he has created within himself a figure that allows him to gain love and gratification. Frequently, the social woman creates the inner figure of the good, wise princess, always available for the other. That is why she finally believes that she is worthy of love and that if the other person leaves her, with time they will realize what they have lost and will regret their choice.

“ I had a seven-year relationship that started at a very young age, it ended because he fell in love with another girl, I remember it was like dying for me. The thought of being replaceable and losing the person I dreamed of having a family with and growing old together brought me to a stage of utter despair. I didn't feel hungry, and I lost so much weight that not eating made me feel like I didn't need anything. I remember that what brought me out of that state was anger and envy towards the other girl, which turned into a desire to show that I was better and the illusion that she would return to me on her knees asking for forgiveness.”

Chiara F.

In the fear of losing love, a touching melancholy invades us with the certainty that someone better than us will soon be replaced. This moving melancholy does not allow one to live fully in the present and enjoy the love for what is to come, the tragic sorrow is already savored and it is understood that the future is not benevolent: “<it will leave me sooner or later”, and that day will probably come with painful consequences... Negative anticipation ends up being an external reality and, when it arrives, it is not only unexpected, but also unacceptable due to the baggage of pain it brings with it, as if negative anticipation.

"It will act as an antidote to loss. In renunciation, one becomes a sacrificial victim; the meaning of existence depends on the level of lack."

Rosi C.

Basically, there is a lack of true authenticity in the relationship of the social E4, since it avoids showing the other what is unpleasant, negative, burdensome, and even unacceptable about itself. This could tarnish one's own image and undermine the other person's esteem. So he does not really show himself as he is, he does not talk about the existential pain that has always accompanied him, the feeling of internal loneliness, or the negative feelings such as envy or jealousy that he may feel, since this would expose him to the danger of being rejected, just as he does not openly express his needs and desires because of the danger of being seen as a burden. The result of this, however, is the expectation that the partner can read his thoughts and his soul and intuit for himself what he wants. What one is allowed to attract attention is to complain. The consequences of these attitudes are frustration and disappointment with the partner, which over time turn into silent resentment. By letting the other see only the parts of himself that he considers worthy of appreciation, including the image of the person who suffers, he creates a vicious circle in which he shows himself better than he really feels to win love, but at the same time. At the same time, he also proves to himself that if he let the other see him as he really is, he could not be worthy of his love.

The prototype of the ideal couple includes caring for the other at all levels, trying to fulfil their wishes, both expressed and intuited, listening to them, and taking care of them, supporting them in the different spheres of existence, always being there when they need it; basically, a mixture of father, ideal partner/friend and even therapist in case of need.

This prototype of the ideal couple tends to make the other dependent, as if to avoid abandonment one of the possibilities was to make yourself indispensable within the relationship, satisfying all your needs. If this, on the one hand, helps calm anxiety, on the other, it often makes them not realize that they are sacrificing the role of man/woman in favor of that of father/mother. The dependence of the other on the couple and low self-esteem also make it necessary to use pain and suffering as manipulative tools. The fact of not being able to directly demand the satisfaction of one's own needs sets in motion a strategy that keeps the other tied to himself through the continuous need for help. Often illness and physical problems become a blackmail tool to avoid abandonment.

The constant fear of being abandoned allows you to keep love tension high and avoid the feeling of not loving your partner enough.

In a situation of balance and certainty, he is often unable to feel love for the other person, and it may even happen that his gaze is directed elsewhere. Love, therefore, is often reduced to the immense effort not to be abandoned and to the search for a certainty and a confirmation in the relationship that we do not feel and that we will never be able to perceive. The strong dependency that characterizes this character is usually expressed when it enters intimacy with the other and creates a relationship of trust. Often, to escape the awareness of triggering a strong dependency on his partner, he puts into practice the opposite process, counter dependency. He experiences his needs with discomfort and shame, considers them unacceptable and flees from the slightest attempt at serious bonding, so as not to become a victim of the other and not depend on him.

These dynamics, when there is no partner, tend to overflow the dynamics of friendship. The need to open totally leads him to look for a person in friendship with whom he can make a pact of loyalty, a true association to obviate the unbearable feeling of internal loneliness. The absolute loyalty of the friend serves to contain the fear of abandonment, and therefore feel a strong need to know that the other can be counted on at any time. As in the couple, seek fusion in friendship, unconditional love, protection, total trust. For such a character, superficial relationships, light friendships, going out, and mere one-night entertainment make no sense. In friendship they must find a home in a certain way, the friendship relationship is a kind of nest that makes them feel safe, protected from the world and understood. But, precisely because of this high level sought in the relationship, a person with this character is strongly intransigent with respect to the defects of the other; any slightest inattention can be a source of disappointment and can be interpreted as a betrayal.

Friendship, for social E4s, is a true anchor, a refuge against the Specter of loneliness, a substitute for love and maternal care.

The only possibility of salvation comes from the dream of a prince or fairy creature that comes to save him with his unconditional love. But now when the prince arrives and loves him deeply, the paradox is that the subject cannot believe that all this is true and begins to devalue him.

The feeling of not being lovable is so strong for the E4 that he cannot believe that an individual of value could love him.

The Three Loves:

The least developed love in the social E4 is undoubtedly erotic love. There are many reasons for this, mainly the repression of the most instinctive sphere and the expression of emotions such as anger. In addition, they did not experience this type of love in their relationship with their mother (in which physical contact is the basis) and they never acquired a relationship of trust and security with their own body. growing up in the puberty phase, the E4 feels the development of his own emasculated sexuality, and it is something for which he often felt guilty as well. In many cases, daughters are inhibited by their mother in expressing their femininity. Thus, in adulthood, the body and sexuality are often used solely to obtain admiring and maternal love. The purpose of physical love is to contain the quarrel of abandonment and, thus, avoid the loss of the loved one.

One Christmas, Claudio invited me to use a vibrator. I, who had spent years sighing for not having found the long-awaited love! In the days that followed, he told me that I no longer had to wait for Prince Charming, that adults also meet in sexuality and that a relationship can be born from shared sexuality. For me, it was a Copernican revolution.

Giulia C.

Admiring love seems more accessible, apparently. In the relationship with a teacher, the social E4 manages to incorporate it into his inner world, but in reality, he confuses admiration and envy. The relationship with him is characterized by a great idealization: he embodies the highest realization of the person; he is a point of reference for others and receives the esteem and admiration of all.

Therefore, the social E4 aspires to resemble the teacher, aspires to be like him, to be the one who directs, the one who helps, but also the one who has experienced and overcome pain. However, this envy is unbearable because it deprives him of his relationship with the teacher, so he turns it into admiration. The social E4 is a dedicated student who firmly aspires to be the favorite student, the most respected and loved, even though he is certain that this will never happen.

Love of God is also characterized by strong devotion, but at the same time, it is also full of desire, longing to achieve something. It is an admiration to fill one's own inner emptiness.

The dominant love is maternal love: the social E4 feels comfortable giving the other person attention, care, help of various kinds, and emotional support. The remarkable empathy with which she is endowed you to intercept the mood of the other, understand him deeply and make him feel his closeness, but be with him without a clarity of limits. By helping the other person, you feel good and therefore more deserving of love; In addition, by taking care of another person, she somehow distracts herself from her own existential pain. Through maternal love, she feels the warmth of the other and her own, she feels generous and safe from abandonment, because the other needs her.

It is an affective investment that with his resignation puts everything in order, does not put obstacles to the lives of others, moreover, facilitates it, in the relationship he is willing to sacrifice himself to be "unconsciously" reciprocated, thus ensuring the long-awaited contact.

Rosi C.

There was like a crazy idea inside of me that if I was attentive, caring, warm and welcoming to my partner, he would never leave me. It was like a guarantee for me against abandonment. Obviously, this did not happen and the unbearable pain in which I found myself, and which made me feel that I was almost dying from his abandonment, taught me the most important lesson: the only real abandonment that can make me die is the one that only I can make myself, and even if I didn't know it... It was what I had been doing in life up to that moment!

Alicia R

9. HISTORICAL PERSON: GUSTAV MAHLER

By Witte Maria Weber

❖ FRIEDRICH RÜCKERT:

*If you love for beauty,
O love not me! Love
the sun,
She has golden hair. If
you love for youth, O
love not me!
Love the spring.
Which is young each year.
If you love for riches, O
love not me!
Love the mermaid.
Who has many shining pearls.
If you love for love, ah
yes, love me!
Love me always,
I shall love you ever more.*

What immense luck for a social E4 to be blessed with a musical genius! This thought came to mind as I got closer to Mahler, reading about him, watching movies, listening to his music. Above all, I asked myself: how do you combine the typical insecurity of the social E4 with the genius of a Gustav Mahler?

Perhaps genius means carrying a seed within oneself that pushes hard towards the light and must absolutely blossom. The environment recognizes the power of this upward push and begins to revolve around the little plant to nurture, protect, let it grow and flourish. Mahler's gift opened doors that would otherwise have remained closed. He received, without demanding it, what an average social E4 usually fights in vain to achieve throughout his life and that, because he perceives it as unfairly withheld, occupies first place in his attention and feeds his envy: promotion, recognition, a stage, entranced admirers, a woman young and beautiful from a good family, rich and with excellent connections; in short: an important place in the midst of society, a place in the sun.

Gustav Mahler was born into a Jewish family in the Bohemian-Moravian city of Kalischt on July 7, 1860. His mother, Marie, the daughter of a soap manufacturer, had no right to a good match, because she limped. She was not allowed to marry the man she loved, instead having to settle for Bernhard Mahler, who came from humble backgrounds, was quick-tempered but also ambitious. Gustav Mahler would later say that they were not very compatible, that they were like fire and water. The infant mortality rate at that time was fifty percent, and of the fourteen children Marie gave birth to, only eight survived. Gustav, the second born, had to replace his older brother.

Bernhard Mahler owns an inn that he runs together with the wine distillery he inherited from his father. Beginning in October 1860, a manifesto issued by Emperor Franz Joseph allows underprivileged people, including Jews, to take advantage of new opportunities through freedom of movement. That same year, Bernhard Mahler moved with his family to the city of Iglau.

Gustav spent most of his childhood and youth in Iglau. Their growth is marked by family tensions, violence, and losses. The couple often argues. The child traumatically experiences how his father hits his mother. Later, he will witness the illness and death of his beloved thirteen-year-old brother Ernst, an especially bad experience for the fourteen-year-old. Another brother will take his own life at the age of twenty-three. Before he turns thirty, Mahler will also have lost both of his parents within a year.

Gustav's talent became apparent at an early age. He takes his first musical steps at the age of four. He develops rapidly, to the joy and pride of his father, who encourages him and allows him to take classes with several teachers. Gustav learns various instruments, starts writing small pieces at an early age and will soon be teaching others himself. At the age of ten he gave his first concert in Iglau, considered a child prodigy.

Father Mahler thinks freely about religious questions and is open-minded to German culture. He has many books. Because he always carries something to read on his travels, people nickname him "the learned coachman." Your child is baptized with water from various musical sources: you may not hear the synagogue singing too often, but instead you hear the songs and dances from the tavern that permeate upstairs each night, the marches soldiers from the nearby parade ground, the village band hears the bells of the Catholic church in Iglau and probably also sings in the church choir. All these sounds and rhythms, the different musical languages, act on him, form him and later he will leave them into his works as threads of life. As a composer, he will send his wife to silence all sources of disturbance, such as cowbells, chatter, laughter, shouting, bellowing, church bells, dance bands around, yes, the noisy life of others: he needs the As much silence as possible for his work, to listen inwardly to the echo of his youthful years, to preserve the pure memory and let it resonate within himself, in order to once again display within himself a sublime nature that is outside, to transform what has been by the work of his genius and thus tell the deepest human suffering, death, but at the same time the incomprehensible beauty of paradise, the pure longing for life, let the past come alive like a distillation of the ear interior and make it perceptible to the outside world with all the colours of unprecedented tenderness and overwhelming force: captivating, melancholic, loving, inconsolable, enthusiastic, sorrowful, orgiastic, tangled, playful, deadly serious, fresh, complicated, expansive, contracted, connected to nature, isolated from the living, vigorous, thin-skinned, confident, irritable, calmness itself, cheeky and impetuous, serene and peaceful.

Mahler must have been an intense, nervous, alert, impulsive person who commanded attention for his often-unusual behavior. From a young age, he learns to be capable of suffering and to tolerate everyday things; for example, he is not surprised that, as a teenager in foster care, he must go to bed hungry every day and have his clothes taken from him. Believe that it is so. However, it becomes clear from the start that he knows the musical stuff and knows how to get his way, even if it's not in confrontation. As a student, he takes an interest in spiritual matters, lives as a vegetarian for several years, and strikes many as a general weirdo. The lack of appreciation during his years of study in Vienna and the rejection of his first symphony work due to misspellings hit him in the gut. Later, faced with the initial lack of recognition of his musical work by journalists and

the public, he does not give up, but persists on his way to international success as a conductor and composer. After the death of his parents, Mahler -already with a job as director of the Royal Opera in Budapest- is in charge of supporting his siblings. Sometimes he seems to keep less money for himself than he passes to them. She asks them to make a better budget, because she hasn't had money for months to sew her shoes.

When he marries Alma, in his older age, he is heavily in debt and leaves the task of putting the house and money to her. However, it is interesting that he manages other people's money as a holder of senior professional positions, always very prudently and for the good of the institutions.

Mahler's health is poor. It is true that he is an athlete and that he loves to exercise outdoors, take strenuous walks, sunbathe, and swim. Being in nature means relaxation and comfort for him. But he has inherited a heart disease from his mother and does not know the measure of his resistance. Too often he pushes himself to the limit of his physical capacity. Even in the context of their gruelling duties as a conductor, often combined with long travel, he repeatedly works to the point of exhaustion and illness.

Despite all the difficulties he experienced from early childhood, the unpleasant times in high school (at eleven he was the worst of the sixty-four students; he would later say that he had learned nothing), the worries economic conditions, physical frailty, and a general feeling of helplessness ("as a Bohemian among Austrians, as an Austrian among Germans, and as a Jew in all nations of the world"), many circumstances of life seem to have contributed in an excellent way to the development of his genius.

However, envy, shame typical of social E4 and deep feelings of guilt also marked Mahler's life. He considers himself an unattractive man, lanky and with an overly large head, who is at least not handsome in the usual sense. Even when he is dressed well, he looks badly dressed, writes his wife Alma. His walk is stormy and bumpy.

Mahler makes sure that there is no one announcing the wedding in the newspaper at the wrong time. Is the concern that Alma will outshine you at the church wedding ceremony greater than the joy of celebrating the wedding in public? Isn't Alma allowed to be a happy young bride in public? Is Mahler afraid of unpleasant comments, for example, about the age difference? Or do you just feel too insecure and uncomfortable in your role as a man, as a husband? Alma writes that she clumsily slipped off the bench as she knelt down, lucky no one was there. It would probably have been very embarrassing.

Mahler doesn't just hide his wife from the public on this big day. He wants the beautiful, rich and socially admired Alma all to himself, so that she will wither by his side as an artist and as a woman. You act under the influence of social envy, which often refers to the social status of others that you believe you cannot achieve. All the beauty, all wealth is just junk, he tells Alma. Mahler will have felt miserable, old and unattractive next to his wife. He says that he can only love a beautiful woman, but he tells Alma that he could only love her completely if, for example, her face was disfigured by pockmarks. Alma becomes a shy woman with her first pregnancy and feels visibly insecure next to the great Mahler. Both are constantly jealous of each other. The couple will avoid company whenever possible and live in the safety of union (Mahler prefers "splendid isolation") or in the circle of family and friends. One day, after nine years of marriage, Alma will take a young, beautiful and gifted lover, which will deal a heavy blow to Gustav. Mahler, who is fifty by then, will wake up, seek help, and change. He doesn't have much time left to do it.

As is apparent from Freud's notes on the one session Mahler spent with him, which lasted several hours after long hesitation, he was diagnosed with, among other things, a "Maria complex," an overly strong attachment to Mother. Mahler searched for and missed her face, marked by suffering, in his wife Alma. How could he find it there? Perhaps he was looking for her to lead her back to redemption, to beauty, to her true nature through the power of her primordial music, to free herself from the feeling that he was to blame for her unhappiness in life, that he had not protected her. of the blows of his father, the man who had treated him so well, the brilliant son, and had encouraged him...

*If you love for love, ah
yes, love me!
Love me always,
I love you forever!*

10. LITERARY AND FILM EXAMPLES

❖ A LITERARY EXAMPLE

La Peau de Chagrin (The Chagrin Skin):

by Honoré de Balzac Character: Raphaël de Valentin

BY VITTE MARIA WEBER Paris, 1829. Raphaël de Valentin, a twenty-five-year-old man from an impoverished aristocracy and disillusioned with life, gambles away his remaining money one morning at the Palais Royal. Since he has nothing left, he feels that his existence has no meaning and wants to drown in the Seine. To kill time until nightfall, he goes into an antique shop and contemplates the chaos of objects and works of art of all origins, from all eras and cultures to his heart's content. The old owner of the antique shop shows Raphaël a carved skin, which promises to fulfil all the wishes of its owner. However, the price will be lifetime: for each wish fulfilled, the skin is reduced. Despite the antiques dealer's insistent warning, Raphaël steals the skin, making a first wish and taking it with him. As soon as he goes outside, he runs into his friends, who were looking for him, and follows them to a banquet, which ends in an orgy, just as he had wished. Later, Raphaël mentions to his friend Emile that he was about to commit suicide. Emile asks about the cause of his despair.

Raphaël narrates all his life and his stories of suffering to the sleepy Emile: how he, as an only child, growing up under the strict watch of his father (the mother had died when Raphaël was ten years old), becomes a lawyer only to recover the honour of the family, and how after the death of his father, with almost no means, he is in the sterile attic of a cheap pension beginning to write a Theory of the will.

Raphaël has a hopeless love for Countess Feodora (the "heartless woman"), and through his intelligence and budding success as a writer he becomes her confidante; the countess tells him from time to time that she does not love him, which incites Raphaël even more to win her over, because he believes that Feodora's dismissive attitude is nothing more than a sign of her love. Raphaël also tells Emile about Pauline, the beautiful and still very young daughter of the boarding house's housekeeper, who is in love with him, but due to her poor position, does not interest him as a woman. Raphaël's stories make it clear that his masochistic love for Feodora and his constant worry about money and his idea of life make him sicker and sicker.

When morning comes, Raphaël remembers the carved skin. Uncontrolled, he lets out a howl and wakes up all the sleeping banquet attendees and boasts that he is capable of anything. At the same time, he wants to prove that the skin works: he copies the outline of the skin, and he wishes to have a large pension; after a short time, he receives this in the form of an unexpected inheritance, and immediately afterwards the skin is reduced. Raphaël is disgusted by the mockery of the guests, and he threatens them with wishing them death. Now he feels that his power, instead of admiration, brings him great loneliness and fear.

In the next chapter, Raphaël already lives with Jonathan, his prior mentor, in his newly purchased palace. Jonathan is tasked with organizing Raphaël's life according to well defined rules to spare him any wish. One afternoon they have scheduled a visit to the theatre. Raphaël, bitter-since people look at him with suspicion and envy, meets many acquaintances, but nevertheless avoids any contact. In the center of attention is as always the beautiful countess. But suddenly, there is another woman in the center of all eyes; she sits directly with Raphaël, who ignores her. Unintentionally, he reacts to a rustle in her silk dress, turning to see the beautiful, radiant Pauline beautifully dressed. Pauline runs off scared, though she sets an appointment with him for the next day; they want to meet in the old attic. After an initial phase of doubt, Raphaël gives in to his overwhelming feelings and sheds the skin, determined to forget about it. The two live together in the purest happiness of their love until, one day, the gardener finds the skin: Raphaël is very scared to see that it is very shrunken. He pushes Pauline away without explanation and goes to find the bigger scientists, but there's no way to deal with the skin issue. When Pauline returns, without warning, Raphaël falls for her charms again. Detecting the first signs of a lung disease, he cuts Pauline out of his life again. In a panic, he seeks the help of four doctors at once; despite his distrust, he follows their advice and goes to a spa. There he is openly rejected by the other patients, due to his arrogance, and is challenged to a duel. After having killed his opponent, he flees very ill and finally finds peace in an idyllic place in nature, where he is welcomed by some simple peasants. When he also feels watched by them and rejected, he leaves for home, disappointed and deathly ill. Jonathan tries to distract Raphaël by throwing a big party, following the advice from his friend, the doctor Bianchon, but he hits him, angry: he wants a life without vitality and asks Bianchon for a drink that will keep him awake for exactly one hour a day. When Pauline appears again, desire awakens in Raphaël. In the end he explains to her the misfortune of the skin. She understands everything and wants to kill herself to save Raphaël. The attempt fails. Raphaël dies of desire by biting into Pauline's breast.

Balzac explains to the readers that Pauline represents the love that only exists in illusion and Feodora the society that is found everywhere.

Next, I would like to talk about the title that Balzac chose: "La peau de chagrin", which can be translated as "The chagrin skin". Chagrin comes from the Turkish word *sagri* or *çâgri* and refers to the dorsal part of a donkey's skin. Likewise, the title could be translated as "The skin of sorrows" (from the French *peau*, skin, and *chagrin*, sorrow, suffering, concern), which would be an accurate description of the hero. Raphaël feels his life as "lingering, diffuse pain, and we can both feel this pain atmospherically, especially as we have to watch our gifted hero lose himself more and more - through his erratic behaviour in a state of hopelessness and negative feelings.

The skin is what is seen from the outside, it is almost the business card of a person. For the social E4, the exterior becomes a kind of "negative calling card": he does not want to put on a "friendly face", he hates that idea. Generally, he suffers from his unbearable existence, and this can be quite visible, perhaps as a manifestation of his weak revenge. Balzac describes Raphaël in the first chapter as: "innocent soul", "very unhappy", "very weak">, "terrible-looking", "gloomy elegance", "his look shows disappointed efforts", "sickly paleness", "bitter smile", "resignation that hurts to look at her", "hidden genius">, "hands... fragile like a woman's", "like an angel without rays that has lost its way". All this gives the impression of a needy, theatrical and somewhat uptight person, not all fit for life. The skin also symbolizes the ability to protect oneself from the ups and downs of life.

It is said that someone has the skin of an elephant or thick skin and we mean that it is someone who can endure a lot and does not perceive too much. The blond Raphaël has subtle, fair skin, blushes with embarrassment, is easily irritable and quickly becomes insecure. On top of that, "la peau de chagrin" comes from a donkey, from a pack animal, which in our culture usually represents perseverance, but also stupidity and stubbornness, that also has to do with Raphaël: he often insists on his opinion against common sense, despite his indisputable intelligence, shows a certain stupidity in his impulsiveness with which he harms himself, only to demonstrate a pseudo autonomy opposed to the described inability to help himself by saying with refusal: "I don't need you, I can get it myself".

With *La piel de chagrin*, Balzac created a metaphor for a heartbreaking attitude towards life: everything positive (desires) is at the cost of the duration of life. nothing is obtained easily or for free, nothing is joyful or playful, it is as if pleasure were punishable and as if life took revenge on the living being itself. At the same time, it is a metaphor for how one can die if one is carried away by the passion of one's desires. Then the skin could represent a metaphor for general neurosis and for the fact that "we are living according to our neurosis, which is stealing our energy like a parasite that knows how to convince us that its interest is ours".

The novel is a praise of the bitter seriousness of life, of the glass literally half empty, of our undervalued mortality, even of the injustice of life that is found always and everywhere because this is what one is looking for Raphaël's incapacity even in the immense happiness that he lives through the total dedication of Pauline and also in the labour process of his work to erase the effect of the chagrin skin demonstrates his deep distrust towards the forces of life themselves. Locked up in his feelings of lack, in his impotence and inferiority, this gifted young man finds himself unable to assimilate his turbulent experiences in life and to overcome them.

It seems consistent to award the disposition of E4 to Raphaël due to the following indications regarding his childhood. As was customary in aristocratic circles at the time, Raphaël was not nursed by his mother, but by a wet nurse. And he was educated by a mentor. Raphaël talks about his life in detail but does not tell us about any events that have to do with his mother. Surely she is the true "heartless woman">, it was her coldness and absence that made Raphaël's life difficult from the beginning and weakened his will to live. Nor is the mother much mentioned in the narrative as a whole: we understand only that she was descended from the wealthy aristocracy, that she was "a good catch," that she provided for the servant Jonathan on a life annuity, and that she died when Jonathan was ten. years. Raphaël sells the island of the Loire, with the maternal grave, with remorse, but not towards her, but towards his father. The man, bitter and rigid, was at least always present during Raphaël's years of study, demanding and helping him if only for the sake of using and instrumentalizing him in the service of himself and the honour of the family. One of Raphaël's doctors also detects the cause of his illness in the "wound at the very roots of the vital energy".

We deduce the social aspect from the hero's way of directing his envious gaze always towards the privileged, thus wasting a lot of energy with complaints about his inferiority and lack of self-confidence, instead of actively conquering his place in society. He is envious of the rich and powerful and everyone who feels comfortable with their social ties, dreams of fame achieved through their literary activities, united with a beautiful and rich woman Unjustifiably, which causes the envy of all men. He has a link with Countess Feodora, who would have to save him from this injustice and would give him the place in society that would correspond to his genius, restoring in such a way the corresponding lost privileges. Then he betrays himself and his talents, allows himself to

be irritated by others and withdraws from his work: when his friends make fun of his works, when Rastignac appears and advises him to abandon serious work in exchange for going into debt, or when it is again and again led by the ear by the countess, he becomes discouraged or runs after them, wastes time, energy and his little money with them, with the result that he feels his already weakened vitality exhausted, and his life unworthy of living. . The outside world, to which he believes he owes all his attention, feels so invasive while it is difficult for him to find his inner world and establish the change towards it with the necessary flexibility.

Envy:

What Raphaël likes the most is explaining himself, trapped in comparisons and moved by a tug of war between the feeling of inferiority and arrogance. For example, he scolds Emile when she mocks Raphaël's belief in leading a particularly hard life, telling her that some people have much deeper feelings than others. In his last attempt to win over the countess, he confesses his financial problems; so far he had managed with some effort to convince her of an apparent fortune. Now he only has to show himself as an exceptional person:

There are two miseries, madam [...]. The one is the misery of the people, the other, that of the freeloaders, kings and talented people. I am not a person, a king, or a playboy, perhaps I do not have talent, I am an exception. My last name orders me to die rather than beg. Calm down, ma'am!

As a man, Raphaël belongs to the privileged sex and, as an only child, does not have to put up with feelings of envy from possible brothers. The root of their envy is apparently an early lack of paternal affection, aggravated by the decline in the family's social rank due to the loss of aristocratic privileges. and of wealth.

When his father dies, Raphaël complains about his situation, which he finds extremely hard, and compares himself to other orphans:

At the age of twenty-two, and at the end of the autumn of 1825, I attended, completely alone, the funeral of my favourite friend, my father. Few young people have seen themselves, like me, alone with their thoughts, escorting a death carriage, lost in Paris, with no future, no fortune. Orphans taken in by public charity have, at least, official protection and protection and shelter in a hospice. I was disinherited!

In the following paragraph, the fact that he mentions his highly influential relatives and at the same time denies having any relatives seems strange: that Raphaël

Although related to very influential people and prodigals of their protection for strangers, I lacked relatives and protectors.

Raphaël will also have nurtured a certain envy for the fact that his own mother provided a life annuity to the servant Jonathan while he ends up without any income.

Lack of perseverance and self-humiliation:

In a few sentences the hero speaks of enormous self-esteem and ends by describing himself as poor:

That immense self-love that bubbled up in me, that sublime belief in a destiny, which perhaps turns a man into a genius, when he does not allow himself to be torn away by business jerks, [...] have been precisely those who have saved me I wanted to cover myself with glory and work silently for the woman I loved for whom I hoped to see me reciprocated one day. All women were summed up in one, and that one, I thought I found

in the first one that offered itself to my eyes; but, seeing a queen in each one, they all had to, like queens who are forced to declare themselves to their lovers, come out to meet my painful, miserable, and timid personality. So much gratitude was harboured in my heart; In addition to love, towards the one who would have taken pity on me, who would have always adored her.

Raphaël wants to win Feodora's compassion by showing himself as a weak person:

I told her about my sacrifices, I described my life, [...] He inspired her with phrases that project a whole life, repeating the cries of a torn soul. My accent was that of the last prayers raised by a dying man on the battlefield. Fedora cried. I kept silent. Great God! Her tears were the fruit of that fleeting emotion that is experienced in exchange for giving up the price of a ticket purchased at a theatre box office. I had achieved the success of a good actor.

I also take charge of my ridiculousness; Excuse me! I said sweetly, unable to hold back my tears. I love you enough to hear with delight the words you have spoken.

The longing for paradise lost:

In its third part-"The Agony-the story is built as a slow regression: when Raphaël understands the effects of the chagrin skin, he retires with his former mentor to the palace and lives there with him adapting almost swapped roles: he is not the Raphaël Rich man who gives orders to his servant, but it is Jonathan who independently handles all of Raphaël's business, it is he who commands Raphaël. For in order to live, Raphaël is forbidden to have any desire:

You will take care of me, Jonathan, like a baby in its infancy. [...] You will think for me, and you will provide for all my needs.

In this state of "wanting nothing more", Raphaël meets again the beautiful Pauline, who gives him the joy, ease and eroticism of her devoted love; things seem to be going well for Raphaël. However, she continues with her suspicious attitude until he consciously leans towards happiness by pulling the skin. The two coexist in a state of total innocence in a paradisiacal idyll that lasts until the skin appears again:

By studying himself, his love increased; both harboured identical feelings of delicacy and modesty; the same voluptuousness, the sweetest of voluptuousness, that of the angels. Not the slightest cloud clouded the horizon of his happiness. The desires of each were supreme law for the other.

At the end of the story, Pauline returns to meet Raphaël again, being the only person who loved him and who gave and was rejected by him. was apart-

She wants to commit suicide when she realizes the importance of the chagrin skin for Raphaël, as perhaps only a mother would do for her child. The last image of the novel shows us Raphaël lying on top of Pauline, and how he suffocates when biting into her breast.

The moral of the story?

Naturally, a part of Raphaël thought that he could be happy if he got everything he wanted. But the ego was stronger. No, he did not want to be happy but to continue suffering, because how would it have ended, who would have listened to him? He wanted to continue wallowing in the lack, in the daily frustration, in Raphaël's impotence and

grief, he wanted to continue satiating himself with Raphaël's feelings of envy and inferiority, the meaninglessness of his irrational actions and his erratic feelings!

To break the vicious circle that kept him caged between the fear of being rejected and the desire to be admired, in the tug of war between stubborn contempt and involuntary submission, Raphaël would have to learn to really know himself. Retirement cannot be fruitful as long as it acts as an act of revenge against others, as long as society is abused to strengthen one's own frustration, there is no way out. To truly live without desires, one cannot feel any lack. In order not to feel any lack, you have to live in the present. To achieve the necessary peace and contemplation, it is necessary to start with work. In Balzac's time that was curiously called, although in the most concrete sense, "aller au chagrin".

❖ A FILM EXAMPLE:

The French Lieutenant's Wife (Karel Reisz, 1981)

Character: Sarah

By Alichita Rossi, Elena Lunardi

The film is based on the homonymous novel by John Fowles and is set in 1867. It is a film within a film in which the story of the unhappy Sarah (played by Meryl Streep), banished in Victorian England for her fleeting adventure, is intertwined with the love story of the actress who, based on the same novel, is making a film.

Sarah Woodruff is a distinguished English ex-governor shunned by all for having fallen out of favor with a French lieutenant who is shipwrecked in the waters of a small coastal town, Lyme Regis. Everyone considers her crazy and of easy virtue. Since she is considered the crazy woman of the town, Sarah no longer has a reputation to lose and can allow herself the freedom to be always alone in all places and, something absolutely forbidden for a respectable young woman of the time. Victorian England is closely linked to the values of privacy, discretion, self-control, and obedience to duty.

The young English gentleman Charles, a paleontologist who works in the recovery of fossils on the coast, is anchored to the same values. These certainties are destined to be shaken when the protagonist meets the French lieutenant's wife. He feels attracted to her who, after being abandoned by her lover, had fallen into a deep suffering that tormented her daily and only gave her respite at night during sleep. Sarah is afflicted with a deep melancholy.

And it is to save her from the stormy sea that Charles Smithson ventures onto the jetty where she remained motionless, despite from the wind and the rain, looking at the horizon. He calls her repeatedly until she turns and looks at him. That long look will be the beginning of a passionate romance that will be intertwined with the true love of the two protagonists of the film, Mike and Anna, two actors who interpret the love story of the 19th century.

Sarah agrees to go live in another house as a lady-in-waiting, not even knowing what awaits her, but only by virtue of the fact that this house has views of the sea and can therefore allow her to remain attached to the memory of love and be able to relive it daily.

This is a clear example of the social attachment to the past that continues to give life to an event or a feeling through the imagination and memories aroused, in this case, by the landscape.

Charles discusses Sarah with his fiancée, and this scene highlights the typical aspect of the social E4 character: the attachment to a relationship that has ended and the endless, if pointless, wait for the return of the lost love. An emotional and sentimental languor and a continuous rethinking of the most intense moments lived with the lost person. The E4 social child enacted this mode within himself regarding his mother's love, endlessly hoping that one day it would manifest with hugs and physical contact. He learned to wait, to wait, not to stop waiting.

Sarah meets Charles and when he asks if he can come with her, she politely says no without looking up, a gesture of embarrassment clearly visible. In this case it is the shame of meeting the eyes of the other, of the person with whom she had felt captivated from the beginning, as she confesses at the end of the film. So the greater the interest in the other, the more intense and unbearable the shame. The more you want the love of another, the more you enter into the loop of not being interesting, beautiful, lovable enough. One comes into contact with the negative and devalued image of oneself and identifies with it, losing the perception of what we really are and thus ending up feeling so small that one is ashamed in the eyes of the other. The consequence of this feeling is distance, the disappearance of the gaze of the other.

Sarah begs Charles to let her go. She implores him, that is, she begs him, she is not assertive or self-confident, she seems unable to defend herself from the interference of the other, as if she did not have the resources and strength to set a limit, and on the other hand she delegates in the other his fear of saying yes or no. And this reflects the feeling of internal weakness that a social E4 experiences in relation to the world. as if she wasn't strong enough to defend herself and be able to face him alone. The only way for a social E4 to defend itself and avoid failure is to leave.

Sarah meets Charles in the woods, and when the hunters pass by, she immediately hides, to protect the man from the gossip that would arise from seeing them together. This character has developed from childhood the idea that the other has more value and importance than himself, in addition he has learned as a child to protect his mother at his own expense; In order not to lose a good image of her, he has unconsciously preferred to devalue himself and feel undeserving of her love. He poisoned himself so he could have a mother. He did not direct his anger at her, who did not make him feel loved, devalued him, humiliated him, but blamed himself and considered himself unlovable.

Sarah tells Charles that she can't even imagine her suffering and that she is only happy when she sleeps. This passage shows how strong and constant the inner torment of this character is, a torment so intense that it cannot be imagined from the outside. A continuous suffering that only sleep can interrupt. Sarah desperately wonders why she was born the way she is and compares herself to Charles's girlfriend, revealing the characteristic trait of envy that leads the subject to constantly compare herself with an external object, which she obviously always judges better than her own. itself. She then tells her of her meeting with the French lieutenant, how she was captivated by his courage and how she admired him until she fell in love madly from him, so much so that when he left, he couldn't help but follow him. In this passage from the film, Sarah explains how the loss of love was unbearable since it brought her in contact with a sense of loneliness so deep that she drowned in it. For the social E4, love is the meaning of life, being loved and loving is the only way to achieve happiness. Losing love or being abandoned by the person you love is like losing the meaning of your existence. Sarah was seduced by his compliments and by the beautiful image he sent her of herself. The social E4 is in such a

profound devaluation of itself that it lives in a constant need for confirmation and, therefore, is easily seduced by the attention and compliments of the other.

After making love to Charles, Sarah says, "I've been imagining a day like this for so long!", alluding to the fact that she's been waiting a long time to feel truly loved by the man she loves. This type of personality lives waiting for a deep, true, intense and idealized love, with the expectation of feeling loved like never before in his life, in an attempt to make up for what he did not have in childhood. So that moment of true and intense love is like the repair, the cure of an old emotional abyss, of an old love hole that originated in childhood. Sarah insists that Charles can make any decision (even leaving her) because at this point, strong in the love she has felt, she will be able to bear anything. From that moment comes her strength to live. Although that feeling of satisfaction and peace achieved thanks to the love that she has finally received turns into melancholy and nostalgia. Every day Sarah will think back on those moments and relive them with the languor and longing that accompanies them. Every day you will live with your eyes turned to the past.

Anna, the actress who plays Sarah, talks to Mike's wife, and confesses that she is envious of him for the beauty and care of her garden, although it is clear that she is actually envious of the fact that the woman can live next door to the man with whom Anna is in love. Here we can see the nature of the envy felt by a social E4, that is, a feeling of strong disgust that refers to love, not an object: the social E4 does not feel envy for material things, but for the feeling of love. It is as if the possibility of existing, and above all of confirming oneself and having a place in the world, revolves around a great point of support, which is precisely love. Everything else is secondary, almost superfluous. The fundamental need of a social E4 is not to drink, nor to eat, nor to own things, but to be loved and to love. This means that for this character it makes no sense to live if there is no love and to achieve it or not lose it, it can go as far as total forgetfulness of itself and, therefore, self-destruction.

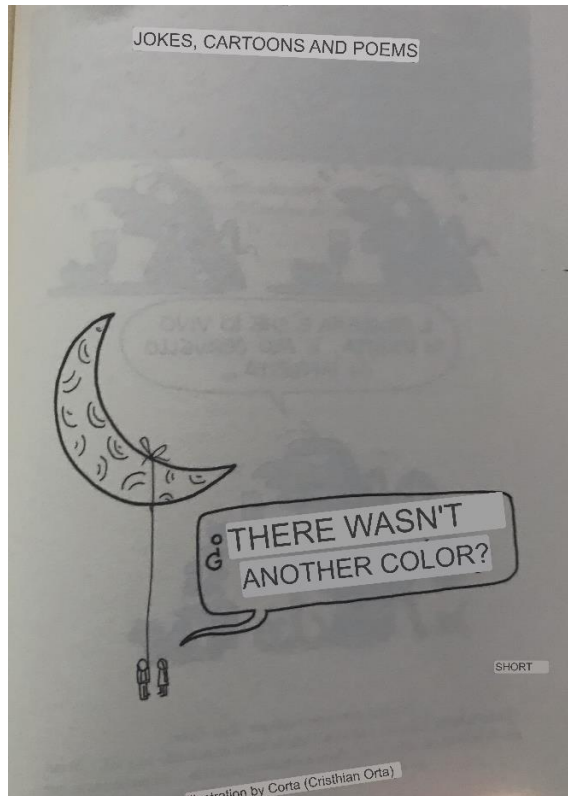
Three years have passed, and Sarah makes sure Charles is where he is. She has changed a lot, she is surer of herself, more serene, more present in herself. When Charles asks her why she didn't wait for him, she explains that she was mad, bitter, and envious inside her at that moment. She felt that she had imposed herself on him, that she had other obligations to another woman. She hadn't been able to stay and wait for him because she felt that everything was too much for her and that she would probably feel a burden. She is only willing to truly meet him after she has built her own life, her own identity, as if she first needed to find her own center within herself and regain her dignity. She has dedicated these three years to finding a place in the world, to fulfil herself professionally and to develop her artistic talent, only at this moment does she seem to be ready to meet her love again.

Here we witness an evolutionary change in the personality of Sarah, who goes from being a woman wholly dependent on the love of the other, with her center outside of herself, to one who becomes independent and present to herself, capable, for both, with the other on an equal.

In the end, the love between the two actors has a sad epilogue, since Anna, although she seems to be sure of her love for Mike, decides not to leave her husband and renounce her own feelings, her happiness and herself. Anna makes this choice, giving up her own happiness so as not to cause pain to the other. The social E4 irrationally believes that the other has an increasing right to be happy. As if there could be no happiness if it involves the suffering of others, which is too great to bear. Therefore, Anna decides to

give up her love. But in this sense and relying on this "crazy idea" he reaffirms his position as a false defect and feeds his envious passion.

11.JOKES AND CARTOONS



Jokes, cartoons and poems



"The only way to survive... is to bury yourself."

The Philosophical Bambina, by Vanna Vinci

A poem...

Pain does not want light,
 nor words that have peace:
 with great weight it takes
 you to love what
 displeases. It is a poison that they
 have given you To hide
 your smile And the ghosts that you
 have created have impregnated you
 with sorrow. Like a prisoner
 insect from time to time you move
 your wings, that web
 that you woven does not
 free you from evil. You believe
 in the Wizard of the past, in
 everything you haven't
 had: your body is broken,
 its breath held. Time flows
 without time, like stalagmite
 drops: like waiting without,
 waiting, lives are
 consumed. The script is
 consumed, the same story,
 without end: try an unexpected
 step to reopen your border.

VALTER M.

It is true

Oh what a job it costs me
to love you as I love you!

For your love my air hurts,
my heart
and my hat.

Who would buy me this
headband that I have and
this sadness of white
thread, to make handkerchiefs?

Oh what a job it costs me
to love you as I love you!

FEDERICO GARCIA LORCA

12. THERAPEUTIC RECOMMENDATIONS AND MOST USEFUL TASKS

By Alichita Rossi, Chiara Fustini and Susana Bayonas

The first step for the social E4 is to give rise to envy: to recognize that the comparison in which one tortures oneself-where one always loses is not an objective reality but rather its nuclear neurotic motivation, that is, an existential distortion, a sense of identity that has served him to live. It is time for him to redirect his envy to a nuclear internal dynamic, taking away the sensation of a real condition of inferiority and deprivation of his person. It is about giving dignity to envy, connecting it with the story of his life, of his childhood, so that he can feel that behind it there is a wound and a pain, consequently he can reappropriate the right to ask for what he needs, to take a step for satisfaction and not remain impotent and mistrust. It will be necessary to accompany the social E4 patient to assume the limits of reality and his own limits, he will have to confront himself with the very demanding and unattainable ideal of himself, with the right to be loved for what he is. In the end, it is about realizing that his inexorable crying and his suffering for not being adequate are a fog that does not allow him to contact the real pain of loss: the job is to mourn the real wound so as not to suffer eternally and, thus, realize that shame is not a confirmation of one's "inferiority", but rather the emotional passion that allows one to cultivate the ideal great to have to be perfect and unique.

To heal envy, you need to look inside and find your own light, reach the awareness that we are all equal and find true equanimity. To heal the masochistic component, it is necessary to undo the retroflexion.

Vomit that mother who one day swallowed. Differentiate from her. Being able to direct his anger towards her (which will also allow him to direct his anger towards the other, whoever the other is), become aware of the hate he feels and hides, connect hate with the need for love and redirect it to the "fair" rage for not having had the place that belonged to him. Let's say that the social E4 must increase the sexual instinct to let go and gain strength.

He needs to go through the pain of accepting that his mother will never give him what she did not give him. If he lacked maternal recognition, he must learn to give it to himself and stop expecting to receive it from her (while he is trapped in the expectation of receiving from the mother, anger feeds back on himself day after day, because the frustration is permanent, and his mother will never give him what he doesn't have, and even if she gave it to him now, as an adult, he is useless, the demand is that of a child, the lack of childhood can no longer be changed, that time will never return, what happened cannot be undone for facts).

Work with the body to disidentify from the introjection. Only in deep contact with one's own body can one establish the limits between "what I am" and "<what the other is" (the mother). It is about breaking the symbiosis.

Once you differentiate who she is beyond who the mother is, once that vomit is made, then you can obtain internal permission to laugh, play and be happy. Then the association of "pleasure equals pain" can be broken. Because you stop punishing yourself (She no longer has her mother inside, she no longer needs to torture herself and she no longer needs to hate her by hating herself).

Finally, the authentic healing of these mechanisms lies in being able to "see" the mother, without comparing her with the ideal that she would have needed,

"understanding" the mother's wound, accepting that she did give her the love she had, even if that wasn't what he needed, it was all she had. And to finally be able to make a new internal incorporation, this time from the good mother that she never saw and valued. In this way, he will be able to integrate that if he deserves to be loved, that he is worthy, that he does come from a good creative source.

While he has lived feeling that his creative source is rotten, he has also felt rotten, because he is its fruit.

It is important to understand dependency, the tendency towards destructive and unloving relationships, learn to contain ourselves and put our own care before the illusion of the salvific couple.

Body work must have a central place to release instinct, the spontaneity of the child who plays, laughs, and moves in the world. There is also a sexual inhibition in this character, but mainly in explicit seduction, in proposing to another. What frees him the most is playful, joyful sexuality. Body work and dance can bring you back to the awareness that you have the right to take up space. It would be useful for you to do group work to experience the exposure and be able to work on shame.

It is also appropriate to integrate individual therapy with group therapy: in a protected environment you can learn to let go and share yourself, as well as grow in the confidence of being able to belong to a group and let yourself be seen.

If all this can be done, we will find ourselves before one more obstacle, a "therapeutic" impasse: at the moment when a state of well-being is reached in therapy, an awareness of the right to ask directly and a possibility of energization and hope, it can be that the social E4 patient takes a big step back. will start to disqualify the achievements, perhaps commenting that they are little, superficial, that the basics do not change, that life continues to feel impossible and other similar things. It disqualifies the steps you take, just as it disqualifies the therapist. What emerges, and it may be that he is not aware of it due to his fear of change, is the resistance to leaving the mask of the lacking and needy, because the fear of being alone appears again, and also the anger at having to accept the real lack in their childhood world and in their daily life. There is a difficulty in accepting the limits, and for this reason it is better to stay in the

desert and continue cultivating the false image of oneself and the distorted interpretations of oneself and of others. If this situation occurs, it is very easy to interrupt the therapy. People with this character are neurotically very adept at "chopping off" therapists and leaving themselves with a sense of helplessness. The great empathy towards the suffering of the other is the polarity of a difficulty in seeing the other in an intersubjective relationship.

Healing Work:

Let me feel, listen to my body, leave my head, breathe, open my chest, my heart, feel the greatness of life, the invitation to enjoy, breathe and let go, let go of the heaviness, the shadow, the character, breathe and take the air, the sun, stop, leave me alone, look at the clouds, the plants, hug the other, let myself feel, bow my head, with you I am, I go and I am, I take a step and the earth is there, I hug myself, I lean on my feet, I jump, I move, I dance, I dance, I sing, I play, I enjoy, I cry, I love, I walk away, I say no, I look for your gaze, I look at you, my eyes smile, I ask you for a hug, I receive your hug, your

chest , your caresses, I breathe, I scream, I get angry, I feel my guts, my strength, my anger, I express, I ask, I dare, I trust, it's okay, I like this, it's big, it's enough.

At a concrete level it is important to work on the commitment, the dedication to what has been chosen to be done, the determination to stop doubting, put structure and order at work, to maintain a dignified place among co-workers, not put yourself up or down without awareness, develop creative leadership skills - to know how to promote yourself, speak well of yourself, to tolerate success and abundance, to know how to ask and command.

Repairing gestures:

- Dare to confront, verify that one is not destroyed, does not disappear.
- Dare to fight for what you want.
- Develop strength from the feet, in the legs, the belly.
- Tolerate aggression.
- Trust intuition.
- Break the taboos of anger and pleasure. Allow yourself to savour the pleasure.
- Feel and enjoy the movement.
- Take charge of the need for contact.
- De-dramatize, leave the drama for the theatre, do theatre.
- Be content with what they give you when you seek valuation.
- More shameless sexuality of sexual talent. Give yourself over to pleasure, not let yourself be robbed by guilt, tolerate it without paying attention to it while enjoying yourself.
- To venture. Become more active, say yes to action without much thought, without lethargy.
- Without shame of one's own talents.
- Contacting the ability to get angry, giving yourself permission, tolerating the energy of anger in the body in the solar plexus. Life has given us an aggressive instinct, letting go of the angelic ideal of not having aggression.
- Organize and structure yourself with daily practices and disciplines, without losing the creative dimension.

Meditation And Equanimity:

The contemplation of nature, observed in the small, with serenity, without clinging (...) is no different than looking at the sky in the dark of night, when we feel to be a part, to be a small stone of the mosaic, we calm down, sim mas ambir: we are well in our place.

Chandra Candiani

Vipassana and Shamata meditation can greatly help the social E4 to see what is there, inside and outside of themselves, and calm the small mind to give space to neutrality and deeper emotions, without being distracted by "emotional overload". This space of neutrality cultivated in meditation can be integrated with the practice of equanimity, virtue of E4, antidote to envy. Being equanimous means being in the midst of the whirlwind of emotions and life without letting oneself be carried away by the polarity of suffering and the idealization of satisfaction. Have faith in the flow of life, in divine providence, because life is full of fruits for everyone.

It would be very healing to meditate on the joy of living.

EQUIVALENCES OF E4 IN THE ACADEMIC WORLD: CONSERVATION, SEXUAL AND SOCIAL SUBTYPES

By Elena Curiel And Yolanda Martinez

Envy:

In her work *Envy and Gratitude* (1975), Melanie Klein defines envy as “angry” feeling against another person who possesses or enjoys something desirable, the envious impulse being to take it away or damage it; furthermore, envy implies the subject's relationship with a single person and goes back to the earliest and most exclusive relationship with the mother” (p 186). In addition, it clearly relates the origin of this desire to have what the other has with a feeling of lack and a feeling of internal badness, which leads the person to eagerly seek the good outside to incorporate it within themselves. Unfortunately for the envious, that feeling of being or being filled with something bad contaminates everything that he incorporates, so he never manages to feed himself, thus increasing his frustration and despair, and this being the basis of his insatiability.

Regarding the voracity of the envious, it could be said that the very envious person is insatiable. She can never be satisfied, because her envy comes from within, and therefore she always finds an object to focus on (p. 187).

Klein explains a specific case of a patient who “wanted to be cared for but, at the same time, repelled the very object that was to gratify her. This woman was suspicious of the gift she wished to receive because the object was already damaged by envy and hate, while there was deep resentment for each frustration. It was characteristic of this patient in her attitude towards others and this clarified her earlier relations with the breast- that she wished to be cared for, but at the same time repelled the very object that was to gratify her. Suspicion regarding the gift received, together with her imperious need to be cared for - which ultimately means a desire to be fed - expressed her ambivalent attitude towards the breast. I have referred to babies whose response to frustration is to make insufficient use of the gratification that, however belated, the feed might provide. I might suppose that even if they do not give up their desires for a gratifying breast, they fail to enjoy it and therefore repel it. (p.210)

Klein identifies several defences against envy that he has encountered throughout his work. Envy is visibly hateful in the sexual subtype, while in the social subtype it manifests as admiration from a painful position of impotence, of renouncing desire, due to the inhibition of aggressiveness. Envy in the social E4 takes the form of idealization of the other and devaluation of oneself.

Some people deal with their inability (derived from excessive envy) to possess a good object by idealizing it.

In a previous section I have suggested that idealization not only serves as a defence against persecution, but also against envy. (...) The great exaltation of the object and its gifts is an attempt to reduce envy. However, if the envy is very strong, it is likely that sooner or later it will turn against the primary idealized object and the other people who during development will come to represent it” (p. 221).

Typical of type 4 is the devaluation of the other as a form of compensation: "The defence against envy often takes the form of devaluation of the object. I have suggested that ruining and devaluing are at the heart of envy. The object that has been devalued no longer needs to be envied. This soon applies to the idealized object that is devalued and therefore ceases to be ideal. The speed with which this idealization is destroyed depends on the strength of the envy. But devaluation and ingratitude are the resources used as a defence against envy at each stage of development.

In the social subtype Four, self-devaluation is very relevant: "A particular defence of a more depressive type is the devaluation of one's own person. (...) By devaluing their own gifts, they deny envy and at the same time punish themselves for it. However, it can be seen in the analysis that the devaluation of one's own person arouses envy again in front of the analyst, who is perceived as superior, especially since the patient has been so distorted. (...) However, I have found that one of the deepest causes of this defence is guilt and misfortune for not having been able to preserve the good object, due to envy. People who have established their good object in a somewhat precarious way suffer from the anxiety that it may be ruined and lost as a consequence of competition and envy; hence they avoid success and competition" (p. 223).

In the conservation subtype, we can see how the subject denies envy and hatred to resolve the experience of loss and the feeling of worthlessness. Envy is not so much the object itself but the identity that the object gives to the person who is envied. The subject demands of himself to repair the guilt and the feeling of inferiority through self-demand, idealizing a self that can be adequate and perfect with the result of continuing to persecute himself, and that retroflects the aggressiveness towards the other (originally the mother) against himself.

An oral character:

Enneatype 4 can be recognized as an "oral character." This character emerges from a suddenly repressed desire for the mother. There remains an insurmountable dissatisfaction that generates an ambivalence between the desire of the other and the fear of receiving rejection and delusion again. The child leaves depressed or angry and throughout his life he will continue to experience the wound of abandonment, but not definitively giving up his needs, which are constantly activated.

The other is experienced as a source that can satisfy their thirst for love, but their need for love does not correspond to their capacity to love and give, since they do not develop an independence that effectively allows them to have a mutual and adult love relationship.

Within the psychoanalytic theory on the structuring of personality based on libidinal development during the first years of life, and as Claudio Naranjo points out in *Character and neurosis*, it was Karl Abraham who first drew attention to the enneatype 4 syndrome. in his description of the "oral aggressive character." The quote where Goldman-Eisler describes this character is reproduced below: "This type is characterized by a deeply pessimistic outlook on life, sometimes accompanied by states of depressive moods and withdrawal attitudes, passive-receptive attitude, feeling of insecurity, need to have a livelihood guaranteed, an ambition that combines an intense desire to move up with a feeling of inability to do so, a spiteful feeling of injustice, a competitive susceptibility, a disgust at the idea of competing, and an impatience-filled importunity."

From the bioenergetic approach created by Wilhem Reich and developed by Alexander Lowen, the constitutive fixations of this type of character are located in the oral stage. According to the Lowenian categories, muscularly speaking, the oral characters are lax and rather prone to depressive states. They have flaccid muscles and a fallen tone. In the sexual subtype we see more psychopathic traits, whose fixations are more phallic than in the other envious subtypes.

Lowen explains that, from an energetic point of view, the oral structure is a state of low charge and low degree of sexual arousal. In the description that he makes of this character in bioenergetics, he defines it in a way that is closer to the social E4:

We say that a personality has an oral character structure when it contains many typical features of the oral period of life, that is, of childhood. These traits are a weak sense of independence, a tendency to be attached to others, decreased aggressiveness, and an inner feeling of needing to be held, attended to, and cared for. (...) The essential experience of the oral character is deprivation (...).

He has an exaggerated need for contact with other people, for their warmth and support. The oral type suffers from an internal feeling of emptiness, and is constantly looking for someone to satisfy it, even if he sometimes acts as if he were the one providing and offering support. (...) Due to their low energy level, the oral type is prone to mood swings of depression and exaltation. The tendency to depression is typical of the oral personality. Another peculiar trait of his is the attitude that he is owed "something."

This may be expressed in the idea that the world must give him life. It stems directly from his early experience of deprivation.

The physical description of the type is also like the appearance of social E4s, with "a body that tends to be long and skinny, with underdeveloped musculature, a body that shows a certain tendency to collapse, and often physical signs of immaturity, with bodies of a certain childish appearance".

From what Lowen describes about the oral character, to which all the subjects of E4 belong, we highlight the following paragraph that covers a little more specifically what is proper to the sexual subtype:

In the oral nature, the love relationship presents the same alterations as his work activity. You have narcissistic interests, your demands are considerable, and your response is limited. He expects understanding, sympathy, and love, and is excessively sensitive to any gesture of coldness on the part of his partner or those around him. Unable to satisfy the other person's narcissistic demands, the oral character experiences feelings of rejection, resentment, and hostility. Since the couple has their own needs that the oral nature is unable to satisfy, the situation is one of almost permanent conflict. Dependence is considerable, but it is often hidden by hostility.

The psychiatrist Juan José Albert Gutiérrez, in his book *Tenderness and aggressiveness*, a work in which he relates, among others, the Reichian characters with the enneagram, devotes a chapter to the oral in which he explains that the fact that this character perceives his needs in a distorted way as a source of tension and anguish, added to the lack of aggressive energy, predispose him to perpetuate his lack and suffering, which "gives us the profile of an important masochistic component in this character, to the point that we can affirm that, after the properly masochistic character, it is the most masochistic".

According to Juan José Albert, the sexual subtype is the one that ends the oral phase with the greatest amount of unit energy in aggressive function. It is the envious subtype that has the most energy to get what it needs. Although, of course, the perception of their needs and capabilities is distorted in an envious way: increasing their lacks and impoverishing their self-image. In this subtype, the smug and brash responses serve to hide both.

Reich mentions many oral characteristics when describing the character that he considered to be a masochist. A difference of interest between the oral character and the masochistic character is that, while the former develops on a hysterical personality structure, which leads him to extrovert his feelings of suffering, the masochistic character it does so from an obsessive structure tending towards emotional introversion, rationalization, and resignation. For this reason, I usually say with regard to masochism in these two characters that, while the oral character dramatizes suffering, the masochist sanctifies it through resignation.

HELPLESSNESS AND POWERLESSNESS AT E4 CONSERVATION

By Yolanda Martinez

The feeling of hopelessness and helplessness characteristic of conservation subtype Four is described in different classifications of depression and masochism.

The interferences during the early phases of upbringing in the mother-child relationship form the basis of the formation of this character. The analytical depression described by Spitz in 1945 made it possible to recognize the importance of the relationship between the child and the mother in upbringing during the first year of life.

The masochistic-depressive syndrome of character (Markson, 1993) describes that "the important thing is in the renunciation of personal needs and pleasure and the idealization of pain and personal sacrifice". The origin of this malaise is "having felt like an unhappy child or a source of grief and disappointment for the parents and having failed in attempts to repair the parents for the damages for which they may feel responsible." "The sequel in his development implies not only the impoverishment and guilt of himself, but also the deterioration of a variety of essential psychological capacities: the feeling of entitlement, the operational efficiency and the initiative". Markson sees the exercise of these abilities as valuable "instruments in the production of self-esteem, initiative, and the capacity for hope (the promising)."

A notable element of the three subtypes is the feeling of guilt. In this regard, Markson comments that this arises "for having caused parental suffering and not having been able to alleviate it". He considers that this "guilt and underestimated self-representation result from the feeling of having been a burden to suffering parents and depressives, whose fatigue and personal suffering have been idealized. He talks about the hostility that arises towards these parents, which would be more manifest in the E4 sexual, while the anger is contained and even denied in the E4 conservation. Identification with depressive parents is an important condition in the organization of the depressive character (Bleichmar).

In all depressive disorders there is a feeling of impotence and hopelessness for the realization of a desire to which one is intensely fixed", explains Bleichmar, through his modular-transformational model. The predisposition to depression is given by "the fixation to experiences of impotence/helplessness, which leaves its mark on the psyche." Because what began as a feeling of impotence ends up impregnating the entire representation of the subject, including his feeling of power to face reality and its dangers. "The representation of the subject as incapable, inferior, weak, creates the conditions for everything to be threatening". We verified how in the E4 it is very common to find early experiences of this type.

There is another condition that can lead to depression: persecutory anxiety. In the conservation subtype they constitute an essential element of character, whether they come from "actual persecuting characters attacking the subject or from the subject's own projective identification of impulses, or from early childhood identification with parents who lived, themselves, in an imaginary world, felt to be full of dangers and persecution". Persecutory anxieties can lead to depression due to the consequences they have on mental functioning: "They disturb the development of the self, cognitive development, emotional and relational expressive capacities, instrumental abilities in the relationship with reality,

one's own sense of reality". Defences that are activated to decrease persecutory feelings severely limit the abilities of the subject, make him feel powerless, defenceless to dominate his mind and to satisfy his desires. Defences of the conservation subtype are obsessive control of thought and action, withdrawal (phobic avoidance), fantasies, and (unspoken) aggressive behaviours. Depression ends up appearing when these conditions occur. Bleichmar collects an example through a circuit: "Persecutory anxieties / phobic avoidance / inhibition / failure in narcissistic achievements / deterioration of the representation of the self / depression".

Persecutory anxieties can generate more episodic depressive episodes, called depressive reactions. They occur when a person "scared by a task to be carried out, and fearing that he will not satisfy the figures before whom he must report, experiences a feeling of impotence, crushing, devitalization". This situation causes dissatisfaction in the person about the task, rationalizing questions that question him, inhibition in action, with the consequent deterioration of self-esteem. It has been proven that once the frightening task is eliminated, depression automatically disappears.

Bleichmar speaks of guilty depression when it is impossible to achieve the well-being of the object and a feeling of moral worth of the subject, and of narcissistic depression when the desire to identify with the ideal self is not fulfilled. Both types of depressions are seen in the tenacious Four, where both possibilities occur. The desires considered unrealizable occupy a central place in the E4 conservation person and have to do with the "desires to reduce the level of tension; attachment desires; narcissistic desires for recognition and worth".

Unexpressed aggressiveness is another aspect that plays an important role in the generation of depression, because by internally wearing down the object through criticism and devaluation, it is lost as a valued object. And if the object is the support of the self-esteem of the subject, its devaluation will fall on the subject himself. This mechanism produces impotence in the person because it leads to a world empty of valuable and stimulating objects, a world that is compared by the subject with an imaginary world populated with idealized objects that are felt, consequently, as unattainable".

Bleichmar also comments on the aggressiveness directed against the subject himself, in the form of self-criticism. "It not only deteriorates the representation itself (the self), but also exerts a negative impact on its functioning. The subject, hating himself, consumes his energies in an internal war, attacks and inhibits his ego, produces ego deficits, restricting any movement towards the realization of his desires. The consequence is an impoverished subject, unable to support his self-esteem".

Bleichmar also talks about how guilt can lead to depression. In this subtype it occurs in two ways: a) "guilt due to identification with guilty parents, incorporating all the attributes of the object, including the feeling of guilt", and b) "guilt due to introjection of the attack of the object: self-reproach, the self-incrimination, is the result of the introjection of the aggression originally directed against the object, in the conscious self-reproach, in the unconscious the object is reproached">, the mother.

Regarding narcissistic disorders, depression can be reached in two ways: a) "directly, because the poor representation of the subject makes them feel that they are impotent, incapable of reaching the object of desire, to which they give for lost", and b) "indirectly, due to the consequences derived from the defences put into play... for example, in order not to expose themselves to situations that produce fear or shame, the

person inhibits himself, renounces interpersonal contacts and learning experiences, with the consequent impoverishment in the development of ego functions and resources”.

“It also occupies a central role in the creation of sentiment. hopelessness and helplessness a traumatic external reality. Regarding the affective dependence of the tenacious Four with the other, we find that Blatt names it as anaclitic depression: it happens in people “dependent on the external object, who live the vicissitudes of the tests of love that this can offer or deprive; when they feel "the loss of the love object", they will react with enormous sensitivity", in an interjective depression.

Schneider, in his book *Psychopathic Personalities*, from 1962, proposes a psychopathic classification of personality. In the depressive psychopathic type, he speaks of a person with a pessimistic, skeptical and negative vision of life. This perception is fed “with a kind of unrequited love” and with a worried look when taking everything “too seriously”. Transferred to the Tenacious Four subtype, the person experiences a feeling of uncertainty and internal restlessness that makes it difficult for them to feel calm and restful as a vital attitude. Schneider also speaks of an exaggerated intensity of "sad experiences". and every rest brings with it the danger that the ghosts that have been chased away will break in again." This personality coincides with the E4 conservation, because in relation to the sexual E4 and the social E4 it is the most active, being the most committed in the assumption of responsibilities.

Millon and Davis, in their book *Personality Disorders of Modern Life*, refer to depressive personality describing extremely negative characteristics in relation to E4 conservation; Of these we can point out some such as the fear of abandonment and the demand for affection. He points out the mechanism of asceticism, self-denial, in which he believes that he must do penance and deprive himself of the pleasures of life; not only rejects enjoyment but makes judgments very hard on himself. You tend to blame yourself when things go wrong.

Of the types of depression included in the *Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders (DSM IV)*, dysthymic disorder is included, closely related to characteristics described in E4 conservation, such as: “Sad or discouraged mood - encouraged... low self-esteem, difficulties concentrating or making decisions and feelings of hopelessness... loss of interest and increased self-criticism, often seeing themselves as uninteresting or useless”. DSM IV points out how these symptoms "are part of everyday experience", not being present in the consciousness of the person that they are part of their own identity.

MELANCHOLY IN E4 SOCIAL

By Elena Curiel

The Royal Spanish Academy defines melancholy as “vague, deep, calm and permanent sadness, born of physical or moral causes, which means that those who suffer from it find no pleasure or fun in anything”. Just reading this definition, it already comes to mind that, of the three E4 subtypes, the social one is undoubtedly the melancholic par excellence: languid, nostalgic, sunk in sadness, self-absorbed and complaining.

Melancholy is part of the human condition and there have been many who have dedicated their genius and efforts to define and understand this condition from so many other disciplines throughout the history of civilization. To specify an origin, we will say that the term melancholy comes from the Greek, *melanos cholés*, which means black bile, and that it was Hippocrates who named one of the four fundamental humours that, at that time, was thought to animate the body. human, and whose imbalance caused diseases, including melancholy, which was due to an excess of this “black humour”.

Galen of Pergamum (131-201) dedicates a chapter of his work on the affected parts to melancholy, in which he defends the existence of a group of diseases caused by black bile and known as melancholia, describing its symptoms in this way:

Although each melancholic patient acts quite differently from the others, they all show fear or despair. They believe that life is bad and they hate others, although not all of them want to die. For some, the fear of death is the primary concern during melancholia. Others, strangely enough, will fear death as well as wish for it. (Galen, *Of the affected parties*, Book III).

Abraham and Freud were the first psychoanalysts to deal with melancholy, both giving importance to introjected aggressiveness. In his letter to Wilhelm Fliess, known as “Manuscript G”, Freud reflects on melancholy and its possible causes, relating it to the loss of libido.

The affect corresponding to melancholy is that of mourning or grief; that is, the longing for something lost. Consequently, in melancholia it is probably a matter of some loss: a loss in the instinctive life (sometimes translated as “drive”) of the subject himself. Therefore, it would not be unreasonable to start from the following idea: Melancholy would consist of mourning for the loss of libido.”

In his *Mourning and Melancholy* (1917), Freud also raises the differences between the two concepts. Mourning would be a normal process, while melancholy would be pathological. Both appear because of the loss of a loved object or situation, or of an abstraction that takes its place. In both there is a state of pain and an impoverished mood, but in melancholy there is also a differentiating component: loss of self-esteem, an extraordinary reduction in self-feeling, an enormous impoverishment of the self, self-reproach, criticism, and self-denigration.

In the resolution of the duel, the subject understands and assumes that the lost object no longer exists and is capable of placing his loving need on other or other objects; melancholy is the impossibility of mourning, because it is an endless mourning. Unlike the mourner who knows what he lost, the melancholic either ignores it or at least does not know what he lost with said loss. Then, and unlike mourning, sometimes a melancholic process starts without manifest loss; this means for Freud that the loss is unconscious.

Freud proposes a four-step circuit for melancholy. It begins with a first narcissistic choice of object; the initial object is the mother. This gives way to the loss of the object, abandonment, disappointment, being a manifest or unconscious loss. There is a third step in which an identification of the ego with the lost object occurs: "The shadow of the object has fallen on the ego," Freud notes. And finally, from this identification, the self will be, by the critical instance -the superego-, as if it were the object. The Freudian idea is that the melancholic, by mistreating himself, is mistreating the object, but since the object has been identified with the ego, he harms himself.

There is an object in the world that was holding the self of the subject, and when the object is lost, it triggers a massive melancholic reaction. What differentiates the subtypes of E4 is the way in which they are damaged, through the persecution against us or against the "lost" object. Melancholy, then, can be conceived as aggressiveness, as a tendency to destruction that, emerging explicitly or not emerging outwards, destroys the subject himself, putting into play a very primary mechanism that is the return against of the subject itself.

Claudio Naranjo, in his theory of the three loves applied to characters, explains that in each subtype there is an imbalance, consisting of the excessive and neurotic development of one of the loves (erotic, admiring or compassionate) to the detriment of the others. especially one of them. The E4 has excessively developed maternal love, despite the cruelty of the sexual subtype, while underdeveloped love differs in each subtype: for conservation and social, it is erotic love, that is, the instinctive part of our essential nature that includes pleasure, the aggressive, the sexual, which is inhibited in these subtypes. Health would therefore come from recovering that part and, with it, the spontaneity and freedom of the inner child.

It is important here to differentiate the sexual subtype, which lacks compassionate love, consistent with its dynamic of getting out of melancholy by attacking the desired and lost object, failing to develop empathy towards the object of love, which appears to its gaze. defective or guilty of it lack.

W. Reich also considers that this repression of instinct is at the origin of depressive and submissive tendencies.

The opposite of the impulsive character is the character of inhibited instincts. The first shows in his story the impact of an instinct fully developed and of a sudden frustration; the second, the constant frustration, from the beginning to the end, of the instinctive development. Correspondingly, the character armor tends to be rigid, greatly diminishes the individual's psychic mobility, forms the basis of depressive reactions and compulsive symptoms that correspond to inhibited aggression; on the other hand - and this is its sociological meaning - it makes people submissive and deprives them of critical faculties (Reich, *Character Analysis*, p. 136).

The sexual E4 is aggressive, the social E4 sad, in the latter, having inhibited its aggressiveness, its resource is to transform it into suffering. Gabbard explains in his chapter dedicated to affective disorders:

(...) the melancholic patient feels a profound loss of self-esteem, accompanied by self-reproach and guilt, while the mourner maintains a reasonably stable sense of self-esteem. Freud explained the marked self-contempt common in depressed patients as the result of inward-turned anger. More specifically, the anger is directed inward because the patient has identified with the lost object. In 1923 (...), in "The I and the Id", he postulated that melancholic patients have a severe superego, which he related to the guilt of having shown aggression towards loved ones."

And Melanie Klein contributes: "Experiences of depression and guilt imply the desire to avoid harm to the loved object and to restrict envy" (Klein, *Envy and gratitude*, p. 225).

According to Gabbard, for Klein, "depressive patients are desperately concerned that they have destroyed the good, loved objects within them as a result of their own greed and destructiveness. (...) In other words, patients may feel devalued because they perceive that they have changed their internal good parents into persecutors as a result of their fantasies and destructive impulses".

Twenty years after writing his aforementioned "Manuscript G">, Freud published his article *Mourning and Melancholy*, in which he maintains that melancholy "is singled out in the psychic by a deeply hurt despondency, a cancellation of interest in the world exterior, the loss of the capacity to love, the inhibition of all productivity and a reduction in the feeling of self that is externalized in self-reproach and self-denigration and extreme towards a delirious expectation of punishment". Later on he completes his portrait of the melancholic in I that we can clearly see our social E4 with his suffering, sadness and self-contempt.

(...) melancholic inhibition impresses us as something enigmatic because we fail to see what absorbs the patient so completely. The melancholic still shows us something that is missing in mourning: an extraordinary reduction in his ego feeling, an enormous impoverishment of the ego. In mourning the world has become poor and empty; in melancholy that happens to myself. The patient describes himself as unworthy, sterile and morally despicable; He reproaches himself, denigrates himself and expects repulsion and punishment. He humiliates himself before everyone else and commiserates with each of his relatives for having ties to such an unworthy person. He does not judge that an alteration has come over him but extends his self-criticism to the past; He asserts that it was never better. The picture of this delusion of insignificance -predominantly moral- is completed with insomnia, the rejection of food and a collapse, psychologically astonishing in the extreme, of the drive that compels all beings to cling to life.

And again, Gabbard reminds us that Blatt (1998) suggests two different types of depression: anaclitic and interjective. Anaclitic depression would be "characterized by feelings of helplessness, loneliness and weakness related to chronic fears of being abandoned and unprotected. Individuals with this type of depression long to be nurtured, protected, and loved. It is also characterized by vulnerability to ruptures in interpersonal relationships, and depression manifests itself initially as dysphoric feelings of abandonment, loss, and loneliness".

We do not find among Jung's psychological types of equivalences with the social Four; Despite what the name of one of them may suggest, the sentimental introvert, we agree with Claudio Naranjo that the traits that Jung describes as typical of this type, such as coldness, indifference, and rejection, correspond more to the detached and retired enneatype Five.

If we find it, instead, among Schneider's psychopathic personalities, in the description of melancholic depressives as "soft, kind, delicate, full of understanding with the sufferings and weaknesses of others. And shy and discouraged in the face of unusual events and tasks".

In general, features of the social E4 appear in all the typical depressive pictures, but especially in the depressive personality disorder (PDD) that the DSM IV proposed in its appendix B for its possible inclusion in later revisions and that was finally eliminated in the DSM IV. current DSM V. According to Gabbard (2003), the criteria for depressive disorder specify a constellation of personality traits that include "a mood dominated by discontent, sorrow, and sadness; a self-concept centered on devaluation and low self-esteem; a tendency to blame and criticize oneself; a propensity to feel guilt or remorse; a pessimistic attitude; a negative and critical attitude towards others; a tendency to brood and worry."

Research criteria for depressive personality disorder:

A. Permanent pattern of depressive behaviours and cognitive functions that begins in early adulthood and is reflected in a wide variety of contexts and that is characterized by (or more) of the following symptoms:

1. the habitual state of mind is dominated by feelings of despondency, sadness, discouragement, disappointment and unhappiness.
2. the conception that the subject has of himself is mainly focused on feelings of impotence, uselessness and low self-esteem, criticizes, accuses or disqualifies oneself.
3. broods and tends to worry about everything,
4. criticizes, judges, and contradicts others,
5. is pessimistic,
6. tends to feel guilty or remorseful.

B. The symptoms do not occur exclusively during Major Depressive Episodes and are not better accounted for by Dysthymic Disorder.

The suffering:

Another significant feature of the social E4, which may seem paradoxical given its shyness and its feeling of shame, is the dramatic expression of suffering. In Freud's words, it is "significant that the melancholic does not behave entirely like someone who constructs regret and self-reproach. He lacks (or at least is not noticeable in him) the shame in the presence of others, which would be the main characteristic of this last state. In the melancholic one could almost stand out the opposite trait, that of an urgent frankness that takes pleasure in revealing itself".

If the love for the object -this love that cannot be resigned as the object itself is resigned- takes refuge in narcissistic identification, hatred is merciless with this substitute object, insulting it, denigrating it, making it suffer and winning over it. this suffering a sadistic satisfaction. This self-martyrdom of melancholy, unequivocally joyful, involves, in a whole as the parallel phenomenon of obsessive neurosis, the satisfaction of sadistic tendencies and of tendencies to hatred that fall on an object and that, by the indicated path, they have experienced a turn towards the person himself. In both affections, the patients usually achieve, through the detour of self-punishment, to get even with the original objects and torment their loved ones through their condition as patients, after having surrendered to the disease in order not to have to show hostility directly to it. (Freud).

This externalization of suffering, as Karen Horney explains and we will discuss below, would fulfil various functions, among which is that of moving the other and attracting their love, but also a vindictive function.

In his theory of neurosis, Horney groups neurotic tendencies into three types of neurotic personality, depending on the unconscious strategies that the person uses compulsively and indiscriminately in their search for security and in an effort to reduce their feelings of anguish and relate to the world and others.

These categories are the following:

- ❖ Submission (modesty): These people tend to submit and try to please and indulge others (get closer to others).
- ❖ Aggression: consider life a struggle, seek control and dominance, show hostility or aggression towards others (go against others).
- ❖ Resignation: their “intimate need to put an emotional distance between themselves and others” leads them to a neurotic detachment (get away from others). (Horney, 1959, p.73).

The solution of modesty is to approach others with a style of personal suffering and martyrdom in which we can undoubtedly include the social E4 with its intense needs for affection and approval. Although this is something that also applies to E4 conservation, and, as Claudio Naranjo explains in the book *Essays on Psychology of Enneatypes*, it is more realistic to speak of social E4 in terms of resignation (estrangement).

In summary, this type needs to be wanted, wanted, loved, to feel accepted, welcomed, approved, or appreciated; to be needed, to be important to others, especially to a particular person; to be helped, protected, cared for, guided (Horney, 1945, p. 51).

Behind the submissive's compulsive search to be in harmony with others, avoiding all friction, lies a desire to excel, great competition, and unrecognized feelings of anger and hostility. He has idealized the qualities of suffering, helplessness and martyrdom and is only capable of sustaining the hostility that he does not allow himself to express if he sees himself as an innocent and harmless person.

The needs for love, affection, understanding, sympathy or help become “I have the right to love, affection, understanding, sympathy. I have the right to have things done for me. I have the right not to pursue happiness but to have happiness come to my lap. It

must be said that these claims remain more unconscious than in the expansive type (p. 232).

The submissive is demanding because he feels "entitled" because of his great need and suffering. Suffering is good for one who believes himself to be very holy, and it will be even better if he can extend it to others.

Suffering is unconsciously placed at the service of the affirmation of claims, which not only slows down the incentive to overcome it, but also contributes to an involuntary exaggeration. (...) He must feel that his suffering is so exceptional and so excessive that it gives him the right to be helped. In other words, this process makes a person feel his sufferings more intensely than he would without having acquired an unconscious strategic value (p. 233).

In the chapter "The Modesty Solution: The Love Appeal," Horney describes how this guy uses suffering, helplessness, powerlessness, and martyrdom, and we find it a good description of social E4, with typical traits such as devaluation and self-denigration, inhibition of hostility and aggressiveness, emphasis on the emotional or a very strong internal judge. Some examples are the following:

- The emphasis on the emotional, which generates the illusion of being intensely alive and of depth that somehow compensates for the feeling of inner emptiness.
- It emphasizes feelings: feelings of joy or pain, feelings not only for individuals, but for humility, art, nature, values of all kinds. Having depth of feeling is part of your image. (p.225)
- The Constant devaluation:

Thus, the process of shrinking begins, leaving you helpless. It would be impossible for him to identify with his glorious and proud self. It can only be experienced as his subjugated and victimized self. He not only feels small and helpless, but also guilty, rejected, unlovable, stupid, and incompetent. It is the fallen who identifies with all the fallen (p. 226).

- The feeling of helplessness and helplessness:

(...) the need is so great that any wish for help seems reasonable (...) in reality it represents the hope that everything will be done for him. Others have to take the initiative, do his job, take responsibility, give meaning to his life, or take charge of his life so that he can live through them.

In general, the E4 has a very low tolerance for frustration, but each subtype offers a different response to it: the aggressive call in the sexual E4, a redoubling of efforts in the E4 conservation, and the response to withdraw and suffer in the social E4.

In this last subtype, his typical response to the frustration of his claims is, rather than a righteous indignation, a feeling of commiseration towards himself for feeling unfairly treated.

(...) he can make heartbreaking accounts of his sorrows, arouse compassion and a desire to be treated better, but before long he finds himself in the same situation.

Horney extensively exposes the functions that suffering has in this neurotic type, which correlate perfectly with the masochistic traits of our social E4, such as the function of giving repressed aggression an outlet or serving as a pretext for to justify impotence and inhibition of action:

The passive externalization of self-hatred can go beyond simply feeling mistreated. You can provoke others to mistreat you, and in this way move the inner scene to the outside. In this way he becomes the noble victim who suffers under a cruel and ignoble world.

Feeling mistreated also has an important function. This function is to allow a way out of the repressed expansive tendencies (...) and at the same time to keep them hidden. It allows you to secretly feel superior to others (the crown of martyrdom); it allows him to give a legitimate basis to his hostile and aggressive feelings against others; and, finally, it allows him to disguise his hostile aggression because (...) most of the hostility is repressed and is expressed through suffering (p. 235).

His most characteristic means of expressing vindictive resentment is suffering. Anger can be absorbed into increased suffering from whatever psychosomatic symptoms you have, or by feeling prostrate or depressed.

(...) Thus, suffering acquires another function: that of absorbing anger, and making others feel guilty, which is the only effective means of taking revenge on them (p. 238).

His suffering accuses others and excuses him (...) He gives him a total cut, for not making his life brighter and not reaching ambitious goals. Although, as we have seen, he eagerly avoids ambition and success, the need for success continues to operate. And his suffering allows him to save face, keeping in his mind ---consciously or unconsciously the possibility of supreme feats, if he were not afflicted by mysterious ailments (p.239).

In the chapter “Morbid Dependence”, Horney develops the theme of the longing for love in this type, and explains how romantic love “is and seems like the ticket to paradise, where all evils end; no more loneliness; no more feeling lost, guilty and unworthy; no more self-responsibility; no more struggling with a harsh world for which he does not feel equipped. Instead, love seems to promise protection, support, affection, encouragement, sympathy, understanding. It will give you a sense of value. It will give meaning to your life. It will be salvation and redemption. It is therefore not surprising that for him people are often divided into haves and have-nots, not in terms of money or social position, but in terms of being (or not being) married or having an equivalent relationship.

And we find in Horney, too, the intense longing for a place of belonging characteristic of this social subtype, a place that he desires intensely and never dares to take, this search time and time again resulting in painful frustration that drives him to withdraw, disturbed by deep feelings of shame, inadequacy, and helplessness. A pendulous movement that exhausts him and fills him with despair.

(...) looks to others to strengthen his inner position by giving him a feeling of being accepted, approved, needed, wanted, loved, appreciated. His salvation is others.

Hence his need for people is not only greatly reinforced but frequently reaches a frenzied character. We begin to understand what love means to this guy. (pp. 228 and

229) (...) t

They must feel accepted by others. Need such acceptance that the in whatever form is available: attention, approval, gratitude, affection, sympathy, love, sex. (...) He is worth as much as they want him, they need him the aman (p. 230).

(...) Being alone means for him the proof of not being loved, and therefore it is a dishonor that must be kept secret. It is a shame to go alone to the movies or on vacation, and it is a shame to spend the weekend alone, when others are in society (p. 230).

Anorexia:

His orality, feeling of painful deprivation and voracity, make E4 prone to eating disorders, and both bulimia and anorexia nervosa manifest in this type, with bulimia being more characteristic of sexual E4 and anorexia of social E4. Freud, in his already mentioned "Manuscript G", relates anorexia and melancholia in this way, attributing it to the loss of libido, or, if we use the words of Claudio Naranjo, of healthy erotic instinct:

The food neurosis parallel to melancholia is anorexia. The well-known anorexia nervosa of adolescents seems to me to represent, after careful observation, a melancholy in the presence of a rudimentary sexuality. The patient asserts that she did not eat simply because she had no appetite, and nothing else. Loss of appetite is equivalent, in sexual terms, to loss of libido.

Gabbard, in his Dynamic Psychiatry in Clinical Practice, in the chapter dedicated to substance-related disorders and eating behavior, makes an exposition of the psychodynamics underlying this disease in which we find correspondences with the social E4.

Most patients with anorexia nervosa have an exhaustive conviction that they are utterly ineffective and powerless. The disease usually features "good girls who have spent their lives trying to please their parents, only to suddenly become stubborn and negativistic adolescents. The body is almost always experienced as separate from self, as if it belonged to the parents.

For Bruch, the origin of anorexia nervosa goes back to a failure in the relationship between the baby and the mother. Specifically, the mother raises the child according to her own needs rather than the child's.

Although there is also a propensity to anorexia in enneatype Three, this would have more to do with a motivation to "get better", increase their attractiveness and be the best, and although we cannot forget that the E4 it is also located in the enneagram on the side of the image, we can understand anorexia in the envious as a manifestation of the difficulty of this enneatype to integrate what nourishes him, thus remaining lacking and in need of his voracity, in addition of being another way of suffering and punishing those around him. Gabbard collects from Palazzoli and Boris what, it seems to us, perfectly explains how the E4 deficiency motivation sustains the dynamics of this disease:

Selvini Palazzoli (1978) noted that patients with anorexia nervosa have been unable to separate psychologically from their mothers, resulting in a failure to achieve any stable sense of their own bodies. The body is then often perceived as being inhabited by an introjected bad mother, and starvation may be an attempt to stop the growth of this intrusive and hostile internal object.

Boris (1984b) noted that intense greed forms the heart of anorexia nervosa. (...) Through projective identification, the representation of the self, gluttonous and demanding, is transferred to the parents.

In a formulation influenced by Kleinian thought, Boris conceptualized anorexia nervosa as an inability to receive good things from others due to an inordinate desire for possession. Any act of receiving food or love honestly confronts these patients with the fact that they cannot have what they want. His solution is to receive nothing from anyone. Envy and greed are often closely linked in the unconscious. The patient is envious of the mother's good possessions—love, compassion, nurturing—but receiving these things increases her envy. Giving them up implies the unconscious fantasy of harming what is envied, as the fox does in Aesop's fable who argued that the grapes he could not reach were sour.

The patient conveys the following message: "Since there is nothing good available for me to possess, so I simply give up all my desires." Such renunciation makes the anorexic patient the object of others' desire and, in her fantasy, the object of their envy and admiration because they are "impressed" by her self-control. Food symbolizes the positive qualities of others that she desires in herself; being enslaved by hunger is preferable to wishing to possess the mother figure.

And, as Juan José Albert explains, if the social E4 also has conservation as its second subtype, it will be joined by an extreme tenacity that will greatly complicate the remission of the picture anorexic.

Bruch then understood the behavior of the anorexic patient as a frantic effort to gain admiration and validation. as a unique and special person with extraordinary attributes.

E4 SEXUAL HISTRIONISM AND BORDERLINE DISORDER

The sexual ones, due to their high degree of histrionics, fueled by the greater use of the projection defense mechanism, are the most extroverted; of the three subtypes they are the most histrionic. This subtype presents problems, sometimes important ones, with limits. They are invasive in the relationship with others and tend to establish a form of anaclitic link typical of the limit or borderline organization. The individuals of the social subtype, the shameful, also tend to establish this type of relationship, but their style is more submissive, while that of the sexual ones is demanding and manipulative. In the words of Jean Bergeret: "As the etymology indicates, the Greek term anaclitos means to be thrown back, lying on one's back, in an essentially passive manner". "The meanings derived from the term anaclitos account for the movements of "withdrawing into", "leaning towards", "leaning against". And this is precisely the characteristic characteristic of the borderline organization. It is necessary to lean on the interlocutor, either in passive waiting and begging for positive satisfaction, or in much more aggressive manipulations, obvious or not, of that indispensable partner".

E4 SEXUAL, E4 SOCIAL. BORDERLINE DISORDER:

By Elena Curiel

In the current DSM V,¹⁸ we find correspondences with the social E4 and with the sexual E4 in the personality disorder picture, included in Group B, called borderline personality disorder. The difference is that the sexual E4 is more expressive and impulsive in action, complaining aggressively, while the social, more inhibited, tends to experience emotional ups and downs in privacy, complaining with tears and a painful expression of his suffering, albeit equally intense.

Diagnostic criteria.

Dominant pattern of instability in interpersonal relationships, self-image and affect, and intense impulsivity, beginning in early adulthood and present in various contexts, manifesting in five or more of the cases. following facts:

- a) Desperate efforts to avoid real or imagined homelessness.
- b) Pattern of unstable and intense interpersonal relationships that is characterized by an alternation between the extremes of idealization and devaluation.
- c) Alteration of the identity instability and intense and persistent self-image and sense of self.
- d) Impulsivity in two or more areas that are potentially self-injurious (for example spending, sex, drugs, reckless driving, binge eating...).
- e) Behavior, attitude or recurring threats of suicide or self-injurious behavior.

- a) Affective instability due to marked mood reactivity (for example, intense episodes of dysphoria, intense irritability or anxiety that usually lasts a few hours and rarely more than a few days).
- b) Chronicle feeling of emptiness.
- c) Inappropriate and intense anger or difficulty controlling anger (for example, frequent display of temper, constant anger, recurrent physical fights...)
- d) Transient stress-related paranoid ideations or more serious dissociative symptoms.

People with borderline personality disorder make frantic efforts to avoid real or imagined abandonment (Criterion 1). The perception of impending separation or rejection or the loss of external structure can lead to profound changes in self-image, affect, cognition, and behavior. These individuals are very sensitive to environmental circumstances, they experience an intense fear of abandonment and inappropriate anger even when faced with a real time-limited separation or when unavoidable changes in plans occur. (...) They may believe that this "abandonment" implies that they are "bad." These fears of abandonment are related to an intolerance of loneliness and the need to have other people with them.

People with this disorder have a pattern of unstable and intense relationships (Criterion 2). They may idealize caregivers or potential lovers on the first or second date, demand to spend too much time together and share the most intimate details of a relationship too soon. However, they can quickly switch from idealizing to devaluing people, and feel that the other person doesn't care too much, doesn't give them enough, or "doesn't have enough time for them."

These people can understand and care for others, but only with the expectation that that person will "be there" for their own needs when asked. These individuals are prone to sudden and dramatic changes in their view of others who, alternatively, may be seen as their best supporter or cruel punisher. These changes often reflect disappointment with a caregiver whose parenting qualities have been idealized or whose rejection or abandonment is expected.

There may be an identity disturbance characterized by a markedly and persistently unstable self-image or sense of self (Criterion 3). There are sudden and dramatic changes in self-image, characterized by changing goals, values, and professional aspirations. There may be sudden changes in opinions and projects about the profession, sexual identity, values, and types of friends. These individuals can suddenly shift from the role of a needy person pleading for help, to an avenging person willing to make amends for mistreatment. Although they usually have a bad or harmful self image, people with this disorder sometimes have the feeling that they don't exist at all. These experiences often occur in situations where the individual feels a lack of a meaningful relationship, care, and support. They tend to perform worse in unstructured situations at work or school.

Individuals with borderline personality disorder exhibit impulsivity, plus sexually explicit E4, in at least two areas that are potentially harmful to themselves (Criterion 4). They may gamble pathologically, spend money irresponsibly, indulge in binge eating, using substances of abuse, having unprotected sex or reckless driving.

People with this disorder often exhibit recurrent suicidal behaviors, gestures, or threats, in addition to behaviors self-injurious actions (Criterion 5).

People with borderline personality disorder demonstrate affective instability that is due to marked mood reactivity (for example, episodes of intense dysphoria, irritability, or anxiety that usually last a few hours, rarely more than a few days) (Criterion 6). The usual dysphoric mood of people with this disorder is often interrupted by periods of anger, panic, or despair and is rarely relieved by moments of well-being or contentment. These episodes may reflect the individual's extreme reactivity to interpersonal stressors.

People with borderline personality disorder often complain of chronic feelings of emptiness (Criterion 7). They are also easily bored and may constantly look for something to do.

In addition, they express anger inappropriately and intensely and have great difficulty controlling it (Criterion 8). They tend to come out very sarcastically, with long-lasting resentments and verbal outbursts. They feel anger often triggered when they perceive a caregiver or lover to be neglectful, distant, indifferent, or intending to abandon them. Such expressions of anger lead to feelings of shame and guilt, which in turn help reinforce the thought that they are bad.

During periods of extreme stress, transient paranoid ideation or dissociative symptoms (e.g. depersonalization) may occur (Criterion 9).

Referring to suicide, suicide attempts or self-mutilation typical of this disorder, it is stated: "These self-destructive acts may be precipitated by fears of separation or rejection, or by the expectation of having to assume greater responsibility. Self-mutilation can occur during experiences dissociative and often provides relief by reaffirming their ability to feel or expiating a bad feeling.

Continuing with the rest of the criteria set out there, which coincide with the characteristics of the sexual subtype, we find that: "Subjects with borderline personality disorder may present affective instability that is due to a notable reactivity of the mood." And he goes on to say: "(...) they may be tormented by chronic feelings of emptiness. They get bored easily and are always looking for something to do. Individuals with borderline personality disorder often express inappropriate and intense anger or have problems controlling anger. They may display extreme sarcasm, lingering bitterness, or verbal explosions. Anger is often triggered when they consider a caretaker or lover to be neglectful, suppressive, uncaring, or abandoning them. These expressions of anger are often followed by shame and guilt and contribute to their feeling of being bad.

As expected, and as we will see later, aspects of his childhood even coincide. "(...) in the childhood histories of subjects with borderline personality disorder" where "physical and sexual abuse, negligence in their care, hostile conflicts and early loss or parental separation are frequent."

Associated aspects that support the diagnosis:

People with borderline personality disorder may show a pattern of boycotting themselves when they are about to reach a goal (for example, they drop out of college just before graduation, they become severely worse after having treated the progress in therapy, break a good relationship when it is evident that the relationship can last). Some individuals develop psychotic-like symptoms (eg, hallucinations, body image distortions, reference ideas, hypnagogic phenomena) during times of stress. Individuals with this disorder may feel more secure with transitional objects (ie, a pet or inanimate possession) than in interpersonal relationships. Premature death by suicide may occur, especially in those with comorbid depression or substance use disorders. There may be physical disability because of self-inflicted abusive behaviours or failed suicide attempts. Recurring job loss, interruption of education, and separation or divorce are also common. Physical and sexual abuse, neglect, hostile conflict, and premature loss of parents are common in the childhood history of people with borderline personality disorder. The most common coexisting disorders are depressive and bipolar disorders, substance use disorders, eating disorders (especially bulimia nervosa), post-traumatic stress disorder, and attention deficit disorder.

BACKPART OF THE BOOK:

The definitive work on the enneagram comprises nine volumes that bring together all the knowledge generated by Claudio Naranjo and his team on the 27 types of personality.

Envy is the passion to control and calibrate one's own existence by comparing it with that of another. Their objective is not to satisfy themselves, but to perpetuate a state of unhappiness and lack with which people of this character try to fill their existential void.

The envious person idealizes love so much that nothing and no one can satisfy him, while condemning himself to look at the other with eternally demanding eyes. The subtypes of envy are also the most contrasting in the Enneagram, with great differences between the self-sacrificing ones who have learned to introject their voracity and swallow their tears, the haters-competitive, with intense cannibalistic desires, and the melancholic species. complaining mermaids with an exaggerated affective dependence who, at the same time, know how to stimulate in others their need to feel protected.

Envy, the seventh volume of the work "*Psicología de los encatipos*", describes the enneatype Four as a character prone to relationships of dependency and abuse, with self-injurious tendencies and even illness, and with a great sensitivity to the suffering of others that the own underline function. At the same time, the envious tend to invalidate, despise, and undervalue the envied object, reminding us, not in vain, that envy is the sin of Cain".